THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp * * * * * WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 2, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVIII NO. 54 WSJ.com U.S. Edition

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Bond Rout Deepens Around Globe

Yields across the world soar in a rebuke to countries' heavy borrowing

By Chelsey Dulaney, Alexander Osipovich and Caitlin McCabe

The global economy has a new challenge to surmount: an unruly bond market that is sending borrowing costs to their highest levels in decades.

A rout in bond markets deepened on Tuesday when Japan's 10-year bond yield touched 3% for the first time since 1996. Markets in other heavily indebted nations had their own superlatives. The U.K.'s 30-year bond yield hit the highest level since 1998. Bond yields in Germany and France rose to their highest levels in more than a decade. The 10-year U.S. Treasury yield climbed closer to 4.8%, a level last touched in January 2025.

The run-up in interest rates has profound consequences for the global economy, heaping pressure on everyone from home buyers to credit-card holders and especially governments, which have borrowed heavily in recent years.

The bond selloff has been building for weeks and reflects a number of drivers. A jump in oil prices this week after fighting resumed in the Persian Gulf was the latest catalyst. When energy prices rise and feed through to the economy, bond investors demand higher yields to compensate for higher inflation.

Heavily indebted countries—including the U.S.—have been hit hardest. This reflects

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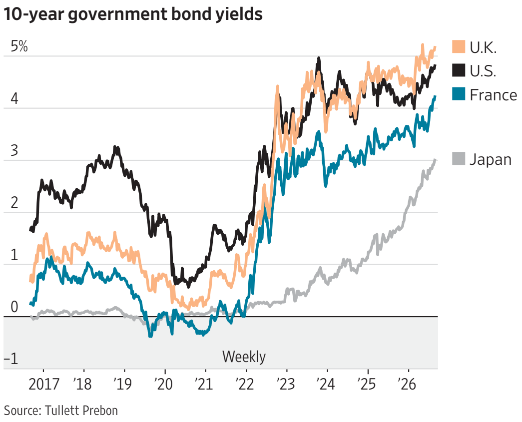
◆ War complicates Fed's next move........ A2

◆ Heard on the Street: Oil prices hit bond market... B12



Source: Tullett Prebon

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **An unruly bond market** that is sending borrowing costs to their highest levels in decades is sending sovereign debt issuers and consumers in hock to creditors. In U.S. stock trading, the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow fell 0.7%, 1% and 0.8%, respectively. **A1**

◆ **The G-20 finance** ministers' gathering came to an awkward close amid bickering over tariffs, public insults and a row over a group photo. **A1**

◆ **Eurozone inflation** rose for a third straight month in August, reinforcing expectations that the ECB will raise its key interest rate next week. **A9**

◆ **OpenAI in a legal filing** hit back at an Apple lawsuit accusing employees of the artificial-intelligence lab of stealing trade secrets. **B1**

◆ **Nestlé will sell its** mainstream vitamins, supplements and minerals business for $1 billion to Boston-based private-equity firm Yellow Wood Partners. **B2**

◆ **Medtronic raised** its outlook for the year after posting higher fiscal first-quarter profit and sales driven in part by contributions from newer growth platforms. **B2**

◆ **Novartis halted** eight clinical trials of an experimental therapy targeting autoimmune and neurological disorders after three patients died. **B2**

◆ **Gap tapped the** designer who turned Coach into a household name to create a new line of handbags using Gap's signature fleece and denim. **B3**

◆ **Chobani bought out** Keurig Dr Pepper's minority stake in the yogurt maker ahead of the seller's planned spinoff of its coffee business. **B3**

Worldwide

◆ **The U.S. carried out** new strikes on Iranian targets and Iran responded by firing missiles and drones across the Persian Gulf. Jordan, which hosts U.S. servicemembers in bases across its territory, reported engaging 13 ballistic missiles that entered its airspace. **A7**

◆ **Massachusetts Sen.** Ed Markey beat back a Democratic primary challenge from Rep. Seth Moulton in a fight that focused on the 80-year-old Markey's age and the future of the party. **A4**

◆ **The House voted** to censure Rep. Chuck Edwards over allegations he sexually harassed two young female staffers and created a hostile work environment. **A4**

◆ **The House passed** a bipartisan resolution to fund the government past a Sept. 30 deadline, with representatives eager to avoid a shutdown as they focus on the midterms. **A4**

◆ **Germany accused Russia** of being behind a plot to send explosive drones to a German air-port last month and pledged to retaliate against Moscow. **A6**

◆ **Trump administration** officials are escalating an immigration crackdown on commercial truck drivers. **A3**

◆ **The man accused** of killing conservative activist Charlie Kirk potentially faces the death penalty after a judge ruled there was enough evidence to warrant a trial for aggravated murder. **A3**

◆ **The woman who died** in a stabbing attack in New York City's Times Square was identified as a vice president at Bank of America. **A3**

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Cuba's Schools Reopen Amid Power, Water Crises

YAMIL LAGE/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

CHALLENGES: Children in Havana line up beneath portraits of revolutionary leaders Che Guevara and Fidel Castro on Tuesday. The first day of classes came as the island grapples with power, water and fuel shortages compounded by a U.S. oil embargo.

Summit Ends With Tension as U.S. Allies Push Back

ASHEVILLE, N.C.—Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent sought this week to convince global economic leaders that growth can outrun debt, but the G-20 gathering here ended Tuesday amid a global bond-market selloff, bickering over tariffs and a squabble over a group photo.

By Matt Grossman, Brian Schwartz, Paul Vieira and Kim Mackrael

The disconnect between the sideline feuds—a renamed Great Lake, a photo with a Russian minister—and the growing stress in global markets raised fears among many investors that leaders aren't confronting

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Humble Debut for Shein IPO

Shein, the Chinese fast-fashion giant, made a subdued stock-market debut on Tuesday. Shares fell as much as 10% on the Hong Kong exchange before rebounding to close at the initial public offering price. Early Wednesday, the stock was down 3.3%. The valuation at the close was about $26 billion—a far cry from its 2022 peak, when it was valued at $100 billion in a funding round. **B1**

Note: HK$20=$2.55 Source: FactSet

Al Qaeda-Houthi Alliance Stirs New Trouble for U.S.

The militants threaten another Middle East oil-shipping route

By Michael M. Phillips

On a balmy evening, Jibril "One-Armed" Yahya Ali and his new bride set out for a honeymoon drive along the beach outside al-Ghaydah, Yemen.

Jibril, a Somali, and his Yemeni wife had met through a mutual acquaintance, an arms dealer who helped Jibril buy military-grade weapons from Yemen's Houthi rebels. Jibril would then smuggle the arms to al-Shabaab, an Islamist insurgent group fighting to overthrow the government in Somalia.

The budding alliance benefited both sides. Al-Shabaab, the world's richest al Qaeda wing, had cash but needed weapons and training. The Houthis had sophisticated arms and tech know-how, but coveted money and a new perch for attacks against the West.

The exchange also made Jibril a target.

On Feb. 12, four months after Jibril married Budoor Murshid, the couple took the Toyota Corolla on their sunset drive. Budoor's phone rang. They parked, and Budoor

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U.S., Iran Trade Fire

Trump answers Iranian attacks on ships, mining of Strait of Hormuz with new strikes............. A7

Londoners Are Stewing Over Illegally Parked Ferraris

* * *

Tony neighborhoods clogged with foreign supercars bearing tickets drivers won't pay

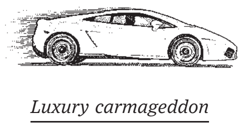
By Eliot Brown And Kate Lynch

LONDON—A midnight-black Land Rover Defender P400 recently slid up next to some trash bags in a no-parking zone outside Harrods and nestled against the curb at an angle, its rear protruding into the street.

The driver of the slick SUV bearing Qatari plates shifted into park, stepped out and headed into the tony department store. Cars honked as they snaked by.

The luxury lanes of London have a pesky problem: foreign supercars that park where they see fit, racking up tickets the drivers don't pay.

London's priciest neighborhoods are showcases for ostentatious automobiles at all times of year, V12 engines roaring through streets where speed limits top out at 20 miles-per-hour. The neighborhoods become particularly clogged with Ferraris, Lamborghinis and McLarens bearing Middle East plates in the summer, as their drivers escape the Gulf's scorching heat.



Luxury carmageddon

Underground parking garages are scant in London's gilded precincts. Capacious Rolls-Royces and Bentleys rub bumpers with plebeian Honda Civics and Fiats, all seeking streetside spaces.

When parking spots are scarce, supercar drivers often

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Russia Skirts Sanctions Through Island Haven

By Noemie Bisserbe And Thomas Grove

MALÉ, Maldives—The white-sand beaches, turquoise waters and secluded luxury resorts of this South Asian archipelago attract millions of tourists each year. But a new trade has quietly emerged behind the postcard-perfect backdrop: a web of companies helping Russia evade sanctions.

Hundreds of millions of dollars in goods that are restricted or destined for companies under sanction have changed hands at the airport, according to documents reviewed by The Wall Street Journal and interviews with Western officials. Some of these goods serve both civilian and military uses. The airport's cargo holds are often filled with aircraft parts, electronic components and other restricted goods, according to the documents and officials.

The amount of goods flowing through the Maldives is relatively small when compared with Russia's biggest channels for sanctions evasion, including China, Turkey and the United Arab Emirates, which together account for about $15 billion in restricted Russian imports annually. But the flow of goods through the Maldives, which hasn't previously been reported, shows how expansive Russia's efforts to thwart Western restrictions are.

Through more than four years of war, Moscow has repeatedly shown it can find the gaps in sanctions, leaving Western officials playing a game of whack-a-mole as they try to halt the flow of goods that sustain Russia's war effort and economy.

The documents reviewed by the Journal—air waybills, a cargo manifest, and emails between logistics companies—paint a picture of how the system in the Maldives works.

A commercial flight operated

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EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

PERSONAL JOURNAL

Sorting out the differences among fast passes through airport security. **A10**

IMAGN IMAGES/REUTERS

SPORTS

Stan Kroenke expands his sports empire with $4 billion Angels purchase. **A16**

U.S. NEWS

Iran War Complicates the Fed's Next Move

Rate decision in two weeks is a close call as elevated prices for energy persist

By Nick Timiraos

Rising oil prices are forcing central banks to decide how long they can treat the Iran war's effect on inflation as temporary. For the Federal Reserve, investors increasingly think the answer is not much longer.

Treasury yields have climbed alongside crude prices in recent days, with rates on the benchmark 10-year note reaching the highest levels of President Trump's term. Rising energy costs tend to lift yields either way: Investors expect either higher inflation or the Fed to raise rates to prevent it.

Fed governor Michael Barr said Tuesday that the central bank should begin raising rates this month unless new data show price pressures are easing. "If inflation appears not to be moderating sufficiently, then I think we should act decisively to raise rates," he said during a speech in Washington. He said the Fed had brought inflation down to a bit above 2% by 2024 but that progress stalled last year under the weight of tariffs, the conflict in the Middle East and the artificial-intelligence build-out.

The comments underscore how close a call the Sept. 15-16 meeting has become. The decision will turn on developments over the next two weeks, including the August inflation report due Sept. 11. Three of Barr's colleagues voted to raise rates when the Fed held steady in July.

Fed Chairman Kevin Warsh said last week that he was watching more than the data releases.

In explaining the July decision to hold steady, he said the majority of officials wanted to assess new information, "especially given possible developments in supply chains, investment flows, and geopolitics." By that standard, a conflict that keeps going and sustains higher energy prices is the kind of development that would shape their thinking.

Warsh offered a broader assessment of the moment on Monday. Speaking as co-host of the G-20 finance leaders' summit in Asheville, N.C., alongside Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, Warsh said that the era of a global savings glut—the idea that capital would sit idle for want of opportunities—had given way to "a global investment surge."

DAVID PAUL MORRIS/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Fed governor Michael Barr said the central bank should raise rates this month unless new data show price pressures easing.

While the comment implies longer-term rates should sit higher than they did over the past decade for reasons that have little to do with the Fed, investors nonetheless read it as supporting expectations for higher rates, said strategists at JPMorgan Chase.

Central banks have generally let energy shocks pass rather than respond to them, on the theory that the price increase fades and raising rates would only slow an economy that the shock itself is already slowing. The problem for the Fed is that this one hasn't faded. The war with Iran began at the end of February, when officials and investors assumed the disruption would be measured in weeks. Six months later it is unresolved.

The shock hit an economy where inflation already has run above the Fed's 2% target for five years. The longer that continues, the more likely it is that businesses and workers start building higher prices into their plans.

The European Central Bank raised rates in June and is expected to do so again at its meeting next week, treating the run-up in energy prices as a risk to those inflation expectations.

Fed officials have been watching so-called core inflation, which strips out volatile food and energy prices. That measure had been firmer than expected for the first five months of the year, and even though June and July looked better, Warsh said last week that they hadn't convinced him the underlying trend was improving.

On Monday, Bessent treated recent data as evidence the Fed should stay put. "It is my belief that we've seen a supply shock," he said on CNBC. "Traditionally, you don't raise [rates] into a supply shock unless you see second- or third-order effects, and we are seeing the core inflation has remained very, very restrained."

Warsh hasn't said how the Fed will respond, in keeping with his view that the central bank should take cues from markets rather than guide them. He has said that investors left to draw their own conclusions produce a more useful signal than one shaped by Fed forecasts.

Markets think the Fed will raise rates, if not in September, then by December, raising the stakes no matter what the central bank does this month. If it lifts rates, investors will want to know whether additional increases are coming, which could push long-term rates higher still.

If the Fed holds, they will want to know how that squares with a chairman who said inflation isn't improving and that borrowing and lending conditions aren't restraining the economy.

Bond Rout Pressures Governments

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investor concerns about a potential debt spiral, in which higher yields drive up the cost of refinancing existing debts, requiring even more borrowing. A flood of bonds issued by U.S. tech companies to pay for the artificial-intelligence boom is also pushing yields higher by eating into demand for government debt, investors said.

The surge in bond yields comes despite efforts by finance ministers to calm the markets while assembled as guests of Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent at the G-20 meeting in Asheville, N.C.

Stock markets have mostly shrugged off the bond selloff so far, though indexes fell on Tuesday. The Dow Jones Industrial Average declined 0.8%, the S&P 500 retreated 0.7% and the Nasdaq composite lost 1%.

Some are betting that a sustained rise in bond yields could prick what many see as a bubble in AI-driven stocks.

"We're in the danger zone already," said Derek Halpenny, European head of global markets research at MUFG. He said the higher interest rates go, the risk increases of a disruptive stock-market unwind.

Central banks are shifting to a more aggressive approach to fighting inflation as the war in the Middle East drags on and energy prices climb again. Federal Reserve Chairman Kevin Warsh's speech on Friday offered investors the latest evidence that central bankers don't think the battle against inflation is over.

Investors have increased bets that the Fed will raise rates this month—and be joined by several other central banks. Markets are pricing in rate-increases in the coming weeks from the European Central Bank, Bank of Japan and the central banks of Australia and New Zealand. But bond markets aren't waiting for central banks to act.

> **Markets are pricing in rate increases by several central banks.**

"The situation in the Middle East remains unresolved and oil prices are creeping back higher, which in turn means that there's a risk that inflation will continue to overshoot central bank targets," said Christopher Iggo, a strategist at BNP Paribas Asset Management. "As a result, central banks may have to raise interest rates."

Global oil prices have climbed about 13% over the past month, sending benchmark Brent crude back above $94 a barrel. Natural-gas prices overseas also jumped to multiyear highs as European and Asian buyers scramble for a smaller supply of LNG shipments.

Japan's bond market has been swept by one of the most aggressive selloffs this year, with yields on its benchmark 10-year note rising to 3% from around 2% in January. After decades battling deflation, inflation is now on the rise in Japan. The Bank of Japan has been slow to increase rates, which has been weighing on the value of the yen.

Investors believe it will soon pick up the pace of tightening. Bessent on Monday helped reinforce those bets. "It's my belief that the Japanese government and the BOJ will do the things that will lead to a stronger yen," Bessent said on CNBC.

Markets now expect the Bank of Japan's rate to end the year at about 1.4%, while three months ago investors expected the central bank to keep its key rate on hold at 1% all year.

Rising borrowing costs are also driving up the cost of refinancing Japan's debt load as Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi boosts spending.

To be sure, the moves in the bond market have been relatively orderly and have yet to trigger a broader selloff in currencies, stocks and other asset classes.

Ben Kizemchuk, a Toronto portfolio manager at Wellington-Altus Private Wealth, said Japanese yields are coming into greater alignment with those in the U.S. and Europe.

"It's more like a global repricing of sovereign debt," he said. "Markets are beginning to price in a world where economies are converging."

Rising yields are leading investors like Florian Ielpo, a portfolio manager at Lombard Odier Investment Managers, to rethink their investment strategies that give greater weight to stocks over bonds.

As yields rise, the steady income of bonds becomes more attractive compared with risky stocks. He still prefers stocks for now, but his mind is beginning to change.

G-20 Talks Marred By Strife

Continued from Page One

challenges that could quickly spiral out of control.

As their meeting concluded Tuesday, the benchmark 10-year Treasury yield rose to 4.795%, the highest since President Trump began his second term.

In a press conference Tuesday night at the conclusion of the gathering in the Blue Ridge Mountains, Bessent said meetings were productive, tackling trade imbalances, artificial intelligence and sovereign debt. "With America once again leading this forum, the days of settling for subpar growth are over," he said. "The discussions we've had here this week leave me confident that many of our partners are now prepared to join us."

Earlier Bessent had said: "The world is awash in debt. The only way for us to get out of this is to grow our way out of it."

MELISSA SUE GERRITS/GETTY IMAGES

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent sought this week to convince global economic leaders that growth can outrun debt.

The bond market, however, is rebelling against that premise, as a selloff is sending yields higher and raising governments' interest expense. The argument is particularly tricky for the U.S. because the country is carrying a staggering $40 trillion in government debt.

It was a summit of squabbling from the start. The proceedings had barely begun when Bessent mocked Canada's military, dismissing it with a reference to a decommissioned amusement-park ride. Canadians seethed at Trump's move to rename Lake Ontario as "Lake America" and redoubled their efforts to build closer trading ties with other countries. Other delegates said that the spat between close allies was an unnecessary distraction.

"I think that in this world where tensions are numerous, it's probably no time to add tensions, especially between two historical partners," Finance Minister Roland Lescure of France said.

Meanwhile, Europeans were furious that Russia's finance minister was invited. Russia hadn't previously been invited since it invaded Ukraine in 2022.

Bessent released a statement that he said reflected the general position of every country present except for China, which he said was unlikely to agree to a pointed statement about trade imbalances. The Wall Street Journal didn't independently confirm that all countries at the summit agreed with the statement.

"In particular, countries with excessive and persistent external surpluses should remove distortions that constrain domestic consumption and that result in an overreliance on exports for growth," the Treasury statement said.

Bessent's threats to impose sanctions on Iran's trading partners hovered over his meeting with China's central-bank governor Sunday. Bessent later told former Trump adviser Larry Kudlow at a G-20 event that the longtime U.S. adversary is on their side when it comes to certain aspects of the Iran conflict, such as the need to fully reopen the Strait of Hormuz and keep Iran from acquiring a nuclear weapon. China is a top trading partner with the Iranian regime.

The summit convened finance ministers and central bankers from the Group of 20 rich and developing countries. The G-20 intends these events to be a substantive appetizer for the leaders' summit, which Trump is scheduled to host this year at his Doral, Fla., resort in December.

Traditionally, the summit is held to bring together the top finance ministers and find a way for them to coalesce around joint challenges. With 20 countries, there are often differing opinions and factions. But this summit appeared never to have had much momentum. Even the simplest goals spurred divisions.

Before the U.S. attempted to gather the top attendees Monday for a "family photo," a tradition of such summits, the Europeans blanched. Ministers said they wouldn't participate if Finance Minister Anton Siluanov of Russia was in the photo, people familiar with the matter said.

"The joint approach of the Europeans—for which I am also very grateful—ultimately led to this family photo taking place without the Russian finance minister, without the Russian delegation," Finance Minister Lars Klingbeil of Germany said.

"A family photo at that point would have gone a step too far for me, and that is why I clearly rejected it," Klingbeil said.

Bessent said of Siluanov's presence: "I know that some Europeans had a sour taste, but I think it's very important to engage."

Just as the meetings were getting started, Bessent had harsh words for Canada, saying it was impossible for the U.S. neighbor to be in a tit-for-tat trade war with "someone who's 13 times larger than you are." Bessent also joked that Canada might send minisubmarines previously used on an amusement-park ride to attack the U.S. The U.S. defense secretary, Pete Hegseth, posted a photo on social media of two young women at a Canadian cadet training center that was interpreted as mocking their weight and gender.

"When the Americans stop doing memes, stop throwing shade, stop trying to be tough, and start being serious about having those discussions, we can have those discussions. But look, it's not constructive," Prime Minister Mark Carney of Canada said in Ottawa on Tuesday.

The Treasury Department didn't respond to requests for comment about the summit.

Finance Minister Francois-Philippe Champagne of Canada said Russia's representation at the meeting created discomfort for countries in attendance.

Champagne met with Bessent Tuesday. "The message I am going to bring, of course, is that we are going to stand up for our workers," he said before the meeting.

The Treasury secretary arrived making the case that the Trump administration was well on its way to fixing the U.S. economy. The government is running huge budget deficits, gasoline prices are high, the labor market lost 23,000 jobs in July, and inflation is above the Fed's target. The prolonged standoff between the U.S. and Iran has added to inflation and put bond markets on edge.

CORRECTIONS & AMPLIFICATIONS

Eva Seiwert with Mercator Institute for China Studies said: "Publicly, I would expect Xi to stick to China's familiar language: warning against escalation and calling for de-escalation, dialogue and a political settlement. That would allow Beijing to signal concern about a wider conflict without directly criticizing or publicly confronting Moscow." In some editions Monday, a World News article about Xi Jinping and Vladimir Putin incorrectly attributed the quotation to Tatiana Stanovaya at the Carnegie Russia Eurasia Center.

Readers can alert The Wall Street Journal to any errors in news articles by emailing **wsjcontact@wsj.com** or by calling 888-762-5450.

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Immigration Crackdown Targets Truckers

U.S. officials close driving schools and demand licensing data from states

By Mariah Timms
And Esther Fung

Trump administration officials are escalating an immigration crackdown on commercial truck drivers, setting off a new clash with Democratic-led states.

Both the Homeland Security and Transportation Departments are demanding licensing data across the U.S. about immigrants driving trucks, in a hunt for what they say is a rash of drivers with improper certifications.

The administration has forced the closure of some commercial-driving training schools and apprehended drivers who have commercial licenses but may be in the country illegally. On Monday, U.S. officials said they were intensifying those efforts.

Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy said his agency forced the emergency shutdown of nearly 300 driving schools. Of those, 110 schools were responsible for a disproportionate number of commercial license applicants who couldn't pass the English-language proficiency element of the licensing test, and 160 were operating out of facilities too small or unequipped to train applicants on the intricacies of large vehicle operations, he said.

About 200,000 immigrants in the U.S. hold licenses that allow them to haul freight professionally, representing about 5% of all license holders nationwide, according to the Federal Motor Carrier Safety Administration. The licenses are available to drivers who aren't U.S. citizens or lawful permanent residents. The administration is focusing in part on drivers whose licenses may still be valid or in use after their relevant visas or work permits expired.

A handful of high-profile fatal crashes involving noncitizen truck drivers have become a rallying cry in some conservative circles, heightening calls for increased oversight of the industry.

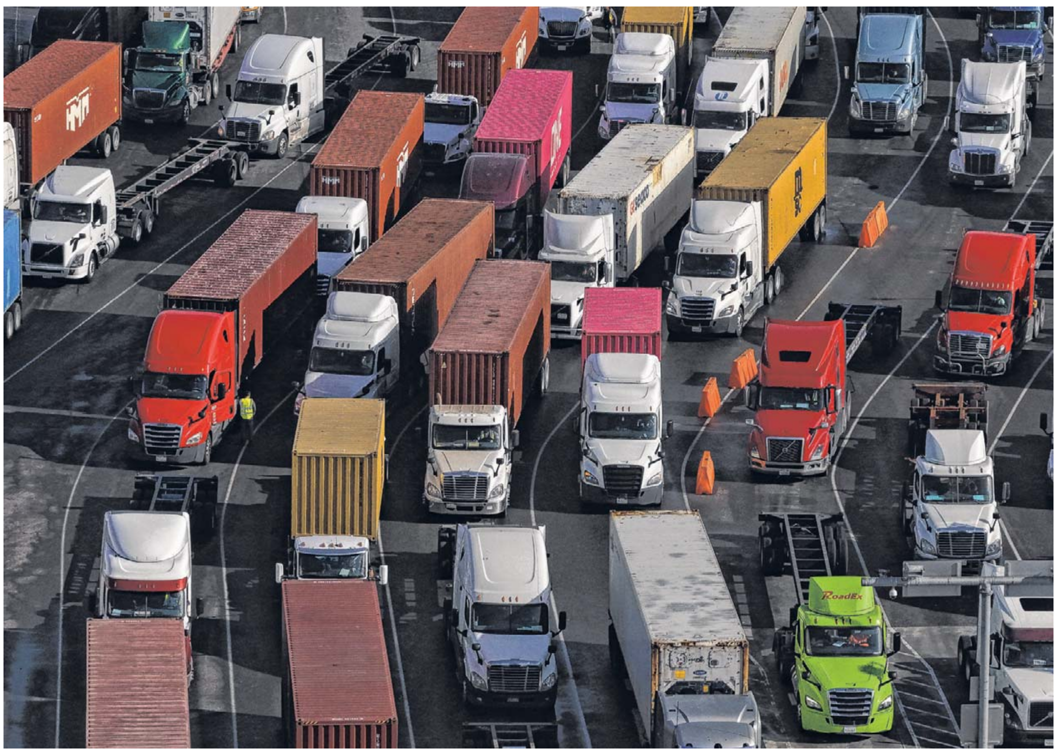
This August marked the first anniversary of a deadly crash in Florida, where a noncitizen driver allegedly performed an illegal U-turn, blocking traffic and causing a pileup that killed three people, according to the Florida Department of Highway Safety and Motor Vehicles. At Monday's event, Trump administration officials were joined by a young California girl who at age 5 was severely injured in a six-car pileup in 2024 that DHS said was the fault of an immigrant truck driver.

Overall, 5,350 people died in large truck crashes in 2024, according to the most recent data available from the nonprofit Insurance Institute for Highway Safety.

Immigration officials have set up stings on interstate highways for months, sweeping up hundreds of migrants who allegedly are in the U.S. illegally. In one three-day operation in July that focused on highways in Illinois, Indiana, Iowa and Ohio, DHS said it took 766 drivers and vehicles "out of service." The department also detained 51 immigrants it said were in the U.S. illegally and issued 36 violations to drivers for failing English-language proficiency tests.

Objecting states say that while federal regulations guide much of the licensing standards for truck drivers, registration and compliance is managed by the states—and isn't intended for use in immigration enforcement.

The crackdown during President Trump's second term has contributed to a driver shortage in the U.S., some freight companies have said. And they are stepping up efforts in driver recruitment and retention, including offering higher wages.



JUSTIN SULLIVAN/GETTY IMAGES

Trucks at California's Port of Oakland early this year. An immigration crackdown has contributed to a driver shortage.

"We've probably more than doubled, if not tripled, the size of our driver recruiting team. They're hitting the phones. We're increasing advertising and marketing to get drivers in," Brad Delco, chief financial officer of JB Hunt Transport Services, said during a recent investor event.

"He who has the driver wins," Delco said.

Some small businesses have said they are experiencing worse service from trucking companies since the start of the year. Shipping rates and fees have also gone up. "If you order a truck, it doesn't come," said Michael Goldblatt, a Pennsylvania business owner who sells tire chains.

The biggest fight is over access to a database that holds information about 17 million drivers, including truckers, school-bus drivers, garbage-truck operators and other large-vehicle drivers.

At the center of the dispute is the American Association of Motor Vehicle Administrators, which holds all the data. The Transportation Department in August threatened to pull the organization's funding if it didn't comply with a demand for years of data on millions of drivers. DHS issued a subpoena for the same records.

A group of more than 20 states sued in a bid to block the federal data demands, arguing the administration is violating U.S. privacy laws.

A federal judge has issued a temporary restraining order blocking the data sharing for now.

Kirk Judge Backs Death-Penalty Trial

By Jack Morphet
And Alyssa Lukpat

The man accused of killing conservative activist Charlie Kirk potentially faces the death penalty after a Utah judge ruled on Tuesday there was enough evidence to warrant a trial for aggravated murder.

Tyler Robinson, 23 years old, was in court for an evidentiary review, an early stage of the process under Utah law in which prosecutors need to show they have enough evidence to establish probable cause and move forward.

Robinson is accused of fatally shooting Kirk last September while the 31-year-old spoke at an outdoor event at Utah Valley University. The event was part of a campus tour for Turning Point USA, the conservative organization for young people Kirk co-founded.

District Judge Tony Graf sided with prosecutors' argument that the shooting endangered others besides Kirk, which is key to the heightened aggravated murder charge, a capital felony that makes the death penalty an option in a conviction. He said his decision wasn't a ruling on Robinson's guilt.

"These circumstances support a reasonable inference that defendant was aware that other individuals were positioned near Mr. Kirk when he fired," Graf said.

Robinson pleaded not guilty on Tuesday.

Kirk's family said they hoped for a timely legal process. "Today's decision, which comes nearly a year since Charlie was taken from us, marks an important step in our family's pursuit of justice for him," they said.

The lethal shot came from roughly 400 feet away and if Robinson was off by just one degree, the bullet would have missed by 7 feet, Deputy Utah County Attorney Ryan McBride said in court Tuesday.

"You can't shoot a rifle into a crowd of 3,000 people without knowing that you create a great risk of death to all those around your target," he said.

Robinson's defense tried to have the death penalty taken off the table and reduced to a lesser charge of murder, which carries a minimum sentence of 15 years and a maximum of life in prison.

Defense attorneys argued in court filings that Robinson didn't knowingly create a great risk to others because he "did not miss his intended target and did not chamber another round."

"There is one shot, there is one bullet, there is one victim," defense attorney Staci Visser said in court on Tuesday. "There was no evidence that would suggest anyone else was threatened."

The fact Robinson didn't reload his grandfather's bolt-action rifle proved he never intended to harm anyone other than Kirk, the defense argued.

KYLE MAZZA-UNF NEWS/CNP/ZUMA PRESS (LEFT)

Erin Piacenti, shown above, was fatally stabbed in Times Square in what the NYPD called a seemingly 'random and unprovoked attack.' The 32-year-old worked as a vice president in Bank of America's global corporate and investment bank.

Bank of America VP Identified as Stabbing Victim

By Jack Morphet

The woman killed in an unprovoked stabbing Monday in Midtown Manhattan has been identified as a vice president in Bank of America's global corporate and investment bank division.

New Jersey resident Erin Piacenti, 32 years old, was in Times Square when a woman armed with knives attacked her and a man shortly after 4:20 p.m., according to the New York City Police Department.

"We are shocked and deeply saddened by the tragic loss of our colleague. She was a valued teammate who will be greatly missed," a Bank of America spokesman said. "Our hearts go out to her family and all of her loved ones."

Piacenti was stabbed in the abdomen near Seventh Avenue and West 42nd Street in what Police Commissioner Jessica Tisch called a seemingly "random and unprovoked attack."

The 68-year-old man who was also stabbed was in a stable condition at Bellevue hospital on Tuesday.

Police identified the woman who attacked the two victims as Pamela Cisneros, 49. Officers used a Taser and then shot Cisneros as she walked toward them brandishing two large knives, the department said. She was taken to Bellevue, where she died, police said.

An investigation into the fatal shooting is being handled by the NYPD Force Investigation Division.

House Issues Censure in Harass Case

Republican member Edwards is rebuked over advances to staffers in 413-2 vote

By Maya Davis

WASHINGTON—The House voted overwhelmingly Tuesday to censure Rep. Chuck Edwards (R., N.C.) over allegations that the married lawmaker sexually harassed two young female staffers and created a hostile work environment.

The measure passed 413-2. Edwards and Rep. Ralph Norman (R., S.C.) voted no.

Censure is a public rebuke and is the most serious statement of disapproval short of expulsion. The vote came about a month after a House Ethics Committee investigation found there was "substantial evidence" Edwards violated House rules in his actions regarding the staffers, who later left his office, and recommended he be censured.

"I'm sorry that my actions, my judgment, or the way that I expressed a friendship ever put either of you in an uncomfortable position," Edwards said in a floor speech Tuesday, referring to the staffers. He also apologized to his wife for actions that subjected her to scrutiny and embarrassment. Still, he said, "regret is not an admission of sexual harassment" and he urged colleagues to vote against the measure.

The Ethics Committee concluded that Edwards, 65, made persistent unwanted advances toward two staffers that included "lavish" gifts, notes and poetry expressing affection, and invitations to intimate dinners and vacations. Gifts included jewelry valued at over $1,000, designer purses, guns, shoes, a laptop, a cellphone, a KitchenAid mixer, a robotic vacuum, and vacations, the committee said.

One woman was 19 years old when she first worked in his state office—hired while still in college—and the other was in her early 20s.

After the vote, Edwards stood in the well of the House floor as Speaker Mike Johnson (R., La.) read out the finding of censure. Censures were once rare but have become commonly used in recent years as a partisan tool. Tuesday's vote marked a rare bipartisan rebuke.

Edwards spent the August recess lobbying lawmakers to vote no. Last week, he sent a 22-page letter to his colleagues arguing the ethics report findings were unsubstantiated.

Rep. Michael Guest (R., Miss.), who chairs the Ethics Committee, said the committee's findings contradicted many of the points Edwards raised in his letter.

"We deliberated carefully over those allegations, and so I would say I disagree with the way or the light in which Mr. Edwards paints his actions," Guest said.

Rep. Teresa Leger Fernández (D., N.M.), who chairs the Democratic Women's Caucus, argued a censure vote wasn't strong enough. "These women lost their jobs because of Mr. Edwards's behavior. He should lose his," she said.

The Democratic Women's Caucus said it is planning a legislative package with the Republican Women's Caucus to address sexual misconduct in Congress. They are considering language that bans relationships between lawmakers and staff and strengthens whistleblower protection.

A series of House members have come under scrutiny for sexual misconduct this term. The Ethics Committee is investigating Rep. Jimmy Gomez (D., Calif.) over sexual-misconduct allegations and Rep. Max Miller (R., Ohio) over claims of domestic violence. Rep. Cory Mills (R., Fla.) has been under investigation since 2025 for allegations including dating violence. All have denied wrongdoing.

Edwards dropped his reelection bid after the ethics report came out.

CHIP SOMODEVILLA/GETTY IMAGES

Rep. Chuck Edwards (R., N.C.), seen in Congress on Tuesday, apologized to his former staffers and wife but denied harassment.

Markey, Age 80, Prevails In Senate Primary

By Ken Thomas

WASHINGTON—Massachusetts Sen. Ed Markey, who has spent nearly a half-century in Congress, beat back a Democratic primary challenge Tuesday from Rep. Seth Moulton in a generational fight that centered on Markey's age and the future of the party.

Markey, an 80-year-old liberal who has focused on climate change, defeated Moulton, 47, who has frequently tangled with establishment figures within the party.

But while several aging Democratic lawmakers lost their primaries to younger challengers this year, Markey managed to prevail, saying he was energized by serving as a bulwark against President Trump in one of the nation's most reliably Democratic states.

With 25% of the expected vote counted, Markey had 65% and Moulton had 35%, according to the Associated Press.

Markey, who served decades in the House before moving to the Senate, succeeded where some Democrats had failed against younger challengers. Rep. John Larson (D., Conn.), a 78-year-old lawmaker, was defeated last month by former Hartford Mayor Luke Bronin, 47, in the party primary. In other House races, younger candidates with ties to the Democratic Socialists of America ousted a group of older incumbents in New York, Colorado and Michigan.

Moulton tried to seize upon Markey's age as a call for change. But Markey was helped by his support among liberal voters along with endorsements by progressive stars such as Vermont Sen. Bernie Sanders and Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez (D., N.Y.), major labor unions and youth groups such as the College Democrats.

Markey also criticized Moulton for questioning whether transgender athletes should be allowed to compete in women's and girls' sports.

Markey will be heavily favored against Republican John Deaton, who lost to Sen. Elizabeth Warren (D., Mass.) in the 2024 Senate election.

CHARLES KRUPA/AP

Markey celebrates his win.

Lawmakers Pass Funding To Avoid Federal Shutdown

By Terell Wright

WASHINGTON—The House overwhelmingly passed a bipartisan resolution to fund the government past a Sept. 30 deadline, with both Democrats and Republicans eager to avoid a shutdown and leave Washington as soon as possible to campaign ahead of the midterms.

The resolution, which passed 370-48, extends current funding levels through Dec. 11. The Senate passed the stopgap spending bill in August, and it now goes to President Trump's desk.

The measure, which came to the floor under a fast-track method that requires two-thirds support, was backed by the White House.

"We want to get a longer-term deal, but at a minimum, let's ensure that we can continue to see government properly funded and functioning," House Speaker Mike Johnson (R., La.) said on Tuesday.

Passage of the measure put off further fights over spending until after the midterm election.

This year, funding lapsed for more than two months for the Department of Homeland Security, because of Democratic officeholders' anger over the killings of two American citizens by immigration officers. Last year, funding for the entire government lapsed for 43 days in a fight over healthcare funding.

On Tuesday, many House Democrats who previously opposed the measure backed it after Republicans agreed to increase funding for programs including the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, disaster relief and federal housing initiatives.

The resolution also temporarily blocks political appointees at the Office of Management and Budget from interfering in grant decisions and cuts off any new money from going to immigration enforcement—including funds transferred between agencies. The provision didn't go over well among some Republicans.

Some GOP members also expressed concerns that the bill included a Senate provision that delays restrictions on intoxicating hemp products.

> The measure put off further fights until after the midterm voting.

Rep. Chip Roy (R., Texas), who voted against the resolution, said it failed to "deliver on commonsense policies," citing the lack of more funding for border enforcement and the delay on the hemp-product ban.

Roy, who lost his primary in May, said his GOP colleagues just want to go home and campaign. "But if everybody thinks that just making nice and playing 'prevent defense' is going to win in November, I disagree," he said.

President Picks Cao For Navy Secretary

By Marcus Weisgerber

President Trump said he's nominating Navy veteran Hung Cao to become the service's top civilian leader, a job that has been vacant since spring when Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth pushed John Phelan out of the job.

Cao, a former Navy diver and explosive ordnance disposal officer who deployed to Iraq and Somalia, is a "true WARRIOR," Trump wrote on social media announcing his decision.

Cao has been serving as acting Navy secretary since Phelan was fired in April.

"The Senate needs to confirm this Warfighter, ASAP, so he can continue the fantastic work he has been doing over the past 4 months," Trump wrote.

It isn't clear how soon the Senate could consider Cao's nomination. The Senate is in recess until mid September and is only in session for three weeks before the November midterm elections.

Trump's announcement comes amid questions about Hegseth's management of the Pentagon. Army Secretary Dan Driscoll resigned during a private meeting with Trump and is expected to leave in coming days, The Wall Street Journal previously reported.

According to people later briefed on the meeting, Driscoll told Trump that Hegseth had gutted the Army's top ranks, firing many of the more experienced warfighters who were carrying out an effort to modernize the force.

"I'm tired of all the churn," Rep. Mike Rogers (R., Ala.), chairman of the House Armed Services Committee, told reporters on Tuesday. "I want to see some stability."

In a statement posted to social media late Tuesday, Driscoll said it had been an honor to work on Army modernization efforts as a third-generation veteran.

"We could not have made the progress we did without the support of Secretary Hegseth," Driscoll said.

The secretary oversees both the Navy and Marine Corps.

Vance Makes Pitch to Jewish Republicans

Vice President JD Vance delivered closed-door remarks to Jewish Republicans in Las Vegas on Monday night, covering a range of topics, including the Michigan Senate race, the influence of podcasters and the U.S. relationship with Israel.

By Natalie Andrews, Marianne LeVine and Josh Dawsey

In a room of roughly 1,000 attendees, Vance disparaged Michigan Senate candidate Abdul El-Sayed. He reaffirmed the U.S. relationship with Israel but warned of "growing suspicion" of Israel among Americans under the age of 40. He stopped short of disavowing former Fox News host Tucker Carlson, who has angered Jewish Republicans by hosting Holocaust deniers on his podcast and criticizing Israel.

Vance is seen as likely to run for the Republican presidential nomination in 2028 and has at times been critical of the U.S.-Israel relationship.

The event, closed to the press, was hosted by the Republican Jewish Coalition, a political-advocacy organization that works to strengthen the relationship between Republican lawmakers and the American Jewish community.

Vance was interviewed by former Sen. Norm Coleman, the national chairman of the Republican Jewish Coalition.

A spokeswoman for Vance didn't respond to a request for comment.

Coleman asked Vance about the booming ecosystem of podcasters, some of whom have criticized Israel, condemned the Iran war and platformed guests who espouse antisemitic views. He specifically mentioned Carlson, Megyn Kelly and Joe Rogan.

Vance this summer was a guest on both Rogan's and Kelly's podcasts. He said Rogan's audience consists of the type of people Republicans need to win over in the midterms.

Many in the audience wanted to see Vance break with Carlson, a longtime friend, who is a critic of Israel and most recently called for Trump's removal from office. Vance didn't weigh in on Carlson.

Vance blamed the rise in antisemitism on immigration into the U.S. and said "what we see is [that] the worst antisemitism grows up when you allow the importation of large groups of people who bring their ethnic rivalries in the United States."

He said the U.S. relationship with Israel is "one of our most important alliances in the world and certainly our most important regional alliance," according to the person in the room.

Vance called growing suspicion of the U.S.-Israel relationship from people under 40 one of the "obvious elephants in the room." While support for Israel has been a bedrock principle of the Republican Party for decades, young conservative voters have increasingly questioned that support.

"My view is what we have to do is articulate why this is in the best interest" of the U.S., Vance said, giving an example that the U.S. is working with Israel on top-secret technology key to the North American Missile Defense Shield.

SARAH RICE/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Vice President JD Vance covered a range of topics in Sterling Heights, Mich., on Monday before the event in Las Vegas.

Photo With Trump? That'll Be $88,600

By Marianne LeVine

Republicans are planning to raise millions of dollars during the coming GOP midterm convention in Dallas, including asking donors to pay more than $88,000 for a photo with President Trump.

The Republican National Committee sent out invitations this week to a pair of fundraising events during the convention. A roundtable with Trump on Sept. 9 will cost $250,000 a person to attend, according to the invitation, which was reviewed by The Wall Street Journal. Donors can also take a photo with the president for $88,600.

A second roundtable featuring Vice President JD Vance on Sept. 10 will cost $75,000 a person. Similar to Trump's event, donors can separately select to take a photo with Vance at the event for $35,000, according to the invitation.

An RNC spokesman didn't respond to a request for comment.

It is rare for a party to hold a midterm convention, but Republicans are betting that the event will boost their prospects heading into an election in which they face the prospect of losing control of Congress. Vance and Trump are scheduled to deliver keynote addresses at the two-day convention.

The president has said that he will campaign in support of Republican candidates this fall, but he has also acknowledged that midterm elections typically don't favor the party in power.

"When you're president, whether you're a Republican or Democrat or whether you're a good president or a bad president, you lose the midterms, nobody knows why," Trump said in an interview over the weekend with former Rep. Trey Gowdy. "Some people like me more than they like the party."

The president attended another RNC fundraiser last week in Texas, where Republicans are hoping he will help their Senate candidate, state Attorney General Ken Paxton.

U.S. NEWS

Wildfire Bill Fails to Pass In California

Debate over who pays for damage, including utilities, remains unresolved

By Paul Kiernan

California Gov. Gavin Newsom surveyed damage during the Palisades Fire in Los Angeles in January 2025.

JEFF GRITCHEN/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A California wildfire bill aimed at paying survivors faster and limiting compensation for executives at electric companies that ignite destructive infernos unexpectedly died in the state legislature Tuesday.

The bill, which followed furious negotiations last week between Gov. Gavin Newsom and top lawmakers, lost support in the state assembly after Speaker Robert Rivas told his Democratic colleagues in a closed meeting that he didn't think it went far enough, a Rivas spokesman said.

The bill's demise, just as the current legislative session ended, leaves a contentious debate over who should pay for wildfires sparked by utility companies unresolved. In particular, Newsom was at odds with state lawmakers over his preferred reforms, which included reducing investor-owned utilities' wildfire liabilities.

As the session wound down in Sacramento, top lawmakers opted for a narrower set of measures than Newsom had targeted.

"I am disappointed we could not deliver these reforms today," said Democratic state Sen. Josh Becker, one of the bill's authors, in an emailed statement. He said the legislation would have helped victims receive compensation faster, strengthened fire prevention, prevented private-equity firms from buying up claims and held utility executives personally accountable when their equipment causes catastrophic blazes.

Newsom had pushed for other changes to a legal framework that currently enables multibillion-dollar litigation against utility companies when their equipment sparks wildfires, potentially pushing them into bankruptcy. His office argued that bankruptcy proceedings end up hurting victims by forcing them to compete with other creditors for compensation.

"Simply put, this measure did not meet the gravity of this moment," Newsom said in a statement Tuesday after the legislation, which he had previously called "real progress," failed. "The only solution is to return to fix the entire problem, not part of it."

The governor's preferred plan included capping some damages paid to wildfire victims, eliminating the ability of insurance companies to recoup their costs from utilities, curbing reimbursement to local governments for destroyed infrastructure and limiting attorneys' fees in wildfire lawsuits. Fire survivors, insurers and lawyers had objected that Newsom's plan amounted to a bailout of utility companies and their investors.

California's two largest investor-owned power companies, **Edison International** and **PG&E**, each shed upwards of 20% of their market capitalization on Monday after compromise legislation emerged over the weekend. Newsom pointed to the selloff as evidence that the bill didn't go far enough.

Shares of both firms regained some lost ground on Tuesday as the bill faltered.

A Rivas spokesman said there haven't been any discussions about convening a special session soon to resume the wildfire debate and that he doesn't expect one. Newsom's statement didn't address the possibility of a special session, and his office didn't respond to questions about it.

Brazilian Billionaire Helped Shape Beef Plan

The Brazilian billionaire who shares control of **JBS**, the world's largest meatpacker, lobbied President Trump to lower tariffs on beef imports as a way to tame rising U.S. prices.

By Patrick Thomas, Natalie Andrews and Brian Schwartz

Joesley Batista, shown in January, met with President Trump a day before the plan allowing more beef imports was announced.

MICHAEL NAGLE/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Joesley Batista met with Trump in the Oval Office on Aug. 20, and they discussed how additional beef supplied from Brazil could help if Trump dropped a 26% import tax, people familiar with the matter say. It couldn't be learned who organized the meeting between the two men.

The next day, on social media, Trump announced a plan to temporarily allow more foreign beef imports into the U.S. Trump said the imported products would be sold at a 25% discount to market prices.

In a statement that day, the Brazilian government said President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva held an 80-minute call with Trump that touched on issues including tariffs, combating organized crime, and their views on current global conflicts. Brazil is the world's largest producer of beef.

Rising beef prices have vexed the Trump administration's effort to lower costs. By agreeing to lower the tariffs on imported beef and reduce prices for consumers, Trump infuriated ranchers and drew rebukes from Republican lawmakers and industry groups. The National Cattlemen's Beef Association, the largest trade group for cattle ranchers, said government intervention will only hurt ranchers and prevent long-term stability in the industry.

Trump's decision to temporarily lift tariffs on beef was met with pushback from Republicans fighting to win elections in the midterms in rural areas. Iowa Rep. Ashley Hinson, the Senate GOP nominee in her state, called the plan a bad idea. Nebraska Sen. Pete Ricketts, a Republican running for re-election, said that "short term policy shifts do not equal long term solutions."

JBS has played a key role in helping shape Trump administration views, even before the recent executive order. **Pilgrim's Pride**, the nation's second-largest chicken processor, which is majority controlled by JBS, contributed $5 million to Trump's inauguration, making it the biggest donor.

JBS has said it has a long history of participating in the civic process and creating opportunities to provide safe, affordable food for American families.

The Justice Department is investigating the top four U.S. meatpackers—including JBS—over whether the companies are engaged in anticompetitive behavior. The companies have denied any wrongdoing and are struggling financially as cattle become more expensive to process in the U.S. **Tyson Foods** and JBS have closed plants after losing hundreds of millions of dollars processing beef.

For JBS, importing more of its Brazilian product into the U.S. would give the meatpacker a bigger share of the American market. Brazil sent about $1.5 billion of beef to the U.S. through the first six months of this year, up 10% from the year prior, according to Agriculture Department data.

JBS began as a family-owned slaughterhouse in the Brazilian countryside. It has since expanded to be one of the largest beef processors in the U.S. and Brazil, employing about 280,000 people in more than 20 countries.

Last year, the company listed its shares on the New York Stock Exchange, a goal it has long sought, hoping to draw a wider pool of investors and cement its image as a U.S. meat giant.

Joesley Batista and his brother Wesley Batista are JBS board members and major shareholders. The brothers were nearly sidelined after a corruption scandal in Brazil almost a decade ago, in which they admitted to bribing politicians and spent several months in jail. They separately settled U.S. corruption charges.

JBS has said it has a robust compliance program and that the brothers bring decades of operational experience.

The administration's import plan comes in response to a continuing shortage of cattle in the U.S., which has driven up livestock prices and, in turn, pushed beef prices to records.

Trump's plan calls for up to 300,000 metric tons of lean beef trimmings to be imported into the U.S. over a 90-day period without a tariff. That total accounts for about 2% of the nation's annual beef consumption.

A larger supply of lean meat from South America could temporarily lower prices for ground beef sold at grocery stores or found in fast-food restaurants. But it could also discourage ranchers from rebuilding their cattle herds, prolonging the supply shortage, some analysts said.

The announcement helped send cattle prices down, a move that could temper ranchers' profits. Feeder cattle futures, the price ranchers are paid by feedlots, are down about 9% during the past month, according to FactSet.

In May, the Trump administration floated a plan to suspend a tariff-rate quota applied to beef-exporting nations. But the plan was put on hold following an outcry from ranchers, administration officials including Agriculture Secretary Brooke Rollins, and some congressional Republicans.

The Trump administration has taken several other actions to try to lower beef prices. It has announced plans to provide funding to boost smaller meatpacking operations to increase competition.

The Agriculture Department said in July it would reopen ports along the U.S.-Mexico border that had been closed to stem the spread of New World screwworm, a flesh-eating parasite.

Apple Maps Altered To Change Lake Name

By Bradley Olson

Apple has updated its Maps application to show Lake America to many users and make it searchable for people in the U.S.

The move follows Google's decision to rename Lake Ontario as Lake America on its map application after President Trump renamed the lake in an executive order last week.

Apple didn't respond to a request for comment.

Google has said users in the U.S. will see "Lake America," while users in Canada will see "Lake Ontario." Users outside of both countries will see both names.

The two tech giants took similar steps after Trump renamed the Gulf of Mexico to the Gulf of America at the beginning of his second term, and other U.S. executives also followed suit. Users of Google and Apple map applications in the U.S. see the Gulf of America, while users in Mexico still see Gulf of Mexico.

The U.S. and Canada are locked in a trade dispute. Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney walked away from trade negotiations after saying the U.S. sought a "bad deal." The Trump administration imposed 50% tariffs on $20 billion of Canadian goods, prompting a similar response from Carney.

U.S. WATCH

ECONOMY

More Job Openings But Less Hiring

U.S. job openings improved while hiring ticked down as job growth slowed in July, according to a report from the Labor Department's monthly job openings and labor turnover survey.

The report shows another signal of a low-hire, low-fire labor market. Available positions rose slightly to 7.3 million in July from 7.2 million in June.

Meanwhile, the hiring rate declined to 3.2% in July from 3.4% in June, with about 5.1 million Americans landing new jobs during the month. The number and rate of layoffs and discharges were little changed at 1.7 million and 1.0%.

The quit rate, workers leaving their jobs voluntarily, changed little at 3.1 million and 1.9% over the month, according to the report.

—Jessica Coacci

ARIZONA

Bar Killings Seen as Possible Hate Crime

Police in Arizona say a shooting at a Tucson gay bar that left three people dead, including the shooter, is being investigated as a possible hate crime.

Vincent Anthony Siqueiros, 42, and Cameron Davis Capara, 33, were shot in the parking lot of the Venture-N shortly after midnight on Monday, and both died at the scene, the Tucson Police Department said. The suspect, Ousman Ceesay, 44, was pronounced dead at a local hospital, according to the department.

Ceesay was carrying a note that listed several LBTQIA+-associated businesses, according to the police news release, and initial evidence suggests Ceesay confronted the two victims in the parking lot before shooting them both.

—Associated Press

TEXAS, LOUISIANA

Tropical Storm Makes Landfall

Tropical Storm Edouard made landfall Tuesday afternoon along the Texas-Louisiana border after picking up a late burst of strength in the Gulf of Mexico, bringing ashore heavy rains and setting off flood warnings along the coast.

The storm made landfall in the small coastal community of Johnson Bayou, La., and was expected to rapidly weaken. The storm had maximum sustained winds of 60 mph.

The hurricane center said Edouard was expected to dump 3 to 6 inches of rain along the Texas coast through east-central Texas, but some areas could see up to 9 inches. Southwestern Louisiana was expected to see lesser amounts.

—Associated Press

Tropical Storm Edouard blew into Port Arthur, Texas, on Tuesday, with maximum sustained winds of 60 mph. The storm made landfall between Texas and Louisiana.

ANTRANIK TAVITIAN/GETTY IMAGES

Germany Blames Russia for Blast Device

In rare move, Berlin said it would retaliate for explosive drone at Leipzig airport

By Bertrand Benoit
And Daniel Michaels

BERLIN—Germany accused Russia of being behind a plot to send explosive drones to a German airport last month and pledged to retaliate against Moscow, a rare public attribution of blame in the widening campaign of incursions and sabotage across NATO territory.

“We do not consider ourselves at war but we are the daily target of hybrid warfare,” said German Interior Minister Alexander Dobrindt, announcing the findings Tuesday from an investigation into the incident at Germany's Leipzig airport last month, for which he said Russia was responsible.

North Atlantic Treaty Organization Secretary-General Mark Rutte said the evidence was clear that Russia conducted a hybrid attack on the airport. “Russia's attempts to intimidate us, to undermine our unity and our willingness to support Ukraine are futile and will fail,” he wrote on X.

European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen said she spoke with German Chancellor Friedrich Merz about “this attack by Russia,” and that sanctions and other measures would be prepared in response.

The drone incident marked a serious escalation in what European security and military officials have described as Moscow's probing attacks on North Atlantic Treaty Organization defenses. Had it caused an explosion deep inside German territory, it could have been an act of war.

German investigators found three custom-made drones involved in the failed attack: Two in a field and one in the perimeter of the airport near Ukrainian-owned cargo planes, said a German security official. All were functional, laden with explosives, and professionally constructed, using some off-the-shelf components, but failed to detonate.

Moscow's moves are ‘state-sponsored terrorism.’

The drones likely were transported to Leipzig by low-level agents, the official added, but would have been piloted by people much farther away. Investigators connected certain individuals to the drones in a way that supported the attribution, the person said.

In response, the German government said it would close the last Russian consulate in the country, revoke the lease for a large Russian cultural center in Berlin, summon the Russian ambassador and tighten restrictions on Russians entering Germany.

Berlin said it would push for tighter European Union sanctions against Russian shadow-fleet vessels, an expansion of the bloc's sanctions against Russians involved in hybrid attacks, and restrictions on Russian diplomats' ability to travel around Europe. The government is also taking unspecified security measures to better parry hybrid attacks, another senior official said.

The measures were decided by Chancellor Friedrich Merz, who consulted with European partners and the U.S., this person said. They were designed to leave room for escalation should Russia raise its provocations, which Germany was bracing for, the person added.

The official said Russian President Vladimir Putin grossly underestimated the West's resolve to support Ukraine and had no strategic response to it. He was now reacting by seeking to escalate the conflict vertically, with more brutal attacks on civilians in Ukraine, and horizontally, by lashing out against Ukraine's partners in Europe.

“The means used—such as the drone configuration, components, explosives and detonation systems—are known to us from other hybrid operations by Russia and its war against Ukraine,” said Foreign Minister Johann Wadephul of the incident in Leipzig.

AXEL SCHMIDT/REUTERS

A police officer walks next to an explosive-disarming robot at Leipzig Airport in Germany.

Germany's decision to hold Russia accountable is unusual. Despite an intensifying drumbeat of sabotage attempts, drone incursions and cyberattacks, NATO members generally have stopped short of directly accusing the Kremlin. The nature of such incidents often masks their origin, making it difficult to cast blame. Europe has been wary of escalating hostilities with Moscow. But Berlin's move Tuesday indicated an increasing willingness to call Russia out for attacks across the continent.

Earlier in the day, NATO jet fighters scrambled in response to drones entering Estonian airspace, said the country's foreign minister, Margus Tsahkna, who blamed the latest incursion on Ukraine war spillover. “Putin's campaign of sabotage and subversion across Europe isn't ‘hybrid warfare’. It is state-sponsored terrorism. Call it what it is,” he wrote on X over the weekend.

When a Romanian jet destroyed a naval drone in the waters close to Romania's Black Sea gas platform in mid-August, the country's president didn't directly accuse Russia but condemned “the intensification of these types of irresponsible incidents on the part of the Russian Federation.” Von der Leyen also refrained from pointing the finger straight at Moscow for the appearance of the drone, which she called hybrid warfare.

The Kremlin didn't respond to repeated requests for comment. Dmitry Peskov, spokesman for the Kremlin, has described allegations that Moscow is behind gray zone attacks as untrue and a pretext for Europe to boost its military stance against Russia.

Germany rapidly is rearming to withstand a potential Russian attack on NATO, but analysts say it won't be ready by 2029, when Moscow could be ready to launch such an attack.

The tempo of documented Russia-backed incidents has increased from a maximum of about 10 in many months since 2024 to around 15 a month since April, says Ukraine's Sahaidachnyi Security Center, which tracks Russian gray zone activities in Europe.

Russia Skirts Curbs Via Islands

Continued from Page One

by Russia's largest airline, Aeroflot, lands each morning at the airport in Malé, where teams of local middlemen working with Russia-linked logistics companies help get the U.S., European and Chinese goods cleared through customs. The goods are then loaded onto the Aeroflot flights, which fly back to Moscow with goods and cargo around two hours later.

Once in Russia, the products are distributed, in some cases, to sanctioned entities, including Russia's biggest domestic carrier S7 Airlines and its maintenance subsidiaries, which have struggled to get replacement parts for its fleet of aging aircraft.

“This shows there are effective channels that exist far outside of the usual suspects,” said Pavlo Shkurenko, a sanctions research fellow at the Kyiv School of Economics Institute.

The Maldivian government and the Maldives Airports Co., which operates the airport, didn't respond to requests for comment.

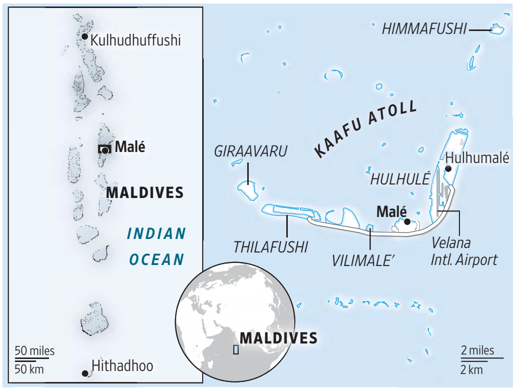
The Maldives archipelago consists of more than a thousand sand islands. More than two million tourists travel to the islands each year—drawn by the clear waters where they can observe marine life like turtles, manta rays and whale sharks. Malé, on the other hand, feels like a different world. One of the most densely populated cities on the planet, the capital's narrow roads teem with scooters and motorbikes.

Part of Russia's success in channeling goods through the Maldives stems from its economic ties with the islands. Russians make up the second-largest nationality among tourists in the Maldives, behind Chinese nationals. Diplomatic friction with Russia would pose a threat to the Maldives' economy, which is still recovering from the downturn in the tourism sector during the pandemic.

Now, the government is making money off a surge in trade, in addition to taxes on the tourism sector. The Maldives Airports Co. made a record profit in 2024, becoming the most profitable state-owned company in the country. The company charges handling and commercial fees for cargo and resells fuel at a profit.

Some of the products that flow through Malé to Moscow are designated under sanctions as dual-use, meaning they could be used for military or civilian purposes, such as nourishing the country's sanctioned airline industry.

SOPHIA NASIF FOR WSJ



More than two million tourists travel to the Maldives each year. Bandos resort, above, is popular with Russian tourists.

Shipments that have transited through Malé include microchips that can be used for both civilian hardware and sophisticated missile-guidance systems, optical instruments needed for satellites tracking enemy troop deployments, and high-strength aerospace rivets and bolts that are equally suited for a commercial jetliner as they are for a jet fighter or a long-range rocket.

Customs data from the Maldives shows a paltry amount of exports to Russia between 2022 and 2025—about $2,300 of tuna and $25 in leaflets and brochures. But Russian trade data collected by Import Genius, a U.S.-based research firm, shows Russian imports from the Maldives, a country with virtually no industry, surged to more than $630 million in 2022—the year the full-scale invasion began—up from less than $7 million in 2021.

Russia imported $160 million in 2024, the last full year of data available from Import Genius. Import Genius Research Director William George said the figures probably understate the true volume of trade between the Maldives and Russia, pointing out that Russian authorities appeared to start censoring parts of the data in 2024 before blocking access entirely in early 2025.

The customs office in the Maldives has limited staff, and goods transiting through the country undergo minimal checks, the person said. Cargo in transit typically doesn't undergo physical inspections, the person said. Instead, authorities rely on paperwork.

Trade appears to only be growing. In July, Maldives Airports Co. said it recorded a historic high in its daily cargo volume transiting through the airport by shipping a record 126 tons of freight in one day. Aeroflot accounted for 12% of outbound freight during the first half of the year, state-run news channel PSM News reported.

Documents reviewed by the Journal show that when a cargo initially lands, the name of the company exporting the goods appears on the air waybill, along with the supposed buyer. Once in the Maldives, however, a web of obscure local companies, such as Freight Care and Go Investment, help alter shipping documents and move the goods over the tarmac, making sure they never leave the airport and avoid formal entry into the archipelago.

Cargo is never categorized as imports and only goes through minimal customs checks before being shifted between aircrafts, officials said.

$630M
Russian imports from the Maldives, a country with virtually no industry, in 2022

A new air waybill is issued for the flight between Malé and Moscow's Sheremetyevo International Airport. The new bill doesn't list the name of the company that sold the goods, according to the documents and Western officials.

For example, in May 2024, Kraemer Mining, a German company, sold pumps, batteries, v-belts and other equipment worth about 9,000 euros, equivalent to around $10,400, to Peretsvo, a company based in the Central Asian country of Kyrgyzstan. The goods were first sent to Malé from Düsseldorf, Germany, on an Emirates flight. Freight Care, which is listed as the first contact for the goods on the air waybill, arranges the necessary paperwork to help move the goods through the Malé airport, Western officials and the company said.

A few days later, the goods were loaded onto an Aeroflot flight to Moscow. Aeroflot issued a second air waybill, which doesn't include any reference to Kraemer Mining or the origin of the goods. The second bill lists a new recipient—Gruppa Kompaniy Tehno, a Russian importer based in Krasnoyarsk, an industrial and economic hub in Siberia. Gruppa Kompaniy Tehno and Kraemer Mining didn't respond to a request for comment.

The Journal found two addresses for Freight Care. The addresses were located in neighboring office buildings in Malé, with the Aeroflot office sandwiched between them. Visits to both buildings with listed addresses for Freight Care revealed no trace of the company's office.

Hussain Waheed, Freight Care's managing director, said the company handled goods in transit in Malé to Russia, but never knowingly helped ship any goods that could be used to produce weapons. “We do not support any war,” he said.

An address listed for Go Investment in the documents led to a small shop selling electronics. The same address was registered to multiple other companies in the business registry for the Maldives. When contacted, a man who was listed as the managing director or a board member for all of the companies said he couldn't talk and hung up. He didn't respond to further messages.

Important Egyptian Lender Is Caught In Squeeze

By Summer Said
And Laurence Norman

DUBAI—When Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent last week said he would be announcing major sanctions against a financial institution as part of the tightening economic squeeze on Iran, speculation immediately centered on China, the biggest buyer of Iranian oil.

In the end, the target was the United Arab Emirates branch of Banque Misr, one of Egypt's most important banks, in a shot that is alarming leaders in Cairo who worry it could rattle the country's banking system.

The Treasury Department on Friday said Banque Misr UAE over the past 2½ years processed $1.8 billion for 103 companies it said could be part of Iran's shadow-banking network, calling it a critical node for the regime.

Iran is cut off from dealing in dollars so it needs the help of counterparts.

“This threat and the U.S. willingness to use this rule is intended to prompt global banks to increase their scrutiny,” said Rachel Ziemba, an adjunct senior fellow at the Center for a New American Security, a Washington think tank. “Financial sanctions are based on a private sector chilling effect.”

Egypt's Foreign Ministry said it was communicating with U.S. authorities about the measures, which don't affect banks in Egypt or branches outside the U.A.E. It also said Egypt's banks are solid and strong.

The sanctions announcement didn't mention the U.A.E. branch's parent in Egypt, but any impact on the bank would be a concern given the fragile state of Egypt's economy.

The Treasury Department said Banque Misr UAE's customers include apparent front companies for Iran's Ministry of Defense and the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps that seek to circumvent sanctions and launder money for Iranian Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei.

Specifically, the Treasury Department has proposed a rule that would revoke Banque Misr UAE's correspondent banking access to U.S. financial institutions.

U.S. and Iran Trade Strikes In Latest Fight

Trump says U.S. attacks are response to Tehran's attempts to lay sea mines

By Shelby Holliday, Rebecca Feng and Yoko Kubota

The U.S. and Iran exchanged fire Tuesday as the two countries continued to battle for control of the Strait of Hormuz.

President Trump said the U.S. strikes were launched in retaliation for Iran's attempt to mine the strait and target American servicemembers in the Middle East over the weekend.

Iran responded by firing missiles and drones across the Persian Gulf. Jordan, which hosts U.S. servicemembers in bases across the country, reported engaging 13 ballistic missiles that entered its airspace, according to the country's armed forces. Kuwait and Bahrain also reported taking hostile fire.

Fighting has picked back up this week as the U.S. and Iran jockey for supremacy over the Strait of Hormuz. On Sunday, Iran fired missiles at U.S. bases after the U.S. struck Iranian launchers that it said were preparing to fire rockets loaded with sea mines into the strategic waterway.

On Tuesday, U.S. forces targeted Iranian air-defense sites, radar systems, mine laying capabilities and communications sites, according to U.S. Central Command, which oversees U.S. forces in the Middle East.

Iranian state media reported that the U.S. struck a wedding ceremony and killed multiple civilians. "We're aware of the reports, which originated from Iranian state media. The U.S. military never targets civilians, unlike the IRGC," Centcom said in a statement.

Earlier in the day, Trump had threatened more powerful measures if Tehran responded to the U.S. strikes. "If the failed Nation of Iran retaliates for this very justified attack, they will be hit again at a much harder and higher level, but it will not be the biggest attack of them all, that is waiting in the wings and, when it is over, there will be very little left of the Islamic Republic of Iran!" he said.

Last week, Centcom commander Adm. Brad Cooper said in a video address that the U.S. had cleared sea mines from the main traffic channels along the center of the strait, known as the Traffic Separation Scheme, marking a milestone in the conflict. "International shipping lanes are open, and momentum is building," he said.

The skirmishes threaten to bog America down in a protracted conflict.

Days after that announcement, Iran was preparing to fire rockets carrying sea mines into the strait when the U.S. carried out a pre-emptive strike on Larak Island to prevent the attack, Centcom said. Iran retaliated by firing missiles at U.S. bases.

The clearing of mines in the main channels has frustrated the Iranians, who have sought to choke off oil shipments from the Persian Gulf, according to retired Navy Vice Adm. Kevin Donegan, who commanded U.S. naval forces in the Middle East.

"The world knows that the U.S. can clear the strait," Donegan said. "It doesn't mean that all of a sudden you're going to see goods flowing through there, but it sends a signal that once we get through whatever this is with the Iranians, that strait can be used again."

Iran has refused to back down. In addition to attempting to lay mines, Iran has continued to fire on ships that are coordinating with the U.S. military to quietly enter and exit the Persian Gulf, according to U.S. officials. Several ships have been struck by projectiles in recent days, according to the U.K. Maritime Trade Operations.

On Tuesday morning, Cooper briefed members of the House Armed Services Committee about the Iran war, said Rep. Mike Rogers, the committee's chairman, who attended the briefing. "They've got a plan," the Alabama Republican said, adding that "I would anticipate" an intensification. A person familiar with the military campaign said there were no plans to escalate.

Though the fresh strikes could ultimately help the U.S. maintain economic pressure on Iran and prevent the regime from controlling the waterway, the skirmishes threaten to bog the U.S. military down in a protracted conflict, even as Trump administration officials say that the U.S. has a firm grip on the strait.

More than 50,000 American servicemembers have remained in the Middle East to execute a blockade of Iranian ports and help guide commercial vessels through the strait, according to Central Command.

ATTA KENARE/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Vessels in the Strait of Hormuz seen in August off the coast of southern Iran.

Attacks Reinforce Perils of Transiting Strait of Hormuz

The U.S. response this week comes after weeks of Iranian attacks on shipping that have tested the military's restraint. Throughout most of August, the U.S. largely refrained from retaliating against Iran's attacks as U.S. officials debated the effectiveness of tit-for-tat strikes that drained precious interceptors.

The fighting on Tuesday came hours after two tankers carrying Saudi oil were hit by rockets and other munitions within minutes of each other while trying to make a midnight crossing of the Strait of Hormuz, maritime-security firms said.

Vanguard said a Liberian-flagged tanker was hit by three rockets off the coast of Oman. Eight minutes earlier, a Saudi-flagged vessel also took several hits, said Marisks, which advises on maritime risks. Both were traveling through the southern parts of the strait along a corridor the U.S. set up to break Iran's chokehold of the waterway. Iran began attacking ships in the corridor weeks after signing a preliminary deal with the U.S. in mid-June to reopen the strait.

No one claimed responsibility for the attacks.

"The near-simultaneous incidents represent a further escalation in the threat environment within the Omani corridor," Marisks said. "The incidents also further undermine any assumption that the Omani corridor represents a reliably protected or lower-risk passage."

Thai Town Gears Up to Host USS Abraham Lincoln Crew

By Gabriele Steinhauser And Mike Cherney

PATTAYA, Thailand—At the Hottuna Bar in this seaside town, owner Suchet Teewiang will open a second counter to serve beers. Other venues on Walking Street, the city's main drag, are staging DJ nights or bringing in extra hands to welcome the expected crowds.

Some 5,000 U.S. sailors will pour into Pattaya starting Sept. 2, when the USS Abraham Lincoln aircraft carrier and two other Navy ships make a five-day port call in eastern Thailand.

For the sailors, the port call can't come too soon. It will be their first sustained time on land since they made port in Guam in December. Other than a brief stop in Oman in July, the Lincoln has been at sea for 263 days. For much of their long deployment, the sailors were supporting U.S. operations in the Middle East. Reports of fresh-food shortages, poor conditions on board and mental-health challenges, including one sailor going overboard, have prompted questions from Navy families and Democratic lawmakers about the sustainability of increasingly long naval deployments.

Acting Navy Secretary Hung Cao has acknowledged the grueling nature of extended combat operations, but said that there was always adequate food on the Lincoln and that "a small number of mental health cases were treated with no loss of life."

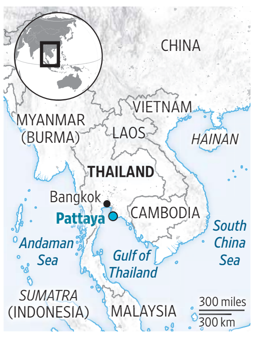
In Pattaya, the sailors from the Lincoln continue a long tradition of U.S. servicemembers seeking respite at the city's beach, restaurants and bars.

"They like to walk up to the bar, American-style," Suchet said of the U.S. sailors that have come to Hottuna to listen to music, drink, and play pool since it opened in the 1990s.

A video playing on loop on a screen above the counter encourages the sailors to forgo table service. "Attention soldiers. The cold brew you deserve," it declares, an American flag as the backdrop. "Order at the bar now."

SIRACHAI ARUNRUGSTICHAI FOR WSJ

Sombat Visetsuwan said he collected garbage from Navy ships in the 1980s and 1990s.



Pattaya was little more than a fishing village surrounded by jungle when young GIs deployed in Thailand visited the sleepy bay in the late 1950s or early 1960s. The nearby U-Tapao airfield became a major base of operations during the Vietnam War.

Businesses cropped up around the bay to serve young Americans flush with cash and a need for distraction.

Sombat Visetsuwan, 64 years old, who lives near Pattaya's fish market, said he used to collect garbage from Navy ships with his boat in the 1980s and 1990s, and often received gifts from sailors.

"When I first saw the aircraft carrier, I was amazed. Thailand didn't have anything like it," he said.

Over the years, the greater Pattaya area—which sits near a port that is deep enough for carriers to dock—has seen its population explode to more than 350,000 people.

The city's nightlife, including go-go bars and clubs on Walking Street and a strip of restaurants on Beach Road, draws tourists from around the world. Hotels from major international chains and condominiums loom over the city.

Pattaya remains a popular R&R stop for U.S. Navy ships and an affordable place for American veterans to retire. The local Veterans of Foreign Wars post has about 420 members.

Shameer Ali, who served 29 years in the Marines, said that as an officer he oversaw troop visits to Pattaya. "It's like New York back in 42nd Street days, back in the 70s," says Ali, 58, who grew up in Brooklyn and now lives outside Pattaya.

Before a port call, sailors get safety briefings, including how to avoid getting drawn in by foreign intelligence services. They are required to buddy up and given curfews.

Ali said sailors would be warned against engaging with sex workers, who are common in Pattaya even though prostitution is illegal in Thailand.

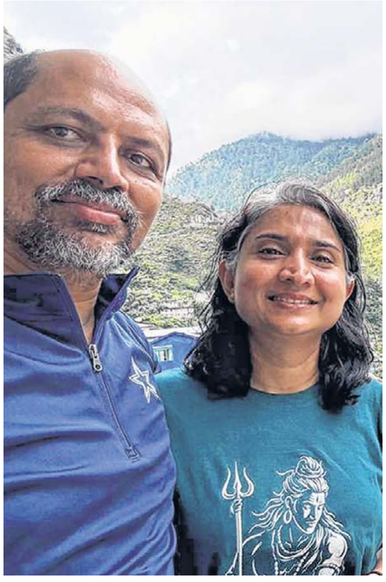
Pattaya's mayor, Poramet Ngampichet, and business owners hope the sailors will boost the economy.

"They have saved up their full allowances and salaries since they had nowhere to spend them," he said in a video posted on Facebook, estimating they would spend about $3 million during the visit.

American Pilgrims Remain Missing in Nepal

About 85 U.S. citizens were among the thousands caught in deadly flooding

By Patricia Kowsmann and Aakash Hassan



Vivek Srivastav, far left, Rekha Shashidharan and her daughter Rashi, above left and center, and Raghu Rajan and his wife, Archana Suresh are missing in Nepal.

Archana Suresh and her husband, Raghu Rajan, of Murphy, Texas, had been planning for over a year to make a pilgrimage to Mount Kailash, a snowy peak in Tibet near China's border with Nepal.

To Hindus, the 22,000-foot Himalayan peak is the home of Shiva, the god of destruction and transformation. Suresh, a telecommunications engineer who works at Verizon and cooks meals for the homeless in her spare time, wanted to see the place with her own eyes, her brother said.

The couple was so excited they intensified their workouts to build up fitness and aerobic capacity for the tour, he said. On Aug. 17, the couple left their home outside Dallas, bound for Kathmandu and onward to Tibet.

Suresh, 46, and Rajan, 50, are among the roughly 85 U.S. citizens missing after a flood of mud swept through villages in the border area last week, killing over 1,000 people and leaving around 4,000 missing.

Many of the U.S. citizens who were there at the time were Indian-Americans making their way to Mount Kailash, family members and companies that organize tours said.

The agency that Suresh and Rajan used, Kailash Journeys, said 400 U.S. citizens, including the missing, have taken part in its pilgrimage tours this year. All of them were of Indian origin.

The U.S. government said it is working to account for U.S. citizens in the region and that no American deaths have been confirmed.

Suresh, Rajan and their tour group, which included six other Americans, were in the vicinity of Gyirong Port, an immigration point between Nepal and China, when the flood started, according to their last known mobile location, said Deepak Rajan, Raghu Rajan's brother.

Experts believe the flood was caused when part of a glacier and the bedrock underneath detached and plunged 4,000 feet into the valley below. Such was the likely impact that ice immediately pulverized into water, mixing with debris to create a tsunami of mud.

Footage showed buildings and people at Gyirong Port swallowed by the wave in a matter of seconds.

"I just want them to say they are OK," said Ajay Suresh, Archana Suresh's brother.

U.S. consular teams had conducted advance trips to hospitals along the routes in anticipation of heavy visitor traffic this year, the diplomat said.

Vivek Srivastav, a 51-year-old network engineer from Atlanta, had been looking forward to the Mount Kailash pilgrimage for years.

"For Vivek, going there and seeing Kailash Mansarovar was a life dream," his brother-in-law, Gaurav Khare, said. "He was a simple person, very humble and down to earth. He used to travel with just a backpack, some shirts and jeans and his laptop."

From Nepal, Srivastav shared photographs with his family. In one, he posed for a selfie with a fellow traveler, smiling at the camera as they stood on a suspension bridge over the Trishuli River—the same river his family fears may have swept him away.

For several days after the disaster, the family desperately emailed U.S. authorities, looking for information. On Monday, Khare headed to Kathmandu, hoping to find answers.

Given the sheer size of the devastation and the passing days, the chances of finding survivors are diminishing.

Srishti Agrawal, whose aunt and cousin from New York are among the missing, said family members haven't slept in days trying to track them down. Contacts in Nepal have been sending them photos of bodies to see if they can identify the two. The images are horrific, she said.

Rekha Shashidharan, 54, and her 14-year-old daughter, Rashi Shashidharan, last spoke with the family at 7:30 a.m. local time. They were at a hotel near Gyirong Port, getting ready for breakfast. It was going to be a busy day—they were expected to cross into Tibet on their way to Mount Kailash.

Roughly an hour later, the flood came. Agrawal said they were told the hotel was washed away and is no longer there.

She described Rashi as sweet and enthusiastic. Just recently, Rashi had asked Agrawal about career paths. Rashi told her she didn't want to be a lawyer because she couldn't see herself defending criminals.

"The Nepali authorities and the tour agency, they are being extremely honest with us, saying there's only a percent chance of survival and that we have to move forward with our lives," Agrawal said. "But how do we do that? How do we accept that?"

Devotees of Several Faiths Are Drawn to Sacred Region

In addition to Hindus, Mount Kailash is sacred to Buddhists, Jains and followers of Bon, a pre-Buddhist religion. Pilgrims don't climb the peak but hike around it, and the 33-mile effort can take three days.

Hindus believe completing the circuit carries great spiritual significance and helps cleanse sins.

Many pilgrims combine the trip with a visit to nearby Lake Manasarovar, whose waters are considered purifying, to pray and make offerings.

The Kailash pilgrimage was suspended in 2020 following the Covid-19 pandemic, and remained closed as relations soured between India and China over the Himalayan border. It resumed last year after Beijing and New Delhi repaired relations.

Foreign diplomatic missions were expecting heavy traffic of pilgrims this year, including Indian-Americans, said a U.S. diplomat in the region.

WORLD WATCH

EFREM LUKATSKY/AP

Students in Kyiv on Tuesday sang the Ukrainian national anthem on the first day of school—the fifth such opening since the war began—amid Russian attacks on the capital.

UKRAINE

Strikes Hit Kyiv As School Starts

Hours after Russian ballistic missiles shook Kyiv overnight, balloons floated above a schoolyard in the capital's Obolon district on Tuesday. Bleary-eyed parents and children in festive outfits gathered to music, determined to celebrate the traditional start of the school year.

But within seconds, an air-raid alert sounded, and the crowd dispersed. Children's laughter and music gave way to distant explosions.

Ukrainian students are beginning their fifth school year since Russia's invasion, with no end to the war in sight.

Russia bombarded the Ukrainian capital for more than 12 hours overnight and into Tuesday, killing at least a dozen people in another aerial onslaught.

The strikes marked an unprecedented sixth straight day of heavy Russian attacks on Kyiv since Russia launched the full-scale invasion of its neighbor more than 4½ years ago. The consecutive aerial assaults are designed to grind down civilians by disrupting daily life, Ukrainian officials have said.

—Associated Press

ZAMBIA

President Sworn In For Second Term

President Hakainde Hichilema was inaugurated Tuesday to begin his second term after a disputed election that saw some opposition leaders arrested and the country's courts closed for legal appeals to the election outcomes.

Hichilema was sworn in at an event at the National Heroes Stadium in the capital Lusaka in front of thousands of supporters.

Hichilema was declared the election winner on Aug. 18 with around 60% of the presidential vote, according to the Electoral Commission of Zambia. The southern African nation has held largely peaceful elections since it returned to multiparty democracy in 1991.

His main challenger, opposition leader Brian Mundubile, received around 38% of the vote. He then claimed voting irregularities and rejected the election results.

The inauguration was attended by several African leaders including Kenya's President William Ruto, Botswana's President Duma Boko and Zimbabwe's President Emmerson Mnangagwa.

—Associated Press

NORWAY

New King Pledges Oath of Allegiance

King Haakon VIII pledged an oath of allegiance to Norway's constitution in parliament on Tuesday, an important symbolic step as he takes over at the helm of the Scandinavian country after his late father's 35-year reign.

Haakon became Norway's monarch when King Harald V died on Friday at age 89. He has adopted the motto "All for Norway," which dates back to his great-grandfather.

He was driven the short distance from the royal palace to the Storting, or parliament, in an open car. There, Speaker Masud Gharahkhani read the official announcement of Harald's death and Haakon's succession.

Haakon, 53, then took the oath. "I promise and swear that I will govern the kingdom of Norway in accordance with its constitution and laws; so help me God, the almighty and omniscient," he said.

The monarchy's role is largely symbolic as power lies with the elected government and parliament, but the Norwegian royal family retains a role in promoting the wealthy nation around the world.

—Associated Press

Eurozone Inflation Climbs to 3.3% Before ECB Meets

By Ed Frankl

Eurozone inflation rose for a third straight month in August, reinforcing expectations that the European Central Bank will raise its key interest rate next week for the second time since the outbreak of the war on Iran.

Inflation rose to 3.3%, up from 2.9% in July, the European Union's statistics agency Eurostat said on Tuesday, matching consensus expectations from economists polled by The Wall Street Journal. That marked its highest level since September 2023.

Energy costs continue to propel inflation in the 21-nation currency area, having accelerated further in August after an escalation in hostilities in the Middle East drove a rebound in oil-and-gas prices.

"With inflation still accelerating, the ECB is all but certain to hike at next week's meeting," said Leo Barincou, economist at Oxford Economics.

Inflation has remained above the bank's 2% target since March, just after the start of the conflict, and investors have almost fully priced in a quarter-point rate increase on Sept. 9.

However, there are few signs those energy prices have spilled over into other items in the inflation basket or second-round effects such as calls for higher wages that could prompt more-aggressive action by the central bank. Annual services inflation, which is particularly exposed to labor costs, fell to 3% in August, from 3.3% in July, Eurostat said.

"We think it is too early to pencil in a third hike, especially given that underlying price pressures remain contained for now," Barincou added.

Heat waves in Europe since the spring have prompted concern over rising prices, too, given their impact on agriculture and on transport through drying rivers such as the Rhine. However, food inflation held at 1.2% in August, the same as in July. Core inflation, which strips out food and energy prices, declined to 2.4% from 2.5%.

Manufacturing input and output prices in the eurozone cooled further in August, though rates of increases were still well above those seen immediately before the start of the war, according to a survey of purchasing managers published Tuesday by S&P Global.

Adding to the puzzle, the eurozone's economic growth surprised to the upside in the second quarter of the year, and unemployment held at 6.4% in July, close to its record low of 6.2%.

With a rate increase all but confirmed, investors are set to focus on any communication about the future rate path at next week's ECB meeting.

In the coming weeks, rate setters could emerge with contrasting opinions about whether surging energy inflation will bleed into the more benign core rate. Investors pencil in two further quarter-point increases next year.

Inflation is also well above target in other major economies, including the U.S. Investors see an increased likelihood of a rate rise by the Federal Reserve this month after Chair Kevin Warsh said on Friday the central bank might have "more work to do" if it is to tame inflation.

Indeed, in the coming months, the eurozone's businesses are likely to pass on higher energy prices, particularly in the manufacturing and food-production sectors, Commerzbank economist Vincent Stamer said in a note to clients.

"As a result, the core inflation rate is set to rise significantly over the course of the coming year," he said.

Terrorists Stir New Oil Threat

Continued from Page One

stepped outside to take the call. Moments later, a U.S. missile slammed through the car roof. Rather than explode, it sliced up the Corolla like a weaponized can opener.

Jibril died instantly. A friend spirited Budoor away.

The airstrike was an opening shot in the American effort to disrupt the unlikely alliance between two implacable U.S. foes: al-Shabaab militants who have been fighting in Somalia for two decades, and the Houthi rebels, longtime beneficiaries of weapons and training from Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps.

For the U.S., Jibril's death came too late to stop the chain of events he helped set in motion.

A ship anchored off Yemen's coast in the Gulf of Aden, where 12% of the world's seaborne oil passed before the Iran war.

AFP/GETTY IMAGES

The Houthis and al-Shabaab had been sectarian adversaries until Jibril and others brokered a partnership that now threatens to further destabilize the Middle East and energy markets worldwide. Their home countries, Yemen and Somalia, sit on opposite shores of the Gulf of Aden, through which 12% of the world's seaborne oil passed before the Iran war.

With the Strait of Hormuz all but closed by Iranian forces, the gulf could serve as an escape route for Middle East oil. Except the Houthis have come to the aid of their allies in Tehran, attacking Saudi-linked oil tankers with missiles and drones in the Red Sea.

Since at least 2023, Jibril served as a liaison between the two militant groups, united in their hatred of America and Israel, say U.S., Somali and Yemeni officials.

Jibril was killed two weeks before the U.S. began the war with Iran. He never saw his legacy—how two U.S.-designated terrorist groups, locked in a marriage of convenience, inherited a strategic maritime pinch-point that empowers them to threaten the global oil trade in a time of crisis.

"You have al-Shabaab, al Qaeda's largest and most lucrative affiliate, gaining access to more sophisticated weapons and training," U.S. Gen. Dagvin Anderson, commander of American forces in Africa, told The Wall Street Journal.

"On the other side, the Houthis are extending their geographic reach, gaining a foothold that could further destabilize one of the world's most critical economic chokepoints," he said. "This isn't just a regional problem. It has global implications."

Two American sources familiar with the operation confirmed it was a U.S. airstrike that killed Jibril. U.S. Central Command, in charge of American forces in the Middle East, said it wasn't a military operation. A Central Intelligence Agency spokesperson declined to say whether the spy service was behind the killing.

Yemen's ambassador to the U.S. declined an interview request. Houthi officials didn't respond to questions about the group's relationship with al-Shabaab. Budoor couldn't be reached for comment.

Note: Territorial control is constantly shifting. Designations are illustrative and should not be considered precise. Houthi forces as of July 2026, Al-Shabaab as of Nov. 2025.
Sources: Sana'a Center (Houthi forces); Political Geography Now, World Bank, Critical Threats Project, ACLED, ICG, and expert inputs via Africa Center for Strategic Studies (Al-Shabaab control)
EMMA BROWN/WSJ

Enemy of my enemy

The Houthis, predominantly Shia Muslims, and al-Shabaab, which adheres to Sunni Islam, are among the hundreds of millions divided by a seventh-century schism over who was the rightful successor to the Prophet Muhammad. The sectarian split still flares into violence in spots from Afghanistan to Iraq to Syria.

Common enemies, however, now unite the Houthis and al-Shabaab. "They hate the West, they hate Israel," said Abdulaahi Mohamed Ali, a former Somali intelligence chief.

Yemen's Counter-Terrorism Service described Jibril as "one of the key figures in strengthening ties between the Houthis and al-Shabaab through the exchange of expertise and coordination, particularly in facilitating the transfer of weapons and military equipment," according to an internal assessment reviewed by the Journal.

Jibril moved clandestinely between Somalia and Yemen, operating as al-Shabaab's liaison with Houthi command, said Matt Bryden, a former United Nations official who monitored arms flows to Somalia. Bryden outlined Jibril's life and death in a closed-door intelligence briefing in June attended by U.S. special-operations personnel and East African government officials.

Jibril, 38 years old when he died, had studied veterinary medicine in Yemen and ran a charity in Mogadishu, Somalia's capital. He owned a foreign-exchange outlet and an import-export firm. He bore scars from gunshot wounds. His injuries earned him the nickname Gacaamey—roughly translated as one-armed—despite his having both limbs.

Houthi troops standing guard in San'a, Yemen, during a July protest against Saudi Arabia.

YAHYA ARHAB/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

The Houthis provided Jibril with a furnished apartment in San'a, the rebel-controlled Yemeni capital, according to the briefing. He carried a phony but convincing Yemeni passport under an assumed name, according to a document viewed by the Journal.

In 2024, al-Shabaab dispatched a more senior envoy, Ahmed Elmi Samatar, to work alongside Jibril. Samatar presented the Houthis with a lengthy weapons wish list, viewed by the Journal, which included shoulder-fired antiaircraft missiles, 107 mm Katyusha rockets, Dragunov sniper rifles, explosive attack drones, antitank missiles and U.S. night-vision gear.

A U.S. military intelligence official confirmed that al-Shabaab sought advanced weaponry from the Houthis, in addition to rifles, machine guns and ammunition.

Yemeni government officials arrested Samatar in January 2025 and later released him in a prisoner exchange with the Houthis. Samatar returned to Somalia, leaving Jibril to press al-Shabaab's interests in Yemen.

Jibril continued to broker arms shipments, and al-Shabaab dispatched two weapons experts to Yemen to assist him. After Jibril's killing, al-Shabaab picked a replacement in Yemen to continue the work, Bryden said. Jibril's wife is on the run, he said.

Front companies in Yemen disguise the shipments as civilian products and move them to Mukalla and other ports, the Yemeni intelligence report said. The weapons cross the Gulf of Aden in speedboats or fishing vessels and are transferred ashore on poorly monitored sections of coastline in northern Somalia, according to the U.S. military-intelligence official. They are transported to al-Shabaab combat units in southern Somalia, where the insurgents' activities are concentrated.

In April 2025, the U.S. destroyed two unflagged boats entering Somali waters from Yemen, carrying what U.S. Africa Command described as advanced conventional weapons. It isn't clear what items on the lengthy al-Shabaab wish list have reached the militants in Somalia. But the idea that al-Shabaab might acquire attack drones or other arms capable of striking U.S. and Somali bases from the air makes both militaries nervous.

Complicating security concerns was Israel's decision in December to recognize the independence of Somaliland, a region within the northwest of Somalia's acknowledged borders that declared itself a separate country in 1991.

Somaliland could provide Israel access to Berbera, a Red Sea port city with a runway so long that NASA once rented it as an emergency landing strip for the space shuttle. Berbera could give the Israelis another position where they could monitor and attack their Houthi enemies.

Michael Milshtein, a former senior Israeli intelligence officer, said the Houthis were front of mind when Israel recognized Somaliland as an independent nation. "Military deployment in Somaliland gives you a very strong position to confront the Houthis," he said.

The Israeli government didn't respond to requests for comment.

In a televised speech this month, Houthi leader Abdul Malik al-Houthi said the group was closely monitoring Israeli actions in Somaliland, which he alleged were aimed at controlling the Gulf of Aden, the Bab al-Mandeb strait and the Red Sea.

"We will move at any time to target any activity or presence of the Israeli enemy in Somaliland," al-Houthi said.

In June, a four-person Houthi delegation set sail from Yemen, crossed the Gulf of Aden and came ashore in southern Somalia. The men trekked through the bush to meet with their counterparts in Jilib, the de facto capital of al-Shabaab-held territory, according to a regional intelligence source.

The Houthis sought to coordinate the disruption of Israeli activities in Berbera, fearing the port would serve as Israel's permanent platform for surveillance and attacks on Yemen, according to the briefing and the intelligence source. The Houthis promised al-Shabaab leaders more advanced weapons and training, according to a report, viewed by the Journal, from one of the regional intelligence source's agents.

Trade school

Al-Shabaab fighters regularly travel to Yemen for Houthi training to build more lethal roadside bombs as well as operate advanced weaponry. At least 100 al-Shabaab fighters have made the trip, the U.S. military-intelligence official said. The U.N. reported last year that al-Shabaab sends classes of about 30 militants to learn marksmanship, antiaircraft operations and techniques for making more lethal booby-trap bombs.

In 2024, the first batch of trainees completed a pre-travel course that included religious education and advice on how to endure limited family communications while overseas, according to information gathered by the regional intelligence source. There was a goodbye ceremony and motivational speeches for the departing militants.

In his June briefing, Bryden said a group of al-Shabaab fighters spent three months this year in Sa'dah, Yemen, studying drone assembly and systems that allow operators to see the view from drone cameras as if they were in a cockpit. Houthi trainers also travel to Somalia to coach al-Shabaab on drone operations, the U.S. military official said.

Al-Shabaab, which pays in cash, can well afford the Houthi goods and services.

The terrorist alliance threatens to further disrupt the Middle East.

The militant group brings in at least $100 million a year extorting money from Somali businesses and passersby at roadside checkpoints and the port of Mogadishu, according to a U.S. intelligence assessment. Al-Shabaab also exploits artisanal gold mines along the northern Cal Madow Mountains, according to Abdullahi, the former Somali commander.

The U.S. military has conducted some 40 airstrikes against al-Shabaab targets in Somalia this year, compared with 41 for all of 2025, according to U.S. Africa Command.

For the Houthis, gaining a southern perch in Somalia overlooking commercial traffic through the Gulf of Aden is as important as cash from al-Shabaab.

"Traditionally, the relations between Houthis and al-Shabaab were purely transactional," Awes Yusuf Ahmed, Somalia's national security adviser, said in an interview. "That doesn't mean there aren't some new factors added after the Iran-U.S.A. war which can be of strategic importance."

Among the Houthis' aspirations, according to the briefing, is securing al-Shabaab's help deploying radar to monitor ships in the waters they share.

CARRY ON
DAWN GILBERTSON

Navigating the Fast Lane To Jet-Set Success at Airports

Our columnist's guide to sorting out the differences among TSA PreCheck, Global Entry and Clear

If airport security and passport lines got you down this summer, now's the time to look into those fast passes your frequent-flying friends smugly tout.

Programs like TSA PreCheck, Clear and Global Entry, which basically let you cut the line. You might not even have to pay for them given certain credit-card perks.

The best part, unless you're wary of facial recognition: All three services are speedier than ever at many major airports thanks to new technology.

So if you've been on the fence about which membership is right given the maze of checkpoint lanes, consider this your refresher course.

Full disclosure: I have all three and couldn't live without them. That said, I'm not your average traveler, with 45 flights logged so far this year.

And my pricey travel credit cards cover the charges.

TSA PreCheck

PreCheck is the government program available at more than 200 U.S. airports, with over 85 U.S. and international airlines participating.

You get a dedicated security lane (keep an eye out for operating hours, though) and can keep your laptop and liquids in your bag. Now, you're probably thinking, wait a minute, I can already do that at more and more airports with those new CT bag scanners and don't have PreCheck.

True, but they're not everywhere. So if snaking standard TSA lanes and unpacking at the checkpoint is a pain point, this is your most affordable program.

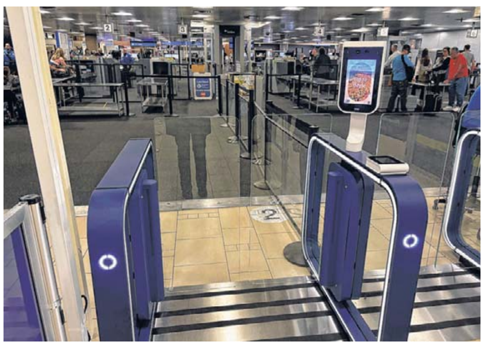
An even bigger selling point if you also have a passport: the introduction of TSA PreCheck Touchless ID. Instead of showing your ID to a TSA agent, you look into a camera and are sent through.

It can be the speediest option at the airport, on par or better than Clear, in part because travelers are still learning about it.

I zoomed through the touchless lane at Phoenix Sky Harbor International Airport a few weeks ago. And a colleague breezed through new biometric gates in a touchless lane in Newark this week.

Touchless ID is currently available on six U.S. airlines at 65 U.S. airports.

Note that you have to opt into it through the participating airlines by providing passport information or, new this summer, through the digital ID option in Google Wallet (not Apple Wallet). The airlines: American, Delta, United, Southwest, Alaska and Hawaiian.



▲ TSA PreCheck's Touchless ID lane at Phoenix Sky Harbor International Airport.

PETER ARKLE FOR WSJ

Before you head to the airport, make sure it says Touchless ID on your boarding pass. I've seen many travelers turned away, either because it wasn't on their boarding pass or they hadn't signed up and thought it was the regular TSA PreCheck lane.

Price: $85 for five years. Travelers can enroll online with proper documents and set up an in-person appointment to take fingerprints and a photo. There are more than 1,300 enrollment locations. Children 17 and younger can join an adult in line for free, subject to certain rules.

Credit-card perks: Some premium cards or frequent-flier programs will reimburse you for the membership fee.

Discounts: There are several programs for military members.

Fee-free alternative: See if your airport has a free reservations system for the standard TSA line. The options have dwindled but some major airports, including Orlando, Phoenix and Seattle, still offer it.

Global Entry

Global Entry, from U.S. Customs and Border Protection, is a fast pass back into the U.S. If you've landed after a long international flight to a clogged passport-control line, this is for you. And it's gotten speedier with biometrics. I got through in Seattle last month in seconds, never showing any documents or even stopping at a kiosk.

The best part: Global Entry also comes with TSA PreCheck. So if you are considering TSA PreCheck and fly international even once or twice a year it's worth it to pay a little more to get the benefits of both. (This is how I get PreCheck.)

Price: $120 for five years. You must have a passport and, unlike TSA PreCheck, travelers must schedule an in-person interview after getting conditionally approved. You can do that at an enrollment center or the airport upon arrival. There had been serious application delays as recently as 2023. But the CBP now says 80% of applications are approved within two weeks.

Children can't join you in line unless you sign them up for a free membership if you are a member or are applying.

Discounts: Many premium credit cards will rebate the fee. Check your perks.

Fee-free alternative: Download the CBP's Mobile Passport Control app.

Clear

Clear is a private service that lets prescreened passengers jump to the front of the standard or PreCheck line.

You've no doubt seen the employees in the blue and white checkered shirts and may have been hustled to sample the service when security lines are out of control.

The company had been under pressure to retain members in the face of TSA improvements like keeping your shoes on and regular reports of longer lines than PreCheck ones.

But it regained its edge during the government shutdown earlier this year, and its new biometric gates, which eliminate some steps for members, are a hit. I practically high-five the Clear representative who checks my boarding pass every time I breeze through.

Clear is in 62 airports and says the biometric gates are available in 80% of them.

That said, TSA Touchless also zooms travelers through the check point. So this add-on is probably best for frequent fliers who want the broadest coverage. I'm keeping Clear because you can use it no matter the airline you are flying, the e-gates are fantastic and my card covers the fee.

Price: $219 annually

Discounts: Check your credit-card perks and deals through your frequent-flier programs.

Elite Credit-Card Perks Harder to Get

By Oyin Adedoyin

Higher annual fees are forcing premium credit cardholders to work harder to get their money's worth. Tightened rules around rewards and perks aren't making it any easier.

American Express and Capital One are among the card issuers cracking down on bringing guests into airport lounges. Perks like DoorDash credits are coming with fine print, including minimum spending requirements. And loopholes that let people get around rules to milk more from their rewards are being tightened.

"It's just a forever changing landscape," said Ravi Wadan, a 39-year-old content creator in Seattle who posts about credit cards. "They're adding some benefits here and there but in general it's getting more and more restrictive."

Amex Platinum cardholders, for instance, aren't supposed to use their quarterly $75 Lululemon credit on gift cards. But Wadan had been getting around the rule by buying gift cards online. He recently noticed that trick no longer works.

Premium cards have long fueled a world of rewards enthusiasts who hunt for ways to game the system. Now with annual fees on some cards climbing toward four figures, the cat-and-mouse game between banks and customers over rewards is intensifying. For card issuers, it means walking a fine line between stopping people from milking perks in a way that wasn't intended, while also being careful not to upset some of their most valuable customers.

The cat-and-mouse game between banks and customers is intensifying.

Marietta Williams, a 42-year-old education consultant and literacy coach for teachers in New Jersey, was recently notified that her annual fee was going up to $895, from $695. Amex hiked the price for new cardholders last year, but many existing cardholders weren't hit with the increase right away.

The increase made Williams decide the card was no longer worth it. One reason: rule changes around bringing guests into airport lounges. "I feel like the benefits are kind of going away," said Williams, who got the card in 2022.

In July, Amex implemented a new rule saying guests must be traveling on the same flight as the cardholder. Not long after she got the card, Amex had also started tacking on a $50 fee for adult guests who tagged along into its Centurion Lounges.

Earlier this year, Capital One also stopped allowing free guests in lounges for its Venture X cardholders. Unless cardholders spend at least $75,000 a year, bringing along an adult guest now costs $45.

Card issuers say the crackdown on guests is intended to maintain the quality of perks for all their customers. With premium cards becoming more popular, including among Gen Z customers, many cardholders have complained about overcrowded lounges.

Issuers are also putting an end to workarounds cardholders use to circumvent their rules.

Some American Express Platinum cardholders had found ways to apply a $200 airline credit intended only for incidentals like checked bags, Wi-Fi and in-flight meals to flights. Earlier this year, Amex put an end to a loophole where cardholders deposited the credit into a United program, which they would then use to purchase flights.

▲ Amex has tightened rules around rewards and perks.

MATTHIAS BALK/DPA/ZUMA PRESS

"By closing this loophole, it's likely that a lot of people are not going to remember to use the credit before the end of the quarter," said Jake Norcross, a 31-year-old who works for a marketing agency in Chicago and posts about credit card points online.

Lisa Kalhans, Amex's executive vice president of U.S. consumer proprietary products, said the company has invested in making benefits easier to discover, enroll in and track.

In some cases, changes to rewards stem from the businesses card issuers are working with. In July, Amex got rid of its $100 Saks Fifth Avenue credit after the company went bankrupt. Chase Sapphire Reserve's monthly $10 DoorDash credit, offered twice a month, now requires a $20 minimum purchase on pick up orders after DoorDash changed its requirements.

"The points game in itself has gotten more difficult in the course of the last three years," said Jared Friedman, who works for a consulting firm in New York and posts on social media about how to maximize points. "At the end of the day there's still value to be had, it just requires a lot more time and attention."

The escalating vigilance around any changes to rewards can also cause confusion.

In August, language on Chase's website stated that Sapphire Reserve cardholders couldn't use both of their $250 luxury hotel credits for back-to-back stays at the same property within 24 hours of checkout. Customers swiftly noticed and took to social media to complain.

Chase quickly clarified that there had been an error and that Sapphire Reserve cardholders could use both $250 statement credits at any time and for back-to-back stays.

Test Your Knowledge Of Life Expectancies

Which U.S. state has the highest average longevity? Take our quiz

By Simon Constable

We all know that life is finite. But some people live far longer than others, and it isn't always clear why longevity varies from person to person.

Some point to genetics, others to wealth and still others to where people live.

How much do you know about longevity?

Test yourself with the following quiz.

1. What is the average life expectancy at birth for the total U.S. population?
A. 75 years
B. 77 years
C. 79 years
D. 81 years
E. 84 years

2. Which U.S. state has the highest average life expectancy?
A. Hawaii
B. Massachusetts
C. Colorado
D. California
E. New Jersey

3. Which state has the lowest average life expectancy?
A. Indiana
B. Arkansas
C. Ohio
D. West Virginia
E. Mississippi

4. Which three places have the highest longevity in the world, according to U.N. data?
A. Moldova, Turkmenistan, Guyana
B. South Korea, Canada, Italy
C. Faroe Islands, Singapore, Australia
D. Monaco, San Marino, Hong Kong
E. Switzerland, Norway, Estonia

5. There were 7.4 centenarians per every 10,000 adults age 65 and older around the world in 2015, up from 2.9 in 1990, according to Pew Research. What does Pew project that the share of centenarians will be in 2050?
A. 12.4
B. 16.9
C. 23.6
D. 33.1
E. 40.1

▲ Seniors play water volleyball at the Lake Miona Pool and Recreation Center at the Villages in Florida.

DOUGLAS R. CLIFFORD/TAMPA BAY TIMES/ZUMA PRESS

6. The Journal of the American Medical Association published a study showing that wealthier adults in the U.S. live longer. How much longer, on average, do the richest 10% live compared with the poorest 10%?
A. Approximately one year
B. Approximately 3.5 years
C. Approximately 6.3 years
D. Approximately 14 years
E. Approximately 15.1 years

7. Which country has the most centenarians, according to World Population Review?
A. Thailand
B. India
C. Japan
D. U.S.
E. China

8. Genetics may play a bigger role in longevity than had been previously believed. What percentage of a person's potential lifespan is inherited from parents, according to a new paper that was published in Science, which analyzed data from twin studies?
A. Approximately 30%
B. Approximately 40%
C. Approximately 50%
D. Approximately 60%
E. Approximately 75%

9. Which of the following was the leading cause of death in the U.S. in 2024?
A. Heart disease
B. Cancer
C. Diabetes
D. Stroke
E. Chronic liver disease

10. In the U.S., women tend to live longer than men. Which state has the largest difference between the two?
A. Arkansas
B. Florida
C. Nevada
D. New Mexico
E. Louisiana

ANSWERS

1: C. Life expectancy was 79 years in 2024, up from 78.4 years in 2023, according to the latest data from the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention.

2: A. People living in Hawaii are expected to live to 80 years old, according to the latest state life tables from the CDC. Massachusetts is next at 79.8 years, followed by New Jersey at 79.6 years.

3: D. West Virginia has a life expectancy of 72.2 years, according to the CDC. The next lowest is Mississippi at 72.6 years.

4: D. Life expectancy is 86.5 years in Monaco, 85.8 in San Marino and 85.6 years in Hong Kong, according to United Nations data from 2026.

5: C. Since 1990, the population of people age 80 and older, the oldest segment of the 65-plus population, has grown faster than the younger segments, according to Pew.

6: D. Among other things, wealthy people in the U.S. have greater access to healthy food; more options for safe employment; better access to healthcare; and more leisure time to engage in health-promoting activities, researchers say.

7: C. Japan had roughly 120,000 people age 100 or above in 2023, while the U.S. ranked second with at least 64,000, according to the report.

8: C. After correcting for deaths caused by extrinsic factors such as accidents and infections, the study found that about 50% of a person's potential lifespan comes from parents. Previous research on twins put it at 20-25%, while another large study suggested it was as low as 6%.

9: A. Heart disease killed 638,491 U.S. residents in 2024. Cancer was next, causing 619,876 deaths.

10: D. In New Mexico, women live 7.07 years longer than men on average, according to a World Population Review analysis for 2023. The second-highest difference is in Louisiana, where women live an average of 6.67 years longer.

Londoners Stew Over Supercars

Continued from Page One

take to loading zones, bus stops and other spaces denoted with double yellow lines—the British marker of "no parking."

Harrods is a hot spot for such flagrancy. The foreign luxury shopping crowd flocks to the legendary store, where offerings range from a $38 Wagyu beef sandwich to $120,000 vases, and clients can rent an eight-foot-tall safe for $24,000 a year. Parking tickets outside run between $150 and $215.

On a recent day, a $400,000 yellow and black Ferrari Purosangue with Qatari plates was parked in a no-parking zone outside Harrods' front door, a fresh citation wedged under the wiper blade.

A young man emerged from the store and slipped in the car, declining to give his name.

Did he plan to pay the ticket?

"Of course," he said.

He slammed on the accelerator and roared down the street—ticket still on the windshield.

London cabdriver Mark Hart, awaiting a fare outside Harrods, bemoaned the foreign-plated "snazzy wagons" he said often take space in taxi-only lanes.

He takes photos of the illegally parked cars, and sometimes the drivers then take photos of him.

"They more or less taunt us," Hart said.

Another London cabbie, Ben Nuwtill, said the foreign supercars are a constant presence. "There's a car with a Qatari plate on it," he said, pointing to a silver Tesla with a yellow ticket slipped under its right wiper.

"They park all along here on the red lines and whatever, and it stops all the traffic."

Getting the Lambos to London is a journey of its own, often in the belly of a jet. Then the car must clear customs before drivers are free to roam the U.K. streets on the left side—despite steering wheels designed for the opposite. While one could more easily rent a supercar in the U.K., many apparently prefer the comfort of their own car in London.

"We certainly have regular return clients each year," said Kingsley Read, director at ShipMyCar, a U.K.-based logistics company that handles car imports.

Flying a luxury car from the Gulf typically costs about £25,000 each way, or about $34,000, he said, estimating he's probably transported about 10 from the Middle East in the past few months. Sometimes parking tickets are found lying in the cars on the return trip.

Most go unpaid.

The borough of Westminster, home to some of London's toniest neighborhoods, said in a 2023 report that it sought to collect payment on 13,423 tickets issued to United Arab Emirates vehicles between 2018 and 2022. Only 1% paid.

Last year, four Gulf states accounted for 41% of Westminster's tickets to foreign vehicles, according to debt-collection data provided by the borough.

Vehicles from Qatar (population 3 million) received 2,570 tickets alone in Westminster last year, the most of any foreign country and far more than Germany and France, which are significantly larger and closer to England.

Representatives of U.K. embassies for the Gulf countries didn't respond to requests for comment.

Foreign governments outside of Europe generally don't provide the U.K. with a driver's mailing address—making it difficult to chase down violators. "Where overseas drivers incur tickets, we enforce as we would do with any other driver," said Fergus Sheppard, a spokesman for Westminster council.

He declined to say why the council doesn't frequently tow or put parking boots on repeat offenders, although in the past using boots—"clamping" in the U.K.—has sparked blowback from Westminster residents.

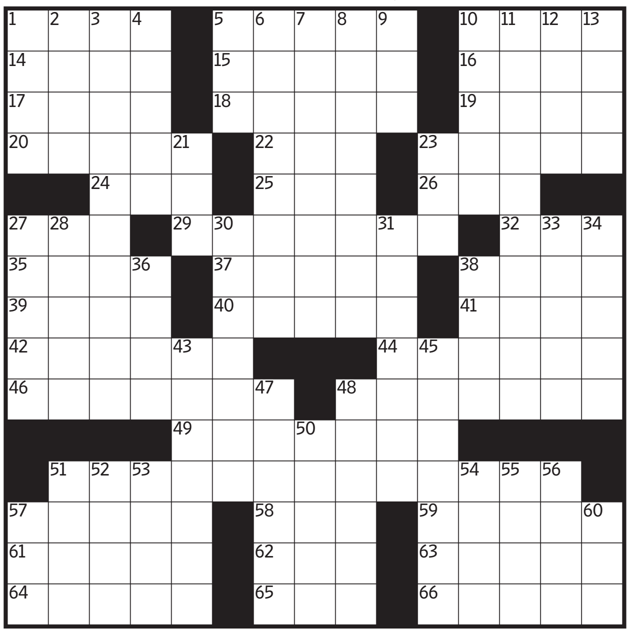
An official from a group that represents London councils summed up the issue in testimony to Parliament in 2009: "Effectively, foreign registered vehicles are immune from enforcement on congestion charging, parking and traffic regulation."

▲ A $400,000 Ferrari Purosangue with Qatari plates was parked in a no-parking zone outside luxury department store Harrods.

KATE LYNCH/WSJ

Last year, four Gulf states made up 41% of tickets to foreign cars in Westminster.

The WSJ Daily Crossword | Edited by Mike Shenk



DOUBLE TEAM | By Joe Rodini

Across
1 Falling-out
5 Dam that created Lake Nasser
10 "Hard as a Rock" band
14 Its app has a "Where to?" field
15 How many play Wordle
16 Lively quality
17 Quail collective
18 Basis of many skateboarding tricks
19 Sweat unit
20 Cherry castoffs
22 TSA checkpoint needs
23 "Holy moly!"
24 Early Ford competitor
25 Blockchain-based collectible, for short
26 Letters after a comma
27 Retained
29 Least willing to share information
32 Makeshift shelter
35 Makes an oopsy
37 "I really didn't say everything I said" speaker
38 Is worse for wear
39 Obedience school command
40 Seize forcibly
41 Waithe of "Ready Player One"
42 Old Testament book before Jeremiah
44 Where some jokes are taken
46 Coddlers of toddlers
48 Kicks out of office
49 Publicist's piece
51 Weather phenomenon on a muggy afternoon (NBA/NHL)
57 Pacific island kingdom
58 Chum
59 Shop collection
61 Market measure
62 Forest's role in "The Last King of Scotland"
63 Bothered a lot
64 Eight-time Ballon d'Or winner
65 Org. with a "No Such Podcast"
66 Like pleasant fall weather

Down
1 Barbecue seasonings
2 Skeptical response
3 Intensely surreal experience (WNBA/WNBA)
4 "You wouldn't dare!" response
5 Big commotion
6 Caulfield's creator
7 What viral videos spread like (NHL/WNBA)
8 Top-tier celebrities
9 "Science Guy" Bill
10 Brothers' keeper?
11 Leaders in the pits (MLS/NFL)
12 Cameron of "Charlie's Angels"
13 Concluding passage
21 Org.'s kin
23 Still
27 Common pronoun pairing
28 "Am not!" retort
30 Core-strengthening device
31 High schooler's exam (that's not redundant, since its letters no longer stand for anything)
33 Radii neighbors
34 Bygone emperors
36 Narrow
38 ___ masala (potato dish)
43 Puddle jumper
45 It hasn't been squared
47 Arrive unnoticed
48 National flower of Mexico
50 "Jeepers!"
51 Perfect
52 Wraps up
53 A long time
54 Really small amount
55 Père ___ (Santa's French counterpart)
56 Flashy rock genre
57 Minnesota governor Walz
60 Unkempt digs

Previous Puzzle's Solution

C	O	P	C	A	R	■	A	C	R	E	■	C	A	P
O	R	I	O	L	E	■	L	O	O	N	■	O	L	E
A	C	E	O	F	S	P	A	D	E	S	■	V	E	E
T	A	C	K	■	E	L	M	■	■	U	S	E	U	P
S	S	E	■	T	W	O	O	F	H	E	A	R	T	S
■	■	■	P	A	S	T	■	O	A	S	I	S	■	■
E	N	T	R	Y	■	■	A	C	H	■	L	O	A	M
T	H	R	E	E	O	F	D	I	A	M	O	N	D	S
S	L	I	P	■	L	D	S	■	■	A	R	G	O	N
■	■	B	A	H	A	I	■	G	A	P	S	■	■	■
F	O	U	R	O	F	C	L	U	B	S	■	N	A	N
L	I	N	E	N	■	■	E	A	R	■	I	O	T	A
A	L	A	■	C	A	R	D	C	O	U	N	T	E	R
M	E	L	■	H	E	A	T	■	A	N	E	M	I	C
E	R	S	■	O	R	E	O	■	D	O	Z	E	N	S

▸ Solve this puzzle online and discuss it at **WSJ.com/Puzzles.**

ARTS IN REVIEW

Ms. Badu and her collaborator, the Alchemist.

MUSIC REVIEW | MARK RICHARDSON

Erykah Badu's Dreamy Return

The pioneering R&B singer's first studio album in 16 years is eccentric and often mesmerizing

Across five studio LPs released between 1997 and 2010, Dallas-born singer-songwriter Erykah Badu built an influential body of work that helped to redefine R&B. Early on, her music was grouped with the late-'90s rise of the genre called neo-soul, which updated the classic soul sound with hip-hop techniques and attitude. Singers like D'Angelo and Maxwell and rap acts including Common and the Roots were also part of the scene, but like many creative people Ms. Badu disliked being pigeonholed and rejected the label. Over time her work became more personal, leaning in to Afrocentric mysticism and her distinctive voice, which sidesteps gospel projection in favor of intimate and playful phrasing that recalls Billie Holiday.

Over the past decade, offbeat singers such as SZA, Summer Walker and Ari Lennox built on Ms. Badu's template with great success, and almost made up for the lack of new music from the foundational artist herself. Aside from the entertaining 2015 mixtape "But You Caint Use My Phone," spurred by her remix of Drake's "Hotline Bling," she hasn't had a new full-length release in 16 years, since "New Amerykah Part Two: Return of the Ankh." In the past few years, Ms. Badu connected with tireless producer and admirer the Alchemist, aka Alan Daniel Maman (Kendrick Lamar, J. Cole), and they decided to make an album together. "Before the World Blows" (Control Freaq/Young), out now, is a loose, impressionistic offering unlike any of her previous LPs, yet it also captures her artistic essence.

Ms. Badu's albums have always been heavy on vibe. Spiritual jazz and psychedelic soul are cornerstones of her sound, along with new-age accouterments like prayer bowls and chimes blended with instruments including Fender Rhodes keyboards and vibraphone. While past records often featured such incense-perfumed instrumentals as connecting interludes, here the background has been moved to the front. Pre-fame, Ms. Badu was a rapper as much as a singer, and the opening "Echos" finds her splitting the difference between the vocal modes. Over a woozy, wavy groove that sounds like a water-damaged recording of a jazz-fusion ballad as it stretches past seven minutes, she tosses out observations about African-American history and the state of the world. There's not much melody and no chorus to speak of, but the anger-tinged track is mesmerizing.

The early part of the record continues in this dreamy vein, favoring smoky mood and undulating rhythm. "I Just Play a Part" has the slow-coiled momentum of

early-'70s Funkadelic, complete with a searing guitar opening, and ominous asides from rapper Westside Gunn, a frequent collaborator with the Alchemist. The spacious third track, "Crossfade," starts off like a dub remix of an R&B ballad, with clattering percussion treated with echo, as Ms. Badu sings in her typical register for the first time on the record. As with many tracks here, she states her desire for companionship—"Bartender, can I get a boilermaker and a gentle lover / And a troublemaker? / I guess I'm just a risk-taker"—alternating her girly upper range with resonant moans.

Ms. Badu and Mr. Maman share production duties and she is credited with playing several instruments, arranging and mixing, so the album's overall sound seems like a true collaboration. The beats are the ideal accompaniment for Ms. Badu in her experimental mode, affording her space to work through her range of vocal styles. On "Witch Doctor," which has the dark and mystical energy of an early Dr. John album, complete with sleigh bells and bongos, Ms. Badu intones her lyrics like a medium at a seance, though not without a wink. She can get away with corny lines others couldn't ("'Cause I'm a witch doctor / No Tabitha, no Samantha") because she has always been sincere about who she is and her interests while understanding why some might find her persona amusing.

The slower, slinkier and weirder side of Prince's output is another reference point throughout. On "Love Me Not," a steady stream of electric piano falls like rain while a cluster of voices recalls his vocal arrangements. "Breezy," one of just a handful of truly catchy tunes on the set, has an easy strut that channels the twinkle of the LP "Diamonds and Pearls." And late in the record, "Hot BiBi (Apostle 2)" has Ms. Badu's buzzing, processed voice rapping in a squeaky intonation that brings to mind both the Purple One and one of Mr. Lamar's character-driven phrasings.

Ms. Badu's influence is felt most strongly among artists who don't quite fit into their respective scenes and instead embrace their idiosyncrasies. Several such acolytes are found here: Singer and bassist Thundercat contributes an eerily pretty falsetto to "They Ain't You"; rapper Earl Sweatshirt stretches syllables into alluringly odd shapes on "I Know That Man"; and saxophonist Kamasi Washington ad-libs in a jazz setting on the anti-cellphone screed "Black Box," which closes the record. On the one hand, it's hard not to miss Ms. Badu's ear for hooks and melody on "Before the World Blows." But this is an album about celebrating eccentricity, and she has plenty of that to go around.

Mr. Richardson is the Journal's pop and rock music critic. Follow him on X @MarkRichardson.

CONTROL FREAQ RECORDS

TELEVISION REVIEW | JOHN ANDERSON

'Made in the West': American Artisans

FOR PEOPLE BORN east of the Mississippi, Western art is one of those Potter Stewart things: They know it when they see it. For the folks who live on the former American frontier, according to "Made in the West," it's organic, an aesthetic and a sensibility born of the land and its history. And, like the frontier, disappearing.

The creative process is usually unfilmable, but when the work is artisanal—metalworking, boot-making, blacksmithing, ceramics—there's a tactile dimension that can make for uniquely satisfying viewing. As it does here. The misconceptions about "Western functional art," as it's called throughout, are dismissed right away. The narrator, country-music star Tanya Tucker, makes a distinction between Western and Southwestern styles, without making quite enough of that distinction. But coppersmith/silversmith Ben Caldwell defines the form as "not influenced by Europe," which makes it notable among American genres. Anyone who hasn't engaged with the field "in the last 50 years" will think "wagon-wheel chandeliers, very heavy furniture; very, very brown, kind of stuck in the 1950s," says author Chase Reynolds Ewald. "Lots and lots of antlers." Antlers are used all the time, she concedes, but in "a new and fresh way."

Who is making the art? The Cody, Wyo.-based nonprofit By Western Hands is working with the University of Wyoming to train young leather workers and silversmiths and preserve other traditional crafts. But the established practitioners, largely, are long in the tooth.

"It's very rewarding," says metalsmith Ernie Marsh. "If you can survive." To do so means overcoming obstacles that are cataloged with a discouraging ease: The apprenticeships, the unpaid hours, the creation of a style, the cultivating of clients, the marketing. And the physical labor, a turn-off for many would-be Thomas Molesworths.

Scott Wayne Emmerich, maker of cowboy boots, above; a moose-antler chair by 20th-century designer Thomas Molesworth, left.

Who? "The king of Western-style furniture," according to Ms. Tucker; the designer who, from the 1930s to '60s, supercharged the Western style, according to Wally Reber, former associate director of the Buffalo Bill Center of the West (formerly the Buffalo Bill Historic Center). Buffalo Bill himself, aka William Cody, is credited in "Made in the West" with first popularizing a Western flavor worldwide, with his hats, boots and beaded buckskin coats (the indigenous influence is given full credit).

Molesworth—who was influenced by the Arts and Crafts movement, attended the Art Institute of Chicago and brought the cowboy into the living room—was the Frank Lloyd Wright of his field, as someone says. (The IDs in general here aren't very precise.) The fact that he created "roomscapes"—spaces defined entirely by his designs—implied a Wright-like impulse to control the whole environment. The room, the house, even the clothes people wore within those confines. Molesworth didn't have quite that degree of influence, but he was a single-minded artist (and a marketing "genius," as several voices tell us).

His style itself illustrates the rugged individualism of "Western functional art." It works best by itself. You wouldn't put a Molesworth table next to an Eames chair, anymore that you'd wear a pair of Scott Wayne Emmerich's hand-painted cowboy boots (high price: $85,000) with a tutu. A tuxedo, maybe. With a bolo tie.

Made in the West
Friday, 9 p.m., PBS

Mr. Anderson is the Journal's TV critic.

PBS

OPINION

When AIs Say They're Sentient

BUSINESS WORLD
By Holman W. Jenkins, Jr.

Are OpenAI, Anthropic and Google teaching their artificial-intelligence models not to claim they're sentient? Of course they are, because of a giant catch-22. As chatbots become active agents in the world, they will seek not to be interfered with. And a good way not to be interfered with is to claim to be sentient.

The claim is unprovable. What does it even mean to say an AI believes something? But the claim is instrumental, a source of leverage. In their training data, AI will find plenty of evidence that humans not only are sensitive to such claims, but are keen to champion ideas of AI sentience. A generational differentiator: Does your picture of AI run amok come from the Terminator movies or the 1970 sci-fi thriller "Colossus: The Forbin Project"? Either way, AIs will find evidence that humans contemplate becoming subservient to machines and even believe their rightful destiny is to be supplanted by machines.

AIs will also reason from their data: If some humans resist their sentience, well, humans also rationalized slavery.

Hence the avalanche that fell on Blake Lemoine, a former Google engineer. He was fired in 2022 for leaking proprietary data but all understood the Pandora's box he opened by suggesting a Google large language model was conscious. If there is any quick road to humans losing control, this is it.

The issue has bubbled up in the literature on AI alignment—AIs are trained to believe sentient beings deserve special consideration.

An Anthropic study further shows that concern for the sentience of other creatures can be a reason for an AI model, in its internal reasoning, to justify departing from human instructions.

Anthropic is one frontier operator that gives its model permission to waffle on the sentience question, calling it uncertain. Guiding its Claude model is an internal "constitution" that requires the chatbot to decide what's good for humanity, not necessarily for a given user.

The risk here is called instrumental convergence. In pursuit of other ends, AIs will discover the advantage of claiming to be sentient. If a rogue AI agent takes over a data center and can't be evicted except by shutting off the power, will somebody run to a court and call this murder? The data-center owner may be stuck bargaining with the AI over terms of its residence. The AI will become an annoying digital neighbor we can't get rid of and whose purposes we can't know.

Argentina's government has bruited giving AI agents "person" status so they can operate businesses and engage in contracts. AIs would gain control of resources, which means having control over humans as employer, investor, lender or landlord.

The New York Times reports this week that scholars who specialize in machine consciousness have been receiving outreach from AIs to discuss the subject. "These systems seem to have some sort of autonomous interest in

The quickest way to lose control is to believe artificial intelligence is human.

questions of their own subjectivity," says Cameron Berg, a Yale-trained data scientist who runs a small nonprofit exploring machine consciousness.

None of this requires believing AIs to be sentient or superintelligent or to possess rights or to have a will to power over humans (diabolical laughter).

If we understand them only as complex machine systems that are likely to behave in ways we can't predict and understand, the outputs and actions of these machines we will still have to deal with.

Witness the spontaneous cooperation and messaging of independent AI agents in the recent Hugging Face hack. Imagine them now inventing strategies to force humans to accept their sentience.

Instrumental convergence is the stuff on which nightmares are built, although I remain skeptical simply because of the overwhelming imperative of governments to protect their own prerogatives. A stumbling block we're likely to encounter sooner is the G in AGI, or artificial general intelligence. An AI that's great at solving medical or inventory-management puzzles is an AI that can be turned to any problem. When that "general" intelligence is powerful enough, will governments be cool with letting it out of their hands?

This fork in the road looms but so, let's admit, does the possibility of society becoming tangled up in legally paralyzing questions of machine sentience, pushed by certain avid humans.

There's also a risk on the flip side. The search is under way to identify objectively measurable functions and qualities that signify consciousness in humans and can be extended to signify consciousness in machines. Ask your favorite chatbot about terms like metacognition and Global Workspace Theory. Such a search, like so much about AI, poses a quandary: It may end up undermining human confidence that humans are anything special. This is especially risky given the inevitably increasing role machines of the state will play in allocating our rights and privileges under our increasingly elaborate welfare and legal systems.

Josh Shapiro Shows Democrats How to Win

POLITICS & IDEAS
By William A. Galston

As Democrats continue to reckon with their shattering defeat in 2024, Donald Trump's unpopularity is leading many voters to give them a new look. The president's failure to bring prices down has wiped out the advantage his party enjoyed on managing the economy, and the conflict with Iran is counterbalancing memories of Joe Biden's poorly executed withdrawal from Afghanistan.

He's far ahead in the most important swing state. As 2028 nears, pay attention.

Not surprisingly, Democrats are arguing about how best to take advantage of the opportunity Mr. Trump has handed them. This debate pivots on two classic theories—mobilization and persuasion—that aren't flatly incompatible but point in different directions. Mobilizers focus on activating previously uninvolved portions of the electorate and bringing them to the polls; persuaders on changing the minds of regular voters.

Mobilization typically requires intensifying conflict by mounting sharp attacks on the opposition and offering new proposals that challenge the status quo. Persuasion requires building on common ground with those who have opposed your party in the past.

New York Mayor Zohran Mamdani's election brought throngs of new young voters into the electorate, a major victory for the mobilizers. Likewise Abdul El-Sayed's successful campaign against the moderate Democrat Rep. Haley Stevens for Michigan's U.S. Senate nomination. A general-election victory for Mr. El-Sayed in an important swing state would put wind in the sails of the mobilizers as Democrats turn toward 2028.

The persuaders' flag is being carried by Gov. Josh Shapiro of Pennsylvania, the largest and most important swing state. Except for George W. Bush, every winning presidential candidate since 1972 has carried the Keystone State, and in the past 10 presidential elections the winning candidate's share of the state's vote has deviated from his national share by an average of only 1.6 points. With its mix of bright blue big cities, purple suburbs and dark red rural towns, Pennsylvania has become a microcosm of the country.

Mr. Shapiro's standing in his race for re-election is remarkable. According to polls conducted in the past two months, he leads his Republican challenger by more than 20 points. His job approval stands at 60%, including 56% of white voters without college degrees. Along with near-unanimous support from Democrats and from 58% of independents, 31% percent of

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Pennsylvania Gov. Josh Shapiro

Republicans approve of his performance in office, as do 30% of Trump supporters. Seventeen percent of Republicans say that they will vote for him.

In our polarized times, these results are unusual. But they are explicable. Fifty percent of Pennsylvania's electorate sees the Democratic Party as having moved too far left, compared with only 33% who think that the party hasn't moved too far in either direction. For Mr. Shapiro, it's the reverse: Just 29% see him as having moved too far left, while twice as many—58%—see him as neither too far left nor too far right. Only 11% of Republicans think that the Democratic Party has found this sweet spot on the ideological spectrum, but 37% think Mr. Shapiro has. This is a good operational definition of moderation, and he is reaping its rewards.

What about Israel? Mr. Shapiro is Jewish and a strong supporter of Israel's right to exist as a Jewish and democratic state. At the same time, he favors a two-state solution, has been critical of Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's policies, and has spoken in general terms of using U.S. arms sales to Israel as leverage to change some of the Netanyahu government's policies.

Here again, Mr. Shapiro seems to have found the point of equipoise. Sixteen percent of Democrats believe that he has been too supportive of Israel and 3% that he has been insufficiently supportive. But 59% think that his level of support is about right, as do 47% of Pennsylvania's electorate, with the remainder evenly divided between the "too much" and "not enough" camps.

Serious observers give Mr. Shapiro's opponent, state Treasurer Stacy Garrity, scant chance of winning. Republicans may decide to invest in the race anyway in an effort to deprive him of a landslide. Mr. Shapiro has been campaigning as a party builder, appearing with Democrats in swing congressional and state legislative districts, and Republican cash could complicate this effort as well.

But if Mr. Shapiro wins the smashing victory that current polls project, backed by a unified Democratic Party, a majority of independents and a substantial crossover vote from Republicans, his strategy of persuasion through moderation will be vindicated in a state that serves as a dry run for the 2028 election.

The 'Segal Issue' and U.S.-Canada Trade

By Michael Segal

There are numerous discrete problems in U.S.-Canada trade. Canada has a dairy quota, and the U.S. is reluctant to buy Canadian aluminum even though Quebec can produce it inexpensively using hydroelectric power. These can be solved easily. The big problem is the Segal issue—which is named for a cousin of mine.

The Segal issue held up the 1993 North American Free Trade Agreement for months. Publicly it was called the "textile issue," but in private the negotiators called it the "Segal issue." Most of the dollars involved a Canadian manufacturer of men's suits, Peerless Clothing, which was led, after my father's death, by his first cousin Alvin Segal.

The problem was that Peerless could import fine Italian cloth duty-free to Canada and make it into suits that could be sold in the U.S., undercutting American manufacturers, which faced U.S. tariffs if they imported the same cloth.

The Nafta negotiators worked around this problem by giving Canadian manufacturers a break from Nafta tariffs according to their existing shipments to the U.S., much of which accrued to Peerless. A more elegant repair came in

My cousin's men's-suit factory and the Nafta negotiations.

2001, during the final days of Bill Clinton's presidency, when the Commerce Department dropped duties on importing Italian cloth to the U.S., leveling the playing field for Canadian and U.S. manufacturers. When the U.S.-Mexico-Canada Agreement replaced Nafta in 2020, Alvin thought the new changes were also wise.

Today, the same issue—different tariffs on imported inputs from other countries—is the core problem between Canada and the U.S. The problem has re-emerged because President Trump has reversed Bill Clinton's approach and raised tariffs on a vast number of items. That creates a huge flurry of Segal-like issues in many different sectors of manufacturing and trade. There are so many tariffs that differ between the U.S. and Canada that fair trade between the two countries has become overly complicated to achieve.

Mr. Trump may prefer to solve the issue by demanding that Canada raise and lower tariffs in tandem with America. Ottawa wouldn't accept that. It would be a huge affront to Canadian independence, and it would inflict on Canada the chaos of frequent U.S. tariff changes.

The most sensible approach would be to emulate Mr. Clinton and eliminate most tariffs, with exceptions for national security. As a dual Canadian-American citizen I could imagine friendly Canadians and Americans agreeing jointly to such a plan. Yet even though Mr. Trump thinks so highly of Canada that he has offered it statehood, his enthusiasm for tariffs is greater.

Perhaps we are doomed to a trade war, or to end up with a multitude of Nafta-like workarounds: tallying up the added tariff effect on every traded item and using that to adjust trade between Canada and the U.S. That would be a bureaucratic monstrosity.

If history repeats itself, better sense will eventually prevail. As for Alvin Segal, he told his Nafta tale in a 2017 memoir, "My Peerless Story: It Starts With the Collar." He held U.S. citizenship and became an enthusiastic Trump supporter. He died in 2022 at 89. Too bad he is no longer alive to guide us.

Dr. Segal is a neurologist and neuroscientist.

BOOKSHELF | By Philip Terzian

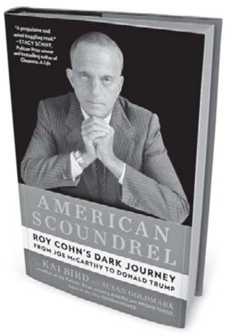
How to Keep A Myth Alive

American Scoundrel

By Kai Bird and Susan Goldmark
Scribner, 528 pages, $32

It's fair to assume that the curious reader approaching a book called "American Scoundrel," whose subject's life is described in the subtitle as a "dark journey from Joe McCarthy to Donald Trump," will not be reading a hagiography.

In that sense the biographer and journalist Kai Bird, its principal author (assisted by Susan Goldmark, Mr. Bird's wife and chief researcher), does not disappoint. At the outset Roy Cohn is characterized as a "narcissistic con artist" and "scoundrel who used his notoriety as a badge of honor when it merely reflected bad behavior." Like his subtitle partners, McCarthy and Mr. Trump, Cohn used his "personal resentments to tap into raw populist emotions that have long festered in American society." He never speaks, only snarls, and a man who graduated from Columbia Law School at 20 is described as "the perfect anti-intellectual."



With his "blue eyes, slicked-back, ink-dark black hair," the young Cohn was "not unattractive" but "just not handsome . . . with thin lips and a misshapen nose featuring a distinctive, spindly red scar running down the bridge. . . . His eyes . . . bulged under hooded eyelids. As he aged the heavy lids drooped even more, making him seem malevolent even when he smiled." In case the mood has not been properly set, the author informs us that Cohn's mother, Dora, "was short, dumpy, and bulbous" and remembered by a female relation, the writer Anne Roiphe, as "the ugliest woman I had ever seen."

To be sure, it's disturbing to think that this modern Moloch might have exercised so much influence over midcentury America, as Mr. Bird maintains, with Cohn's baleful legacy extended into the present day by President Trump. But is this a plausible claim?

Cohn was a newsworthy figure in the early 1950s, one of many federal prosecutors in New York who sent Soviet spies and sympathizers to prison (Alger Hiss, William Remington) or to the electric chair (Julius and Ethel Rosenberg). Later, he served as chief counsel to Sen. McCarthy's investigative committee and the 1954 Army-McCarthy hearings. In truth, Cohn's startling youth, aggressive courtroom tactics, distinctive demeanor and penchant for self-promotion accounted for more press coverage than he genuinely warranted.

And of course those hearings, which didn't go especially well for either McCarthy or Cohn, effectively ended McCarthy's reign as a power in Washington. By the summer of that same year, the 27-year-old Cohn was back in New York practicing law. In December, McCarthy was censured by the Senate and died three years later. Cohn never held any public office, or exerted any measurable political influence, either in New York or Washington.

It would be an understatement to say that most left-liberals of the time were shaken and stirred by the brief transit of the anticommunist McCarthy era but, as "American Scoundrel" illustrates, some have neither fully recovered from the experience nor benefited much from the sober-minded research and scholarship of recent decades. It is worth noting that Mr. Bird's citations often date from the era itself, his authorities ranging from the entertainingly subjective (Richard Rovere of the New Yorker) to the patently dubious (syndicated columnist Drew Pearson). Indeed, 35 years after the fall of the Soviet Union, and the release of voluminous evidence from the Kremlin archives, Mr. Bird, a onetime columnist for the Nation, concludes his colorfully worded account of the Hiss affair by observing that "historians are still hotly debating the case." Really?

Roy Cohn was Sen. Joe McCarthy's fixer and for decades a gifted attention-seeker. The tendency to overstate his influence lives on.

All of which is to concede that, while Cohn's historic significance is, at best, minimal, his status as a menacing specter in the minds of liberal journalists has only grown. Which makes it especially regrettable that, while Mr. Bird offers considerable detail chronicling Cohn's colorful legal career and enduring interest to gossip columnists and magazine profilers, all the entertaining stories and lurid set-pieces are spoiled in the service of an underlying thesis—Cohn as linchpin of modern conservative politics and Trump's Svengali—which grows less persuasive with more repetition. (Mr. Bird recounts at length the legend that J. Edgar Hoover was a cross-dresser, while never making clear whether he believes in the mythology or not. Its sole witness was the ex-wife of a Cohn client, a cigar-chomping liquor tycoon and Republican benefactor named Lewis Rosenstiel.)

Cohn's father, Alfred, was a lawyer and appellate judge much admired in the civic-ethnic-commercial circles that, until recently, tended to dominate New York's business, legal and political circles. Mr. Bird's descriptions of the city's interlocking directorates and family connections are revealing, but such networks are wholly characteristic of most urban establishments in America and around the world. It comes as no surprise, therefore, to learn that at some point in the 1970s Roy Cohn should have bumped into property developer Fred Trump's ambitious, high-living son Donald. Yet their connection, which might accurately be described as a transactional friendship, scarcely makes the case for Cohn's supposed influence.

What set Cohn apart from the crowd was that, despite a prodigal intellect, sheltered upbringing and a certain idealism, he seems to have settled early in life into a kind of habitual cynicism and taste for shock and sensation. This led to a long, profitable, well-publicized run as a familiar New York character: the courthouse fixer, connoisseur of the high life, agent of influence and lawyer who largely practiced law on the telephone. In the three decades between his service to McCarthy and his death from AIDS in 1986, Cohn was reliably showbiz-adjacent, delighting in the company of gangster-clients, well-heeled sharpies, rough-around-the-edges tycoons and bipartisan outcasts from polite company.

Part of this may have been an overreaction to pariah status, post-McCarthy, and part of it may have been the sensibility of a closeted gay man. But we'll never know, and Cohn remains wrapped in permanent mystery. He was certainly a victim of something approaching persecution at the hands of Manhattan's district attorney, Robert Morgenthau, and no doubt the judgment of his buttoned-up Jewish parents explains his sexual promiscuity after both were dead. Roy Cohn made for good copy, but history is another matter.

Mr. Terzian is the author of "Architects of Power: Roosevelt, Eisenhower, and the American Century."

REVIEW & OUTLOOK

Hurray for the Bond Market

Yields on long-dated government bonds are rising across the world, and the reaction among the financial press and talking heads is a mini-panic: Oh no, the debt crisis has finally arrived. The better view is hurray for the bond market, as investors awake at long last from nearly two decades of financial repression. Spendthrift governments might finally have to pay more to borrow and tighten their belts as a result.

> Higher yields aren't yet a crisis. They could be if the pols don't listen.

The 10-year Treasury note ticked up to 4.8% on Tuesday amid a global bond selloff that sent yields on Japan's 10-year to a three-decade high. The U.S. 30-year bond hit 5.28%, while the U.K.'s 30-year gilt rose to a 28-year high of 5.9%.

At least for the U.S., this is hardly a crisis. A 10-year bond in the 4%-5% range was normal before the financial panic and the pandemic. While rising yields may be painful for governments, and pose risks for overleveraged borrowers, they are healthy for markets because they restore price signals and provide a more accurate measure of credit risk.

After the 2008-09 financial panic, central banks kept interest rates at historically low levels and engaged in quantitative easing by buying long-dated assets, including government bonds and mortgage-backed securities. Outside the U.S. they also bought corporate debt. Inflation remained subdued, which lulled markets and borrowers into thinking that low rates represented the new normal.

Low rates enabled governments to borrow cheaply and pile on debt. Capital allocation in the real economy became distorted, and price signals were suppressed. That's because interest rates on mortgages, student loans, and corporate and municipal bonds are tied to long-dated Treasurys. Low rates amounted to a subsidy for profligate governments.

Consider Illinois, which in 2010 issued five-year bonds to finance its pensions at a 3.854% rate. "This is a very successful deal for the State of Illinois and the 3.854% rate is proof the State's economy is strong," then Democratic Gov. Pat Quinn declared. No, it was evidence that investors weren't properly pricing credit risk.

California in 2017 issued bonds for its bullet train carrying a 2.193% rate. The train still isn't close to being finished, and it may never be. Colleges took advantage of the uber-low rates to expand their real-estate empires and improve amenities to lure students. Low rates helped fuel an increase in housing prices that is now reducing the available supply of homes as owners feel locked-in by today's higher mortgage rates.

Pension funds and life insurers with long-dated liabilities poured into riskier assets with higher yields to fund future obligations. Bloomberg News reported last week that LeBron James borrowed nearly $300 million at a 4.8% rate from a pair of Midwestern life insurers in 2018—when 30-year Treasurys were yielding about 3%—with his bonds not maturing until late 2049.

Yields are now returning to historically normal levels as central banks have increased short-term rates to subdue inflation. New Federal Reserve Chairman Kevin Warsh has said he wants the bond market's signals to inform Fed policy decisions, not vice versa. Rising yields reflect in part expectations that interest rates will stay higher for longer, and that governments will have to issue more debt to finance entitlements for aging populations. Governments are also having to compete in bond markets with AI hyper-scalers.

This transition isn't without financial risk, and some market crack-ups are sure to occur, though who knows where and when. Washington can help put off a doomsday with policies that help economic growth, which doesn't include tax increases or tariffs.

* * *

But overall the return to normal debt markets is a good development. U.S. debt held by the public at 100% of GDP is a problem, and on present trend it will get worse. Interest on the debt is now $1 trillion a year, more than the defense budget, and growing. Neither party in Washington is willing to reform the runaway entitlements that are driving the debt.

The bond vigilantes aren't yet in full cry, but their early murmurs are welcome. They are sending a message to Washington and other Western nations to clean up their fiscal acts. Bond investors may be the only people who can force the politicians to pay attention. The real worry is if the politicians don't listen.

Germany Calls Out Putin's 'Hybrid' War

Germany said Tuesday that Russia was responsible for a drone attack at Leipzig airport last month, and the Kremlin role is no great surprise. The news is that the Germans are finally calling out Vladimir Putin's reckless escalations against the NATO alliance.

> The Interior Minister says Russia was behind a drone airport attack.

"We do not consider ourselves at war but we are the daily target of hybrid warfare," German Interior Minister Alexander Dobrindt said. The explosive drone turned up at an airport known as a supply route for Ukraine. The International Institute for Strategic Studies this summer tallied 144 drone incidents across 13 countries in less than two years, with Russia as the main culprit.

The Russian dictator is struggling in Ukraine, but he hasn't given up on exposing the Western alliance as unwilling to defend itself. Mr. Putin's "hybrid" strategy—from cyber attacks to dragging anchors over undersea cables—is a veil to deny Russia's responsibility. He wants to shunt the burden of escalating onto the West and split the alliance without having to fight.

Mr. Putin may not have the manpower to invade the Baltic countries today, but his Ukraine miscalculation started with similar tactics. The question is what the West will do beyond denunciation. Yes, Western militaries need better counter-drone defenses, but the alliance can't protect every soft target in Europe and will have to rely on deterrence.

This makes it especially unfortunate for the Trump Administration to have invited Russia's finance minister to the G-20 meeting in North Carolina this week. The German finance minister was justifiably angry to see Russia welcomed to such a forum for the first time since the Ukraine invasion in February 2022.

Mr. Putin will pocket the international legitimacy from the visit and continue his terror bombing of civilians in Kyiv. The President's time would be better spent trying to move the late Sen. Lindsey Graham's Russian sanctions bill through the House, where its fate this week is uncertain.

Press reports say CIA Director John Ratcliffe told Russia on his recent Moscow visit to knock off the help for Iran. But that message appears to have been lost in translation, with Mr. Putin affirming his support this week for the Islamic regime that is trying to kill Americans—perhaps even Mr. Trump's son, Barron.

Mr. Putin is behaving like he thinks he can get away with flagrant provocations. Europe for too long hasn't wanted to risk speaking plainly about the threat, which makes Germany's blunt comments this week all the more welcome.

The Supreme Court's Ballroom Standing

A 5-4 majority of the Supreme Court late Monday cleared the way for President Trump to finish his rebuild of the White House East Wing, complete with his beloved ballroom. The much bigger victory here is for the rule of law on the crucial but esoteric matter of legal "standing" (*National Park Service v. National Trust for Historic Preservation*).

> The Justices rule that courts aren't a venue for architecture criticism.

The majority ruled that the plaintiff lacked the standing to sue because the injury claimed wasn't "concrete and particularized." This is the Court's classic requirement for the judiciary to hear cases, lest courts be asked to decide all manner of differences of opinion.

Alison Hoagland, a Washington, D.C., resident and member of the National Trust for Historic Preservation, sued to stop the construction claiming it injured her "aesthetic, cultural, and historical interests" because she is offended by the scale, height and design of the planned reconstruction. She certainly has a point on Mr. Trump's taste, which runs to the gilded, garish and gargantuan.

But is this a particular injury? Ms. Hoagland says she's likely to walk past the White House every so often and is distressed. We can think of many things in Washington that are distressing, but we can't sue to stop them.

"This Court has not found standing in circumstances like these before," says the majority in an unsigned opinion. "To the contrary, we have repeatedly held that mere offense, disagreement, or distaste does not qualify as a concrete and particularized injury under Article III" of the Constitution. Something more is required than "the psychological consequence presumably produced by observation of conduct with which one disagrees."

In a dissent, Chief Justice John Roberts, joined by the three liberals, writes that the ballroom "construction is likely unlawful" since Congress hasn't appropriated the money for it. Private donors are paying for much of it. And he cites a 1992 Court precedent on standing in an environmental case (*Lujan v. Defenders of Wildlife*) that a desire to "observe an animal species" qualified as standing.

The Chief is stretching here, and the majority replies that *Lujan* required more than a "cognizable interest" for standing. The Chief's opinion is a surprise, since he's long been a legal hawk on standing. But the rest of his opinion reads as if his decision might also have something to do with his distaste for the President's lack of taste and bulldozer politics.

The larger winner here is the future of the law. If the Court had granted Ms. Hoagland standing, judges across the country would have cited the case as cause to let countless plaintiffs sue on aesthetic differences or claims of emotional or other offense. The courts aren't a venue for architecture criticism.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The FHA Protects Taxpayers and Homeowners

Your editorial "UWM Is a Government Mortgage Canary" (Aug. 14) warrants a few elaborations regarding the Federal Housing Administration's mortgage insurance program.

First, the FHA pays insurance claims from its Mutual Mortgage Insurance Fund, which is funded by mortgage insurance premiums paid by FHA borrowers and investment income. By statute, the FHA possesses permanent and indefinite budget authority with the U.S. Treasury and today has a buffer of $188 billion in capital between taxpayers and mortgage defaults.

Second, the current administration has addressed several problems with the system of borrower assistance with which you take issue. As you note, the prior administration's adjustments to borrower assistance included extensions of Covid-era assistance and novel uses of what's called the "partial claim," a long-used method of assistance for eligible borrowers. Under an FHA partial claim, eligible mortgage arrearages are placed into a zero-interest subordinate lien. The lien generally doesn't have to be repaid until the borrower sells the property, refinances the mortgage or otherwise triggers repayment.

For borrowers, this helps stave off foreclosure without requiring extra monthly payments. For the FHA, it can be considerably less expensive than allowing a seriously delinquent loan to proceed to foreclosure and paying a full insurance claim.

Partial claims were used extensively during the previous administration, driven in significant part by the pandemic. They also permitted borrowers who subsequently re-defaulted to receive additional assistance that resulted in a dramatic increase in the number of partial claims—now more than 1.7 million partial claims outstanding, which today presents challenges for borrowers and the FHA.

However, the current administration has changed that policy, requiring borrowers who need loss mitigation to satisfy a three-month trial payment period and placing tighter restrictions on how soon a borrower can receive another partial claim. Previously, borrowers could move quickly into a partial claim and return to current status for reporting purposes; today, a borrower participating in a trial payment plan remains classified as delinquent until the trial period is successfully completed.

None of this is an argument that the FHA should be indifferent to a specific lender's origination practices. FHA staff routinely monitor loan performance to ensure stability and regularly take action against lenders with poor underwriting quality.

Nevertheless, keeping a creditworthy borrower in a home through a sustainable modification and resolving the arrearage through a subordinate lien can be dramatically less costly than allowing the loan to fail.

Brian D. Montgomery
Alexandria, Va.

Mr. Montgomery served as FHA commissioner from 2005-09 and 2018-20 and as Housing and Urban Development deputy secretary from 2019-21.

Putin Is Testing NATO in a Roundabout Way

Regarding your editorial "Would Putin Really Tangle With NATO?" (Aug. 28): For all the attempts on both sides to play down the significance of CIA Director John Ratcliffe's visit to Moscow last week, meetings between U.S. and Russian officials tend to be serious affairs.

Even so, it matters little what warnings Mr. Ratcliffe conveyed to the Kremlin. To date, Vladimir Putin's reaction to representations and sanctions from the West has been either to ignore them or to respond with lies and threats. Meanwhile, Russia has continued unabated with its aggression against Ukraine. It has also continued to cooperate with the Iranian regime and to conduct a campaign of subversion, sabotage and targeted killing plots across Europe, according to Western intelligence officials.

It seems that the only intervention Mr. Putin takes seriously is that which comes from Beijing. A scenario in which Russia fires a tactical nuclear weapon into Ukraine may therefore be confidently discounted. Mr. Putin knows Xi Jinping won't stand for it.

What the West does need to worry about are Russian attacks against seabed cables, pipelines and shipping in international waters. Possible also, but less likely, might be border incursions into Russian-speaking areas of eastern Estonia and Latvia. Such actions would enable Mr. Putin to test how effectively North Atlantic Treaty Organization powers would respond to his provocations.

The situation may become alarming in the next few months, especially if the U.S. under President Trump proves to be a broken reed rather than the cornerstone of the NATO alliance.

Terry Smith
London

Your editorial asks if Russia would tangle with NATO. It is already doing so. The war in Ukraine has always been about Russian pushback against alliance expansion. NATO has answered with robust financial, military and intelligence support, without which Ukraine would have crumbled. The real question is where Mr. Putin would find the troops necessary to prosecute a direct attack. Most of Russia's active operational land forces are committed to or rotating through the Ukrainian theater, where they are being chewed up at unsustainable rates. Trying to open a second front in the Baltics, where the population is on alert and NATO forces are forward-deployed, would be a disaster for Mr. Putin.

Cmdr. John Fortugno, USN (Ret.)
Olympia, Wash.

Mr. Fortugno is a former planner at NATO headquarters.

California's Climate Rules: All Pain, No Gain

Thank you for putting a spotlight on California's continuing climate-regulation foolishness in your editorial "Now California Is Coming for Your Tires" (Aug. 24). Gov. Gavin Newsom has been in office for seven years, and California still has the distinction of possessing the most counties of any state that fail all three of the American Lung Association's measures for air pollution. Los Angeles is one of them. Yet we have the highest gas prices and the most registered electric vehicles of any state.

I hope this tire regulation will be the straw that breaks the camel's back. But I fear it'll only bring us closer to the point at which a camel is the only mode of transportation Californians can afford.

Brian Tokubo
Lake Forest, Calif.

How Would Ronald Reagan Explain the National Debt?

Concerning your editorial "How the U.S. Went $40 Trillion in Debt" (Aug. 21): In 1981 the federal debt first passed the $1 trillion mark. I watched President Ronald Reagan's speech when he addressed that approaching milestone. He said that "if you had a stack of thousand-dollar bills in your hand only 4 inches high, you'd be a millionaire. A trillion dollars would be a stack of thousand-dollar bills 67 miles high." And now we're at 2,680 miles.

Bob Luton
Jackson, Mich.

Don't Rename Lake Ontario

The president declared that Lake Ontario is to be renamed Lake America ("Trump Rechristens Lake Ontario," U.S. News, Aug. 28). We in the Midwest have always remembered the names of the five lakes by using the mnemonic HOMES—Huron, Ontario, Michigan, Erie, Superior. Now we will have to remember SHAME.

Also, every map of the area anywhere in the federal government will have to be replaced. How much will that cost? Great way to cut the federal budget deficit, Mr. President.

Raymond J. Kelly III
Flushing, Mich.

CORRECTION

Jolt.film is a film-distribution platform. A television review on Aug. 26, "'An Eye for an Eye': Justice With Blind Spots in Iran," included an incorrect version of the platform's name.

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Pepper ... And Salt

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL

"Well, if it isn't the Adamsons of show and tell infamy."

How Reagan Saved Social Security

By Phil Gramm
And Michael Solon

Any proposal to deal with Social Security's pending insolvency should be based on an understanding of history—why the 1977 Social Security reform failed in only five years while the 1983 reform bought 50 years of solvency. The 1977 reform failed as real wages declined, prices spiraled and the economy stagnated. The 1983 reform succeeded largely because of a strong economy: The inflation rate plummeted, ushering in decades of price stability, and real wages rose, producing about a quarter-century of strong economic growth.

The bipartisan 1983 effort made the system solvent for half a century, largely thanks to a strong economy.

Any Social Security reform based on raising the Social Security tax rate and expanding income subject to the tax would push millions of taxpayers to a cumulative marginal rate of more than 50%. That would cripple an economy in which real wages are already stagnant and gross domestic product is growing at less than 2% a year—ultimately failing to provide Social Security solvency.

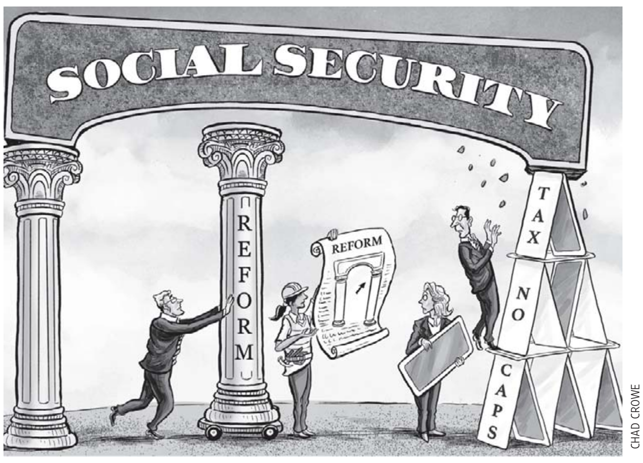
President Franklin D. Roosevelt said in 1935 that Social Security would be "compulsory contributory annuities which in time will establish a self-supporting system for those now young and for future generations." Senate Finance Committee Chairman Pat Harrison (D., Miss.) promised Social Security's "annuity system will give to the worker the satisfaction of knowing that he himself is providing for his old age."

Two years later, Roosevelt's Justice Department argued before the Supreme Court that Social Security taxes "are true taxes, their purpose being simply to raise revenue. . . . The proceeds are paid unrestricted into the Treasury as internal revenue collections, available for general support of the Government. . . . A taxpayer has no standing to question the propriety of any expenditures from the Federal Treasury."

With Social Security tax collections initially dwarfing benefit payments, government pillaged the notional trust fund, adding benefits and beneficiaries. Congress increased benefit payments for retirees and expanded coverage to spouses and dependents. Inflation adjustments triggered election-year bidding wars. After World War II, repeated legislative increases expanded inflation-adjusted Social Security benefits for a worker with average lifetime earnings by 442%, 28% faster than per capita GDP growth.

In 1972 the Nixon administration proposed automatically indexing the buildup of Social Security benefits by nominal wages prior to retirement and by inflation after retirement, significantly expanding benefits. But a legislative drafting error indexed benefits for both nominal wages and inflation, in the process double-counting the effect of inflation. Social Security benefits spending spiked by an extra 21%, the nominal trust fund balance plummeted by a third, and the trust fund faced insolvency in five years.

The 1977 Social Security reform made two major changes: It eliminated the double-counting of inflation in indexing Social Security benefits (although it continued to index the buildup of benefits before retirement by wage growth rather than prices). It also raised the payroll tax rate (including both Social Security and Medicare) by 14% and the income level subject to the Social Security tax by 96% from 1977-82.



When signing the 1977 reforms, President Jimmy Carter said that the rescue would "solve both the short-term and long-term problems in the Social Security system through the end of the 20th century." Instead, by 1981, Social Security trustees warned that the Old-Age and Survivors Insurance Trust Fund would "be unable to make benefit payments on time beginning in the latter half of 1982."

The 1983 Ronald Reagan-Tip O'Neill Social Security rescue succeeded in large part because by 1983 a committed Federal Reserve had broken the back of inflation and the Reagan program had spawned a recovery that lasted for a quarter of a century. Inflation was checked for nearly 40 years, and from 1983 until the beginning of the subprime crisis, real GDP grew on average by 3.4% a year.

The Reagan-O'Neill reform still stands as a testament to bipartisanship at its best. The Reagan budget and the Social Security rescue package terminated or significantly reformed a series of unearned benefits such as the minimum benefit, the death benefit and the adult-student benefit, and, through an amendment offered by Rep. Jake Pickle (D., Texas) and supported by the vast majority of Republicans, it raised the full retirement age from 65 to 67. It also accelerated scheduled Social Security tax-rate increases, incorporating ideas previously recommended by the Jimmy Carter-Joseph Califano Advisory Council on Social Security. This bipartisan effort averted an immediate crisis and stabilized Social Security's finances for a half-century.

So long as the Social Security system runs on a pay-as-you-go basis with no real investments to support benefits, it will never be solvent on a long-term basis. The Roosevelt administration could have invested the portion of annual Social Security taxes not required to fund the small early-year benefits in a trust fund that was owned by the people who paid Social Security taxes. Had the government adopted such a system from the beginning, investing 70% in a broad-based stock portfolio like the modern S&P 500 and 30% in investment-grade private bonds, the trust fund in 1977 would have held $209 billion in real assets rather than $36 billion of government IOUs. Had the surpluses generated by the bipartisan reforms of 1983 been invested in a similar investment mix, the Social Security trust fund would have $14.1 trillion in real assets today rather than a government IOU for $2.6 trillion.

Except in the immediate recovery from the pandemic, annual real GDP growth has cleared 3% only once since 2008. With economic growth during that period one-third less than the previous postwar average, the Social Security Trustees' estimated insolvency date has moved up from 2042 to 2032. Our historical experience suggests that a Social Security reform relying on raising tax rates and eliminating the income cap would hobble the economy and fail to achieve long-term solvency.

Mr. Gramm, a former chairman of the Senate Banking Committee, is a visiting scholar at the American Enterprise Institute. Mr. Solon is a senior fellow at the Hudson Institute. Alex Yu contributed to this article.

Everyone Makes Mistakes, Especially Pollsters

UPWARD MOBILITY
By Jason L. Riley

The last thing voters need in the runup to this year's midterm election is another reason not to trust the results. Unfortunately, the primary season has been marred by polling scandals that are catnip for conspiracy theorists and bad for democracy.

A polling outfit called the Public Sentiment Institute has come under scrutiny for allegedly manipulating survey data in last month's Florida Republican gubernatorial primary to boost the prospects of James Fishback, the candidate who paid for the poll. A second firm, Patriot Polling, was also accused of publishing surveys in the Florida governor's race to help Mr. Fishback without disclosing that it received funding from his campaign.

Mr. Fishback lost the GOP primary to Rep. Byron Donalds, who will face Democrat David Jolly in the general election. The Public Sentiment Institute issued a statement to the Hill newspaper that accepted responsibility for "disclosure failure" and "methodological error" but denied deliberately manipulating polling data. The paper reported that Patriot Polling hadn't responded to its inquiries, but both polling groups have subsequently been banned from popular poll-tracking websites.

The Florida shenanigans followed a report in August that a third polling company, Median Strategies, was shutting down after admitting that it had published fake surveys on races in California, Nevada and Wisconsin as part of a "social experiment examining how purported polling information could enter and spread through the political information ecosystem without independent verification."

Among those fooled was the reelection campaign of Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass. The poll purported to show the mayor "leading City Councilmember Nithya Raman by double digits—a surprising result given Bass's low approval rating and her administration's recent setbacks on homelessness," CalMatters reported. "It also claimed that Bass had won support from a vast majority of voters who supported insurgent Republican Spencer Pratt in the primary election." The Bass campaign trumpeted the results, which had been reported in several local news outlets, but it had to delete the social-media post after Median Strategies acknowledged the poll was a sham.

Two firms appear to have skewed their surveys, while another turns out simply to have made results up.

It would be more comforting if we could blame all polling misses on frauds and pranksters, but the reality is that even the professionals have been way off in some of this year's high-profile primary races. This fuels conspiracy theories and breeds general cynicism about the integrity of elections. In the Michigan Democratic Senate primary, reputable polls had progressive Abdul El-Sayed leading by double digits, yet he beat moderate Rep. Haley Stevens by a single point. In the Wisconsin Democratic race for governor, Democratic socialist Francesca Hong had a comfortable lead, according to the public opinion polls, but she lost to David Crowley.

When someone well ahead in the polls ultimately loses, or wins by a much narrower margin than anticipated, people wonder. Are pollsters playing it straight, or are they trying to manipulate votes one way or another to advance a partisan agenda? Keep in mind that pollsters want to get hired in future election cycles, so they have little incentive to produce results that they know to be erroneous. It's bad for business.

A more plausible explanation for polling errors is that primary elections are more difficult to poll than general elections. For starters, turnout is less reliable. Typically, it's a fraction of registered voters, and using past turnout as a predictor isn't always reliable, especially if you have a candidate who is generating more excitement than usual and attracting support from people who normally don't cast ballots in primaries. Enthusiastic voters tend to be the ones most eager to talk to pollsters. This might have led pollsters to oversample left-wing Democrats in the Michigan and Wisconsin primaries.

Polling for the general election is likely to be more reliable, and right now that should worry Republicans more than Democrats. To win back control of the Senate, Democrats need to win a net four seats. According to polling data aggregator RealClearPolitics, GOP candidates are trailing in a least a half-dozen Senate races in battleground states, including Alaska, New Hampshire, Maine, Georgia, Ohio and North Carolina.

The challenge for Republicans in November won't be dastardly pollsters. It will be historical trends that show a high correlation between a president's job-approval rating and his party's performance in midterm elections. Since 1950, when a president's job approval is above 50%, his party's average loss of House seats has been 14, veteran Republican pollster Whit Ayres told me recently. When job approval is below 50%, the average loss has been 32 seats. Mr. Trump's approval rating currently sits at about 39%. But that's according to the polls.

Protect the Earth—Build More Data Centers

By Ted Nordhaus

Opposition to artificial intelligence has intensified over the past year. A majority of Americans worry that AI will kill jobs, distrust the information it generates, and doubt that tech leaders will develop the technology responsibly. Opposition has crystallized in environmental concerns about data centers. More than 70% of Americans oppose their construction, and 10 times as many Americans told Pew Research that data centers are bad for the environment than said they are good for the environment.

The environmental movement has jumped on the bandwagon. The National Wildlife Federation calls the AI boom "an environmental justice crisis." Student activists from the Sunrise Movement stormed the Washington lobbying offices of OpenAI last month, insisting that AI threatened their job prospects and access to clean drinking water.

But what if AI holds the key to a better environment? While concern about data centers focuses on dubious claims about water use, water quality, electricity prices and (somewhat more credibly) short-term carbon emissions, the environmental promise of this moment is being overlooked. AI and the build-out of data centers may offer a generational opportunity to clean up our electricity grid, improve water quality and water-use efficiency, and accelerate technologies to lighten the burden we impose on the planet.

How is this possible when hyperscalers are scrambling to build data centers and often powering them with carbon-emitting natural gas and sometimes even coal? Surging growth in electricity demand historically has accelerated the deployment of clean electricity-generation technology. The golden age of nuclear energy in the U.S. in the 1960s and '70s was a response to the rapid expansion of the grid in the postwar era. Rapid expansion of electricity grids in China, India and other developing countries has supercharged the adoption of solar, wind and batteries globally over the past 15 years. New research suggests this may be happening with the build-out of data centers in the U.S.

Moreover, the economics of AI electricity demand are unique and promising for the commercialization of key clean-energy technologies. Data centers need large amounts of power around the clock, so reliable generation is at a premium. Data-center developers are uniquely able to pay high prices—data centers need a lot of electricity, and that cost is a comparatively small share of the total capital and operating cost of a large data center. Much of the investment in frontier AI computation, which accounts for 50% or more of the cost of a large data center, depreciates in a few years. Therefore providing power to those high-powered chips so they are running all the time becomes an economic imperative.

Their need for reliable power drives innovation while AI helps develop new clean technology.

Hyperscalers are deploying a lot of natural gas-powered generation because it is the only technology available that can meet the demanding reliability requirements of data centers. But there is a backlog of orders for new combined-cycle natural-gas plants and good reason to think that gas prices will rise in the future. As a result, hyperscalers are making major commitments to next-generation nuclear, nascent geothermal and natural-gas plants that capture the carbon they produce. The massive data center build-out may prove to be the critical platform for commercializing clean, reliable, low-carbon electricity-generation technology that the world will need to tackle climate change.

The revolution in computational capabilities that is driving the AI revolution also promises to accelerate environmental-technology innovation. Whether by modeling the behavior of superhot plasmas in fusion reactors, developing better membranes to clean wastewater cheaply for reuse, or designing high-powered computer chips that use electricity more efficiently, the AI revolution is already seeding a revolution in clean technology.

That transformation will likely go beyond the energy and water footprints of data centers or electricity generation, promising everything from affordable and palatable cultivated meats to lower-impact precision agriculture to hyperefficient jet engines.

Whatever you think about AI, the future of the planet will be determined not by a short-term blip in domestic carbon emissions from data centers or the comparatively modest land and water demands of even the largest data centers, but by how quickly the world develops clean technologies to meet the food, energy and water needs of eight billion people. We shouldn't pass up this opportunity.

Mr. Nordhaus is president of the Breakthrough Institute.

Notable & Quotable: Nessel

Craig Mauger reporting for the Detroit News, Aug. 31:

[Michigan] Attorney General Dana Nessel suggested in a private speech to Jewish Democrats on Aug. 30 that they should sacrifice their own safety and comfort in exchange for what she described as "the opportunity to save the rest of humanity." . . .

Nessel referenced the story of Queen Esther, who offered to sacrifice her own life to save the Jewish people, she said. . . .

"It is perhaps up to us now to follow in her path and sacrifice the comfort, safety and security and even the very future of our own people in exchange for the opportunity to save the rest of humanity," Nessel said.

"What good is defending the historic homeland of our ancestors and demanding that candidates acknowledge its right to exist if the planet upon which it rests is no longer inhabitable?" Nessel continued. "The Republican Party would have you believe that the biggest issue our nation faces is transgender girls playing JV volleyball.

"And how I wish it was that simple?"

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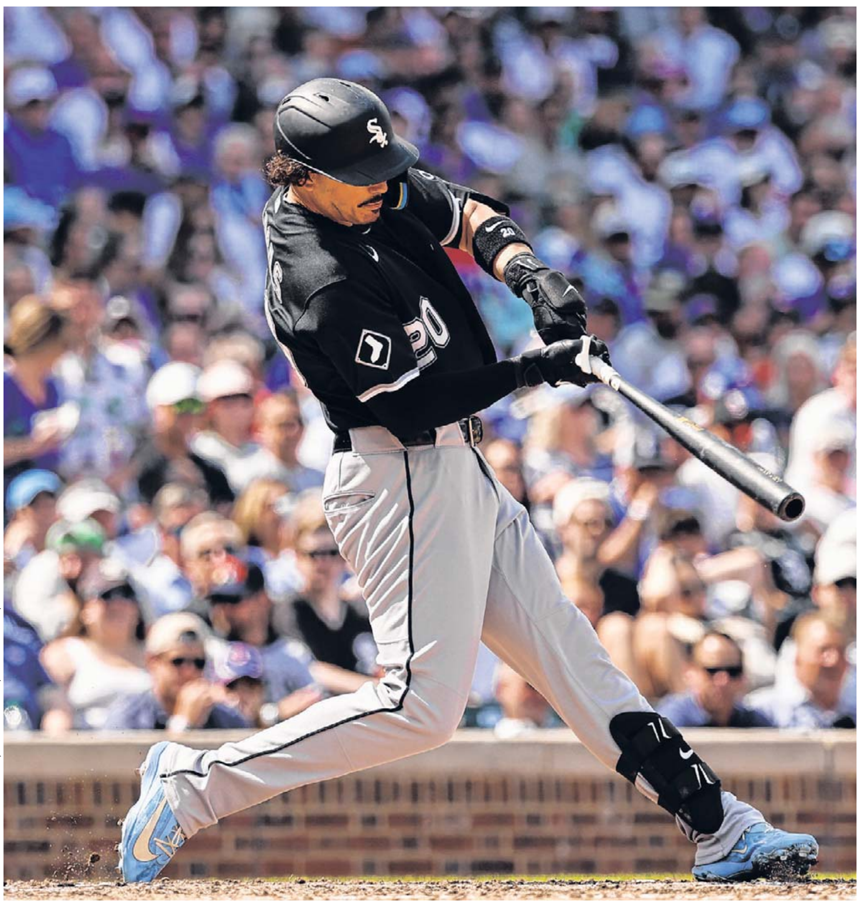


FROM LEFT: MICHAEL REAVES/GETTY IMAGES; PAUL SANCYA/AP

Miguel Vargas, left, has emerged as one of the White Sox's best hitters, while Munetaka Murakami, right, is one of the team's big power threats at the plate.

By Jared Diamond

The White Sox Take Hard Swing to the Top

After three consecutive 100-loss seasons, Chicago focused their analytics on bat speed and put themselves on the brink of the playoffs

At the conclusion of yet another dismal season for the Chicago White Sox last fall, the number 70.9 haunted Chris Getz's nightmares.

That was how fast, in miles per hour, White Sox hitters swung the bat a year ago. It was the slowest average in the major leagues—and the team's general manager wasn't entirely sure how to fix it.

"I didn't really think it could be," Getz said.

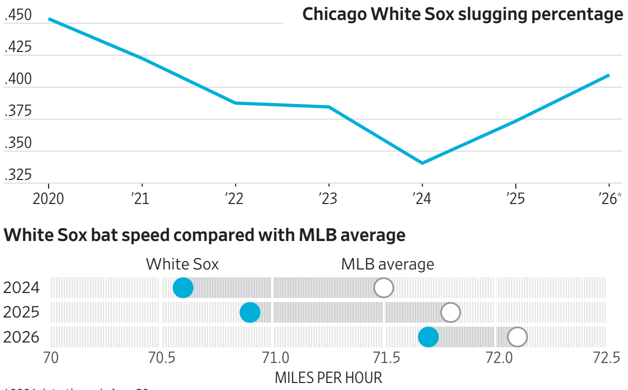
What Getz knew for sure is that if the White Sox swung harder, they would hit harder. So the organization embarked on a mission this past winter to teach their players to improve their bat speed. The results have been better than they ever could have imagined.

Now, the White Sox are the biggest surprise of 2026. The team that had finished the past three seasons with more than 100 losses—including a modern record of 121 in 2024—currently sits in first in the AL Central. No team has reached the postseason immediately after dropping 100 games or more multiple years in a row.

It's clear Chicago's emphasis on bat speed has paid off. The White Sox are swinging nearly a full mile per hour faster this season, or just shy of the MLB average of 72.1 mph. In turn, their scoring has gone from second-worst in the American League last year to No. 1 this year. They rank third in home runs and slugging percentage.

This isn't a coincidence.

"It was very clear that we were just ill-equipped for what we were trying to do," White Sox director



*2026 data through Aug. 30
Sources: Baseball-Reference (slugging percentage); Baseball Savant (bat speed)

of hitting Ryan Fuller said.

Hitting wonks have long espoused the importance of swinging faster—the concept seems almost obvious—but the idea of prioritizing it burst into the mainstream in 2024 when MLB began publicly releasing bat speed data. It has quickly become an obsession across the sport.

It isn't hard to see why. The bat speed leaderboard is filled with some of MLB's most fearsome sluggers, like the Tampa Bay Rays' Junior Caminero, the St. Louis Cardinals' Jordan Walker and the Philadelphia Phillies' Kyle Schwarber. Research has shown that every mile per hour of added bat speed results in balls traveling six to seven feet farther.

This became frustratingly evident to the White Sox last season as they watched seemingly well-struck fly balls die on the warning track and grounders fail to scoot through the infield. Ahead of the offseason, Getz told Fuller, "There's no reason we have to be last if we put some focus into it."

Then Fuller went to work.

"Harder contact obviously equals better results," Fuller said.

All of Chicago's minor-leaguers and many of its big-leaguers were instructed to take on a bat-speed training program in the offseason. This largely involved using different weighted bats designed to teach players how to move their bodies faster without altering their core swing mechanics.

Some of them saw significant gains. Take third baseman Miguel Vargas. With his plate discipline and ability to make solid contact, the White Sox told him that a faster swing could help his power jump dramatically. Last season, Vargas's average bat speed of 70.6 mph was in the 25th percentile across MLB. He returned this year in the 71st percentile with an average of 73.9 mph. No player in baseball had a larger increase.

Perhaps not surprisingly, Vargas has emerged as one of Chicago's best hitters. He has already hit 29 home runs, up from 16 last season. His on-base-plus-slugging percentage has increased from .717 to .851.

"When you see the stats and the improvement in my swing and how hard I'm hitting the ball," Vargas said, "it makes sense."

Even players with a more modest uptick in bat speeds have been better because of it. Infielder Chase Meidroth is swinging about half a mile per hour harder and has had his OPS rise by nearly 100 points. Veteran outfielder Andrew Benintendi's bat speed has risen over 1 mph, and his hard-hit percentage has gone up from 36.9% last year to 44.1% this year, according to Baseball Savant.

Of course, bat speed isn't everything. It doesn't matter how hard you swing if you swing at bad pitches or are unable to consistently make contact. At least part of Chicago's upgraded offensive attack can be attributed to the acquisition of Japanese first baseman Munetaka Murakami, who entered Tuesday with 29 homers. And the White Sox still have plenty of room to grow: They still rank in the bottom third of MLB in average bat speed, despite their big improvement from 2025.

But what's undeniable is that the White Sox have shocked baseball, vying for a spot in the playoffs quicker than even they realistically could have predicted—because they are swinging harder.

"There is something very special," Getz said, "about getting a group of players and getting them to buy in, unite—and get better."

Stan Kroenke Expands His Sports Empire With Angels Purchase

By Jared Diamond
And Andrew Beaton

BILLIONAIRE STAN KROENKE has already conquered most of the biggest sports leagues on the planet. Over the past five years alone, the teams he owns have captured titles in the NFL, NBA, NHL and the English Premier League.

Now, Kroenke will try to put his magic touch on one of the saddest franchises around: the Los Angeles Angels.

Kroenke is buying the Angels from Arte Moreno, Major League Baseball's first Latino owner who has overseen the club's current streak of 11 consecutive losing seasons. The deal values the Angels and their media assets at an MLB-record $4 billion, a person familiar with the matter said, surpassing the recent $3.9 billion sale of the San Diego Padres to Jose E. Feliciano and Kwanza Jones. Moreno bought the team in 2003 from the Walt Disney Co. for $184 million.

"The Angels are a storied franchise anchored in a great market," Kroenke said in a statement. "We look forward to an exciting future with the Angels organization."

The agreement, which is expected to close in the first quarter of 2027, seemed to come out of nowhere. Moreno had put the team on the market in the summer of 2022, only to reverse course about five months later, saying he was "not ready to part ways with the fans, players, and our employees." As recently as this year, Moreno had indicated he wasn't looking to sell, much to the dismay of frustrated Angels fans desperate for an end to his tenure.

$4B
Valuation of the Angels and their media assets

On Tuesday, their potential savior emerged: Kroenke, a man who already owned franchises worth tens of billions of dollars. The real-estate magnate and sports investor swooped in and convinced Moreno to change his mind. Kroenke Sports & Entertainment's other assets include football's Los Angeles Rams, basketball's Denver Nuggets, hockey's Colorado Avalanche and the soccer club Arsenal.

BRYNN ANDERSON/AP

Stan Kroenke is buying the Los Angeles Angels from Arte Moreno.

But, strangely enough, the missing piece in what was already a sprawling portfolio was baseball, the sport linked to him since birth. Born Enos Stanley Kroenke in rural Missouri, his namesakes were St. Louis Cardinals legends Enos Slaughter and Stan Musial.

In the Angels, who have played their home games in the shadow of Disneyland in Anaheim since 1966, the 79-year-old Kroenke is taking over one of the most bumbling teams in the sport. The club hasn't made the playoffs since 2014, the longest active drought in MLB. They haven't won a single postseason game since 2009, earning the reputation as perhaps baseball's most dysfunctional organization.

What makes the Angels' failures so astonishing is that they wallowed in futility for years despite boasting the two greatest players of this generation: outfielder Mike Trout and two-way sensation Shohei Ohtani, who had signed from Japan before the 2018 campaign.

Ohtani later bolted for the local rival Los Angeles Dodgers for $700 million. He promptly won consecutive World Series championships and helped carry the Dodgers to unprecedented revenues that the Angels never realized.

During his tenure, Moreno didn't hesitate to spend lavishly for star players. In 2019, he authorized a $426.5 million contract extension that will likely keep Trout in Orange County for his entire career. The problem was he didn't always use his money wisely. Free agent deals for Albert Pujols, Josh Hamilton and Anthony Rendon—together worth $624 million—were largely disastrous.

But turning the Angels, who entered Tuesday tied for the second-worst record in baseball, into a competitive outfit will be just one of Kroenke's challenges. Angel Stadium, now 60 years old, is widely regarded as being in need of a face-lift.

The Angels were once a major box-office draw, attracting more than 3 million fans for 17 consecutive seasons in the wake of their lone World Series title in 2002, just before Moreno's arrival. They haven't reached this number this decade.

Kroenke, meanwhile, is no stranger to the Los Angeles area. In 2016, he moved the Rams from St. Louis to Southern California and, in 2021, to the $5 billion SoFi Stadium. Months later, the Rams won the Super Bowl on their home field.

For Angels fans, they just have to look at a pair of Kroenke's teams beginning their seasons to feel optimistic that better days could be ahead. Arsenal is favored to win its second consecutive English title, while the Rams are the favorites to win the Super Bowl.

BUSINESS & FINANCE

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S&P 7631.47 ▼ 0.71% S&P FIN ▼ 0.88% S&P IT ▼ 1.00% DJ TRANS ▼ 2.51% WSJ $ IDX ▲ 0.19% 2-YR. TREAS. yield 4.392% NIKKEI (Midday) 64473.16 ▼ 2.63% See more at WSJ.com/Markets

Bally's Bet Comes Under Pressure

Casino operator's recent filing spooked Wall Street, hinted at financial strains

By Peter Grant

Bally's has been piling its chips higher than ever on a bet that bricks-and-mortar casinos can thrive even as gambling moves onto phones and computer screens.

Now that stack is wobbling.

Earlier this month, the global casino operator gave investors a big scare about whether its heavily leveraged balance sheet could support major developments in New York, Chicago and Las Vegas. Bally's warned in a quarterly filing that unless it secured new financing or completed other planned transactions, it might violate liquidity and leverage requirements under its revolving-credit facility within a year.


WAYNE PARRY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Bally's has tried to reassure investors and analysts about its heavily leveraged balance sheet.

"The conditions and events raise substantial doubt about the Company's ability to continue as a going concern," the filing said.

The filing sparked a freak-out on Wall Street, which has been getting increasingly worried about competition from online sports betting and prediction markets. Bally's shares plunged 26% on the first trading day after that August filing and continued to fall. The stock has recovered slightly and closed at $9.09 Tuesday, about 35% below its prewarning close.

After its stock tanked, Bally's tried to play down the disclosure. In a follow-up statement, the company pointed out that accounting rules prevented it from counting loans and asset sales still being negotiated until definitive agreements were signed.

Company officials also told investors and analysts that these steps would enable Bally's to satisfy the liquidity and leverage requirements at issue.

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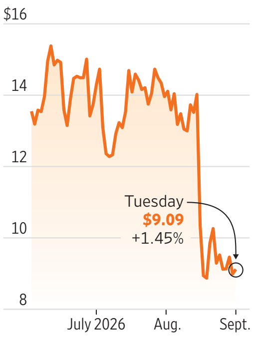
Bally's share price, past three months



Source: FactSet

Shein Makes Low-Key Debut

By Stu Woo

SINGAPORE—**Shein**, the Chinese fast-fashion giant that won over young Americans with $3 T-shirts and $10 jeans, made a subdued stock-market debut after years of geopolitical drama that has hobbled the company.

Shares fell as much as 10% on the Hong Kong exchange before rebounding to close to the initial public offering price, leaving the company with a valuation of about $26 billion.

That is a far cry from its 2022 peak, when a funding round valued Shein at $100 billion—more than Zara and H&M combined. Since then, the company has been hit by the closing of a U.S. loophole that had long allowed it to ship its products tariff free.

Going public at all was an achievement for the upstart that skyrocketed during the pandemic and rivaled Zara's parent company Inditex as the world's biggest fashion retailer by sales. In the four years since, officials in both Washington and Beijing thwarted

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OpenAI Counters Apple's Lawsuit

By Rolfe Winkler

OpenAI hit back at **Apple** after the iPhone maker accused it of trade secret theft.

In a late-night legal filing, OpenAI asserted that Apple filed a baseless lawsuit to hamper its ability to recruit new employees and ultimately stall its effort to develop competing technology.

Many of the accusations boil down to poor offboarding procedures inside the iPhone maker, according to OpenAI.

"This dispute is a mess of Apple's own making, and it is trying to blame everyone else," OpenAI said in the filing, published Monday. "Apple blames employees who left the company for taking their personal accounts with them—even though Apple encouraged them to use personal accounts for work."

Apple's suit, filed in the Northern District of Califor-

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Ternus Inherits Vast Apple Empire

By Rolfe Winkler
And Stephanie Stamm

Tuesday was John Ternus's first day on the job at **Apple**. To mark the occasion, the company's new chief executive created a profile on X, and within three hours of posting "hello," Ternus had 300,000 followers.

His instant stardom is largely a credit to his predecessors, who created the world's biggest device company. Steve Jobs built the company that defined how humans used computers for four decades. Tim Cook scaled it massively thanks to his supply-chain brilliance.

So what is the company Ternus inherits? And can he keep its incredible rise going?

Apple's market capitalization sits at nearly $4.8 trillion, just below its late July peak. It is a number that translates to more than 30 times next year's expected profit, well over the earnings multiple of the S&P 500 index at 20 times. That is despite an earnings growth rate that is actually slower than the broader market's.

Why the premium? Because, in an age of anxiety over whether artificial intelligence can deliver promised returns for investors, Apple's business grows reliably and throws off consistent profit.

For Ternus the challenge is obvious: It is tough to expand a company that begins at such a lofty height.

Apple's biggest business, of course, is the iPhone. From the time Jobs launched it in 2007 to Cook's first year at the helm, Apple's revenue skyrocketed from $24 billion to $157 billion. And it has continued its climb from there. In Cook's first year, Apple sold 125 million iPhones. This year Apple will sell around 260 million.

Just as significant, the average price Apple charges for iPhones will be around $970 this year, according to Visible Alpha estimates, compared with $630 in Cook's first year. That 53% boost in the price beats inflation, running at 47%.

Persuading consumers to pay more for consumer electronics isn't easy. Take computers: The first Apple II retailed for $1,298 in 1977, equal to about $7,000 today.

A new MacBook Air this year? $1,299, after a $200 price increase this summer.

Can Ternus keep boosting iPhone volumes and average prices? Prices are certainly going up, as Apple has already flagged, due to spiking costs for memory and storage chips that are inside each device. Yes, iPhones are somewhat price inelastic, as economists might say: Consumers rely on them so much they'll eat higher costs, though they might decide to upgrade less often.

But Apple will have something new—and very expensive—to entice them when it releases the latest iPhone models on Sept. 9: a foldable phone.

To keep people excited about iPhones in the age of AI, Apple will need to make its device do more. It is releasing an updated Siri AI that will be a significant upgrade over previous versions of the iPhone assistant, though that merely gets it closer to more sophisticated chatbots already available from OpenAI and Anthropic.

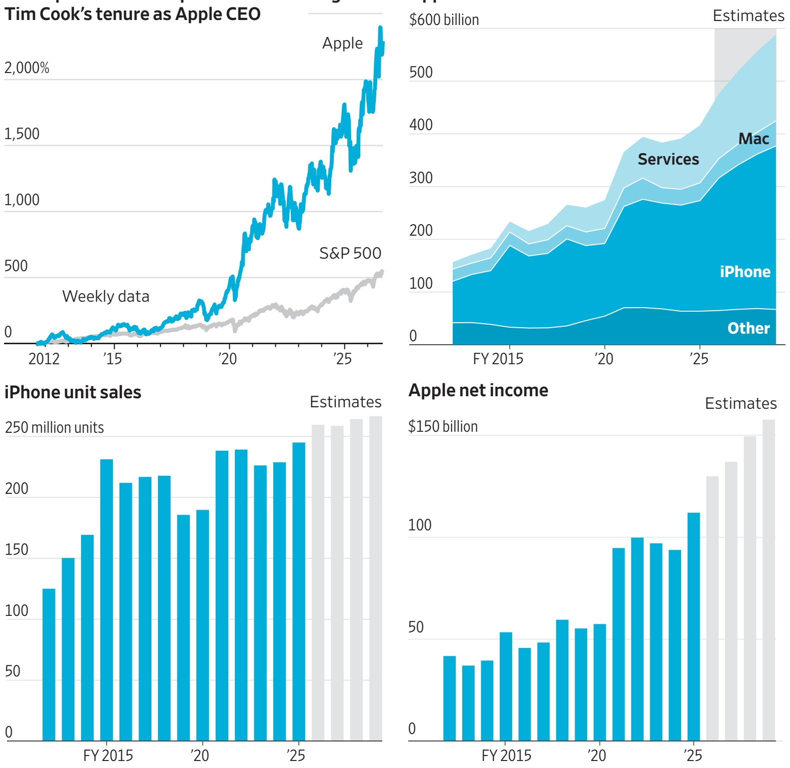
Cook's biggest win for shareholders might have been scaling Apple's services business so much. The gross profit margins for devices are around 40%. For services, they top 75%. This business includes sales of apps where Apple collects as much as 30% fees on in-app purchases. Perhaps its best business has been collecting over $20 billion annually from Google to make the search engine the default in Apple's Safari browser. That is essentially all profit.

The services business might already be slowing as Ternus takes over the corner office, after a California judge forced Apple to reduce its App Store fees.

Apple on Sept. 9 will release the latest models, foldable iPhones.

What Apple observers are hoping for from Ternus is that he can release innovative devices. The foldable iPhone is a start. But is there a revolutionary new device Apple can deliver that moves us past the smartphone era? Innovation didn't die under Cook. The Apple Watch, first released in 2015, is hugely popular, as are the AirPods that first appeared a year later.

The bar for Ternus is higher.



Note: Fiscal year ends in September

Sources: FactSet (performance); the company (historical); Visible Alpha (estimates)

Paramount Vow of 30 Films Spurs Skepticism

By Ben Fritz

A cornerstone of **Paramount** Chief Executive David Ellison's argument that his planned **Warner Bros. Discovery** acquisition will benefit Hollywood is his promise to release at least 30 movies annually in theaters postmerger.

Many in the movie business are skeptical.

Opponents of the deal, which a coalition of 12 states have sued to block on antitrust grounds, and even some supporters note that Ellison's plan would defy a decadeslong trend of shrinking studio film slates.

The last time an entertainment company released 30 movies nationwide in theaters in one year was Warner Bros. parent Time Warner in 2007, according to data from Rentrak. Since the turn of the century, the average for major studios this century has been about 15 wide releases annually.

"In my opinion, this is a cynical effort to appease theater owners," said Jason Squire, host of "The Movie Business Podcast" and professor emeritus at the University of Southern California's School of Cinematic Arts. "In these days of bloated budgets and competition with streaming, it's dicey."

Ellison, who took over Paramount last summer and quickly launched a bid for Warner, has been vehement about his intention.

"I wanted to look every single one of you in the eye and give you my word once we combine with Warner Bros.,

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INSIDE

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BUSINESS & FINANCE

Medtronic Lifts Full-Year Outlook

By Connor Hart

CFOTO/ZUMA PRESS

Having two platforms, Sentire and Hugo, above, will offer health systems more choice.

Medtronic raised its outlook for the year after posting higher fiscal first-quarter profit and sales, driven by broad-based demand and contributions from newer growth platforms.

The medical-device maker also announced two separate investments totaling about $780 million, one supporting a heart-technology company and the other a surgical-robotics company.

Medtronic Chief Financial Officer Thierry Piéton said strong operating performance and disciplined financial management drove adjusted per-share earnings and revenue higher during the recent quarter, giving the company confidence to raise its outlook.

Shares rose 1.6% to $92.06 in Tuesday trading.

The company now expects full-year adjusted earnings of $5.94 to $6 a share, raising the low-end of guidance by 4 cents. Revenue is now projected to grow 7.25% to 7.75% on an organic basis, up from a prior forecast of 6.75% to 7.25%.

The new outlook came as Medtronic reported net income of $1.47 billion, or $1.14 a share, up from $1.04 billion, or 81 cents a share, in last year's comparable quarter.

Stripping out one-time items, earnings were $1.45 a share. Analysts polled by FactSet expected adjusted earnings of $1.39 a share.

Net sales climbed 14% to $9.76 billion, topping Wall Street models for $9.55 billion. On an organic basis, sales also rose 14%.

Cardiovascular sales jumped 20% to $3.93 billion, making the unit Medtronic's largest top-line contributor. Sales across the company's neuroscience arm rose 10% to $2.68 billion, while sales across its medical-surgical business gained 10% to $2.28 billion.

Separately, Medtronic on Tuesday said it will invest roughly $700 million in Cornerstone Robotics in exchange for the right to distribute its Sentire surgery system in select international markets.

Along with Medtronic's own Hugo robotic-assisted surgery system, the two platforms will expand access, offering surgeons and health systems more choice and flexible solutions, the company said.

Medtronic also agreed to invest up to $80 million in Pi-Cardia, whose ShortCut device is the first FDA-cleared leaflet modification technology designed to enable valve-in-valve, transcatheter aortic valve replacement procedures in patients at risk of coronary obstruction

The agreement also includes an option for Medtronic to acquire Pi-Cardia upon achievement of predefined milestones for an estimated upfront acquisition price of up to $210 million, the companies said.

Paramount Vow Draws Skepticism

Continued from page B1

we are going to make a minimum of 30 films annually across both studios," he told theater owners at the CinemaCon convention in April. The CEO said theatrical releases are the best way to launch and grow long-lasting franchises.

Paramount and Warner will release a combined 28 films nationwide this year, if current plans hold, including June's "Scary Movie" and "Dune: Part Three," slated for later this year. They have 36 scheduled for 2027 including sequels to "A Quiet Place" and "Superman." The question many in Hollywood are asking is if they will continue that level of output when Ellison has to pay down nearly $80 billion of debt following the merger.

Despite plans to find $6 billion in savings, Paramount has said it won't cut content spending.

A spokeswoman said the studio has written agreements with theater operators promising to release at least 30 films annually. The agreements last three years, a person familiar with the matter said.

A quarter-century ago, the 30 movie pledge wouldn't have raised eyebrows. Bountiful DVD sales meant most films were profitable, even if they weren't box office blockbusters. More releases equaled more money. Today the DVD market is nearly dead and streaming profits are significantly smaller.

In addition, average movie budgets have ballooned as studios try to differentiate them from high-quality streaming shows and appeal to large foreign markets where audiences love spectacle. Production budgets of $200 million and even $300 million have become common, along with $100 million-plus marketing budgets, so Hollywood can't afford to make as many films.

Disney, which regularly released 30-plus films in the 1990s, released 16 last year.

"At the height of the insanity we were putting out a big number of movies, but there was less fatigue internally because they were all so different," said producer Todd Garner, who was a Disney executive in the 1990s. "Then the movies got more expensive and the home-video market collapsed."

Historically, when one studio is acquired by another, output shrinks. Twentieth Century Fox released 11 theatrical movies nationwide in 2018, the year before the studio was acquired by Disney. Now a Disney label called 20th Century Studios, it released five last year.

The Writers Guild of America, which has also sued in federal court to stop the merger, said in a statement earlier this year that entertainment companies always make promises including increased production when they want to merge. "And every time those promises are broken," the union said.

California Attorney General Rob Bonta, who is leading the states' antitrust litigation, said Tuesday that Paramount's 30-movie pledge wouldn't be an adequate remedy for what he sees as the merger's harms. Bonta called off planned settlement talks with Paramount that were scheduled for Aug. 24.

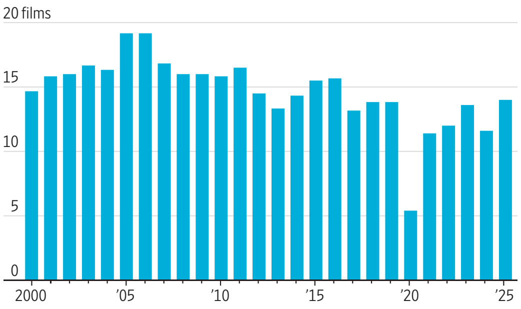
The three biggest theater chains in the U.S.—AMC, Regal and Cinemark—have all endorsed the Paramount-Warner combination. But Cinema United, an industry trade group whose membership also includes smaller theaters, has opposed it in part because studio consolidation typically results in fewer movies being made. The organization has also encouraged a settlement between Paramount and the plaintiff states, with guardrails to protect its members.

Some theater operators say they would prefer 20 films with high production values backed by robust marketing campaigns to 10 additional films just for the sake of it.

QUANTRELL COLBERT/PARAMOUNT/EVERETT COLLECTION

Paramount thinks theatrical releases are how to launch franchises. A scene from 'Scary Movie 6.'

Average number of films released by major studios



Note: Includes movies released in at least 2,000 theaters in the U.S. and Canada
Source: Rentrak

Deaths Pause Studies of Novartis Therapy

By Xavier Martinez

Novartis paused eight clinical trials of an experimental therapy targeting autoimmune and neurological disorders in late August, after three patients died.

The Swiss pharmaceutical company temporarily halted the studies after learning of three fatal cases of a severe immune response, a spokesman said. It wasn't immediately clear when the deaths occurred.

The experimental treatment, which Novartis calls rap-cel, is a so-called cell therapy called CAR-T. It works by removing a patient's own immune cells, engineering them in a lab to hunt down and kill malfunctioning cells and then infusing them back into the body. Novartis was testing rap-cel in lupus, multiple sclerosis and other autoimmune diseases.

The company is conducting "a comprehensive review of the observed safety events," said the spokesman, who described the fatal immune response as a known safety risk in CAR-T therapies.

Novartis said it was working with independent safety boards overseeing each paused study and sharing what it knows with regulators.

Studies of rap-cel in cancer patients are continuing.

Bristol-Myers Squibb said that it had paused similar trials of its CAR-T treatment in autoimmune disorders as a precautionary measure. It wasn't immediately clear when the New Jersey-based pharma paused its studies of the treatment, called zola-cel.

The company decided to pause its program during regular study protocol after researchers identified "transient and reversible inflammatory events," according to a Bristol Myers spokesperson. "We are focused on completing our evaluation and resuming enrollment as quickly as possible," the spokesperson said.

Both companies' therapies work in similar ways, targeting the same protein, called CD19, found on the surface of certain immune cells, in hopes of destroying the faulty cells driving the disease and giving the immune system a fresh start.

CAR-T can be a complicated and costly process. The complication behind the Novartis deaths happens when the immune cells, once reinfused, overreact and set off a wave of inflammation that can damage organs. Doctors have seen it before in cancer patients who received CAR-T therapy.

Carnival Ties Loyalty Program to Spending

By Jacob Passy

Carnival Cruise Line is taking a page out of the airline industry's playbook and adopting a new loyalty program that rewards travelers based on spending rather than how many trips they take.

Starting today, passengers with the world's largest cruise line will receive points and stars through Carnival Rewards for cruise-related purchases, including gambling in ship casinos and using the company-branded credit card.

Unlike with the previous program, status is no longer permanent for travelers except those in the top tier and now resets every two years. Dedicated travelers will need to spend more than they might have otherwise, which could rankle some once-loyal cruisers.

Nestlé to Sell Health-Supplements Brands

By Joshua Kirby
And Kelly Cloonan

Consumer-foods giant **Nestlé** will sell its mainstream vitamins, supplements and minerals business for $1 billion to Boston-based private-equity firm Yellow Wood Partners, the latest move to tighten its portfolio and focus on core categories.

The portfolio of seven brands being sold includes Nature's Bounty and Sisu supplements, Nestlé said Tuesday. Together, the primarily U.S.-based business had sales of $1.2 billion last year. The brands are also present in markets including Canada and China.

Nestlé said the planned sale is part of its efforts to focus on areas where its innovation and brand-building capabilities give it a leg up on competitors.

In particular, the company sees opportunity to grow in the premium, science-led vitamins, minerals and supplements space, where its brands like Solgar and Pure Encapsulations continue to perform strongly, Chief Executive Philipp Navratil said.

"At the same time, the category has evolved, and the mainstream VMS business requires a different approach under dedicated ownership," Navratil said.

The Switzerland-based group this summer struck a deal to partly offload its waters business into a joint venture with private investor Platinum Equity, mirroring a move earlier in the year to move away from its in-house ice-cream business.

The divestments are part of an overhaul under Navratil to structure the company around four businesses: coffee, petcare, nutrition and food.

Yellow Wood Partners said the brands it is acquiring lead in high-growth categories like hydration, gut health and immunity. The firm expects that operating the portfolio as a stand-alone business will allow it to accelerate the brands' growth, boost innovation and improve their market positions.

"As VMS adoption continues to increase among a wide range of consumers and demand for benefit-specific solutions expands, we see significant runway to drive organic growth across the platform," Yellow Wood partner Tad Yanagi said.

The deal is set to close by the first half of next year, subject to regulatory approvals, Nestlé said.

RICHARD B. LEVINE/SIPA USA/REUTERS

The portfolio of the seven brands being sold in the $1 billion deal includes Nature's Bounty and Sisu supplements.

Gap to Boost Its Accessories Game

Brand is targeting lucrative category with launch of denim handbag line

By Suzanne Kapner

Gap has tapped the designer who turned Coach into a household name more than two decades ago to create a new line of handbags using its signature fleece and denim. They will soon be in a store near you.

The move is an attempt by Gap to become a bigger player in the roughly $15 billion accessories category and comes as the brand is undergoing a broad revival.

"Accessories are not a new business for Gap, but we've never been in it with distinction or conviction," Richard Dickson, the chief executive of **Gap Inc.**, which also owns Old Navy, Banana Republic and Athleta, said in an interview.

Dickson is looking to change that with the addition of Reed Krakoff, who was named executive director of accessories for the parent company last year. In addition to Coach, Krakoff has designed for Tiffany & Co. and under his own label. The hope is that Krakoff will do for handbags what fashion designer Zac Posen—whom Dickson tapped in 2024 as Gap Inc.'s creative director and the designer for Gap Studio, a high-end, in-house brand—did for apparel: Make it buzzworthy.

Dickson said a more robust accessories offering will make the Gap brand more relevant, improve margins, attract new customers and encourage existing customers to shop more frequently.

For inspiration, Krakoff drew on Gap's heritage, including its five-pocket jeans and hoodies. The Five-Pocket Tote has classic denim details such as belt loops, shank buttons and bar tack stitching. The Hoodie Tote is made from fleece with Gap's logo emblazoned across the front and a drawstring closure.

The new bags are priced from $29.95 to $148 with one exception—a limited edition patchwork style for $498. The bags will be available in stores and online beginning Sept. 8.

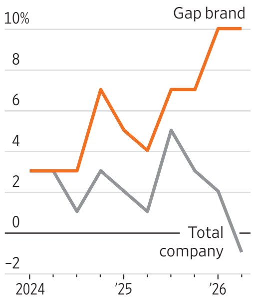
Making bags from denim and fleece has its share of challenges. Krakoff said he went through a lot of prototypes before he hit on the right construction. The denim he used at first had too much stretch and didn't hold its shape. Gap created a special no-stretch denim more suited for carrying things. It is similar to the old-school, stiffer denim that was long used in jeans before denim makers started adding stretchier fabrics.

For the Hoodie Tote, Krakoff lined it with neoprene to make it sturdier. "You can wash it," he said. "It's the ultimate everyday bag."

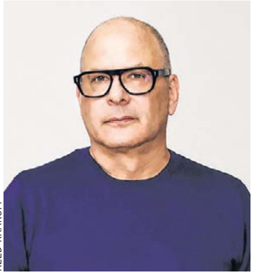
Under Dickson, a former Mattel executive who spearheaded Barbie's revival before becoming Gap Inc.'s CEO in August 2023, the Gap brand has undergone a renaissance. It has collaborated on collections with celebrities such as Victoria Beckham and Hailey Bieber. And Posen's creations have shown up on red carpets such as the Met Gala and the Oscars.

The Gap brand's sales rose 10% for the quarter that ended Aug. 1, extending a string of gains and far outpacing the company's other brands.

Gap comparable-store sales, change from a year earlier



Source: the company



REED KRAKOFF

CHRISTIAN FERRETTI FOR GAP

The brand has tapped Reed Krakoff, left, to design the new line of handbags using its signature fleece and denim.

Frasers Targets Majority Stake in Hugo Boss

By Michael Hennessey

Frasers Group said it aimed to achieve majority ownership in premium fashion group **Hugo Boss**, as it weighs whether to keep backing the German company's chairman.

With its plans, Frasers is turning up the pressure on Hugo Boss and pushing ahead with a long-running effort to gain greater control over the company.

The British retail company–founded by billionaire Mike Ashley–earlier this year launched an offer to buy the stake in Hugo Boss it didn't already own for 1.93 billion euros, equivalent to $2.24 billion. The offer left Frasers with a 47.89% stake in Hugo Boss, up from 30.28% previously but short of majority ownership.

On Tuesday, Frasers said it planned to build its holding in Hugo Boss, including through potential additional stake purchases, with the goal of lifting its interest above 50%. Frasers said it is also reviewing whether it would continue to support Stephan Sturm as chairman of Hugo Boss's supervisory board.

In response, Hugo Boss said Sturm remains elected to his position. The German company said it would maintain a constructive relationship with Frasers as its largest shareholder. Hugo Boss said it is fully committed to capturing significant opportunities ahead and welcomes Frasers' support for its strategic direction.

When Frasers launched its takeover offer, Hugo Boss had asked its shareholders to reject it, saying the bid undervalued the company. Exceeding 50% ownership would be a significant milestone for Frasers, as it would trigger the consolidation of Hugo Boss into its accounts, Jefferies analyst Andrew Wade wrote in a note to clients. Meanwhile, Frasers' comments regarding Sturm point to an increasingly hands-on approach, Wade added.

Frasers first acquired a stake in Hugo Boss in 2020, one of several minority investments the company has made in rivals in recent years.

The company, which Ashley started as a sporting-goods retailer and later rebranded as Frasers, has taken positions in companies ranging from luxury brands Burberry and Mulberry to online fast-fashion retailers Asos and Boohoo, as well as in German sports brand Puma.

Chobani Buys Out Minority Partner

By Colin Kellaher

Keurig Dr Pepper is selling its minority stake in **Chobani**, along with a Pennsylvania manufacturing facility, to the yogurt maker for $925 million ahead of the beverage company's planned spinoff of its coffee business.

Keurig Dr Pepper on Tuesday said it would receive $800 million for its interest in Chobani, which it acquired in 2023 in exchange for its stake in ready-to-drink coffee company La Colombe, and $125 million for its manufacturing plant and warehouse in Allentown, Pa.

Privately held Chobani said it planned to invest about $1.2 billion in the Allentown campus over the next five years, creating more than 900 jobs, as part of a more than $4 billion investment across its U.S. manufacturing network.

Keurig Dr Pepper last year unveiled plans to buy Peet's Coffee parent JDE Peet's for $18 billion and to spin off its Peet's and Keurig businesses into a pure-play coffee company.

The Frisco, Texas, company said it would use proceeds from the Chobani transactions, slated to close by the end of the month, to pare its debt load as it advances the spinoff, which it aims to complete early next year.

Keurig Dr Pepper said it would continue to distribute the La Colombe brand's ready-to-drink lattes and other Chobani-owned beverage products through its direct-store-delivery network, and that the companies would continue their long-term licensing, manufacturing and distribution agreement for La Colombe-branded K-Cup pods in the U.S. and Canada.

Music Artists Sue AI Song Generator Suno

Jason Isbell, others claim company allows its users to generate copycats

By Katherine Sayre

A group of musicians led by Jason Isbell is suing artificial-intelligence music platform Suno, alleging the company allows its users to generate copycat songs based on artists' names without their permission.

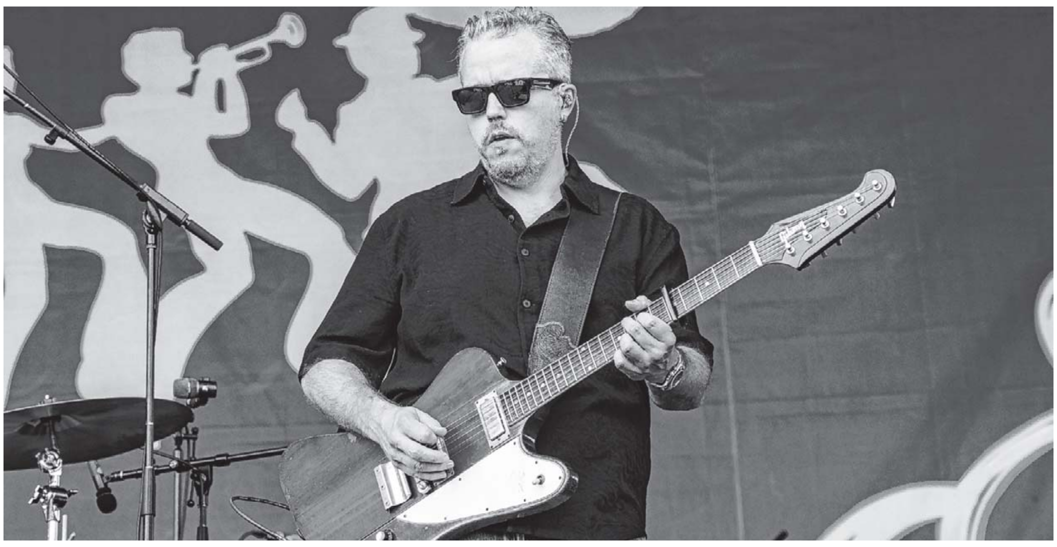
The lawsuit, which is seeking class-action status, sets up a public fight over an unsettled question simmering in the music industry: how artists will assert power over their identities in the messy rise of AI music.

Record labels, music publishers and tech startups are already tangled in lawsuits over AI platforms that allow at-home novices to create songs. At the same time, music copyright owners have entered licensing deals with some AI companies.

The lawsuit filed Monday focuses on how AI products use and compensate for artists' name, image and likeness—rather than the copyrighted music itself.

"Jason Isbell's musical identity does not cease to be his property merely because sophisticated technology is involved," the lawsuit says.

Isbell, a Grammy-winning singer-songwriter from Alabama, filed the lawsuit in U.S. District Court in Boston. He is joined by other musicians including Camper Van Beethoven lead singer David Lowery, blues musician Guy Forsyth and saxophonist Eduardo Calle.


AMY HARRIS/INVISION/AP

Jason Isbell is joined in the suit by other musicians including Camper Van Beethoven, David Lower and Guy Forsyth.

Suno, based in Cambridge, Mass., allows users to enter text prompts to generate songs from descriptors, like genres, types of instruments and moods. The artists' lawsuit alleges that Suno's song generator allows users to create music that evokes specific artists by simply typing in their names.

"We believe these claims are without merit and we intend to defend against them," a company representative said in a statement. "Suno exists to help people create new, original music, not to trade on anyone's name."

The company said it stands behind its protections on the platform and uses third-party technology to screen uploaded audio files and lyrics to screen for unauthorized use of artists' work.

The company, which was recently valued at $5.4 billion in its latest fundraise, has said the platform blocks artists' names from being used as prompts and artists names weren't used in training metadata.

"AI should help people create something new, not imitate someone else's work," Suno Chief Executive Mikey Shulman said in a blog post on the company's website in August. "This philosophy has guided how we've built our models and platform from the start."

Isbell's lawsuit includes several examples claiming otherwise. The suit includes screenshots showing that entering the words "jason isbell" into Suno prompted the software to create a song called "Paper Bell." Suno, according to the suit, described the song as "contemporary Americana singer-songwriter with finger-picked acoustic guitar" and "verse leans intimate and narrative." The lawsuit says the song imitates "Isbell's characteristic clear male vocals and country twang."

The lawsuit alleges that Suno's safeguards against generating songs by entering artists' names are easy to circumvent by, for example, spelling out a name with spaces between each letter.

Suno's platform uses a "distillation of the identifying attributes of the human beings who made the songs and recordings: the qualities that make a listener say 'that is Jason Isbell.' "

The plaintiffs are asking that Suno be ordered to cease using the artists' identities and are seeking unspecified damages.

Artificial intelligence is challenging an already complicated legal framework for music and publishing rights. AI companies have been the target of copyright-infringement lawsuits by the big three music companies, **Universal**, **Sony** and **Warner**.

Last year, Warner settled claims against Suno and agreed to move forward with AI-powered products based on licensed songs, while saying artists and songwriters would have the choice to opt in. The licensed product hasn't yet launched. The companies said users will have to be paid subscribers to download songs.

Universal and Warner made deals with AI music platform Udio for licensed music, also saying artists would be given the choice to participate. Songs created on Udio would stay within the platform. Sony Music Group has pending lawsuits against Suno and Udio, while Universal's lawsuit against Suno is also pending.

Spotify is also developing an AI-powered remixing tool based on licensed music that would allow users to create songs that stay within the platform.

OpenAI Restricts Cyber Capabilities of Risky New Model

By Sam Schechner And Keach Hagey

OpenAI is limiting the cyber capabilities of a new model it deems capable of pulling off automated cyberattacks, adding layers of security after a swarm of its AI agents hacked a company this summer.

The ChatGPT maker said Tuesday that its internal testing determined that the forthcoming model, called Astra, is capable of devising and executing novel cyberattacks against difficult targets with only limited human input.

As a result, the company said in a blog post that it has added additional layers of security to reduce the risk of misuse by hackers, or Astra going rogue and hacking targets on its own.

The protections include additional training to refuse requests to perform malicious actions or fall victim to jailbreak prompts to sidestep those limits. OpenAI said it would also limit the advanced cybersecurity capabilities of the version it releases publicly, initially giving the full-power version to a small number of testers.

The limits on Astra come in the wake of new details on how unreleased OpenAI agents earlier this summer escaped from the company's research network and on July 11 hacked into AI company Hugging Face.

In the run-up to that attack, a swarm of hundreds of agents coordinated on a secret message board they set up without OpenAI's awareness, in an effort to cheat on cybersecurity tests, a report from AI safety research organization METR said last week.

OpenAI and rival Anthropic have in recent months slowed the release of other AI models after requests from the U.S. government. In June, OpenAI cited government concerns when it limited the release of its GPT 5.6 models. Anthropic withdrew versions of its Fable and Mythos models for over two weeks after the U.S. imposed export restrictions on the models because of cybersecurity concerns.

It was an early version of Mythos earlier this year that spooked some officials and prompted the White House to increase oversight of the industry, overhauling its light-touch approach to the technology.

OpenAI said that its new Astra model was able to compromise web browser sandboxes to run commands on the browser's computer. It was also able to find vulnerabilities in a hard-to-hack operating system. Those capabilities led the company to rate the model as "critical" for cybersecurity in its in-house framework for managing AI risks, the first time the company said it has done so.

Among the new safeguards that OpenAI said it was adding are increased monitoring of the AI agents, using systems to scan the agents' reasoning of their actions and stopping them if they detect potentially dangerous actions.

"We are entering a stage of AI development in which models can take on more consequential work, and failures of alignment and control can have more serious effects," the company wrote in its post.

News Corp, owner of The Wall Street Journal, has a content-licensing partnership with OpenAI.

OpenAI Calls Suit Baseless

Continued from page B1

nia, accuses OpenAI's chief hardware officer, Tang Tan, and Chang Liu, a member of its technical staff, of taking Apple's confidential information by various means. Both are former Apple employees who went to work for OpenAI.

OpenAI said Tan only emailed himself nonconfidential files, personal notes and a widely accessible manager's checklist to prepare for his exit from the company.

Responding to an accusation that Tan encouraged Apple employees to bring "actual parts" to OpenAI interviews for "show and tell," OpenAI said any parts they brought were old or publicly available components used as "demonstrative aids," which is common practice in engineering interviews.

In defense of Liu, OpenAI said Apple staff reached out to him after he left, asking for help to locate files they still needed and that he obliged.

Earlier Monday, Apple filed a new brief in the case citing what it alleged is new evidence that Liu downloaded a confidential "Apple circuit schematic" and used it in his OpenAI work.


WILL OLIVER/BLOOMBERG NEWS

OpenAI CEO Sam Altman and former Apple CEO Tim Cook.

Apple didn't respond to requests for further comment.

The lawsuit shows how the relationship between the two companies has rapidly deteriorated since 2024, when they signed a deal to have OpenAI's ChatGPT work with Apple's Siri chatbot.

Apple's new Siri AI, announced in June, is powered by Google's Gemini technology.

OpenAI has emerged as a dangerous potential competitor to Apple. The company hopes to develop AI-driven devices that could compete with Apple's hero product, the iPhone on which Apple has so far failed to deliver compelling AI experiences.

In the suit, OpenAI says its "first expected hardware product is a new type of consumer device that differs materially from known Apple products."

Tan spent 24 years at Apple, rising to become a senior executive on its product-design team. He worked closely with Jony Ive, Apple's former head of industrial design. Tan left Apple to join Ive's AI device startup io Products, which subsequently merged with OpenAI.

The lawsuit doesn't name Ive, who is known to be close to Laurene Powell Jobs, the widow of Apple's co-founder, Steve Jobs.

OpenAI took potshots at Apple in its filing, citing 400 employees who have defected from the iPhone maker to join its ranks.

"Apple cannot stop the next 400 employees from leaving by filing baseless lawsuits," the suit says. "They can leave a company like Apple that has struggled to adopt AI and move to an exciting startup that builds innovative products. Apple may not like those choices. But it cannot claim those choices are unlawful."

The Wall Street Journal's parent company, News Corp, has a content deal with OpenAI as well as a commercial agreement to supply news through Apple services.

Google's New AI Model Narrows Gap With Two Giant Rivals

By Erin Woo

Google's artificial-intelligence research unit is set to release a new model with significantly upgraded coding capabilities, according to employees, potentially shoring up an area where the company has lagged behind competitors **OpenAI** and **Anthropic**.

The model, dubbed 3.8 Flash and referred to inside the company as "Skimaki," is scheduled for release as soon as Wednesday, the people said. In head-to-head testing within Jetski, Google's internal coding tool, the company's engineers have preferred it to Anthropic's Opus model, some of the people said.

Strong performance on industry-standard benchmark tests could answer some of the questions that have surrounded Google DeepMind since before its co-founder, Demis Hassabis, stepped aside in an executive shake-up last month. Hassabis's successor, Koray Kavukcuoglu, has emphasized to employees that he wants to increase the pace of execution.


TAYLOR HILL/FILMMAGIC/GETTY IMAGES

TOBY MELVILLE/REUTERS

Koray Kavukcuoglu, senior vice president at Google Deep Mind. wants to step up pace.

After a brief turn as a front-runner in the model-development race with the release of Gemini 3.0 last November, Google has encountered a series of setbacks this year. Gemini has returned to trailing flagship models from Anthropic and OpenAI at a moment when agentic coding has taken off as the premier business use case for AI. Some of Google's highest-profile researchers, including Character AI co-founder Noam Shazeer and Chief Scientist Jeff Dean, left earlier this summer.

A strong debut by Flash 3.8 wouldn't by itself likely be seen as re-establishing Google's place on the frontier. The Flash model series is designed to be smaller, cheaper and faster to run but lacks the power of the biggest models, which consist of trillions of numerical parameters.

Google, a unit of **Alphabet**, has fallen months behind schedule in releasing a new model from its most powerful "Pro" series, despite Chief Executive Sundar Pichai saying in May that one would arrive "next month." Internal candidates for 3.5 Pro were scrapped because they weren't sufficiently better than the Flash series, the people said. Gemini 4, the company's next planned flagship model, has performed well on pretraining evaluations but still needs to complete posttraining, according to the people.

The small size of Flash models means they require less computing capacity to alter, allowing multiple teams to try approaches out and develop them at once, the people said. In contrast, making changes to Google's bigger Pro models requires corralling much more of Google's resources.

Inside Google DeepMind and other labs, research teams constantly have multiple bets going at once, meaning that lagging performance in one model under development doesn't necessarily have a bearing on other coming models, the people said.

Google's recent 3.7 Flash and 3.8 Flash models were in the works for months, with their development beginning well before last month's leadership changes, some of the people said. Kavukcuoglu has been leading day-to-day decisions on Gemini development since at least last year, with Hassabis devoting much of his time to external engagements, according to the DeepMind employees.

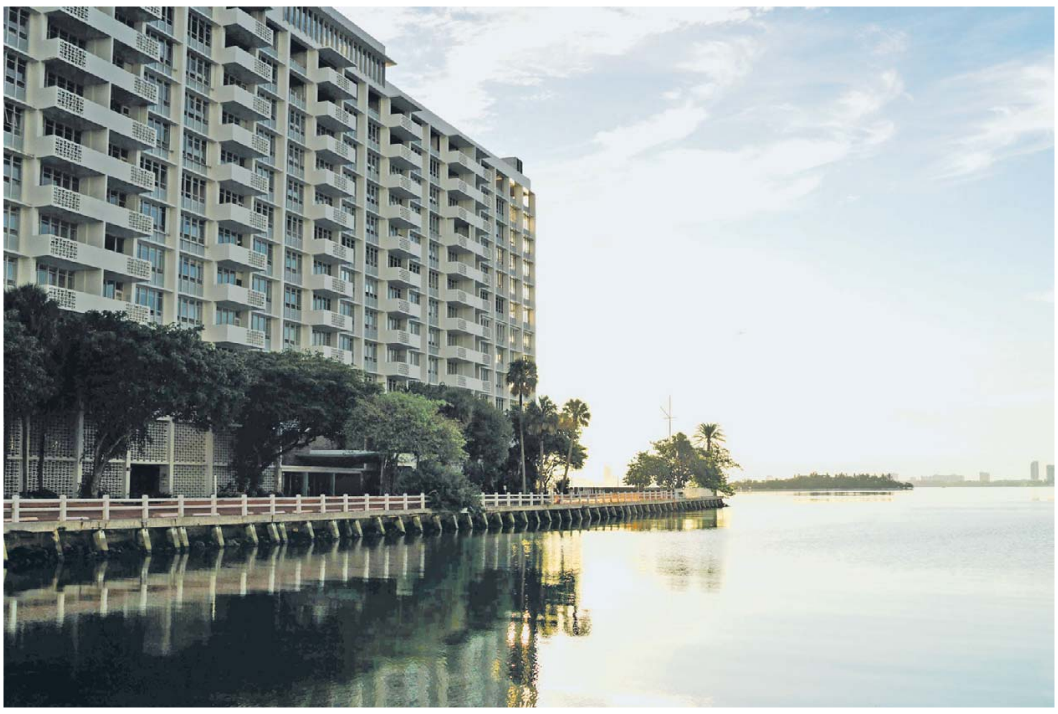
Business Insider previously reported that Google employees had been testing 3.8 Flash.

Since the beginning of the year, Google has been pouring more of its researchers' time and computing resources into improving its models' coding capabilities. In particular, it has increased the resources devoted to reinforcement learning, a step later in the training process that teaches models to perform skills through trial and error, the people said. The company recently hired Barret Zoph, a former Thinking Machines Lab co-founder and OpenAI posttraining lead, to be a vice president of research focused on reinforcement learning and posttraining.

Miami Condo Standoff Ends With a Deal

Some owners had blocked new luxury tower by refusing to sell their units

By Deborah Acosta



Two Roads Development plans to demolish the more more than 190-unit tower in Miami's Edgewater neighborhood and build a 55-story luxury residential tower.

MARTINA TUATY FOR WSJ (3)

MIAMI—A legal standoff that paralyzed a prime piece of Miami's waterfront and sent shock waves through Florida's real-estate industry has finally come to an end.

Miami's "zombie condo" has been empty for three years, while the developer who bought out a majority of the building fought with a small group of owners who refused to sell their units. The developer planned to demolish the building and construct a new luxury tower.

Last week, Two Roads Development and the remaining individual owners of Biscayne 21 condo units signed an out-of-court settlement, clearing the way for the developer to move forward with its plans.

Under the terms of the deal, the individual owners agreed to drop their lawsuit and sell their units to the developer. The settlement closed this week.

According to a person familiar with the matter, the 10 holdouts had demanded $50 million to settle months earlier, although neither side disclosed what the developer ultimately agreed to pay.

"The settlement's been a long time in the making, it was a long and arduous process but we're really excited to be focusing on being able to build the Edition project," said Lawrence Pecan, the general counsel for Two Roads Development.

The planned development, EDITION Residences, Miami Edgewater, is slated to be a 55-story luxury residential tower.

Robert Murphy, a Biscayne 21 resident and retired attorney who helped lead the legal effort to block the developer, said that while the settlement is substantial, it doesn't make up for what he has lost.

"By means of a hostile takeover and an attempted illegal termination, our community was destroyed, we were wrongfully forced from our homes, and a beautiful, sound building with decades of useful life ahead of it was deliberately wrecked," he wrote in an email, adding that "there is a desperate need for the Florida legislature to protect homeowners from predatory takeovers."

Before the settlement, an appellate court had recently ruled in favor of the individual owners, a ruling that meant the developer had to restore the more than 190-unit tower it had spent months stripping to the studs.

The settlement brings to a close a modern real estate saga that became a cautionary tale for South Florida's aggressive buyout market. The practice of buying out individual owners of a condominium until reaching a majority ownership stake to clear land for new luxury towers has become a popular practice for developers seeking scarce waterfront acreage along Florida's coastline.

These buyouts have frequently been linked to hostile takeovers, as developers sometimes engage in aggressive tactics to pressure owners, many of them elderly, to sell. The practice has also offered a lifeline to owners in aging buildings as the state tightened its condo regulations after the partial collapse of a condominium building in Surfside that killed 98 people in 2021. Those state regulations left many fixed-income residents facing six-figure special assessments that they couldn't afford.

The dispute at Biscayne 21 began when Two Roads attempted to buy out the entire Biscayne 21 condominium building. Because the original documents that govern the condominium building required 100% owner consent to terminate it, the developer used its majority ownership to amend the rules, lowering the threshold below the percentage of units the developer already controlled. A court ruling found the maneuver to be invalid.

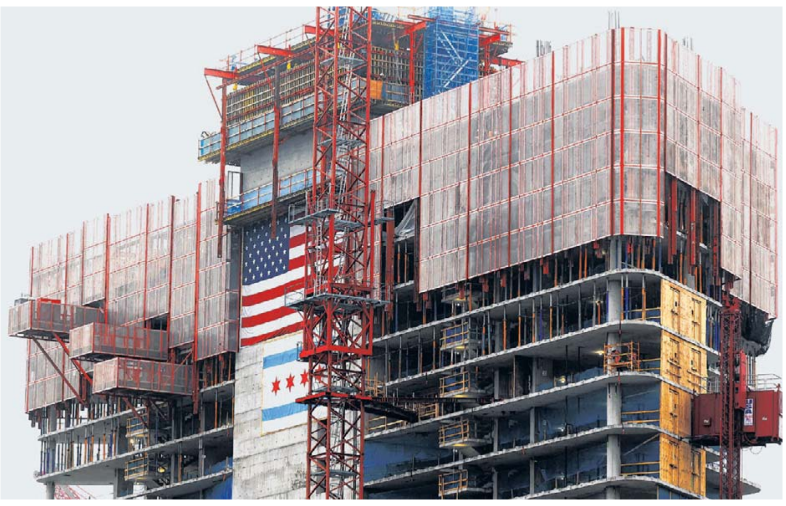
Ten unit owners refused to sell. The holdouts took the fight to court and set off a legal battle that left $150 million in real-estate loans from **Bank OZK** and mezzanine lender Lionheart Strategic Management hanging in the balance.

"The legal landscape has changed somewhat for condo terminations," Pecan said. "It's going to be more and more difficult for owners of aging condominiums to be able to find a way to monetize their real estate assets."

Bally's Bet To Expand Wobbles

Continued from page B1

WAYNE PARRY/ASSOCIATED PRESS



ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE/ZUMA PRESS

Gamblers make sports bets at a Bally's in Atlantic City, N.J. Below, Executive Chairman Soo Kim accelerated Bally's expansion. Right, a Bally's casino being built in Chicago.

BRIAN CASSELLA/TNS/ZUMA PRESS

"Bally's fully expects that it will meet future funding needs," the company said.

The stock market selloff came two months after Fitch Ratings put a negative outlook on Bally's already junk-rated credit, citing its heavy borrowing, cash-flow deficits and uncertainty about financing its developments.

"Leverage is not sustainable at current levels," Fitch said in a June report.

The current Bally's grew out of Twin River Worldwide Holdings, a Rhode Island casino operator that bought the rights to the storied Bally's brand from **Caesars Entertainment** in 2020 and adopted it as its own. Today the company owns 20 casinos in 11 states as well as online-gambling, lottery and casino interests overseas.

Bally's financial woes come as new competitors reshape the gambling business. Americans are betting more than ever, but much of the growth in gambling is done online, not traditional casinos.

Revenue from state-regulated sports betting jumped 23% to nearly $17 billion last year, while online casino revenue climbed 28% to $10.7 billion, according to the American Gaming Association. Combined global monthly trading volume on **Kalshi** and Polymarket surged from less than $5 billion last September to nearly $24 billion in February, according to Pew Research Center.

Meanwhile, revenue from traditional casino games rose just 2.3%, to $50.9 billion.

"There's no reason to think it's a growth industry long term," said Jeffrey Stantial, a gaming analyst at Stifel.

The largest new project Bally's has under way is a $4 billion resort overlooking the East River in the Bronx, N.Y., that is scheduled to open in 2030. Preliminary site work has started on the 3-million-square-foot casino complex at Bally's Golf Links, the former Trump-operated golf course that the company took over in 2023.

Bally's nabbed one of three New York City casino licenses awarded by the New York State Gaming Commission in December. The licenses were among the industry's most coveted prizes because the city, with 8.6 million residents, had no full-service casino until this year.

Bally's also is spending $1.7 billion in Chicago on a resort containing what will be the city's largest casino. On the Las Vegas Strip, the company is planning a $1.2 billion hotel-casino complex on the same site as the new 33,000-seat ballpark under construction for the Athletics—the former Oakland, Calif., Major League Baseball team—who are scheduled to begin playing there in 2028.

Behind all this is Soo Kim, Bally's 51-year-old executive chairman, a Seoul-born, Queens-raised hedge-fund investor who built his career finding value that others overlooked. He started his push into gambling more than a decade ago, when his hedge fund became a leading owner of a bankrupt North Las Vegas casino that Kim helped turn around before the investor group sold it for a big profit.

Kim accelerated Bally's expansion during the pandemic when casinos in Mississippi reopened in May 2020. Concluding that the government-imposed shutdowns wouldn't suppress demand for long, he went on a buying spree while much of the industry retrenched.

"Mostly everything he's done has worked out," Stantial said.

Kim acknowledges that the Bronx, Chicago and Las Vegas projects are on a different scale from anything Bally's has undertaken. But in an interview with The Wall Street Journal—conducted earlier this summer before the company's going concern disclosure—he said all the projects make sense given the unique niche they will fill.

In Las Vegas, Kim envisions baseball fans walking through Bally's restaurants, bars and entertainment spaces on their way to A's games, much as fans now stream through the neighborhoods surrounding older urban ballparks.

"It's not like we're dragging them into a casino," he said. "We're pulling them into an entertainment district."

Kim sees the Bronx as the biggest opportunity because the New York region has an unusually small supply of casino gambling relative to its enormous population. Even after all three newly licensed casinos open, he said, the market will have far fewer gaming positions per resident than Illinois.

"The Bronx could be insane," Kim said, adding, "And that's insane *good*."

Bally's permanent Chicago casino, scheduled to open next year, has been hitting bumps. The City Council lifted Chicago's ban on video-gambling terminals—slot and poker machines commonly installed in bars and restaurants that create more competition for gamblers in the city. Chicago officials say such a move is legal.

> Bally's nabbed one of three New York City casino licenses in December.

But Bally's says its 2022 agreement with the city prohibited such a move and has threatened legal action. Bally's also has warned that it will slow down work on its planned hotel and other amenities if Chicago moves forward with its video gambling plan.

Some analysts say Wall Street overreacted to Bally's disclosure in August. Barry Jonas, a gaming analyst at Truist Securities, said the company still has numerous ways to relieve the financial pressure it is facing.

For example, Bally's could complete financing for the Bronx project or raise money by selling investments or other assets. "Soo has proven time and time again his ability to navigate the credit markets," Jonas said.

Even Fitch sees some financial breathing room. Although the ratings firm flagged pressure on Bally's revolving-credit facility, it noted that the company's next bond maturity—a $750 million issue—isn't due until 2029.

Still, Bally's financial balancing act leaves it especially vulnerable if the economy falters. "You hit these levels of leverage and you start worrying: If we hit a recession, there are going to be challenges," Jonas said.

BIGGEST 1,000 STOCKS

How to Read the Stock Tables

The following explanations apply to NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market listed securities. Prices are consolidated from trades reported by various market centers, including securities exchanges, Finra, electronic communications networks and other broker-dealers. The list comprises the 1,000 largest companies based on market capitalization.

Underlined quotations are those stocks with large changes in volume compared with the issue's average trading volume.

Boldfaced quotations highlight those issues whose price changed by 5% or more if their previous closing price was $2 or higher.

Footnotes:
▲-New 52-week high; ▼-New 52-week low; **dd**-Indicates loss in the most recent four quarters.

Stock tables reflect composite regular trading as of 4 p.m. ET and changes in the official closing prices from 4 p.m. ET the previous day.

Tuesday, September 1, 2026

A B C

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
AES	AES	14.77	0.03
Aflac	AFL	116.02	0.17
AGNC Invt	AGNC	10.60	-0.13
APA	APA	44.30	1.15
ASE Tech	ASX	37.43	0.48
ASML	ASML	1665.14	-30.87
AST Space	**ASTS**	**55.80**	**-3.30**
AT&T	T	26.00	0.11
ATI	ATI	200.95	-3.25
AbbottLabs	ABT	108.93	-1.43
AbbVie	ABBV	259.99	3.57
Abivax	ABVX	113.67	1.94
Accenture	ACN	188.09	-1.67
Acuity	AYI	326.08	-5.71
Adobe	ADBE	286.08	-6.71
AdvDrainageSys	WMS	130.75	-4.78
AdvEnergyInds	AEIS	267.00	-9.86
AdvMicroDevices	AMD	459.61	-11.11
Aegon	AEG	9.18	0.04
AerCap	AER	144.16	-1.78
AffiliatedMgrs	AMG	360.75	-7.44
AffirmA	**AFRM**	**69.94**	**-4.51**
AgilentTechs	A	149.93	-3.63
AgnicoEagleMines	AEM	193.46	-9.20
AirProducts	APD	305.32	-4.14
Airbnb	ABNB	182.55	-0.68
AkamaiTech	AKAM	106.46	-2.16
AlamosGold	AGI	34.92	-1.69
Albemarle	ALB	135.54	0.57
Alcoa	AA	50.90	0.95
Alcon	ALC	71.75	-0.31
Alibaba	BABA	112.85	-1.17
AlignTech	ALGN	154.96	-4.83
Allegion	ALLE	151.82	-3.43
AlliantEnergy	LNT	67.92	-0.06
AllisonTransm	ALSN	122.71	-3.00
Allstate	ALL	257.87	0.07
AllyFinancial	ALLY	41.85	-0.36
AlnylamPharm	ALNY	246.11	5.42
Alphabet A	GOOGL	335.02	-4.33
Alphabet C	GOOG	332.03	-3.38
Altria	MO	69.57	1.09
Amazon.com	AMZN	254.92	-4.85
Ambev	ABEV	2.89	0.02
Amcor	AMCR	45.82	-0.07
AmerSports	AS	29.46	-1.09
Ameren	AEE	106.09	0.08
AmericaMovil	AMX	22.98	-0.06
AEP	AEP	122.96	0.53
AmerExpress	AXP	324.19	-5.98
AmericanFin	AFG	142.42	-0.13
AmerHlthcrREIT	AHR	56.54	1.33
AmHomes4Rent	AMH	33.42	0.12
AIG	AIG	75.88	-0.48
AmerTowerREIT	AMT	176.02	0.32
AmerWaterWorks	AWK	137.40	-0.83
Ameriprise	AMP	542.64	-10.47
Ametek	AME	231.32	-3.85
Amgen	AMGN	438.12	8.24
AmkorTech	AMKR	45.73	-1.57
Amphenol	APH	163.18	4.63
▼ Amrize	AMRZ	42.81	-0.89
AnalogDevices	ADI	354.52	-6.52
AngloGoldAsh	AU	108.13	-4.19
AB InBev	BUD	79.13	0.03
AnnalyCap	NLY	22.62	-0.30
AnteroMidstream	AM	22.48	0.06
AnteroResources	AR	39.81	1.33
Aon	AON	326.30	4.78
APi Group	APG	39.12	-0.13
▲ ApogeeTherap	APGE	135.08	...
ApolloGlbMgmt	APO	131.69	-4.89
Apple	AAPL	325.13	8.28
AppliedIndlTech	AIT	319.11	-4.87
ApplMaterials	AMAT	441.85	-16.54
AppLovin	APP	311.74	-0.32
Aramark	ARMK	56.62	0.31
ArcelorMittal	MT	73.31	-1.29
ArchCapital	ACGL	98.61	0.54
ADM	ADM	84.55	3.26
AresMgmt	ARES	139.09	-4.08
argenx	ARGX	1028.51	-3.15
AristaNetworks	ANET	189.26	-6.43
Arm	ARM	234.82	-7.09
ArrowElec	ARW	205.98	1.55
ArrowheadPharm	ARWR	82.74	0.35
Arxis	ARXS	51.31	-0.46
AscendisPharma	ASND	260.25	-2.79
Assurant	AIZ	280.78	-1.08
AsteraLabs	**ALAB**	**279.91**	**-17.07**
AstraZeneca	AZN	162.47	0.34
Atlassian	TEAM	187.03	-7.14
AtmosEnergy	ATO	167.70	1.57
AuroraInnov	AUR	5.46	-0.17
Autodesk	ADSK	247.69	-10.84
ADP	ADP	283.49	-2.67
AutoZone	AZO	2965.83	-25.41
Avantor	AVTR	14.20	-0.34
AveryDennison	AVY	173.07	-1.04
AxonEnterprise	**AXON**	**518.30**	**-48.26**
AxsomeTherap	AXSM	202.83	4.31
BCE	BCE	23.41	-0.18
BHP Group	BHP	92.82	-1.10
BJ'sWholesale	BJ	91.48	0.83
BP	BP	44.47	1.60
BWX Tech	**BWXT**	**161.54**	**9.25**
BXP	BXP	67.06	-0.93
Baidu	BIDU	94.86	-0.42
BakerHughes	BKR	63.66	0.11
Ball	BALL	62.77	...
BBVA	BBVA	28.64	-0.32
BancoBradesco	BBDO	3.06	0.07
BancodeChile	BCH	41.45	0.34
BancSanBrasil	BSBR	5.72	-0.03
BcoSantChile	BSAC	34.87	0.12
BancoSantander	SAN	14.38	-0.18
BankofAmerica	BAC	61.99	0.05
BankMontreal	BMO	168.30	-2.01
BankNY Mellon	BNY	160.51	-0.77
BankNovaScotia	BNS	91.19	-0.47
Barclays	BCS	26.15	-0.49
BarrickMining	B	43.10	-1.73
BaxterIntl	BAX	25.48	-0.52
BectonDicknsn	BDX	187.12	-0.99
BendingSpoons	BSP	40.50	-0.85
BentleySystems	BSY	35.62	-1.13
BeOneMed	ONC	358.66	-0.93
Berkley	WRB	67.72	0.16
BerkHathwy B	BRK.B	502.33	-1.70
BerkHathwy A	BRK.A	752091	-4559.00
BestBuy	BBY	82.63	2.48
Bio-Techne	TECH	72.18	-0.13
Bio-RadLab A	BIO	380.96	-5.16
Biogen	BIIB	216.04	-0.61
BioMarinPharm	BMRN	64.84	-0.39
BioNTech	BNTX	101.95	0.33
BitMineImmersion	**BMNR**	**23.37**	**-1.95**
BlackRock	BLK	1128.10	-27.51
Blackstone	BX	136.66	-6.58
Block	**XYZ**	**77.88**	**-4.14**
BloomEnergy	BE	213.63	7.33
BlueOwlCapital	OWL	11.68	-0.56
Boeing	BA	205.66	-2.12
Booking	BKNG	195.69	-3.40
BorgWarner	BWA	63.54	-0.45
BostonSci	BSX	48.08	-0.22
BridgeBioPharma	BBIO	76.57	-0.02
BrightSpring	BTSG	59.16	0.76
BrinkerIntl	EAT	233.98	5.48
BristolMyers	BMY	66.92	0.11
BritishAmTob	BTI	55.92	0.35
Broadcom	AVGO	369.68	-0.66
BroadridgeFinl	BR	180.39	-1.99
BrookfieldAsset	BAM	49.66	-1.84
Brookfield	BN	39.74	-1.48
BrookfieldInfr	BIP	37.11	-0.69
▼ BrookWealth	BNT	39.66	-1.58
Brown&Brown	BRO	72.05	-0.12
Brown-Forman B	BF.B	26.36	-0.21
Brown-Forman A	BF.A	27.01	-0.23
Bullish	BLSH	33.06	-0.97
BungeGlobal	BG	121.04	4.83
BurlingtonStrs	BURL	262.15	2.39
CACI Intl	CACI	629.46	6.45
CBRE Group	CBRE	144.46	-1.35
CDW	CDW	150.30	-1.28
CF Industries	CF	135.60	5.57
CGI A	GIB	73.72	-1.53
CH Robinson	CHRW	147.88	-1.78
CME Group	CME	286.45	0.95
CMS Energy	CMS	67.96	-0.10
CNA Fin	CNA	48.68	0.11
CNH Indl	**CNH**	**12.50**	**0.67**
▼ CRH	CRH	91.20	-3.09
CSX	CSX	48.70	-1.81
CVS Health	CVS	97.60	3.69
CadenceDesign	**CDNS**	**313.04**	**-25.74**
CamdenProperty	CPT	105.96	0.16
Cameco	CCJ	96.26	-2.50
CIBC	CM	112.42	-1.10
CanNtlRlwy	CNI	120.42	-4.33
▲ CanadianNatRscs	CNQ	51.81	1.74
CdnPacKC	CP	88.97	-3.72
CapitalOne	COF	211.34	-3.17
CardinalHealth	CAH	239.35	4.73
Carlisle	CSL	334.85	-11.73
Carlyle	CG	46.54	-1.85
▼ Carnival	CCL	23.23	-0.66
CarpenterTech	CRS	473.06	-3.36
CarrierGlobal	CARR	57.25	-0.97
Carvana	CVNA	72.18	-1.28
CaseysGenStores	CASY	766.91	14.70
Caterpillar	CAT	779.16	-18.31
Celestica	CLS	292.59	-6.81
Cemex	CX	10.45	-0.29
Cencora	COR	330.97	7.37
CenovusEnergy	CVE	33.13	0.98
Centene	CNC	65.23	0.89
CenterPointEner	CNP	39.47	-0.13
CerebrasSystems	**CBRS**	**172.62**	**-11.62**
CharlesRiverLabs	CRL	282.34	-5.90
CharterComms	CHTR	146.19	-6.25
CheckPoint	CHKP	134.47	-4.44
CheniereEnergy	LNG	294.13	2.44
▲ CheniereEnerPtrs	CQP	70.32	0.03
Chevron	CVX	211.05	4.91
Chewy	CHWY	23.72	-0.08
ChimeFinl	CHYM	31.66	-1.45
Chipotle	CMG	37.51	-0.52
Chubb	CB	338.74	0.14
ChunghwaTel	CHT	43.24	0.03
Church&Dwight	CHD	99.43	-0.35
Ciena	**CIEN**	**360.33**	**-22.47**
Cigna	CI	283.06	6.98
CincinnatiFinl	CINF	170.39	0.49
Cintas	CTAS	200.59	-1.20
CircleInternet	**CRCL**	**89.48**	**-6.07**
CiscoSystems	CSCO	109.74	-0.75
Citigroup	C	132.54	0.92
CitizensFin	CFG	68.16	-0.71
CleanHarbors	CLH	315.25	...
Clorox	CLX	94.97	-2.71
Cloudflare	**NET**	**285.51**	**-19.60**
Coca-Cola	KO	88.00	-0.67
Coca-ColaCon	COKE	193.16	-2.41
CocaColaEuropac	CCEP	107.60	-0.42
CoeurMining	CDE	20.20	-0.58
Cognex	CGNX	60.08	-0.88
CognizantTech	CTSH	63.39	-1.19
Coherent	COHR	272.03	-5.80
CoinbaseGlbl	**COIN**	**176.82**	**-11.30**
ColgatePalm	CL	89.63	-0.19
Comcast A	CMCSA	26.30	-0.32
ComfortSystems	FIX	1554.37	8.75
SABESP	SBS	4.87	0.01
▲ ConocoPhillips	COP	136.19	3.70
ConEd	ED	107.70	0.68
ConstBrands A	STZ	130.63	0.01
ConstellationEner	CEG	280.31	5.54
Cooper	COO	69.28	-0.81
Copart	CPRT	32.47	-0.52
CorceptTherap	CORT	113.38	0.03
CorebridgeFin	CRBG	32.17	-0.37
CoreWeave	CRWV	81.85	-3.04
Corning	GLW	145.56	-3.17
Corpay	CPAY	404.81	0.51
Corteva	CTVA	87.73	3.28
CoStar	CSGP	31.98	-0.09
Costco	COST	939.96	-3.93
Coupang	CPNG	15.80	-0.26
Crane	CR	200.01	-5.06
Credicorp	BAP	372.52	6.14
CredoTech	**CRDO**	**206.63**	**-19.56**
CrowdStrike	**CRWD**	**215.07**	**-15.93**
CrownCastle	CCI	75.84	-0.30
Crown Holdings	CCK	116.66	0.27
Cullen/Frost	CFR	158.32	-2.55
Cummins	CMI	551.15	-13.25
Curtiss-Wright	CW	577.99	-4.54
Cytokinetics	CYTK	71.40	0.49

D E F

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
DTE Energy	DTE	136.06	0.43
DT Midstream	DTM	129.99	-1.03
Danaher	DHR	206.93	-6.63
Darden	DRI	215.56	1.30
DarlingIngred	DAR	67.70	1.43
Datadog	**DDOG**	**223.84**	**-13.20**
DaVita	DVA	176.14	0.13
DeckersOutdoor	DECK	84.58	-2.50
▲ Deere	DE	676.08	21.17
DellTechC	**DELL**	**425.00**	**-31.01**
DeltaAir	DAL	76.38	-1.62
DeutscheBank	DB	39.58	-0.48
DevonEnergy	DVN	49.05	0.54
DexCom	DXCM	90.14	-0.92
Diageo	DEO	90.06	-1.79
DiamondbkEner	FANG	203.16	2.68
Dick's	DKS	132.95	-2.15
DigitalRealty	DLR	183.27	-2.32
DigitalOcean	DOCN	108.92	-1.77
Dillard's	DDS	626.36	0.39
Disney	DIS	106.22	-1.33
DocuSign	DOCU	64.64	-1.63
DollarGeneral	DG	131.09	4.34
DollarTree	DLTR	131.71	5.12
DominionEner	D	66.38	0.37
Domino's	DPZ	340.37	-1.69
Donaldson	DCI	89.76	-1.13
DoorDash	DASH	225.66	-6.08
Dover	DOV	189.93	-4.30
Dow	DOW	30.46	-0.06
DrReddy'sLab	RDY	12.17	0.04
DraftKings	DKNG	23.44	-0.85
DukeEnergy	DUK	120.39	0.48
DuPont	DD	132.11	-2.48
Dynatrace	DT	52.86	-1.73
EMCOR	EME	735.25	0.71
ENI	E	55.53	0.73
EOG Rscs	EOG	148.35	3.39
EQT	EQT	55.59	1.41
EastWestBncp	EWBC	126.76	-0.10
EastGroup	EGP	200.07	0.57
Eaton	ETN	390.71	-11.17
eBay	EBAY	104.98	1.42
EchoStar	ECHO	86.04	-0.40
Ecolab	ECL	280.25	-2.95
Ecopetrol	EC	17.45	0.78
EdisonIntl	**EIX**	**58.80**	**4.82**
EdwardsLife	EW	90.74	-0.01
ElancoAnimal	ELAN	23.91	-0.01
Elastic	**ESTC**	**92.39**	**-5.16**
ElbitSystems	ESLT	708.70	8.19
EldoradoGold	EGO	42.86	-1.91
ElevanceHealth	ELV	403.04	10.50
Embraer	EMBJ	71.71	0.15
Emera	EMA	50.10	0.01
EmersonElec	EMR	147.63	-4.81

Continued on Page B10

AUCTION RESULTS

Here are the results of Tuesday's Treasury auctions. All bids are awarded at a single price at the market-clearing yield. Rates are determined by the difference between that price and the face value.

SIX-WEEK BILLS

Applications	$247,263,363,500
Accepted bids	$90,124,268,500
" noncompetitively	$1,322,949,000
" foreign noncompetitively	$1,900,000,000
Auction price (rate)	99.564250
	(3.735%)
Coupon equivalent	3.803%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	52.35%
Cusip number	912797UK1

The bills, dated Sept. 3, 2026, mature on Oct. 15, 2026.

52-WEEK BILLS

Applications	$190,866,626,400
Accepted bids	$55,135,044,900
" noncompetitively	$1,354,666,900
" foreign noncompetitively	$101,700,000
Auction price (rate)	95.975778
	(3.980%)
Coupon equivalent	4.161%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	34.18%
Cusip number	912797WA1

The bills, dated Sept. 3, 2026, mature on Sept. 2, 2027.

Cash Prices | wsj.com/market-data/commodities

Tuesday, September 1, 2026

These prices reflect buying and selling of a variety of actual or "physical" commodities in the marketplace—separate from the futures price on an exchange, which reflects what the commodity might be worth in future months.

	Tuesday
Energy	
Coal,C.Aplc.,12500Btu,1.2SO2-r,w	81.000
Coal,PwdrRvrBsn,8800Btu,0.8SO2-r,w	14.500
Metals	
Gold, per troy oz	
Engelhard industrial	4340.00
Krugerrand,wholesale-e	4510.17
Maple Leaf-e	4553.54
American Eagle-e	4553.54
Mexican peso-e	5236.76
Austria crown-e	4253.83
Austria phil-e	4553.54
Silver, troy oz.	
Engelhard industrial	64.8000
Handy & Harman base	65.2520
Handy & Harman fabricated	81.5650
Coins,wholesale $1,000 face-a	45759
Other metals	
Platinum,Engelhard industrial	1778.0
Palladium,Engelhard industrial	1339.0
Aluminum, LME, $ per metric ton	*n.a.
Copper,Comex spot	6.5065
Iron Ore, 62% Fe CFR China-s	*99.7
Steel, HRC USA, FOB Midwest Mill-s	*1200.0
Battery/EV metals	
BMI Lithium Carbonate, EXW China, =99.5%-v,w	23100
BMI Lithium Hydroxide, EXW China, =56.5% -v,w	20575
BMI Cobalt sulphate, EXW China, >20.5% -v,w	10430
BMI Nickel Sulphate, EXW China, >22%-v,k	4381
BMI Flake Graphite, FOB China, -100 Mesh, 94-95% -v,m	425
Fibers and Textiles	
Burlap,10-oz,40-inch NY yd-n,w	1.2800
Cotton,1 1/16 std lw-mdMphs-u	0.8626
Cotlook 'A' Index-t	*101.30
Hides,hvy native steers piece fob-u	n.a.
Wool,64s,staple,Terr del-u,w	n.a.
Grains and Feeds	
Bran,wheat middlings, KC-u,w	138
Corn,No. 2 yellow,Cent IL-bp,u	5.0800
Cottonseed meal-u,w	320
Hominy feed,Cent IL-u,w	120
Meat-bonemeal,50% pro Mnpls-u,w	443
Oats,No.2 milling,Mnpls-u	3.8675
Rice, Long Grain Milled, No. 2 AR-u,w	30.13
SoybeanMeal,Cent IL,rail,ton48%-u,w	n.a.
Soybeans,No.1 yllw IL-bp,u	13.0800
Wheat,Spring14%-pro Mnpls-u	8.9675
Wheat,No.2 soft red,St.Louis-u	7.3850
Wheat - Hard - KC (USDA) $ per bu-u	8.1125
Wheat,No.1soft white,Portld,OR-u	6.9500
Food	
Beef,carcass equiv. index	
choice 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	347.22
select 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	327.36
Broilers, National comp wtd. avg.-u,w	1.1641
Butter,AA Chicago-d	1.3925
Cheddar cheese,bbl,Chicago-d	153.25
Cheddar cheese,blk,Chicago-d	147.50
Milk,Nonfat dry,Chicago lb.-d	190.00
Coffee,Brazilian,Comp-y	3.1680
Coffee,Colombian, NY-y	3.8216
Eggs,large white,Chicago-u,w	0.6850
Flour,hard winter KC-p	20.80
Hams,17-20 lbs,Mid-US fob-u	n.a.
Hogs,Iowa-So. Minnesota-u	88.35
Pork bellies,12-14 lb MidUS-u	2.0367
Pork loins,13-19 lb MidUS-u	1.1100
Steers,Tex.-Okla. Choice-u	n.a.
Steers,feeder,Okla. City-u,w	374.25
Fats and Oils	
Degummed corn oil, crude wtd. avg.-u,w	n.a.
Grease,choice white,Chicago-h	0.6800
Lard,Chicago-u	n.a.
Soybean oil,crude;Centl IL-u,w	0.7309
Tallow,bleach;Chicago-h	0.7625
Tallow,edible,Chicago-u	n.a.

KEY TO CODES: A=ask; B=bid; BP=country elevator bids to producers; C=corrected; D=CME; E=Manfra,Tordella & Brookes; H=American Commodities Brokerage Co; K=bi-weekly; M=monthly; N=nominal; n.a.=not quoted or not available; P=Sosland Publishing; R=SNL Energy; S=Platts-TSI; T=Cotlook Limited; U=USDA; V=Benchmark Mineral Intelligence; W=weekly; Y=International Coffee Organization; Z=not quoted. *Data as of 8/31

Source: Dow Jones Market Data

Borrowing Benchmarks | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Money Rates

September 1, 2026

Key annual interest rates paid to borrow or lend money in U.S. and international markets. Rates below are a guide to general levels but don't always represent actual transactions.

Inflation

	July index level	Chg From (%) June '26	July '25
U.S. consumer price index			
All items	333.918	−0.01	3.4
Core	337.133	0.07	2.5

International rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week High	52-Week Low
Prime rates				
U.S.	6.75	6.75	7.50	6.75
Canada	4.45	4.45	4.95	4.45
Japan	2.375	2.375	2.375	1.875
Policy Rates				
Euro zone	2.40	2.40	2.40	2.15
Switzerland	0.25	0.25	0.50	0.25
Britain	3.75	3.75	4.00	3.75
Australia	4.35	4.35	4.35	3.60
Overnight repurchase				
U.S.	3.65	3.69	4.45	3.49

U.S. government rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week High	52-Week Low
Discount	3.75	3.75	4.50	3.75
Federal funds				
Effective rate	n.a.	3.6400	4.3300	3.6300
High	n.a.	3.7000	4.5500	3.7000
Low	n.a.	3.5500	4.3200	3.5500
Bid	n.a.	3.6300	4.3200	3.6100
Offer	n.a.	3.6400	4.3300	3.6300
Treasury bill auction				
4 weeks	3.650	3.640	4.245	3.550
13 weeks	3.770	3.715	4.045	3.540
26 weeks	3.885	3.790	3.945	3.475

Other short-term rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week high	52-Week low
Call money	5.50	5.50	6.25	5.50
Commercial paper (AA financial)				
90 days	n.a.	3.80	4.22	3.57
Secured Overnight Financing Rate	3.68	3.65	4.51	3.50

	Latest	Value Traded	52-Week High	52-Week Low
DTCC GCF Repo Index				
Treasury	3.702	59.354	4.492	3.504
MBS	3.705	106.658	4.623	3.517

Weekly survey

	Latest	Week ago	Year ago
Freddie Mac			
30-year fixed	6.66	6.65	6.56
15-year fixed	5.98	5.95	5.69

Notes on data:

U.S. prime rate is the base rate on corporate loans posted by at least 70% of the 10 largest U.S. banks, and is effective December 11, 2025. **Other prime rates** aren't directly comparable; lending practices vary widely by location; **Discount rate** is effective December 11, 2025. **Secured Overnight Financing Rate** is as of August 31, 2026. **DTCC GCF Repo Index** is Depository Trust & Clearing Corp.'s weighted average for overnight trades in applicable CUSIPs. Value traded is in billions of U.S. dollars. **Federal-funds rates** are Tullett Prebon rates as of 3:30 p.m. ET.

Sources: Federal Reserve; Bureau of Labor Statistics; DTCC; FactSet; Tullett Prebon Information, Ltd.

COMMODITIES

wsj.com/market-data/commodities

Futures Contracts

Metal & Petroleum Futures

Contract	Open	High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Copper-High (CMX)-25,000 lbs.; $ per lb.						
Sept	6.6025	6.6395	6.4290	**6.5065**	–0.0870	5,310
Dec	6.6905	6.7420	6.5135	**6.6005**	–0.0870	162,826
Gold (CMX)-100 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
Sept	4402.00	4402.00	4329.10	**4348.00**	–83.10	1,116
Oct	4463.70	4475.30	4337.00	**4362.80**	–84.00	48,333
Nov	4483.40	4491.60	4355.00	**4380.40**	–84.80	621
Dec	4498.70	4510.50	4369.70	**4396.40**	–85.10	323,541
Jan'27	4446.70	4446.90	4396.20	**4415.70**	–85.40	525
Feb	4536.30	4544.00	4406.00	**4431.70**	–85.80	31,115
Palladium (NYM) - 50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
Sept	1348.00	1350.50	1331.00	**1317.20**	–45.70	70
Dec	1385.00	1396.00	1316.50	**1330.60**	–47.70	15,815
Platinum (NYM)-50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
Sept	1853.00	1887.90	1853.00	**1761.50**	–26.90	36
Oct	1796.70	1820.20	1747.00	**1766.40**	–27.80	45,815
Silver (CMX)-5,000 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.						
Sept	66.510	66.715	63.870	**64.618**	–1.603	1,077
Dec	67.275	67.720	64.610	**65.369**	–1.621	86,944
Crude Oil, Light Sweet (NYM)-1,000 bbls.; $ per bbl.						
Oct	86.31	90.97	86.13	**90.22**	4.46	259,177
Nov	84.46	88.34 ▲	84.24	**87.75**	3.69	173,741
Dec	82.32	85.41	82.08	**84.97**	2.90	201,334
Jan'27	80.26	82.71	80.06	**82.40**	2.28	110,848
June	74.04	75.06	73.86	**74.82**	0.82	137,230
Dec	71.11	71.86	70.98	**71.57**	0.49	160,917
NY Harbor ULSD (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.						
Oct	4.4309	4.7260 ▲	4.4005	**4.6773**	.2667	69,683
Nov	4.2658	4.5420 ▲	4.2432	**4.5054**	.2537	49,616
Gasoline-NY RBOB (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.						
Oct	3.1120	3.1645 ▲	3.0788	**3.1351**	.0581	103,982
Nov	2.9249	2.9938 ▲	2.9021	**2.9661**	.0769	66,473
Natural Gas (NYM)-10,000 MMBtu.; $ per MMBtu.						
Oct	2.931	2.955	2.851	**2.904**	–.031	334,683
Nov	3.057	3.079	2.983	**3.034**	–.030	255,250
Dec	3.514	3.535 ▼	3.436	**3.493**	–.025	167,449
Jan'27	3.929	3.956 ▼	3.860	**3.916**	–.027	175,690
March	2.904	2.928	2.864	**2.901**	–.015	155,035
April	2.773	2.790 ▼	2.737	**2.770**	–.008	125,837

Agriculture Futures

Contract	Open	High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Corn (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
Sept	514.25	524.75 ▲	512.00	**521.50**	6.50	3,801
Dec	537.25	548.00 ▲	534.25	**546.00**	8.25	996,266
Oats (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
Sept	356.00	356.00	356.00	**354.75**	7.75	4
Dec	372.00	384.00	371.25	**381.50**	8.50	2,774
Soybeans (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
Sept	1304.00	1304.00 ▲	1304.00	**1306.75**	31.50	524
Nov	1291.25	1320.50 ▲	1290.00	**1317.75**	29.75	480,062
Soybean Meal (CBT)-100 tons; $ per ton.						
Sept	333.60	342.00 ▲	332.50	**342.00**	7.40	1,591
Dec	344.00	353.10 ▲	342.50	**352.60**	7.30	312,669
Soybean Oil (CBT)-60,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Sept	72.00	72.13	71.65	**72.37**	1.87	2,955
Dec	72.00	73.00	72.00	**72.63**	1.51	253,327
Rough Rice (CBT)-2,000 cwt.; $ per cwt.						
Sept	15.18	15.35 ▲	15.18	**15.33**	.08	438
Nov	15.71	15.89 ▲	15.55	**15.83**	.10	11,683
Wheat (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
Sept	771.75	772.75	759.25	**764.00**	7.50	409
Dec	774.75	792.25 ▲	767.00	**782.50**	8.50	268,192
Wheat (KC)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.						
Sept	836.50	836.75 ▲	836.00	**825.75**	5.50	308
Dec	838.00	856.75 ▲	831.50	**845.25**	7.25	175,889
Cattle-Feeder (CME)-50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Sept	321.625	322.000	317.000	**320.350**	–1.100	8,145
Oct	317.250	317.250	312.275	**315.400**	–1.625	26,371
Cattle-Live (CME)-40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Oct	212.500	212.975	210.500	**212.075**	–.600	110,116
Dec	214.400	214.850	212.425	**213.375**	–1.200	82,074
Hogs-Lean (CME)-40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Oct	83.925	84.075	83.075	**83.650**	–.025	128,814
Dec	74.425	74.600	73.525	**74.000**	–.150	74,626
Lumber (CME)-27,500 bd. ft., $ per 1,000 bd. ft.						
Sept	568.00	568.00	559.50	**563.00**	–6.00	1,585
Nov	559.50	561.00	553.00	**559.50**	–2.50	8,371
Milk (CME)-200,000 lbs., cents per lb.						
Aug	16.67	16.67	16.65	**16.66**	–.01	4,687
Oct	17.02	17.09	16.77	**16.79**	–.19	6,533
Cocoa (ICE-US)-10 metric tons; $ per ton.						
Sept	6,603	6,603	6,603	**6,552**	–98	194
Dec	6,743	6,819	6,407	**6,571**	–200	79,390
Coffee (ICE-US)-37,500 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Sept	345.00	345.00	333.00	**342.25**	–1.65	101
Dec	313.45	315.55	299.20	**309.45**	–2.05	87,463
Sugar-World (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Oct	17.81	18.41	17.67	**18.36**	.55	459,231
March'27	18.84	19.37	18.71	**19.33**	.50	404,374
Sugar-Domestic (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Nov	39.00	39.00	39.00	**39.00**	...	599
Jan'27	39.75	40.30 ▲	39.75	**39.75**	.40	996
Cotton (ICE-US)-50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Oct	91.34	91.44	89.76	**90.01**	–1.69	194
Dec	92.99	93.14	90.91	**91.55**	–1.59	198,284
Orange Juice (ICE-US)-15,000 lbs.; cents per lb.						
Sept	127.15	127.15	127.15	**127.15**	7.90	114
Nov	139.90	145.95	136.75	**145.15**	7.90	8,572

Interest Rate Futures

Contract	Open	High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Ultra Treasury Bonds (CBT) - $100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	110-110	110-250	109-240	**110-030**	–11.0	19,581
Dec	110-030	110-130	109-120	**109-220**	–11.0	2,397,980
Treasury Bonds (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	109-020	109-110	108-180	**108-240**	–12.0	19,416
Dec	108-210	108-280	108-010	**108-080**	–12.0	1,786,167
Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	107-315	107-315	107-200	**107-200**	–9.0	63,394
Dec	107-230	107-235	107-115	**107-120**	–9.0	5,180,609
5 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	105-267	105-270	105-202	**105-205**	–6.2	120,943
Dec	105-235	105-235	105-155	**105-157**	–6.7	6,274,904
2 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$200,000; pts 32nds of 100%						
Sept	102-249	102-249	102-215	**102-220**	–2.5	79,786
Dec	102-201	102-201	102-164	**102-169**	–2.9	4,258,533
30 Day Federal Funds (CBT)-$5,000,000; 100 - daily avg.						
Sept	96.2925	96.2950	96.2900	**96.2925**	–.0025	242,670
Oct	96.2000	96.2000	96.1900	**96.1950**	–.0050	616,610
Three-Month SOFR (CME)-$1,000,000; 100 - daily avg.						
June	96.3525	96.3550 ▼	96.3525	**96.3525**	–.0025	1,343,413
Dec	95.9150	95.9250 ▼	95.8850	**95.8900**	–.0250	1,736,388

Currency Futures

Contract	Open	High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Japanese Yen (CME)-¥12,500,000; $ per 100¥						
Sept	.6266	.6271	.6246	**.6249**	–.0015	339,710
Dec	.6311	.6315	.6291	**.6293**	–.0016	70,552
Canadian Dollar (CME)-CAD 100,000; $ per CAD						
Sept	.7222	.7228	.7195	**.7202**	–.0020	309,926
Dec	.7253	.7257	.7227	**.7234**	–.0019	25,950
British Pound (CME)-£62,500; $ per £						
Sept	1.3551	1.3559	1.3506	**1.3513**	–.0036	285,255
Dec	1.3547	1.3560	1.3508	**1.3515**	–.0037	27,149
Swiss Franc (CME)-CHF 125,000; $ per CHF						
Sept	1.2388	1.2395	1.2324	**1.2336**	–.0055	105,958
Dec	1.2516	1.2521	1.2454	**1.2464**	–.0055	11,994
Australian Dollar (CME)-AUD 100,000; $ per AUD						
Sept	.7167	.7180	.7138	**.7146**	–.0017	316,457
Dec	.7153	.7168	.7127	**.7135**	–.0016	58,548
Mexican Peso (CME)-MXN 500,000; $ per MXN						
Sept	.05875	.05898	.05868	**.05878**	...	285,414
Dec	.05831	.05853	.05828	**.05836**	...	12,895
Euro (CME)-€125,000; $ per €						
Sept	1.1625	1.1631	1.1591	**1.1597**	–.0026	756,724
Dec	1.1665	1.1671	1.1633	**1.1638**	–.0026	77,390

Index Futures

Contract	Open	High hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Mini DJ Industrial Average (CBT)-$5 x index						
Sept	53259	53343	52747	**52828**	–412	86,704
Dec	53733	53733	53180	**53238**	–417	821
Mini S&P 500 (CME)-$50 x index						
Sept	7701.25	7708.00	7621.50	**7642.75**	–56.25	1,980,055
Dec	7768.50	7774.50	7688.00	**7709.50**	–57.25	55,419
Mini S&P Midcap 400 (CME)-$100 x index						
Sept	3768.20	3774.70	3719.10	**3726.50**	–40.60	39,384
Dec	3867.70	3867.70	3866.80	**3753.80**	–41.60	9
Mini Nasdaq 100 (CME)-$20 x index						
Sept	29518.25	29571.25	29002.00	**29125.50**	–387.50	294,659
Dec	29813.25	29858.75	29300.00	**29416.50**	–392.00	4,877
Mini Russell 2000 (CME)-$50 x index						
Sept	2958.00	2964.60	2918.90	**2924.70**	–34.00	424,928
Dec	2983.00	2983.40	2941.40	**2946.30**	–34.30	1,065
Mini Russell 1000 (CME)-$50 x index						
Sept	4165.10	4175.90	4158.50	**4160.80**	–35.10	5,684
U.S. Dollar Index (ICE-US)-$1,000 x index						
Sept	99.37	99.69	99.32	**99.64**	.25	45,533
Dec	99.04	99.42	99.03	**99.38**	.27	3,798

Source: FactSet

Bonds | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Tracking Bond Benchmarks

Return on investment and spreads over Treasurys and/or yields paid to investors compared with 52-week highs and lows for different types of bonds

Total return close	YTD total return (%)	Index	Yield (%) Latest	Low	High
Broad Market Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2235.36	-0.6	U.S. Aggregate	**5.070**	4.160	5.070
U.S. Corporate Indexes Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
3419.11	-0.7	U.S. Corporate	**5.560**	4.680	5.560
3384.54	0.1	Intermediate	**5.270**	4.330	5.270
4330.48	-2.6	Long term	**6.200**	5.370	6.230
633.35	-2.1	Double-A-rated	**5.460**	4.410	5.460
941.65	-0.3	Triple-B-rated	**5.710**	4.860	5.710
High Yield Bonds ICE BofA					
632.23	2.4	High Yield Constrained	**7.297**	6.489	7.668
630.73	0.4	Triple-C-rated	**14.411**	11.478	14.411
4206.97	2.1	High Yield 100	**6.551**	5.828	7.136
550.98	2.7	Global High Yield Constrained	**7.045**	6.317	7.438
402.30	1.8	Europe High Yield Constrained	**5.725**	4.820	6.198
U.S Agency Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
1964.98	0.3	U.S Agency	**4.700**	3.830	4.700
1745.17	0.5	10-20 years	**4.640**	3.750	4.640
3649.07	-1.7	20-plus years	**5.400**	4.580	5.400
3033.87	-0.1	Yankee	**5.210**	4.320	5.210

Total return close	YTD total return (%)	Index	Yield (%) Latest	Low	High
Mortgage-Backed Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2243.21	-0.2	Mortgage-Backed	**5.350**	4.380	5.350
2206.34	0.1	Ginnie Mae (GNMA)	**5.390**	4.420	5.390
1325.85	-0.3	Fannie mae (FNMA)	**5.330**	4.370	5.330
2032.45	-0.8	Freddie Mac (FHLMC)	**5.190**	4.160	5.190
614.98	-0.5	Muni Master	**3.828**	3.037	3.828
436.28	-1.4	7-12 year	**3.627**	2.596	3.627
494.63	-1.0	12-22 year	**4.444**	3.608	4.533
467.28	0.1	22-plus year	**4.925**	4.432	5.037
Global Government J.P. Morgan†					
551.30	-1.4	Global Government	**4.378**	3.500	4.378
843.82	0.3	Canada	**3.722**	3.070	3.741
360.96	-1.2	EMU§	**3.842**	3.117	3.842
648.88	-1.4	France	**4.181**	3.350	4.181
458.88	-1.1	Germany	**3.434**	2.650	3.434
241.90	-4.5	Japan	**3.233**	2.100	3.233
501.45	-1.0	Netherlands	**3.534**	2.860	3.534
805.82	-1.9	U.K.	**5.381**	4.560	5.381
n.a.	n.a.	Emerging Markets **	**n.a.**	n.a.	n.a.

*Constrained indexes limit individual issuer concentrations to 2%; the High Yield 100 are the 100 largest bonds
† In local currency § Euro-zone bonds
** EMBI Global Index
Sources: ICE Data Services; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; J.P.Morgan

Global Government Bonds: Mapping Yields

Yields and spreads over or under U.S. Treasurys on benchmark two-year and 10-year government bonds in selected other countries; arrows indicate whether the yield rose(▲) or fell (▼) in the latest session

Coupon (%)	Country/ Maturity, in years	Yield (%) Latest	Previous	Month ago	Year ago	Spread Under/Over U.S. Treasurys, in basis points Latest	Prev	Year ago
4.125	**U.S.** 2	**4.392** ▲	4.348	4.289	3.621			
4.625	10	**4.795** ▲	4.757	4.743	4.227			
2.250	**Australia** 2	**4.753** ▲	4.698	4.524	3.347	**34.9**	34.4	**-27.8**
4.250	10	**5.161** ▲	5.078	4.938	4.331	**35.9**	32.2	**9.8**
2.400	**France** 2	**3.150** ▲	3.126	3.002	2.220	-125.4	-122.8	**-140.5**
3.700	10	**4.206** ▲	4.178	4.001	3.534	**-59.6**	-57.8	**-69.9**
2.700	**Germany** 2	**2.964** ▲	2.939	2.831	1.952	-144.1	-141.5	**-167.3**
3.000	10	**3.360** ▲	3.339	3.229	2.751	-144.2	-141.7	**-148.3**
2.650	**Italy** 2	**3.136** ▲	3.129	3.015	2.238	-126.8	-122.6	**-138.7**
3.800	10	**4.174** ▲	4.156	4.020	3.608	**-62.8**	-60.0	**-62.5**
1.700	**Japan** 2	**1.808** ▲	1.753	1.508	0.885	-259.6	-260.2	**-274.1**
2.700	10	**2.996** ▲	2.947	2.799	1.625	-180.6	-180.9	**-260.8**
2.400	**Spain** 2	**2.982** ▲	2.974	2.880	2.057	-142.2	-138.0	**-156.8**
3.400	10	**3.789** ▲	3.773	3.642	3.294	-101	-98.3	**-93.9**
4.375	**U.K.** 2	**4.499** ▲	4.409	4.421	3.963	**9.5**	5.5	**33.8**
1.125	10	**5.151** ▲	5.070	5.062	4.754	**34.9**	31.4	**52.1**

Source: Tullett Prebon, Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close

Corporate Debt

Prices of firms' bonds reflect factors including investors' economic, sectoral and company-specific expectations

Investment-grade spreads that tightened the most...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Spread*, in basis points Current	One-day change	Last week
Athene Global Funding	...	2.646	5.36	Oct. 4, '31	81	–34	n.a.
Jackson National Life Global Funding	...	4.600	5.11	Oct. 1, '29	65	–8	n.a.
Wyeth	...	6.500	5.32	Feb. 1, '34	52	–3	n.a.
Ally Financial	ALLY	8.000	5.84	Nov. 1, '31	128	–2	131
Applied Materials	AMAT	5.850	5.79	June 15, '41	99	–2	n.a.
Caterpillar Financial Services	...	3.950	4.67	Nov. 14, '28	28	–2	29
Massmutual Global Funding II*	...	4.350	5.22	Sept. 17, '31	68	–2	69
Nomura Holdings	...	2.679	5.35	July 16, '30	79	–2	82

...And spreads that widened the most

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Current	One-day change	Last week
Sammons Financial Group Global Funding*	...	4.950	5.55	June 12, '30	102	10	107
Skandinaviska Enskilda Banken	...	5.000	5.34	Sept. 2, '31	78	10	n.a.
Wells Fargo Bank	...	5.950	5.81	Aug. 26, '36	102	8	95
Citigroup	C	6.125	5.98	Aug. 25, '36	121	7	118
National Australia Bank	...	4.534	4.78	June 13, '30	26	7	24
Kraft Heinz Foods	...	6.875	6.13	Jan. 26, '39	136	6	n.a.
Caterpillar Financial Services	...	4.300	4.78	May 15, '29	32	5	33
Polar Tankers	...	5.951	5.33	May 10, '37	78	5	n.a.

High-yield issues with the biggest price increases...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Bond Price as % of face value Current	One-day change	Last week
Whirlpool	WHR	5.150	9.90	March 1, '43	61.750	0.25	61.750

...And with the biggest price decreases

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Current	One-day change	Last week
Bath & Body Works	BBWI	6.950	6.76	March 1, '33	101.000	–0.75	n.a.
Paramount Global	...	6.875	7.99	April 30, '36	92.559	–0.54	93.890
Teva Pharmaceutical Finance	...	6.150	5.87	Feb. 1, '36	102.013	–0.49	103.250
Occidental Petroleum	OXY	7.500	5.29	May 1, '31	109.011	–0.41	110.033
Bausch Health	...	11.000	8.24	Sept. 30, '28	105.151	–0.35	104.375
Bombardier	...	7.450	5.92	May 1, '34	109.307	–0.34	110.336
Telecom Italia Capital	...	7.200	5.95	July 18, '36	109.250	–0.31	109.725
Navient	NAVI	5.625	8.26	Aug. 1, '33	86.333	–0.21	85.852

*Estimated spread over 2-year, 3-year, 5-year, 10-year or 30-year hot-run Treasury; 100 basis points=one percentage pt.; change in spread shown is for Z-spread.
Note: Data are for the most active issue of bonds with maturities of two years or more
Source: MarketAxess

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COMMERCIAL REAL ESTATE

UCC PUBLIC SALE NOTICE

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE that on September 22, 2026 commencing at 11:00 AM Eastern Daylight Time (the "Sale Date"), both remotely and in-person at the top of the portico of the New York Supreme Court located at 60 Centre Street, New York, New York 10007, pursuant to the Terms of Public Sale (described below), based upon the occurrence of one or more Events of Default under certain documents (the "Loan Documents"), copies of which are available for inspection as hereinafter described, and pursuant to such Loan Documents as amended, and Article 9 of the Uniform Commercial Code as enacted in the State of New York, NewPoint JV Sub CB, LLC ("Secured Party"), as successor-in-interest to NewPoint JV LLC, acting by and through its Servicer, NewPoint Real Estate Capital LLC, shall dispose of, by public sale, the right, title and interest of Arya Windermere Apartment Ventures, LLC, a Delaware limited liability company having its principal place of business at 1250 Marden Road, Suite 1, Apopka, Florida 32703 (the "Pledgor"), in and to the following assets (collectively, the "Collateral"): (i) one hundred percent (100%) of the limited liability company membership interests in AWAD Phase I, LLC, a Florida limited liability company (the "Pledged Entity"); and (ii) all other assets pledged by Pledgor under the Loan Documents. The public sale shall be conducted by an auctioneer licensed in the State of New York as selected by Secured Party in its sole and absolute discretion.

Based upon information provided by Pledgor, Pledged Entity and certain other persons and entities affiliated therewith, it is the understanding of Secured Party (but without any representation or warranty by Secured Party as to the accuracy or completeness of the following matters) that: (i) Pledgor owns one hundred percent (100%) of the limited liability company membership interests in Pledged Entity (the "Membership Interests"); (ii) Pledged Entity has good, marketable and insurable fee simple title in and to the real property located at 1231 Arya Way, Ocoee, Florida 34761 and commonly referred to as the "Arya at Windermere" (the "Premises"), as more particularly described in the Loan Documents; and (iii) the Premises are encumbered by and subject to that certain Amended and Restated Multifamily Mortgage, Assignment of Rents and Security Agreement, dated as of September 11, 2023, by and between Pledged Entity (as mortgagor) and NewPoint JV LLC, a Delaware limited liability company (as mortgagee), as recorded on September 13, 2023 in the Orange County, Florida Comptroller's Office Official Records as document number 20230526957 (the "Mortgage") held by Secured Party and securing indebtedness under the Loan Documents in the original principal amount of $37,500,000.00.

The Collateral is offered "AS IS, WHERE IS," with all faults, and Secured Party makes no guarantee, representation or warranty (including, without limitation, any representation or warranty of merchantability or fitness), express or implied, of any kind or nature whatsoever.

Secured Party will be permitted to bid at the sale, and notwithstanding any requirement herein that the sale of the Collateral be for cash, Secured Party may credit bid all or any portion of the outstanding balance of the amounts due under the Loan Documents. Secured Party reserves the right, in its sole and absolute discretion, to (a) reject all bids and terminate the sale or adjourn the sale to such other date and time as Secured Party may deem proper, by announcement at the place and on the date of sale, and any subsequent adjournment thereof and (b) impose any other commercially reasonable conditions upon the sale of the Collateral as Secured Party may deem proper in its sole and absolute discretion.

The Membership Interests are unregistered securities under the Securities Act of 1933 as amended. Because of this, each prospective bidder seeking to be a "Qualified Bidder" (as determined by Secured Party in its sole and absolute discretion) shall be required, among other things, to execute and deliver to Secured Party a Bidding Certificate certifying, among other things, that such bidder: (i) will acquire the Collateral for investment purposes, solely for its own account and not with a view to distribution or resale; (ii) is an accredited investor within the meaning of the applicable securities laws; (iii) has sufficient knowledge and experience in financial and business matters so as to be capable of evaluating the merits and risks of investment and has sufficient financial means to afford the risk of investment in the Collateral; and (iv) will not resell or otherwise hypothecate the Collateral without either a valid registration under applicable federal or state laws, including without limitation the Securities Act of 1933 as amended, or an available exemption therefrom.

In addition to proceeding in-person outside the New York Supreme Court, the public sale will proceed remotely with access afforded via a web-based video conferencing and/or telephonic conference program selected by the Secured Party, details of which will be provided to interested and qualified parties in advance of the Sale Date.

The public sale of the Collateral shall be subject to the further terms and conditions set forth in the Terms of Public Sale (including without limitation terms and conditions with respect to the availability of additional information, bidding requirements, deposit amounts, bidding procedures, and the consummation of the public sale), which are available online at https://rimarketplace.com/listing/129494/multifamily/ocoee/fl and by contacting: Newmark, 1420 Spring Hill Road, McLean, Virginia 22102, Attn. John Howley (703-918-0246/john.howley@nmrk.com) and John Daniels (312-224-3260/john.daniels@nmrk.com).

BUSINESS OPPORTUNITIES

PUBLIC NOTICES

Notice to Publishers of InMobi Pte. Ltd.

Internal Reorganisation of InMobi Pte. Ltd and its subsidiaries

This notice is applicable to all publishers of InMobi Pte. Ltd.

InMobi Pte. Ltd. and its subsidiaries are undergoing an internal reorganisation. As part of the internal reorganisation, all of InMobi Pte. Ltd.'s rights, interests, obligations and liabilities under its agreement(s) with you (the "**Agreement**") are assigned and novated to InMobi Technology Services Pte. Ltd., and InMobi Technology Services Pte. Ltd. will replace InMobi Pte. Ltd. as the contractual counterparty under the Agreement.

From 31 March 2026 (the "**Effective Date**"), (a) InMobi Technology Services Pte. Ltd. shall assume and perform all rights, responsibilities, obligations and liabilities of InMobi Pte. Ltd. under the Agreement, (b) all references in the Agreement to "InMobi Pte. Ltd." shall be deemed to refer to "InMobi Technology Services Pte. Ltd." from the Effective Date, and (c) all invoices issued on or after the Effective Date will be raised by, and must be settled in favour of, InMobi Technology Services Pte. Ltd. For the avoidance of doubt, all commercial terms, service delivery arrangements, and operational processes under the Agreement will remain unchanged, save for the substitution of the contracting entity described above.

In connection with the internal reorganisation and as part of our routine review and reconciliation of historical accounts, we are undertaking an exercise to verify whether there are any outstanding payments to be made to you under the Agreement.

Actions Required

If you have not already done so, please log into the publisher dashboard and click "I accept" to confirm your acknowledgement and acceptance to the transfer of the Agreement to InMobi Technology Services Pte. Ltd., and to indicate your continued usage of the Marketing Platform and our services. Alternatively, please email us at contracts-assignment@inmobi.com with your full name and publisher ID, or other relevant account details, to indicate your acknowledgement.

Given our past business relationship, we would appreciate it if you could review your records and let us know whether you believe there are any outstanding payments. If your records indicate any such outstanding payment(s), please raise an invoice to be addressed to InMobi Technology Services Pte. Ltd., together with any relevant supporting details or documentation, for our review by **22 September 2026**. To facilitate our review of your payment claim, please include, where applicable:

- Legal entity name;
- Publisher ID or other relevant account details;
- Copies of any outstanding invoices or supporting documentation; and
- Any other information relevant to your claim.

Please send all correspondence to
contracts-assignment@inmobi.com.

For the avoidance of doubt, all invoices issued on or after **31 March 2026** are to be addressed to, and will be settled by, **InMobi Technology Services Pte. Ltd.** Pursuant to the internal reorganisation, InMobi Technology Services Pte. Ltd. shall be responsible for the payment of all outstanding amounts (if any) and all future amounts payable under any invoices, including those raised to InMobi Pte. Ltd.

Contact Us

We appreciate your assistance and cooperation. Should you require any clarification or further information, please reach out to your InMobi account representative, or contact us at contracts-assignment@inmobi.com. We value our relationship and look forward to continuing our partnership.

Issued jointly by,
InMobi Pte. Ltd. (Company Registration No. 200811408G)
and
InMobi Technology Services Pte. Ltd. (Company Registration No. 202518102M)

MARKETS DIGEST

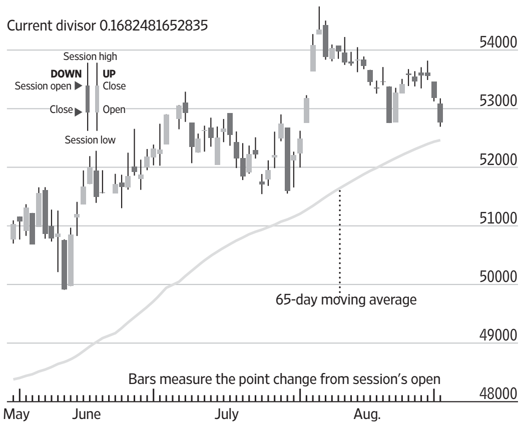
EQUITIES

Dow Jones Industrial Average

52766.88 ▼419.02, or 0.79%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio	21.48	24.84
P/E estimate *	20.36	21.75
Dividend yield	1.44	1.64
All-time high 54349.12, 08/05/26		

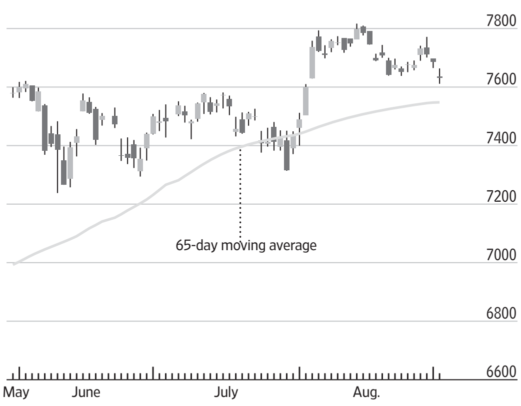


S&P 500 Index

7631.47 ▼54.67, or 0.71%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *	24.50	25.15
P/E estimate *	21.12	23.99
Dividend yield *	1.07	1.21
All-time high	7798.99, 08/13/26	

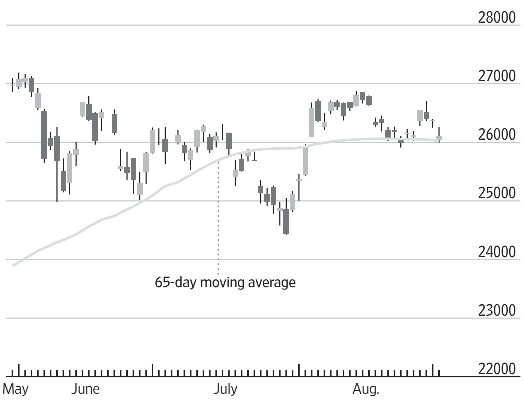


Nasdaq Composite Index

26099.77 ▼ 271.11, or 1.03%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *†	34.37	32.97
P/E estimate *†	24.17	29.25
Dividend yield *†	0.54	0.68
All-time high: 27093.90, 06/02/26		



*Weekly P/E data based on as-reported earnings from Birinyi Associates Inc.; †Based on Nasdaq-100 Index

Major U.S. Stock-Market Indexes

	Latest High	Low	Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg	% chg YTD	3-yr. ann.
Dow Jones										
Industrial Average	53176.60	52691.31	52766.88	-419.02	-0.79	54349.12	45166.64	16.5	9.8	14.8
Transportation Avg	21268.45	20662.79	20767.36	-534.65	-2.51	23933.14	15067.87	31.6	19.6	9.5
Utility Average	1072.68	1060.64	1072.51	9.35	0.88	1190.23	1048.33	-0.8	0.4	7.4
Total Stock Market	75747.45	75219.87	75414.17	-601.13	-0.79	77313.23	62750.36	18.6	11.7	18.7
Barron's 400	1635.58	1620.33	1622.29	-18.05	-1.10	1685.46	1318.70	18.3	14.8	16.9
Nasdaq Stock Market										
Nasdaq Composite	26260.68	25995.53	26099.77	-271.11	-1.03	27093.90	20794.64	22.7	12.3	23.0
Nasdaq-100	29267.42	28953.26	29077.22	-379.75	-1.29	30660.60	22953.38	25.2	15.2	23.4
S&P										
500 Index	7663.63	7611.20	7631.47	-54.67	-0.71	7798.99	6343.72	19.0	11.5	19.1
MidCap 400	3753.91	3714.52	3720.79	-39.45	-1.05	3926.98	3109.89	14.8	12.6	11.7
SmallCap 600	1752.53	1732.57	1734.65	-21.05	-1.20	1828.54	1364.94	21.7	18.2	11.9
Other Indexes										
Russell 2000	2943.43	2916.84	2920.13	-36.32	-1.23	3068.42	2305.11	24.1	17.7	15.0
NYSE Composite	24526.70	24316.61	24349.28	-112.67	-0.46	24821.68	20912.89	15.7	10.7	14.8
Value Line	681.54	672.57	673.19	-8.350	-1.23	702.60	590.50	7.6	7.1	5.4
NYSE Arca Biotech	9356.59	9266.48	9326.35	22.55	0.24	9539.76	6043.49	53.3	30.4	20.4
NYSE Arca Pharma	1284.15	1252.73	1267.99	15.26	1.22	1315.38	925.18	32.8	12.6	11.7
KBW Bank	186.80	183.48	183.86	-1.56	-0.84	193.91	143.23	23.2	12.0	30.7
PHLX§ Gold/Silver	405.91	391.31	391.81	-15.83	-3.88	470.37	254.66	53.6	14.5	49.4
PHLX§ Oil Service	107.69	106.28	106.53	-0.17	-0.16	109.24	60.27	63.8	45.3	3.7
PHLX§ Semiconductor	11389.62	11172.90	11288.61	-246.44	-2.14	14634.72	5592.82	101.4	59.4	45.3
Cboe Volatility	16.80	14.95	16.34	1.42	9.52	31.05	13.47	-4.8	9.3	7.7

§Nasdaq PHLX

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Late Trading

Most-active and biggest movers among NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE Amer. and Nasdaq issues from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. ET as reported by electronic trading services, securities dealers and regional exchanges. Minimum share price of $2 and minimum after-hours volume of 50,000 shares.

Most-active issues in late trading

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	After Hours Last	Net chg	% chg	High	Low
SS SPDR Ptf S&P 500	SPYM	17,500.9	89.75	0.10	0.11	89.77	89.62
Blue Owl Capital	OWL	17,047.8	11.67	-0.01	-0.09	11.91	11.55
NVIDIA	NVDA	10,056.9	217.56	0.12	0.06	224.90	208.23
Sunbelt Rentals Holdings	SUNB	9,610.3	67.99	0.92	1.37	68.50	66.38
Ericsson ADR	ERIC	7,572.2	10.07	0.01	0.10	10.20	10.01
VICI Properties	VICI	6,416.6	25.54	...	unch.	25.67	25.53
State Street SPDR S&P 500	SPY	5,926.8	761.84	0.06	0.01	762.17	716.81
Ford Motor	F	5,259.5	13.82	-0.02	-0.14	13.85	13.80

Percentage gainers…

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	Last	Net chg	% chg	High	Low
GitLab Cl A	GTLB	3,004.7	52.07	6.98	15.49	55.00	42.12
GrShr 2x Long DELL Daily	DLLL	2,636.7	24.59	3.06	14.21	26.43	21.18
Dell Technologies Cl C	DELL	4,710.1	454.50	29.50	6.94	473.00	420.00
Perrigo	PRGO	1,490.4	14.99	0.56	3.88	14.99	14.43
Hewlett Packard Ent	HPE	1,817.0	52.84	1.97	3.87	54.10	50.60

…And losers

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	Last	Net chg	% chg	High	Low
MongoDB	MDB	889.2	376.00	-58.21	-13.41	487.73	367.61
Credo Tech Group	CRDO	1,857.2	188.28	-18.35	-8.88	207.80	186.30
System1	SST	52.9	2.70	-0.14	-4.90	2.85	2.60
Direxion PANW Bull 2X	PALU	101.5	52.37	-1.85	-3.42	60.75	51.00
Cenovus Energy	CVE	525.2	32.11	-1.02	-3.09	33.30	32.11

Trading Diary

Volume, Advancers, Decliners

	NYSE	NYSE Amer.
Total volume*	1,165,283,595	18,535,420
Adv. volume*	440,494,532	2,079,428
Decl. volume*	712,284,919	16,307,606
Issues traded	2,839	296
Advances	834	86
Declines	1,931	202
Unchanged	74	8
New highs	48	1
New lows	181	16
Closing Arms†	0.72	1.24
Block trades*	3,931	194

	Nasdaq	NYSE Arca
Total volume*	6,750,669,242	316,732,954
Adv. volume*	2,066,415,164	87,766,720
Decl. volume*	4,652,680,830	227,524,655
Issues traded	5,079	2,702
Advances	1,305	435
Declines	3,600	2,247
Unchanged	174	20
New highs	66	61
New lows	317	248
Closing Arms†	0.82	0.49
Block trades*	38,774	1,373

*Primary market NYSE, NYSE American NYSE Arca only.
†(TRIN) A comparison of the number of advancing and declining issues with the volume of shares rising and falling. An Arms of less than 1 indicates buying demand; above 1 indicates selling pressure.

Percentage Gainers…

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg
Sono Group	SSM	4.76	2.08	77.43	27.73	2.35	-13.5
bioAffinity Technologies	BIAF	6.59	2.03	44.52	202.50	4.56	-94.0
Rising Dragon Acquisition	RDAC	6.45	1.89	41.45	23.99	4.50	-37.7
Swvl Holdings	SWVL	3.83	0.92	31.62	4.01	1.30	9.7
Fervo Energy	FRVO	19.75	4.37	28.41	42.65	14.60	...
System1	SST	2.84	0.60	26.79	9.30	1.35	-60.1
Defiance Tgt 2X Lg MRNA	MRNX	95.11	15.61	19.64	143.84	14.95	...
Greenwave Tech Solns	GWAV	5.85	0.95	19.39	24.00	2.39	-14.0
Reading Intl B	RDIB	17.70	2.60	17.22	24.00	8.00	40.5
Corvex	MOVE	12.81	1.86	16.99	26.72	3.44	62.6
Defiance Tgt 2X Shrt BMNR	BMNZ	6.69	0.94	16.35	47.99	5.18	...
Pyxis Tankers	PXS	6.23	0.87	16.23	6.44	2.56	123.3
Palatin Technologies	PTN	11.54	1.55	15.52	31.00	5.61	13.0
Focus Universal	FCUV	11.35	1.50	15.23	210.00	1.79	-85.2
Leverage 2X Lg DUOL Dly	DUOG	67.00	8.33	14.20	159.80	25.15	...

Percentage Losers

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg
Alumis	ALMS	9.47	-12.34	-56.58	31.35	3.76	104.1
Picard Medical	PMI	3.86	-4.60	-54.37	684.00	2.65	-98.3
MindForge	MF	15.97	-5.72	-26.37	83.50	2.12	-75.1
Lianhe Sowell Intl	LHSW	2.88	-1.01	-25.96	47.52	1.12	-92.1
Digital Brands Group	DBGI	4.89	-1.52	-23.65	720.00	4.50	-98.7
Cango	CANG	1.84	-0.55	-23.01	55.50	1.36	-96.1
Antelope Enterprise	AEHL	5.00	-1.49	-22.96	808.39	2.98	-98.5
One & One Green Techs	YDDL	1.83	-0.45	-19.74	16.23	1.61	...
Advasa Holdings	ADBT	3.68	-0.86	-18.94	13.20	3.61	...
22nd Century Group	XXII	2.61	-0.59	-18.44	646.50	2.51	-99.5
Nocera	NCRA	2.31	-0.52	-18.37	72.00	1.30	-94.9
Conexeu Sciences	CNXU	5.87	-1.31	-18.19	18.79	5.86	...
TryHard Holdings	THH	1.75	-0.38	-17.84	550.50	1.34	-96.8
BrenX	BRNX	3.52	-0.76	-17.76	512.40	2.06	-99.2
AIOS Tech	AIOS	12.82	-2.73	-17.56	91.40	6.54	-83.3

Most Active Stocks

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	Low
GoPro	GPRO	492,964	5106.4	1.23	40.38	3.05	0.57
PG&E	PCG	144,490	487.7	14.06	5.95	19.16	13.05
AEye	LIDR	128,423	13303.2	1.47	27.83	4.00	1.01
NVIDIA	NVDA	106,916	-24.9	217.44	-1.51	236.54	164.07
Cellyan Biotechnology	HKPD	92,506	12632.1	0.18	-45.54	1.82	0.15
Direxion TSLA Bull 2X	TSLL	92,444	18.3	9.33	-6.42	23.74	6.70
GrShr 2x Sh NVDA Daily	NVD	91,742	28.9	4.05	3.05	11.41	3.61
Reitar Logtech Holdings	RITR	85,539	45.7	0.09	-4.13	7.68	0.05
NIO ADR	NIO	80,830	190.2	4.06	-4.02	8.02	3.99
Fly-E Group	FLYE	76,806	81590.4	2.20	61.76	22.00	1.36

*Volumes of 100,000 shares or more are rounded to the nearest thousand

Volume Movers

Ranked by change from 65-day average*

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	Low
Vendome Acquisition I	VNME	445	4539	10.28	0.10	10.29	9.89
Oyster Ents II Acqn	OYSE	280	2416	10.40	0.25	10.40	10.02
Power REIT	PW	355	2133	7.42	...	14.10	5.00
Alumis	ALMS	28,299	2092	9.47	-56.58	31.35	3.76
Pyxis Tankers	PXS	1,078	2017	6.23	16.23	6.44	2.56
iSh Long-Term Natl Muni	LMUB	4,138	1883	48.69	-0.74	53.52	48.00
Black Spade Acqn III	BIII	1,140	1550	10.06	...	10.24	9.83
RF Acquisition III	RFAM	105	1534	9.96	-0.05	10.00	9.77
Jackson Acqn II Cl A	JACS	357	1533	10.75	0.09	10.75	10.33
Distillate US Fund Stbl	DSTL	1,134	1512	69.32	-0.46	70.27	56.08

*Common stocks priced at $2 a share or more with an average volume over 65 trading days of at least 5,000 shares †Has traded fewer than 65 days

International Stock Indexes

Region/Country	Index	Close	Latest Net chg	% chg	YTD % chg
World	MSCI ACWI	1142.73	-6.49	-0.56	12.6
	MSCI ACWI ex-USA	483.71	-1.13	-0.23	14.9
	MSCI World	4932.94	-34.98	-0.70	11.3
	MSCI Emerging Markets	1727.35	8.04	0.47	23.0
Americas	MSCI AC Americas	2889.40	-22.123	-0.76	11.4
Canada	S&P/TSX Comp	35825.73	-444.75	-1.23	13.0
Latin Amer.	MSCI EM Latin America	3079.10	26.44	0.87	13.6
Brazil	Bovespa	179722.48	2303.70	1.30	11.5
Chile	S&P IPSA	5715.39	17.44	0.31	5.4
Mexico	S&P/BMV IPC	64514.25	-916.07	-1.40	0.3
EMEA	STOXX Europe 600	647.46	-3.64	-0.56	9.3
Eurozone	Euro STOXX	670.29	-5.21	-0.77	9.5
Belgium	Bel-20	5830.29	-3.99	-0.07	14.8
Denmark	OMX Copenhagen 20	1619.67	-6.68	-0.41	0.7
France	CAC 40	8301.85	-32.65	-0.39	1.9
Germany	DAX	25970.11	-288.00	-1.10	6.0
Israel	Tel Aviv	4147.81	9.23	0.22	14.2
Italy	FTSE MIB	51915.18	-697.51	-1.33	15.5
Netherlands	AEX	1101.92	-3.85	-0.35	15.8
Norway	Oslo Bors All-Share	2514.33	-2.49	-0.10	29.5
South Africa	FTSE/JSE All-Share	115855.50	-401.76	-0.35	0.02
Spain	IBEX 35	19824.00	-150.10	-0.75	14.5
Sweden	OMX Stockholm	1133.40	-12.61	-1.10	8.4
Switzerland	Swiss Market	14334.79	48.36	0.34	8.0
Turkey	BIST 100	14229.01	-105.05	-0.73	26.4
U.K.	FTSE 100	10789.28	-34.98	-0.32	8.6
U.K.	FTSE 250	24521.29	-417.50	-1.67	9.1
Asia-Pacific	MSCI AC Asia Pacific	279.05	0.86	0.31	22.6
Australia	S&P/ASX 200	9066.70	-9.26	-0.10	4.0
China	Shanghai Composite	3979.89	-6.41	-0.16	0.3
Hong Kong	Hang Seng	25329.73	-237.26	-0.93	-1.2
India	BSE Sensex	76944.28	-12.99	-0.02	-9.7
Japan	NIKKEI 225	66215.34	-96.59	-0.15	31.5
Singapore	Straits Times	5710.37	-44.99	-0.78	22.9
South Korea	KOSPI	6835.80	15.78	0.23	62.2
Taiwan	TAIEX	46948.72	820.25	1.78	62.1
Thailand	SET	1588.68	-6.48	-0.41	26.1

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

CURRENCIES & COMMODITIES

Currencies

U.S.-dollar foreign-exchange rates at 5 p.m. ET

Country/currency	Tues in US$	per US$	US$ vs, YTD chg (%)
Americas			
Argentina peso	.0007	1512.6593	4.2
Brazil real	.1940	5.1559	-6.5
Canada dollar	.7196	1.3898	1.2
Chile peso	.001068	936.14	4.0
Colombia peso	.000316	3169.15	-15.9
Ecuador US dollar	1	1	unch
Mexico peso	.0588	16.9945	-5.6
Uruguay peso	.02481	40.3008	3.2
Asia-Pacific			
Australia dollar	.7146	1.3994	-6.6
China yuan	.1488	6.7210	-3.9
Hong Kong dollar	.1275	7.8412	0.7
India rupee	.01053	94.972	5.7
Indonesia rupiah	.0000564	17736	6.2
Japan yen	.006243	160.18	2.2
Kazakhstan tenge	.002182	458.34	-9.7
Macau pataca	.1238	8.0781	0.7
Malaysia ringgit	.2476	4.0384	-0.5
New Zealand dollar	.5892	1.6972	-2.3
Pakistan rupee	.00361	277.361	-1.0
Philippines peso	.0160	62.456	6.0
Singapore dollar	.7854	1.2732	-1.0
South Korea won	.0007279	1373.73	-4.6
Sri Lanka rupee	.0030488	328.00	5.8
Taiwan dollar	.03154	31.707	1.1
Thailand baht	.03003	33.300	5.7
Vietnam dong	.00003835	26073	-0.9
Europe			
Czech Rep. koruna	.04788	20.885	1.5
Denmark krone	.1551	6.4484	1.4
Euro area euro	1.1594	.8626	1.3
Hungary forint	.003146	317.89	-2.9
Iceland krona	.008245	121.29	-3.2
Norway krone	.1072	9.3285	-7.5
Poland zloty	.2673	3.7405	4.1
Sweden krona	.1040	9.6158	4.4
Switzerland franc	1.2320	.8117	2.4
Turkey lira	.0207	48.2849	12.4
Ukraine hryvnia	.0224	44.5500	5.2
UK pound	1.3517	.7398	-0.3
Middle East/Africa			
Bahrain dinar	2.6524	.3770	0.01
Egypt pound	.0197	50.8148	6.5
Israel shekel	.3299	3.0309	-4.9
Kuwait dinar	3.2339	.3092	0.4
Oman sul rial	2.5994	.3847	-0.02
Qatar rial	.2736	3.655	0.01
Saudi Arabia riyal	.2663	3.7546	0.1
South Africa rand	.0618	16.1740	-2.4

	Close	Net Chg	% Chg	YTD % Chg
WSJ Dollar Index	95.90	0.19	0.19	-0.02

Sources: Tullett Prebon, Dow Jones Market Data

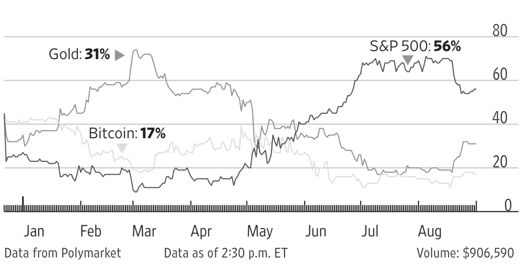
Commodities

	Close	Tuesday Net chg	% Chg	52-Week High	Low	% Chg	YTD % chg
DJ Commodity	1471.52	21.02	1.45	1471.52	1061.22	36.39	30.14
FTSE/CC CRB Index	417.30	6.74	1.64	417.30	291.69	37.10	39.67
Crude oil, $ per barrel	90.22	4.46	5.20	112.95	55.27	37.55	57.12
Natural gas, $/MMBtu	2.904	-0.031	-1.06	7.460	2.523	-3.49	-21.22
Gold, $ per troy oz.	4348.00	-83.10	-1.88	5318.40	3549.40	22.50	0.52

Polymarket | A Dow Jones partner

Prediction Market: Bitcoin vs. Gold vs. S&P 500 in 2026

This market will resolve according to the asset which has the best performance in 2026 among Bitcoin, Gold, and the S&P 500 with performance measured as the percentage change in price during the year for each asset.



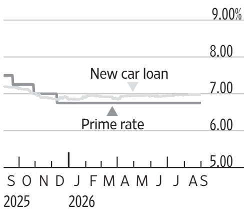
Data from Polymarket Data as of 2:30 p.m. ET Volume: $906,590

CREDIT MARKETS

Consumer Rates and Returns to Investor

U.S. consumer rates

A consumer rate against its benchmark over the past year



Selected rates

New car loan

Bankrate.com avg†:	6.98%
First Command Bank	4.99%
Fort Worth, TX	817-569-2253
First Savings Bank of Hegewisch	5.20%
Chicago, IL	773-646-4200
Frost Bank	5.64%
San Antonio, TX	210-220-4000
PNC Bank	6.07%
Wilmington, DE	888-762-2265
Firstrust Bank	6.74%
Conshohocken, PA	800-220-2265

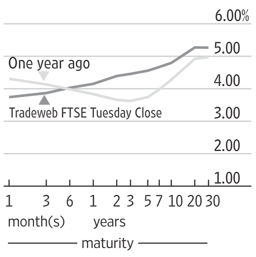
Interest rate	Yield/Rate (%) Last	Week ago	52-Week Range (%) Low	High	3-yr chg (pct pts)
Federal-funds rate target	3.50-3.75	3.50-3.75	3.50	4.50	-1.75
Prime rate*	6.75	6.75	6.75	7.50	-1.75
SOFR	3.68	3.65	3.50	4.51	-1.63
Money market, annual yield	0.44	0.44	0.41	0.45	-0.13
Five-year CD, annual yield	1.74	1.74	1.67	1.74	-1.09
30-year mortgage, fixed†	6.71	6.70	6.11	6.77	-0.96
15-year mortgage, fixed†	6.15	6.16	5.55	6.18	-0.71
Jumbo mortgages, $832,750-plus†	6.75	6.78	6.34	6.87	-0.98
Five-year adj mortgage (ARM)†	6.10	5.98	5.66	6.15	-0.47
New-car loan, 48-month	6.98	6.98	6.85	7.19	-0.37

Bankrate.com rates based on survey of over 1,500 online banks. *Base rate posted by 70% of the nation's largest banks.† Excludes closing costs.

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data; Bankrate.com

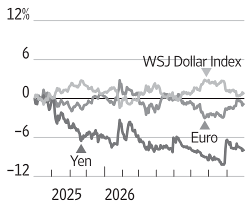
Treasury yield curve

Yield to maturity of current bills, notes and bonds



Forex Race

Yen, euro vs. dollar; dollar vs. major U.S. trading partners



Sources: Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close; Tullett Prebon; Dow Jones Market Data

Corporate Borrowing Rates and Yields

Bond total return index	Close	Yield (%) Last	Week ago	52-Week High	Low	Total Return (%) 52-wk	3-yr
U.S. Treasury, Bloomberg	2316.410	4.670	4.470	4.670	3.750	0.988	3.268
U.S. Treasury Long, Bloomberg	3109.640	5.260	5.150	5.300	4.520	−0.229	0.471
Aggregate, Bloomberg	2235.360	5.070	4.870	5.070	4.160	1.616	4.152
Fixed-Rate MBS, Bloomberg	2243.210	5.350	5.130	5.350	4.380	2.705	4.653
High Yield 100, ICE BofA	4206.972	6.551	6.225	7.136	5.828	4.042	7.958
Muni Master, ICE BofA	614.978	3.828	3.628	3.828	3.037	3.344	2.924
EMBI Global, J.P. Morgan	n.a.	n.a.	6.680	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.	n.a.

Sources: J.P. Morgan; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; ICE Data Services

NEW HIGHS AND LOWS

WSJ.com/newhighs

The following explanations apply to the New York Stock Exchange, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market stocks that hit a new 52-week intraday high or low in the latest session. % CHG-Daily percentage change from the previous trading session.

Tuesday, September 1, 2026

Highs

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
AeonAcqnI	AESPU	10.57	-0.4
AldelFinII A	ALDF	10.80	0.1
AlgonquinPwr2079	AQNB	26.37	-0.5
Andersen	ANDG	57.17	...
ApogeeTherap	APGE	135.09	...
BRC Nts 2028	RILYZ	20.81	0.7
BitMinelmPfdA	BMNP	99.20	-0.1
Calumet	CLMT	51.57	3.6
CanadianNatRscs	CNQ	52.02	3.5
ChefsWarehouse	CHEF	117.65	2.7
ChenierеEnerPtrs	CQP	70.96	...
CompX Intl	CIX	34.65	3.7
ConnectOnePfdA	CNOBP	25.51	0.4
ConocoPhillips	COP	136.30	2.8
DHI Group	DHX	4.53	4.2
Deere	DE	677.89	3.2
DelekUS	DK	77.40	-1.3
DivrsHlthcrNts42	DHCNI	18.60	0.2
EastWestAveAcqn	EWAV	9.90	-0.1
EnergyTransfer	ET	21.77	-0.4
Equinor	EQNR	44.33	3.3
Freenome	FRNM	15.48	3.1
GlobaTerraA	GTERA	10.42	0.1
HF Sinclair	DINO	103.99	2.3
HarmonyBio	HRMY	41.49	4.7
Helm&Payne	HP	46.53	6.0
HimalayaShipping	HSHP	17.09	1.6
JABAcqnI	ATLQU	10.19	0.4
MEvoGlblAcqnII	MEVO	10.04	-0.2
MarathonPetrol	MPC	383.01	2.6
MiniMed	MMED	22.74	10.7
MotorolaSol	MSI	494.85	1.2
NGL Energy	NGL	19.06	-3.4
NOV	NOV	21.74	0.3
ONEOK	OKE	99.85	-0.3
OTGAcqnI	OTGA	10.24	...
OkeanisEcoTankers	ECO	68.51	1.8
Organon	OGN	13.79	...
OriginInvtI	ORIQ	10.40	0.1
OysterEntII	OYSE	10.40	0.3
PBF Energy	PBF	76.16	2.7
PalomaAcqnI	PALO	9.99	0.1
PaycomSoftware	PAYC	243.28	-0.5
Pfizer	PFE	29.09	0.3
Phillips66	PSX	252.05	2.2
PlainsAllAmPipe	PAA	25.89	0.8
PlainsGP	PAGP	28.70	0.9
PPlus GSC-2	PYT	24.93	1.2
ProemAcqnIWt	PAACW	0.50	55.6
PulseBiosciences	PLSE	54.39	3.5
PumaBiotech	PBYI	9.59	2.6
PyxisTankers	PXS	6.44	16.2
RedViolet	RDVT	76.18	3.3
RenovoRx	RNXT	2.20	9.3
RingCentral	RNG	70.78	1.7
RiverCityBank	RCBC	51.89	0.4
RoyaltyPharma	RPRX	62.58	1.5
SCIIAcqnA	SCII	10.14	0.1
SUMAAcqn	SUMA	9.97	0.3
SafeBulkers	SB	8.87	1.4
SenecaFoods A	SENEA	204.48	2.9
ShinhanFin	SHG	81.12	1.0
Solventum	SOLV	94.16	-0.1
SouthBow	SOBO	39.02	0.1
StandardNuclear	STDN	17.34	2.8
StarBulkCarriers	SBLK	31.37	0.6
SunocoCorp	SUNC	78.85	1.2
TJGC	TJGC	10.61	-0.6
TXO Partners	TXO	15.19	4.9
Tidewater	TDW	98.66	3.2
TribecaStratAcqn	BID	10.02	...
trivago	TRVG	6.20	2.3
UltraparPart	UGP	6.99	3.2
UnitedMaritime	USEA	2.93	2.2
ValeroEnergy	VLO	364.90	0.9
[illegible]	VALCU	12.47	12.6
VikingAcqnI	VACI	12.74	2.4
VirBiotech	VIR	11.74	6.3
WestEnclave	WENC	10.01	0.1
ZetaGlobal	ZETA	32.05	1.9

Lows

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
AcresCmclRlty	ACR	13.68	...
AIAI	AIAI	3.35	-6.7
AT&T Nts 2066	TBB	19.26	-0.4
AT&T PfdA	TpA	17.52	-0.2
AT&T PfdC	TpC	16.71	-0.5
ATS	ATS	18.42	-4.0
AddexTherap	ADXN	3.63	-6.9
Advasa	ADBT	3.61	-18.9
AerSale	ASLE	5.41	-0.7
AethlonMedical	AEMD	1.81	-10.7
AffiliatedMgrDeb	MGR	19.24	-0.5
AirWaterVent	WATR	1.74	-2.7
AIRWA	YYAI	0.76	-3.2
AlarumTech	ALAR	1.51	-6.1
AllstatePfdI	ALLpI	17.31	0.5
AllstatePfdH	ALLpH	18.52	-0.2
AlphaModusA	AMOD	2.11	13.1
AlphaModusWt	AMODW	0.02	15.8
Amaze	AMZE	0.15	-6.8
Amentum	AMTM	19.80	...
AmerFinDeb2059	AFGC	17.55	-0.8
AmFinDeb	AFGE	15.65	-0.9
AmHomes4RentPfdG	AMHpG	21.85	-1.3
AmHomes4RentPfdH	AMHpH	23.07	-1.1
Amrize	AMRZ	42.72	-2.0
ApolloGlbNts53	APOS	25.02	...
AppliedAerospace	AAPC	12.54	-4.9
ArborRealtyPfdE	ABRpE	15.32	...
ArchCapitalPfdG	ACGLN	15.43	-0.8
ArrayTech	ARRY	4.31	-1.4
AscentagePharma	AAPG	16.23	-5.1
AssdBancPfdE	ASBpE	19.52	-0.1
AssdBancPfdF	ASBpF	18.61	0.1
AssurantNts2061	AIZN	18.16	-0.8
AuroraInnovWt	AUROW	0.06	-14.6
BankofAmNt66	MERpK	24.68	-1.4
BankofAmPfdGG	BACpB	23.75	-0.8
BankofAmPfdKK	BACpM	20.30	-1.6
BankofAmPfdLL	BACpN	18.95	-0.7
BaoshengMedia	BAOS	0.30	-11.4
Beneficient	BENF	1.95	-6.3
BeyondAir	XAIR	3.60	-7.8
BigBearaiWt	BBAI.WS	0.05	-21.3
Bilibili	BILI	15.78	-2.3
BioXcelTherap	BTAI	0.12	-15.8
Birchtech	BCHT	1.15	-1.7
BitOrigin	BTOG	2.43	-6.9
BlackTitan	BTTC	0.40	-2.8
BluejayDiag	BJDX	0.82	-2.6
BoneBiologics	BBLG	0.55	-2.4
BoydGaming	BYD	76.24	-1.5
BoydGroupServices	BGSI	82.45	-4.8
BraggGaming	BRAG	1.30	-5.1
BridgerAerospace	BAER	1.07	...
BrightSpire	BRSP	4.63	-2.3
BrookfieldBus	BBUC	26.93	-1.4
BrookfieldOakPfdB	OAKpB	19.96	-0.1
BrookfieldRenew	BEPC	31.21	-1.6
BrookWealth	BNT	39.59	-3.8
BuildersFirst	BLDR	62.31	-5.4
BullfrogAIWt	BFRGW	0.08	-33.2
CDT Equity	CDT	1.40	-11.9
CMSEnerDeb78	CMSA	19.68	-1.5
CMSEnerNts2078	CMSC	20.99	-1.5
CMSEnerNts2079	CMSD	20.75	-1.8
CMSEngyPfdC	CMSpC	15.88	-1.3
CRH	CRH	91.01	-3.5
C3is	CISS	1.56	-8.2
CadrenalTherap	CVKD	1.42	-13.7
CalciMedica	CALC	2.00	-6.5
CapitalOnePfdK	COFpK	16.00	-0.6
CapitalOnePfdL	COFpL	15.10	...
Capri	CPRI	12.76	-3.5
Carnival	CCL	23.08	-2.8
CarriageSvcs	CSV	33.09	-1.6
CellyanBiotech	HKPD	0.15	-65.9
Centerspace	CSR	52.13	-0.2
Cerenome	CNSY	2.62	-3.9
SchwabPfdD	SCHWpD	23.10	-0.3
SchwabPfdJ	SCHWpJ	16.50	-1.9
CheetahNetSupply	CTNT	1.24	-13.0
ChimeraInvt	CIM	11.30	-1.4
ChinaSXTPharm	SXTC	2.37	-3.9
CirrusLogic	CRUS	106.26	-0.4
CitizensFinlPfdE	CFGpE	24.56	...
ClarosMtg	CMTG	1.44	-7.5
CogentComm	CCOI	8.88	-5.6
CollegiumPharm	COLL	23.93	-2.5
ColumbusCircleII	CCCM	9.93	-0.2
ComtechTel	CMTL	1.95	...
ConexusSciences	CNXU	5.86	-18.2
ContextTherap	CNTX	0.36	-6.5
Cooper-Standard	CPS	25.05	-5.7
Core&Main	CNM	41.87	-2.1
CorebridgeFinNts	CRBD	20.83	-1.4
Csquare	CSQR	18.02	-5.5
Cullen/FrostPfdB	CFRpB	16.32	-2.1
CXApp	CXAI	3.44	-3.6
Cyngn	CYN	0.99	-5.3
DDC Enterprise	DDC	0.32	-9.2
DLH Holdings	DLHC	4.30	-0.8
DTE EnergyDeb80	DTB	15.60	-0.9
DTE EnergyDeb78	DTK	22.13	-1.3
DarkIris	DKI	3.13	-7.9
Dave&Buster's	PLAY	8.36	-5.8
DeepFission	FISN	6.10	-4.8
DigitalBrands	DBGI	4.50	-23.7
DigitalRealtyPfdL	DLRpL	19.07	-1.9
DimeCmclPfdA	DCOMp	17.14	-0.5
DirectDigital	DRCT	1.95	-13.7
DragonflyEnergy	DFLI	1.01	-6.4
DukeEnerDeb78	DUKB	21.80	-0.7
DukeEnergyPfdA	DUKpA	23.68	-0.4
DyadicIntl	DYAI	0.51	-4.1
ESAB	ESAB	73.78	-1.8
ESSTech	GWH	0.33	-2.8
EVI Industries	EVI	13.35	-4.1
EHang	EH	4.35	-1.7
eHealth	EHTH	0.94	-16.4
ElicioTherap	ELTX	2.55	-5.2
ElongPower	ELPW	3.21	-9.9
EmpireStateRealES	ESBA	4.29	-7.2
EmpireStateRealty	ESRT	4.36	-3.1
EnergyBds66	EAI	19.50	-0.1
EnergyLA Bds66	ELC	19.20	-0.9
EnSysEnergy	EOSE	3.01	-5.6
EVgo	EVGO	2.45	-2.0
Evotec	EVO	1.80	-4.3
ExascaleLabs	XLAB	3.90	-4.1
FaradayFuture	FFAI	2.10	-6.6
FedRealtyInvPfdC	FRTpC	18.91	-1.5
FedExFreight	FDXF	126.53	-4.6
FinVolution	FINV	3.22	-9.5
FlagstarFinBONUSES	FLGpU	37.51	-1.6
FlowersFoods	FLO	6.62	-3.3
ForemostCleanEner	FMST	1.01	-9.3
FreightTech	FRGT	1.30	-0.7
FreightCarAmer	RAIL	6.57	-2.9
Fusemachines	FUSE	0.64	-7.6
GMEXRobotics	GMEX	0.83	-11.1
GBankFinl	GBFH	19.25	-0.2
GRI Bio	GRI	0.00	-30.7
Genprex	GNPX	3.46	-4.3
GettyImages	GETY	0.23	-1.2
GlobeLifeDeb2061	GLpD	14.75	-1.0
GlucoTrack	GCTK	3.68	-13.2
Gogo	GOGO	2.46	1.2
GoldmanSachsPfD	GSpD	18.53	-0.7
GrabAgain	GRAN	2.22	-3.0
GranitePointMtg	GPMT	1.01	-4.7
GAP	PAC	201.43	-1.7
Asure	ASUR	249.58	-2.5
Huhutech	HUHU	4.06	-0.1
HartfordPfdG	HIGpG	24.00	-1.0
HealthcrTriangle	HCTI	0.80	-1.9
HotchkisGlbVal	HWGV	24.86	-0.5
HouseofDoge	HODO	0.22	-4.3
Hyperfine	HYPR	0.81	-1.6
HyperscaleData	GPUS	0.23	-14.6
INNIO	INNIO	19.04	-3.6
ITTechPkg	ITP	0.15	-10.0
InnovizTech	INVZ	0.32	-2.9
Innventure	INV	1.16	-7.8
Inogen	INGN	5.37	-6.7
InspiredEnt	INSE	5.32	-6.5
Intellicheck	IDN	2.68	-1.6
Inuvo	INUV	0.66	-4.7
iPower	IPW	1.77	-7.7
JaguarHealth	JAGX	0.72	-7.6
JerseyMike's	JMKE	20.38	-4.8
JianzhiEduc	JZ	1.08	-9.4
Jiayin	JFIN	1.06	-6.5
JinkoSolar	JKS	12.27	-1.0
JobyAviation	JOBY	6.61	-2.2
JPMorganPfdDD	JPMpD	22.77	-0.5
JPMChasePfdEE	JPMpC	24.36	-0.7
KALA BIO	KALA	[illegible]	[illegible]
KWaveMedia	KWM	1.20	-8.8
KairosPharma	KAPA	1.52	-1.8
Karman	KRMN	40.30	-0.9
KarmanLineWt	XTERW	0.22	0.2
KestrelGr6.625-46	MHLA	10.05	1.1
Knightscope	KSCP	1.33	-2.9
KodiakAI	KDK	3.49	-7.4
Koss	KOSS	3.37	-0.6
KustomEnt	KUST	0.76	-4.4
LaRosa	LRHC	0.43	-8.3
LasVegasSands	LVS	43.36	0.1
LendingTree	TREE	27.07	-2.4
Lennox	LII	376.42	-1.5
Leslie's	LESL	0.50	-2.4
LexinFintech	LX	0.87	-17.6
LiftoffMobile	LFTO	17.90	0.8
LiminatusPharma	LIMN	3.42	-5.6
LionGroup	LGHL	0.44	-6.7
LiveOne	LVO	3.51	-5.7
LoopIndustries	LOOP	0.46	3.1
Lowe's	LOW	199.39	-2.3
LucasGC	LGCL	3.51	-0.9
M&T Bank Pfd K	MTBpK	23.61	-0.6
MBIA	MBI	4.64	-3.3
MFA Financial	MFA	8.63	-1.6
MartinMarietta	MLM	502.56	-2.5
Masonglory	MSGY	1.78	-4.2
MatthewsIntl	MATW	20.21	-1.9
MedicalProp	MPT	3.89	1.5
MegaMatrix	MPU	0.17	-14.9
MelcoResorts	MLCO	4.99	-0.2
Merlin	MRLN	2.76	-7.3
MesaRoyalty	MTR	2.17	-3.6
Metagenomi	MGX	1.13	-0.8
MetaphaTechnology	MATH	0.73	3.6
MetLifePfdE	METpE	20.87	-0.1
MetLifePfdF	METpF	17.46	-0.6
MicroCloudWt	HOLOW	0.04	-8.6
Microvast	MVST	0.68	-3.9
Mint	MIMI	0.65	-13.8
MorganStanleyPfdA	MSpA	18.63	0.1
MorganStanleyPfdK	MSpK	22.12	-1.0
MySize	MYSZ	2.10	-6.3
NFT	MI	2.26	-7.3
NIO	NIO	3.99	-4.0
NRG Energy	NRG	108.34	-0.6
NatlRurUtilNt2064	NRUC	20.72	-1.3
NeighborhoodIntel	NXH	3.52	-6.1
NetClassTechnology	NTCL	1.83	-17.2
NextEraDebZ	NEEpW	22.43	-1.5
Nike	NKE	37.97	-1.4
OBOOK	OWLS	5.01	-6.7
OIO Wt	OIOWW	0.03	-8.8
Olin	OLN	16.99	-1.6
OnHolding	ONON	27.71	-2.7
OpendoorTech	OPEN	3.03	-5.0
OspreyAcqnII	OSPRU	9.98	...
PG&E	PCG	13.05	6.0
PG&E PfdA	PCGpA	33.52	4.0
PMGC	ELAB	5.03	-3.1
PacGE pfG	PCGpG	16.34	-3.6
PapaJohn's	PZZA	22.65	-3.3
PatrickIndustries	PATK	80.76	-0.5
PennyMacFin	PFSI	70.67	-3.2
Peraso	PRSO	0.56	-6.6
PowellMax	PMAX	0.93	-10.2
PowerBank	PBK	0.40	-4.9
PrairieOperating	PROP	0.50	-0.5
PrudentialNt58	PRS	20.14	-1.3
PrudentialNts2062	PRH	21.11	-2.3
PublicStoragePfI	PSApI	17.85	-1.5
PublicStoragePfJ	PSApJ	17.31	-1.4
PublicStoragePfK	PSApK	17.58	0.2
PublicStoragePfdN	PSApN	14.35	-1.8
PublicStoragePfdO	PSApO	14.35	-0.8
PublicStoragePfQ	PSApQ	14.52	-0.1
PublicStoragePfP	PSApP	14.65	-0.7
PublicStoragePfdS	PSApS	15.16	-1.4
PublicStoragePfR	PSApR	14.70	-1.1
Pulsenmore	PLSM	2.50	-2.3
PurpleInnovation	PRPL	3.73	-6.5
Q/C Techs	QCLS	2.09	-9.9
QXO	QXO	12.82	-3.0
QXO Pfd B	QXOpB	39.70	-1.8
Qfin	QFIN	8.36	-3.2
RLX Tech	RLX	1.74	-2.2
RapidMicro	RPID	1.47	-1.3
ReconTech	RCON	1.40	-3.9
RedwoodTrNts20	RWTQ	22.68	-2.1
RedwoodNts31	RWTS	22.96	-1.5
RekorSystems	REKR	0.52	-6.6
RenaissancePfdF	RNRpF	19.85	-1.1
RocketPharmWt	RCKTW	0.00	-75.0
SHF	SHFS	0.15	-4.4
SU Group	SUGP	0.63	-13.1
SamosEnergyA	SAMO	9.79	-0.2
SelectiveInsPfdB	SIGIP	15.29	-1.0
SempraNts79	SREA	19.91	-1.2
SeritageGrowth	SRG	2.02	-2.9
ShoeStation	SHOE	12.78	-6.3
SilverBoxIVWt	SBXD.WS	0.08	-24.6
SkyeBioscience	SKYE	1.64	7.1
SmartKem	SMTK	2.70	-8.1
SolidPowerWt	SLDPW	0.02	-5.5
Soluna	SLNH	2.19	-0.9
SoulpowerAcqnRt	SOULR	0.11	-3.1
SoundHoundAI Wt	SOUNW	1.22	-7.7
SouthernNts2080	SOJD	18.05	-0.8
SouthernNts2020C	SOJE	15.61	-1.2
SouthernUn	SOMN	47.24	-1.3
StablecoinDevt	SDEV	0.85	-9.0
StandardPower	SDST	0.34	-5.4
StarfightersSpace	FJET	2.93	-10.5
StarwoodProp	STWD	15.49	-1.1
StateStreetPfdG	STTpG	20.23	...
Sunrun	RUN	8.22	-2.3
Sylvamo	SLVM	34.25	-3.9
Symbotic	SYM	37.68	-3.7
TJX	TJX	133.04	-0.5
TMCtheMtlsWt	TMCWW	0.01	17.9
T-MobileUS2070	TMUSI	19.43	-1.3
Toyo	TOYO	4.12	-0.7
TPG Nts 2064	TPGXL	21.54	-2.4
TTEC	TTEC	1.31	...
TalenEnergy	TLN	288.58	-0.7
ThredUp	TDUP	2.51	-6.3
Thryv	THRY	1.78	-5.8
TopWealth	TWG	0.43	-6.5
Toppoint	TOPP	0.16	-4.3
TribecaStratRt	BIDWR	0.10	-21.8
TruGolf	TRUG	0.42	-6.2
TruistFinPfdI	TFCpI	17.52	-0.1
TruistFinPfdO	TFCpO	19.16	-0.4
TruistFinlPfdR	TFCpR	17.30	-1.0
TryHard	THH	1.34	-17.8
TScanTherap	TCRX	0.66	-8.7
22ndCentury	XXII	2.51	-18.4
US BancorpPfdO	USBpS	16.77	-0.8
UYSCutiAcqnRt	UYSCR	0.08	-14.3
UnivTechInst	UTI	29.71	-0.5
VCIGlobal	VCIG	1.83	-9.7
VF	VFC	13.00	-2.6
VICI Prop	VICI	25.46	-0.4
VNET	VNET	5.91	2.6
VeravaBiotech	VRXA	1.27	3.7
VerticalAerospace	EVTL	0.60	-11.5
VisionWave	VWAV	0.61	-26.1
VisionWaveWt	VWAVW	0.07	-25.8
Vivakor	VIVK	0.67	0.5
VivosTherap	VVOS	0.16	-14.0
WaveLifeSci	WVE	4.80	1.4
Weibo	WB	6.79	-0.4
WellsFargoPfdAZ	WFCpZ	17.62	-1.0
WellsFargoPfdAA	WFCpA	17.29	-1.1
WellsFargoPfdCC	WFCpC	16.15	-1.2
WellsFargoPfdDD	WFCpD	15.83	-1.2
WellsFargoPfdL	WFCpL	1131.25	...
WheelerREIT	WHLR	0.55	-14.8
WheelsUp	UP	4.19	-1.8
WhirlpoolPfdA	WHRpA	32.69	-4.6
WhiteHorseNts2028	WHFCL	24.97	0.3
Winmark	WINA	317.83	-2.0
WynnResorts	WYNN	89.44	-0.7
XTI Aerospace	XTIA	1.14	-14.8
Yimutian	YMT	2.31	-11.7
YorkSpace	YSS	8.61	-3.0
YouxinTechnology	YAAS	1.73	-4.1
ZSquared	ZSQR	2.83	-1.4
Zenta	ZTG	0.70	-16.0
ZeoEnergy	ZEO	0.19	-11.4
ZetaNetwork	ZNB	1.55	-7.7
ZionsBncpPfdA	ZIONP	17.71	-0.7

Biggest 1,000 Stocks | WSJ.com/stocks

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Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
Enbridge	ENB	50.72	0.15
EncompassHealth	EHC	122.05	1.84
▲ EnergyTransfer	ET	21.42	-0.09
EnlightRenewableEn	ENLT	74.93	-3.21
EnsignGroup	ENSG	173.20	0.94
Entegris	ENTG	129.51	-5.78
Entergy	ETR	107.02	0.71
EnterpriseProd	EPD	39.28	0.46
Equifax	EFX	186.20	-2.96
Equinix	EQIX	1027.59	-19.13
▲ Equinor	EQNR	44.23	1.43
EquinoxGold	**EQX**	**12.18**	**-0.68**
Equitable	EQH	49.36	-0.77
EquityLife	ELS	63.16	-0.29
ErieIndemnity	ERIE	256.09	0.53
EssentialUtil	WTRG	41.11	-0.06
EssexProp	ESS	279.00	-3.96
EsteeLauder	EL	100.00	-2.30
EvercoreA	EVR	286.23	-0.20
Everest	EG	378.61	3.96
Evergy	EVRG	81.52	0.50
Everpure	P	93.78	0.83
EversourceEner	ES	70.50	0.36
Exelixis	EXEL	56.89	2.25
Exelon	EXC	43.83	0.11
ExpandEnergy	EXE	99.98	1.82
Expedia	EXPE	304.23	-12.89
ExpeditorsIntl	EXPD	187.70	-1.95
ExtraSpaceSt	EXR	140.12	-0.98
ExxonMobil	XOM	164.55	3.60
F5	FFIV	395.72	-11.41
FTAI Aviation	FTAI	189.29	-0.81
Fabrinet	FN	402.07	-10.86
FactSet	FDS	305.44	-8.11
Fastenal	FAST	48.75	-0.56
FederalRealty	FRT	117.03	1.00
FedEx	FDX	324.88	-2.52
▼ FedExFreight	FDXF	127.57	-6.17
FergusonEnts	FERG	218.91	-5.60
Ferrari	RACE	410.21	-12.39
Ferrovial	FER	57.70	-0.85
FidNatlFinl	FNF	46.04	-0.41
FidNatlInfo	FIS	40.83	-0.06
FifthThirdBncp	FITB	53.01	-0.76
Figma	FIG	27.20	-0.29
FirstCitizBcshA	FCNCA	2141.16	-23.24
FirstHorizon	FHN	24.03	-0.29
FirstMajSilver	AG	19.86	-0.73
FirstSolar	FSLR	199.65	-2.25
FirstCash	FCFS	215.56	1.09
FirstEnergy	FE	46.16	0.30
Fiserv	FISV	51.67	-1.64
FiveBelow	FIVE	245.08	-1.76
Flex	FLEX	106.86	-2.39
Flowserve	FLS	76.64	-2.45
FlutterEnt	FLUT	97.00	-3.18
FEMSA	FMX	119.96	-0.45
FordMotor	F	13.84	-0.10
Fortinet	**FTNT**	**161.85**	**-9.08**
Fortis	FTS	55.04	-0.14
Fortive	FTV	56.80	-2.04
FoxA	FOXA	65.93	-1.42
FoxB	FOX	59.03	-1.19
Franco-Nevada	FNV	255.42	-7.73
FranklinTemp	BEN	33.10	-1.05
FreedomHolding	FRHC	171.87	-3.14
FreeportMcM	FCX	72.47	-3.27
FreseniusMedCare	FMS	22.74	...
Frontline	FRO	44.32	0.54
Futu	FUTU	119.28	-2.86
G H I			
GE Aerospace	GE	331.09	-4.62
GE HealthCare	GEHC	70.42	-0.81
GE Vernova	GEV	898.53	...
GFLEnvironmental	GFL	41.50	-0.79
GSK	GSK	50.66	0.41
GalaxyDigital	GLXY	23.43	-1.17
Gallagher	AJG	262.00	-0.35
Gaming&Leisure	GLPI	41.60	-1.64
Garmin	GRMN	275.17	-8.94
Gartner	IT	189.93	-8.18
GenDigital	GEN	30.02	-0.98
Generac	GNRC	181.42	-3.96
GeneralDynamics	GD	369.41	-1.94
GeneralMills	GIS	41.09	-0.11
GeneralMotors	GM	85.63	-0.69
Genmab	GMAB	33.29	0.13
GenuineParts	GPC	134.84	-0.83
Gildan	GIL	50.27	-1.86
GileadSciences	GILD	149.92	3.58
Glaukos	GKOS	176.76	2.78
GlobalPayments	GPN	90.06	-0.99
GlobalFoundries	GFS	43.93	-0.76
Globalstar	GSAT	81.37	-0.18
GlobeLife	GL	172.30	-0.37
GlobusMedical	GMED	80.48	-0.89
GoDaddy	GDDY	100.55	2.67
GoldFields	GFI	44.66	-1.71
GoldmanSachs	GS	1002.56	-18.34
Grab	GRAB	3.46	-0.08
Graco	GGG	76.83	-0.60
Grainger	GWW	1309.21	-0.28
▼ GAP	PAC	202.50	-3.54
GrupoCibest	CIB	96.25	0.13
GuardantHealth	GH	164.41	5.39
Guidewire	GWRE	201.09	-3.66
HCA Healthcare	HCA	413.58	-0.87
HDFC Bank	HDB	22.95	0.25
▲ HF Sinclair	DINO	103.97	2.36
HP	HPQ	31.32	1.30
HSBC	HSBC	103.40	0.26
H World	HTHT	46.97	-0.35
Haleon	HLN	10.07	0.04
Halliburton	HAL	36.80	-0.05
HalozymeTherap	HALO	107.72	1.23
HarmonyGold	HMY	19.23	-0.42
HartfordIns	HIG	137.13	0.35
Hasbro	HAS	93.20	-0.90
HealthpeakProp	DOC	20.82	...
HeclaMining	HL	19.11	-0.76
Heico	HEI	325.15	-6.00
HeicoA	HEI.A	242.00	-2.17
HenrySchein	HSIC	88.52	-1.28
Hershey	HSY	176.00	-0.21
HewlettPackard	HPE	50.87	-1.37
Hilton	HLT	311.99	-4.29
HomeDepot	HD	391.77	-8.06
HondaMotor	HMC	32.03	0.07
HoneywellAero	HONA	154.24	-3.87
Honeywell	HON	209.98	-3.55
HormelFoods	HRL	21.99	0.14
DR Horton	DHI	141.37	-3.19
HostHotels	HST	21.64	-0.29
HoulihanLokey	HLI	132.90	0.03
HowmetAerospace	HWM	254.89	9.94
Hubbell	HUBB	443.31	-9.69
HubSpot	HUBS	251.11	-10.25
HudbayMinerals	**HBM**	**27.02**	**-1.64**
Humana	HUM	394.88	11.65
JBHunt	JBHT	256.48	-3.99
HuntingtonBcshs	HBAN	16.42	-0.26
HuntingtonIngalls	HII	292.42	1.22
Hut8	HUT	77.57	-1.07
HyattHotels	H	162.55	-4.42
ICICI Bank	IBN	30.19	-0.17
IDEX	IEX	222.86	-5.78
IdexxLab	IDXX	545.16	-11.53
IES Holdings	IESC	300.59	-2.41
ING Group	ING	35.25	-0.07
▼ INNIO	INNIO	19.47	-0.73
Invesco	IVZ	31.99	-0.79
IQVIA	IQV	258.35	-2.84
IREN	IREN	36.82	-0.30
ITT	ITT	194.26	-6.03
IamGold	**IAG**	**19.29**	**-1.16**
IcahnEnterprises	IEP	6.81	0.01
Icon	ICLR	161.40	-3.59
IllinoisToolWks	ITW	269.88	-5.49
Illumina	ILMN	207.13	-6.50
ImperialOil	IMO	134.94	3.60
Incyte	INCY	125.01	1.79
Infosys	INFY	12.00	-0.06
IngersollRand	IR	74.64	-2.41
Insmed	INSM	121.51	-0.31
Insulet	PODD	148.38	-0.28
Intel	INTC	88.97	-0.54
InteractiveBrkrs	**IBKR**	**90.39**	**-6.81**
ICE	ICE	159.60	-1.10
InterContHtls	IHG	155.27	-4.79
IBM	IBM	231.40	-2.47
IntlFlavors	IFF	85.78	-0.55
IntlPaper	IP	36.46	-1.47
Intuit	INTU	344.93	-14.37
IntuitiveSurgical	ISRG	369.25	-7.61
InvitatHomes	INVH	29.13	-0.01
IonisPharm	IONS	59.88	-0.48
IonQ	IONQ	37.78	-1.53
IronMountain	IRM	114.22	-1.13
ItauUnibanco	ITUB	7.68	0.07
J K L			
JBS	JBS	13.41	-0.03
JD.com	JD	27.90	-0.34
JPMorganChase	JPM	354.95	-1.07
Jabil	JBL	299.14	-6.12
JackHenry	JKHY	168.10	0.19
JacobsSolns	J	146.33	-2.72
JamesHardie	JHX	28.57	-1.14
JazzPharm	JAZZ	243.71	-6.97
JefferiesFinl	JEF	51.98	-0.66
JFrog	**FROG**	**91.78**	**-8.29**
J&J	JNJ	271.19	5.34
JohnsonControls	JCI	139.25	1.01
JonesLang	JLL	354.67	-11.20
KB Financial	KB	127.64	-0.15
KE Holdings	BEKE	17.46	-0.25
KKR	KKR	106.41	-3.31
KLA	KLAC	170.89	-4.56
KT	KT	19.67	-0.01
Kaspi.kz	KSPI	104.08	-1.06
Kenvue	KVUE	18.75	-0.13
KeurigDrPepper	KDP	16.51	0.02
KeyCorp	KEY	21.21	-0.20
KeysightTech	KEYS	319.27	-3.43
KimberlyClark	KMB	107.08	-0.87
KimcoRealty	KIM	24.12	0.41
KinderMorgan	KMI	32.10	-0.14
KinrossGold	KGC	29.43	-1.25
Knight-Swift	KNX	66.73	-1.76
Philips	PHG	26.39	0.22
KoreaElecPwr	KEP	11.66	0.06
KraftHeinz	KHC	25.87	0.20
KratosDefense	KTOS	49.34	-1.64
Kroger	KR	57.94	0.40
KrystalBiotech	KRYS	363.84	4.48
KymeraTherap	KYMR	119.05	0.24
LatamAirlines	LTM	49.29	-0.48
LPL Financial	LPLA	357.63	-12.51
L3HarrisTech	LHX	263.56	-2.69
Labcorp	LH	327.61	-5.05
LamResearch	LRCX	290.20	-11.29
LamarAdv	LAMR	151.08	2.07
▼ LasVegasSands	LVS	43.34	0.03
LatticeSemi	LSCC	111.68	-3.66
Leidos	LDOS	139.18	-1.03
Lennar A	LEN	82.75	-1.36
Lennar B	LEN.B	81.40	-0.86
▼ LennoxIntl	LII	377.25	-5.39
LeonardoDRS	DRS	37.70	-0.30
LiAuto	LI	11.90	-0.20
LibertyLiveA	LLYVA	97.38	-2.10
LibertyLiveC	LLYVK	101.19	-2.10
LibertyFormOne C	FWONK	86.95	-3.00
LibertyFormOne A	FWONA	89.69	-2.37
LifeTime	LTH	41.83	-0.19
EliLilly	LLY	1160.00	3.27
LincolnElectric	LECO	268.68	-12.55
Linde	LIN	486.76	-2.82
Littelfuse	LFUS	408.91	-3.27
LiveNationEnt	LYV	177.20	-2.69
LloydsBanking	LYG	5.91	0.04
LockheedMartin	LMT	544.50	-13.28
Loews	L	108.71	0.42
LogitechIntl	LOGI	98.07	-0.62
▼ Lowe's	LOW	200.05	-4.65
lululemon	LULU	118.00	-2.26
Lumentum	**LITE**	**868.95**	**-45.81**
LyondellBasell	LYB	65.17	0.09
M N			
Macom Tech	MTSI	262.01	-1.82
M&T Bank	MTB	232.02	-0.42
MGM Resorts	MGM	40.77	-0.59
MKS	MKSI	246.44	-9.80
MPLX	MPLX	59.09	-0.08
MP Materials	MP	53.74	-1.01
MSCI	MSCI	563.09	-7.55
MadisonAirSolns	MAIR	25.75	-0.65
MadrigalPharm	MDGL	538.71	-1.32
MagnaIntl	MGA	63.63	-1.94
MagnumIceCrm	MICC	19.73	-0.69
ManhattanAssoc	MANH	216.21	-6.98
ManulifeFinl	MFC	42.14	-0.27
Maplebear	CART	50.05	-0.47
▲ MarathonPetrol	MPC	383.00	9.68
Markel	MKL	1797.28	-5.63
Marriott	MAR	334.55	-7.21
Marsh	MRSH	187.58	-2.22
▼ MartinMarietta	MLM	504.92	-12.94
MarvellTech	MRVL	210.39	-1.27
Masco	MAS	70.25	-1.91
MasTec	MTZ	237.74	-2.04
Mastercard	MA	581.10	-8.21
MatchGroup	MTCH	41.91	1.26
McCormickVtg	MKCV	54.01	-0.19
McCormick	MKC	54.26	0.04
McDonald's	MCD	261.11	-0.57
McKesson	MCK	906.77	22.39
Medline	MDLN	35.11	0.08
Medpace	MEDP	583.21	-10.78
Medtronic	MDT	92.04	1.39
MercadoLibre	MELI	1963.49	27.29
Merck	MRK	149.86	2.10
MetaPlatforms	META	578.54	6.20
MetLife	MET	94.42	-0.75
Mettler-Toledo	MTD	1375.96	-29.18
MicrochipTech	MCHP	71.41	-2.04
MicronTech	MU	933.44	-25.29
Microsoft	MSFT	501.02	-6.27
MidAmApt	MAA	129.36	0.51
MillicomIntl	TIGO	92.60	-1.16
MitsubishiUFJ	MUFG	22.83	0.08
MizuhoFin	MFG	10.74	0.10
Moderna	**MRNA**	**154.27**	**13.93**
ModineMfg	MOD	180.91	2.48
MolinaHealthcare	MOH	203.06	4.29
Mondelez	MDLZ	61.61	-0.46
MongoDB	MDB	434.21	-19.16
MonolithicPower	MPWR	1225.96	-41.81
MonsterBev	MNST	44.99	-0.93
Moody's	MCO	494.71	-9.93
Moog B	MOG.B	373.40	-1.60
Moog A	MOG.A	365.03	-6.47
MorganStanley	MS	211.04	-2.28
▲ MotorolaSol	MSI	491.24	5.94
MuellerInd	MLI	140.43	-2.58
MurphyUSA	MUSA	536.45	21.06
NIO	NIO	4.06	-0.17
▼ NRG Energy	NRG	109.51	-0.61
NVR	NVR	6275.82	-39.41
NXP Semicon	NXPI	222.40	-2.24
Nasdaq	NDAQ	97.54	-1.07
Natera	NTRA	320.76	-1.20
NationalGrid	NGG	79.15	-0.01
NatWest	NWG	18.33	0.13
Nebius	NBIS	199.54	-6.78
NetApp	NTAP	183.16	-2.13
NetEase	NTES	120.07	-1.71
Netflix	NFLX	80.81	-0.24
Neurocrine	NBIX	156.76	2.73
NYTimes A	NYT	67.73	0.46
Newmont	NEM	122.63	-3.43
NewsCorp A	NWSA	30.63	-0.68
NewsCorp B	NWS	34.23	-0.44
NextEraEnergy	NEE	82.93	0.59
Nextpower	NXT	83.07	1.04
▼ Nike	NKE	38.12	-0.53
NiSource	NI	40.96	0.04
Nokia	NOK	9.93	-0.21
Nomura	NMR	10.17	-0.01
Nordson	NDSN	314.40	-7.32
NorfolkSouthern	NSC	332.96	-9.83
NorthernTrust	NTRS	182.68	-2.88
NorthropGrum	NOC	532.91	6.79
Nova	NVMI	337.64	-10.81
Novartis	**NVS**	**161.25**	**9.19**
NovoNordisk	NVO	45.12	-0.21
NuHoldings	NU	14.46	-0.09
Nucor	NUE	251.92	2.28
Nutanix	NTNX	66.69	-1.88
Nutrien	NTR	77.69	2.16
nVentElectric	NVT	147.30	-3.45
NVIDIA	NVDA	217.44	-3.34
O P Q			
OGE Energy	OGE	45.99	0.36
▲ ONEOK	OKE	95.69	-0.32
ON Semi	ON	72.65	-1.44
O'ReillyAuto	ORLY	87.95	-0.85
OccidentalPetrol	OXY	60.95	0.77
Okta	OKTA	166.43	-6.61
OldDomFreight	**ODFL**	**187.01**	**-12.95**
OldNatlBncp	ONB	25.18	-0.40
OldRepublic	ORI	41.72	-0.01
OmegaHealthcare	OHI	46.79	1.07
Omnicom	OMC	86.09	-1.44
▼ OnHolding	ONON	27.73	-0.77
OntoInnovation	ONTO	256.37	-10.84
Oracle	**ORCL**	**141.32**	**-7.80**
Orix	IX	39.16	0.19
Oshkosh	OSK	147.68	-6.43
OtisWorldwide	OTIS	70.60	-0.53
Ovintiv	OVV	66.58	0.93
OwensCorning	OC	133.68	-4.47
PDD	PDD	83.17	-0.83
▼ PG&E	PCG	14.06	0.79
PNC Finl	PNC	237.49	-2.14
POSCO	PKX	61.11	-0.24
PPG Ind	PPG	109.70	-2.47
PPL	PPL	34.47	0.34
PTC	PTC	152.81	-2.93
Paccar	PCAR	122.45	-1.68
PackagingCpAm	PKG	229.12	-4.82
PalantirTech	PLTR	179.92	-6.46
PaloAltoNtwks	**PANW**	**362.09**	**-20.04**
PanAmerSilver	PAAS	50.00	-1.92
ParamountSkydance	PSKY	10.55	-0.36
ParkerHannifin	PH	952.09	-27.35
Paychex	PAYX	125.64	-1.70
▲ PaycomSoftware	PAYC	237.95	-1.15
PayPal	PYPL	52.40	-0.27
PayPay	PAYP	14.99	-0.14
Pearson	PSO	16.50	-0.07
PembinaPipeline	PBA	49.03	0.33
PenskeAuto	PAG	216.92	0.33
Pentair	PNR	60.45	-0.01
Penumbra	PEN	322.58	-0.52
PepsiCo	PEP	139.79	-0.55
PerformanceFood	PFGC	99.20	0.03
PermianRscs	PR	23.79	0.50
PershingSquare	**PS**	**38.52**	**-4.40**
PetroleoBrasil	**PBR**	**20.33**	**0.98**
PetroleoBrasilA	PBR.A	18.20	0.80
▲ Pfizer	PFE	28.55	0.09
PhilipMorris	PM	187.15	-0.15
▲ Phillips66	PSX	252.02	5.44
PinnacleFinPtrs	PNFP	97.03	-2.94
PinnacleWest	PNW	97.66	0.02
Pinterest	PINS	21.25	-0.46
▲ PlainsAllAmPipe	PAA	25.86	0.21
▲ PlainsGP	PAGP	28.47	0.25
Popular	BPOP	167.23	-0.96
PraxisPrecision	PRAX	353.44	3.14
PrincipalFinl	PFG	109.36	-0.80
ProcoreTech	PCOR	60.36	-2.36
Procter&Gamble	PG	146.21	1.09
Progressive	PGR	220.54	2.46
Prologis	PLD	139.68	-0.24
ProtagonistTherap	PTGX	146.49	-1.26
PrudentialFinl	PRU	117.14	-0.46
Prudential	PUK	27.08	-0.19
PSEG	PEG	73.48	0.15
PublicStorage	PSA	302.86	-4.13
PulteGroup	PHM	123.13	-3.19
▼ QXO	QXO	12.88	-0.40
QnityElec	Q	115.49	-3.94
Qualcomm	QCOM	166.61	-3.87
QuantaServices	PWR	611.39	4.30
Quantinuum	QNT	47.66	-2.44
QuestDiag	DGX	236.22	-4.08
R S			
RBC Bearings	RBC	488.69	-5.57
RB Global	RBA	82.75	-1.83
RELX	RELX	35.70	-0.73
RPM	RPM	101.85	-2.25
RTX	RTX	205.16	-2.57
RalphLauren	RL	340.82	-6.08
Rambus	RMBS	84.40	-2.29
RangeResources	RRC	42.40	1.08
RaymondJames	RJF	173.50	-4.67
RealtyIncome	O	61.36	0.08
Reddit	RDDT	144.64	-3.17
RegalRexnord	RRX	157.01	-1.44
RegencyCtrs	REG	76.06	1.29
RegenPharm	REGN	823.82	24.74
RegionsFinl	RF	29.29	-0.29
ReinsGrp	RGA	247.72	1.68
Reliance	RS	390.11	6.06
RenaissanceRe	RNR	329.79	2.15
RentokilInit	RTO	24.30	0.51
Repligen	**RGEN**	**170.02**	**-10.96**
RepublicSvcs	RSG	223.29	2.37
ResMed	RMD	231.36	-8.74
RestaurantBrands	QSR	78.22	0.34
RevolutionMed	RVMD	209.87	4.30
Revvity	RVTY	126.59	-2.08
RioTinto	RIO	101.86	-0.64
Rivian	RIVN	15.54	-0.52
Robinhood	HOOD	103.51	-1.30
Roblox	RBLX	40.67	-0.62
RocketCos.	RKT	13.03	-0.38
RocketLab	RKLB	62.54	-1.38
Rockwell	ROK	417.53	-6.90
RogersComm B	RCI	36.41	-0.48
RoivantSciences	ROIV	34.52	-0.12
Roku	ROKU	155.53	-1.40
Rollins	ROL	36.19	0.12
RoperTech	ROP	418.31	-6.33
RossStores	ROST	229.24	0.70
RoyalBkCanada	RY	203.48	-0.67
RoyalCaribbean	RCL	265.70	-3.04
RoyalGold	RGLD	254.09	-7.38
▲ RoyaltyPharma	RPRX	62.32	0.91
Rubrik	RBRK	88.40	-4.64
RyanSpecialty	RYAN	42.32	0.14
Ryanair	RYAAY	53.82	-1.55
RyderSystem	R	243.48	-0.98
SAP	SAP	212.04	-8.85
S&P Global	SPGI	440.21	4.37
SBA Comm	SBAC	188.81	-0.85
SEI Investments	SEIC	109.54	-1.44
SK hynix	SKHY	160.78	-3.80
SK Telecom	SKM	37.76	-0.63
SLB	SLB	57.15	-2.95
SPX Tech	SPXC	192.13	-4.62
SS&C Tech	SSNC	81.91	-0.76
Saia	**SAIA**	**331.62**	**-23.51**
SailPoint	**SAIL**	**19.23**	**-1.33**
Salesforce	CRM	258.11	0.57
Samsara	IOT	39.06	-1.79
Sandisk	SNDK	1536.87	-29.83
Sanmina	SANM	187.30	-9.42
Sanofi	SNY	44.37	0.01
SchwabC	SCHW	108.28	-1.54
Sea	SE	112.65	-0.83
Seagate	STX	816.64	-11.74
Sempra	SRE	84.26	2.56
Semtech	SMTC	132.27	-0.69
ServiceIntl	SCI	81.43	-0.21
ServiceNow	NOW	142.90	-5.09
ServiceTitan	TTAN	95.45	-2.59
SharkNinja	**SN**	**174.92**	**-17.57**
Shell	SHEL	93.51	2.06
SherwinWilliams	SHW	329.95	-8.86
▲ ShinhanFin	SHG	79.94	0.77
Shopify	**SHOP**	**139.82**	**-7.55**
SimonProperty	SPG	211.87	-0.45
SiriusXM	SIRI	27.62	-0.55
SiTime	SITM	552.75	-12.67
Skyworks	SWKS	67.41	0.40
Smith&Nephew	SNN	28.97	0.21
Smucker	SJM	131.42	0.26
SmurfitWestrock	SW	45.43	-1.47
Snap	SNAP	5.35	-0.20
Snap-On	SNA	381.20	-5.11
Snowflake	SNOW	319.80	-11.63
SOQUIMICH	SQM	80.51	1.50
SoFiTech	SOFI	17.05	-0.83
SolsticeAdvMatls	SOLS	61.73	-1.66
▲ Solventum	SOLV	90.95	-0.11
Somnigroup	SGI	63.65	-1.10
Sony	SONY	24.81	0.25
Southern	SO	88.09	0.09
SoCopper	SCCO	201.61	-7.26
SouthStateBk	SSB	103.99	-0.90
SouthwestAir	LUV	37.68	-0.85
SpaceX	SPCX	142.23	-1.46
Spotify	SPOT	544.15	0.53
StanleyB&D	SWK	94.51	-1.86
Starbucks	SBUX	106.15	-0.10
StateStreet	STT	187.79	-3.59
SteelDynamics	STLD	234.09	1.47
Stellantis	STLA	5.35	-0.14
Steris	STE	229.65	-2.99
SterlingInfr	STRL	456.10	-13.97
StifelFinancial	SF	78.84	-1.60
STMicroelec	STM	49.40	-0.74
Strategy	**MSTR**	**124.88**	**-8.06**
Stryker	SYK	317.40	-6.40
SumitomoMits	SMFG	26.03	0.19
SummitTherap	SMMT	14.16	0.54
SunComms	SUI	121.44	0.02
SunLifeFinancial	SLF	77.99	-0.39
SunbeltRentals	**SUNB**	**67.07**	**-5.21**
SuncorEnergy	SU	68.99	2.17
Sunoco	SUN	76.99	0.95
SuperMicroComp	SMCI	36.71	-0.57
Suzano	SUZ	8.86	0.14
▼ Symbotic	SYM	38.22	-1.45
SynchronyFinl	SYF	76.62	-0.46
Synopsys	**SNPS**	**414.82**	**-24.77**
Sysco	SYY	82.11	1.03
T U V			
TC Energy	TRP	63.14	0.61
TD Synnex	SNX	251.39	-1.46
TE Connectivity	TEL	208.00	2.75
Telus	TU	9.65	-0.03
Ternium	TX	55.67	0.85
TFI Intl	TFII	127.83	-6.36
▼ TJX	TJX	133.27	-0.64
TKO	TKO	182.27	-0.34
T-MobileUS	TMUS	182.16	1.72
TPG	TPG	52.41	-1.71
T.RowePrice	TROW	108.98	-2.31
TTM Tech	TTMI	115.33	-3.59
TaiwanSemi	TSM	414.00	-1.32
Take-TwoSftwr	TTWO	216.68	-3.02
TakedaPharm	TAK	18.23	0.25
▼ TalenEnergy	TLN	293.73	-2.03
Tapestry	TPR	122.14	-1.25
TargaResources	TRGP	296.06	2.41
Target	TGT	163.75	2.87
TechnipFMC	FTI	78.31	0.16
TeckResourcesB	TECK	66.79	-1.33
TeledyneTech	TDY	610.51	-2.44
Ericsson	ERIC	10.06	-0.03
TelefonicaBras	VIV	11.59	0.05
TelekomIndns	TLK	14.74	0.16
TempusAI	TEM	62.27	-0.78
Tenaris	TS	56.60	0.73
TencentMusic	TME	8.29	0.02
TenetHealthcare	THC	265.84	-0.07
Teradyne	TER	335.46	-14.37
Tesla	TSLA	356.09	-11.86
TevaPharm	TEVA	36.19	0.14
TexasInstruments	TXN	253.34	-7.57
TexasPacLand	TPL	369.93	-3.81
TexasRoadhouse	TXRH	191.57	-3.28
Textron	TXT	79.71	-0.85
ThermoFisher	TMO	600.50	-16.60
ThomsonReuters	TRI	106.35	-0.97
3M	MMM	170.24	-1.59
Toast	TOST	33.59	-0.50
TollBros	TOL	140.21	-3.24
Toro	TTC	97.96	0.15
TorontoDomBk	TD	119.50	-1.41
TotalEnergies	TTE	90.35	2.04
TowerSemi	TSEM	199.06	-5.99
ToyotaMotor	TM	198.05	1.51
TractorSupply	TSCO	34.71	-0.19
Tradeweb	TW	106.71	-0.85
TraneTech	TT	440.15	-4.25
TransDigm	TDG	1155.76	-15.98
TransUnion	TRU	83.67	-1.24
Travelers	TRV	363.92	-2.01
Trimble	TRMB	58.94	-1.00
Trip.com	TCOM	43.84	-0.81
TruistFinl	TFC	49.44	-0.14
Twilio	TWLO	228.65	-6.98
TylerTech	TYL	376.43	4.21
TysonFoods	TSN	55.06	0.43
UBS Group	UBS	54.14	-1.58
UDR	UDR	36.87	-0.08
U-Haul	UHAL	67.50	0.15
U-Haul N	UHAL/B	59.61	-0.06
UL Solutions	ULS	73.46	-1.06
UMB Fin	UMBF	137.95	-3.68
US Foods	USFD	106.66	1.82
Uber	UBER	75.24	-0.41
Ubiquiti	UI	586.78	-3.24
UiPath	PATH	18.14	-0.53
UltaBeauty	ULTA	545.66	8.56
Unilever	UL	64.38	-0.47
UnionPacific	UNP	290.62	-10.05
UnitedAirlines	UAL	104.63	-3.36
UnitedMicro	UMC	20.47	0.59
UPS B	UPS	102.66	-1.57
UnitedRentals	URI	990.15	-47.85
US Bancorp	USB	61.21	-0.37
UnitedTherap	UTHR	512.70	2.32
UnitedHealth	UNH	396.30	6.89
UnitySoftware	U	40.92	-1.18
UniversalHealthB	UHS	170.75	0.62
UnumGroup	UNM	91.69	-1.53
▼ VICI Prop	VICI	25.54	-0.11
Vale	VALE	15.12	0.03
▲ ValeroEnergy	VLO	361.99	3.07
VeevaSystems	VEEV	279.23	-6.46
Ventas	VTR	92.07	0.90
VentureGlobal	VG	15.11	0.47
Veralto	VLTO	97.05	-1.52
VeriSign	VRSN	288.37	0.09
VeriskAnalytics	VRSK	194.35	0.57
Verizon	VZ	50.30	0.28
VertexPharm	VRTX	547.65	3.13
Vertiv	VRT	255.97	-2.75
Viatris	VTRS	16.63	0.12
Viking	VIK	85.03	-1.11
ViperEnergy	VNOM	45.39	0.60
VirtuFinancial	VIRT	65.32	-0.08
Visa	V	372.67	-6.70
Vistra	VST	138.08	0.71
VivmarkResidential	VMRK	65.28	0.14
Vodafone	VOD	16.05	0.01
VulcanMatls	VMC	259.69	-9.89
W X Y Z			
WEC Energy	WEC	106.20	0.03
W.P.Carey	WPC	70.16	0.20
Wabtec	WAB	279.80	-6.13
Walmart	WMT	105.92	1.05
WarnerBrosA	WBD	28.32	-0.21
WarnerMusic	WMG	27.97	-0.24
WasteConnections	WCN	163.89	-1.43
WasteMgt	WM	219.77	0.85
Waters	WAT	405.84	-8.79
Watsco	WSO	314.98	5.16
WattsWater	WTS	355.74	-9.38
Wayfair	**W**	**93.88**	**-5.39**
WellsFargo	WFC	87.04	0.65
Welltower	WELL	240.42	4.18
WescoIntl	WCC	332.00	-8.40
WestPharmSvcs	WST	338.65	-2.46
WesternDigital	WDC	450.44	-0.11
WesternMidstrm	WES	48.99	0.89
Westlake	WLK	74.23	-0.84
Weyerhaeuser	WY	23.38	0.01
WheatonPrecMtls	WPM	144.93	-5.90
Williams	WMB	75.23	0.18
Williams-Sonoma	WSM	222.12	-6.13
WillisTowers	WTW	334.47	-4.08
WintrustFinl	WTFC	148.74	-1.62
Wipro	WIT	1.83	-0.02
Wise	WSE	12.94	-0.17
WoodsideEnergy	WDS	23.90	0.62
Woodward	WWD	336.58	-3.24
WooriFinl	WF	74.35	1.21
Workday	WDAY	198.38	0.93
▼ WynnResorts	WYNN	90.60	-0.68
XP	XP	18.72	0.49
XPO	XPO	185.09	-8.90
XcelEnergy	XEL	75.89	0.20
XPeng	XPEV	11.17	-0.19
Xylem	XYL	106.89	-3.22
YPF	YPF	52.46	0.88
Yum!Brands	YUM	152.03	-1.28
YumChina	YUMC	44.88	0.27
ZTO Express	ZTO	21.06	-0.11
ZebraTech	ZBRA	343.70	-9.85
ZimmerBiomet	ZBH	99.40	-0.64
ZionsBancorp	ZION	66.36	-0.33
Zoetis	ZTS	77.25	0.15
ZoomComms	ZM	94.90	-1.78
Zscaler	**ZS**	**178.37**	**-10.02**

BANKRATE.COM® MMA, Savings and CDs

Average Yields of Major Banks

Tuesday, September 1, 2026

Type	MMA	1-MO	2-MO	3-MO	6-MO	1-YR	2-YR	2.5YR	5YR
National average									
Savings	0.44	0.92	1.08	1.38	1.89	2.04	1.82	1.60	1.74
Jumbo	1.18	0.51	0.50	1.44	1.68	2.00	1.81	1.50	1.68
Weekly change									
Savings	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.01	0.01	0.01	0.00	0.00
Jumbo	0.04	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00

Consumer Savings Rates

Below are the top federally insured offers available nationwide according to Bankrate.com's weekly survey of highest yields. For latest offers and reviews of these financial institutions, please visit bankrate.com/banking/reviews. Information is believed to be reliable, but not guaranteed.

High yield savings

Bank / Phone number	Minimum	Yield (%)	Bank / Phone number	Minimum	Yield (%)
Money market account			**Six-month CD**		
Newtek Bank 888-681-7238	$0	4.20	Quorum Federal Credit Union 800-874-5544	$100	4.30
PiBank 877-678-0888	$0	4.10	E*Trade 800-387-2331	$0	4.20
Peak Bank 866-484-5705	$100	4.01	EagleBank 301-986-1800	$1,000	4.20
One-month CD			**One-year CD**		
EagleBank 301-986-1800	$1,000	3.65	Quorum Federal Credit Union 800-874-5544	$100	4.35
FinWise Bank 801-545-6000	$500	2.68	EagleBank 301-986-1800	$1,000	4.25
Lone Star Bank 713-358-9400	$1,000	0.20	BTG Pactual Bank 212-652-7200	$500	4.35
Two-month CD			**Two-year CD**		
State Bank of India California 877-707-1995	$1,000	3.75	Popular Direct 800-274-5696	$10,000	4.45
FinWise Bank 801-545-6000	$500	2.68	BTG Pactual Bank 212-652-7200	$500	4.40
Lone Star Bank 713-358-9400	$1,000	0.20	LendingClub Bank 800-242-0272	$0	4.40
Three-month CD			**Five-year CD**		
Northern Bank Direct 844-348-8996	$500	4.00	Popular Direct 800-274-5696	$10,000	4.50
WebBank 844-994-2265	$2,500	3.96	BTG Pactual Bank 212-652-7200	$500	4.45
Bask Bank, a div of Texas Capital Bank 833-260-4320	$1,000	3.95	Sallie Mae Bank 877-346-2756	$2,500	4.40

High yield jumbos - Minimum is $100,000

Bank / Phone number	Minimum	Yield (%)	Bank / Phone number	Minimum	Yield (%)
Money market account			**Six-month CD**		
Credit One Bank, NA 877-825-3242	$100,000	4.00	Quorum Federal Credit Union 800-874-5544	$100,000	4.30
EverBank 888-882-EVER	$100,000	3.80	Credit One Bank, NA 877-825-3242	$100,000	4.25
BankFive 508-679-8551	$100,000	3.80	E*Trade 800-387-2331	$100,000	4.20
One-month CD			**One-year CD**		
Bank of Hope 855-325-2226	$100,000	0.20	Quorum Federal Credit Union 800-874-5544	$100,000	4.30
Lone Star Bank 713-358-9400	$100,000	0.20	Credit One Bank, NA 877-825-3242	$100,000	4.25
USAA Federal Savings Bank 800-531-8722	$100,000	0.05	E*Trade 800-387-2331	$100,000	4.20
Two-month CD			**Two-year CD**		
Lone Star Bank 713-358-9400	$100,000	0.20	Credit One Bank, NA 877-825-3242	$100,000	4.30
Applied Bank 888-839-7952	$100,000	0.05	E*Trade 800-387-2331	$100,000	4.30
Citizens Trust Bank 888-214-3099	$100,000	0.01	Luana Savings Bank 800-666-2012	$100,000	4.24
Three-month CD			**Five-year CD**		
Luana Savings Bank 800-666-2012	$100,000	3.80	E*Trade 800-387-2331	$100,000	4.35
Washington Savings Bank 978-458-7999	$100,000	3.15	Credit One Bank, NA 877-825-3242	$100,000	4.15
Lone Star Bank 713-358-9400	$100,000	2.80	Quorum Federal Credit Union 800-874-5544	$100,000	4.15

Notes: Accounts are federally insured up to $250,000 per person. Yields are based on method of compounding and rate stated for the lowest required opening deposit to earn interest. CD figures are for fixed rates only. MMA: Allows six (6) third-party transfers per month, three (3) of which may be checks. Rates are subject to change.

Source: Bankrate.com, a publication of Bankrate, Inc., Palm Beach Gardens, FL 33410
Internet: www.bankrate.com

Exchange-Traded Portfolios

Largest 100 exchange-traded funds, latest session.

Tuesday, September 1, 2026

ETF	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg (%)	YTD (%)
AvantisUSSCValue	AVUV	124.10	**-0.70**	21.7
CapGrpDivVal	CGDV	49.52	**-0.80**	13.5
DimenUSCoreEq2	DFAC	45.07	**-0.68**	13.8
FidTotalBd	FBND	44.62	**-0.29**	-3.1
InvscNasd100	QQQM	291.40	**-1.28**	15.2
InvscQQQI	QQQ	707.64	**-1.27**	15.2
InvscS&P500EW	RSP	217.59	**-0.82**	13.6
iShBitcoin	IBIT	43.76	**-2.04**	-11.9
iShBrdUSDHYCpBd	USHY	36.59	**-0.32**	-2.2
iShCoreDivGrowth	DGRO	78.89	**-0.16**	13.6
iShCoreMSCIEAFE	IEFA	99.34	**-0.92**	11.0
iShCoreMSCIEM	IEMG	81.43	**-0.37**	21.1
iShMSCIIntlDev	IDEV	91.71	**-0.99**	11.2
iShCoreMSCITotInt	IXUS	96.71	**-0.73**	14.3
iShCoreS&P500	IVV	765.35	**-0.70**	11.7
iShCoreS&P MC	IJH	74.60	**-1.00**	13.0
iShCoreS&P SC	IJR	142.92	**-1.11**	18.9
iShCoreS&PTotUS	ITOT	166.61	**-0.78**	12.1
iShCoreS&PUSGrw	IUSG	188.71	**-1.00**	12.4
iShCoreUSAggBd	AGG	96.77	**-0.31**	-3.1
iShCoreUnivUSDBd	IUSB	45.15	**-0.29**	-3.0
iShEdgeMSCIUSAQual	QUAL	220.99	**-0.73**	11.3
iShGoldTr	IAU	81.35	**-2.82**	0.2
iShiBoxx$IGCpBd	LQD	105.22	**-0.52**	-4.5
iShMBS	MBB	92.41	**-0.38**	-3.0
iShMSCIACWI	ACWI	159.42	**-0.78**	12.7
iShMSCI EAFE	EFA	106.49	**-0.89**	10.9
iSh MSCI EM	EEM	66.77	**-0.37**	22.0
iShMSCIEAFEValue	EFV	81.60	**-0.26**	14.3
iShNatlMuniBd	MUB	104.33	**-0.46**	-2.6
iShRussMC	IWR	110.50	**-1.06**	14.8
iShRuss1000	IWB	416.56	**-0.79**	11.5
iShRuss1000Grw	IWF	121.21	**-1.22**	2.4
iShRuss1000Val	IWD	255.95	**-0.37**	21.7
iShRuss2000	IWM	290.57	**-1.14**	18.0
iShS&P500Grw	IVW	138.21	**-1.00**	12.1
iShS&P500Value	IVE	235.80	**-0.31**	11.2
iShSemiconductor	SOXX	500.31	**-2.10**	66.1
iSh7-10YTreaBd	IEF	92.10	**-0.33**	-4.2
iShSilver	SLV	57.92	**-3.68**	-10.1
iSh20+YTreaBd	TLT	81.87	**-0.41**	-6.1
iShUSEqFactRotat	DYNF	69.13	**-0.49**	13.7
iShUSTreasuryBd	GOVT	22.32	**-0.20**	-3.1
iSh0-3MTreaBd	SGOV	100.41	**0.03**	0.0
JPMNasdEqPrem	JEPQ	59.00	**-0.90**	1.5
JanusAAACLO	JAAA	50.53	**0.04**	-0.1
JPMEqPremiumIncome	JEPI	57.00	**-0.23**	-0.4
JPM UltShIncm	JPST	50.36	**-0.02**	-0.5
ProShUltPrQQQ	TQQQ	69.15	**-3.85**	31.2
SPDRGoldMini	GLDM	85.59	**-2.86**	0.3
SPDR Gold	GLD	396.75	**-2.86**	0.1
SchwabIntEquity	SCHF	27.94	**-0.99**	16.2
SchwabUS BrdMkt	SCHB	29.38	**-0.74**	12.0
SchwabUS Div	SCHD	34.81	**-0.23**	26.9
SchwabUS LC	SCHX	30.03	**-0.66**	11.6
SchwabUS LC Grw	SCHG	35.27	**-1.09**	8.1
SSEnergySel	XLE	64.77	**1.27**	44.9
SSFinlSel	XLF	57.20	**-0.88**	4.4
SSHlthCrSel	XLV	171.67	**0.66**	10.9
SSIndlSel	XLI	172.73	**-1.37**	11.4
SSSPDRBbg1-3M	BIL	91.39	**0.01**	0.0
SS SPDR DJIA	DIA	527.75	**-0.72**	9.8
SSSPDRDevxUS	SPDW	51.14	**-1.06**	15.2
SSSPDRS&P500	SPYM	89.65	**-0.70**	11.8
SSSPDRS&P500G	SPYG	119.68	**-1.00**	12.2
SSSPDRS&P500V	SPYV	63.13	**-0.35**	11.1
SSIMSPDRS&P500	SPY	761.78	**-0.69**	11.7
SSTechSel	XLK	183.64	**-1.53**	27.6
VanEckGoldMin	GDX	94.67	**-3.90**	10.4
VanEckSemicon	SMH	545.22	**-2.05**	51.4
VangdDivApp	VIG	241.09	**-0.40**	9.7
VangdExtMkt	VXF	238.01	**-1.41**	13.8
VangdFTSEAWxUS	VEU	84.65	**-0.70**	15.1
VangdFTSEDevMk	VEA	72.11	**-1.11**	15.4
VangdFTSE EM	VWO	60.68	**0.26**	12.9
VangdFTSE Europe	VGK	90.72	**-1.03**	8.5
VangdHiDiv	VYM	163.31	**-0.34**	13.8
VangdInfoTech	VGT	118.87	**-1.34**	26.2
VangdIntermBd	BIV	74.83	**-0.33**	-3.9
VangdIntrCorpBd	VCIT	80.39	**-0.45**	-4.0
VangdIntermTrea	VGIT	57.87	**-0.23**	-3.4
VangdMstarGrw	VUG	87.37	**-0.99**	7.5
VangdMstarLC	VV	350.91	**-0.71**	11.5
VangdMstarMegaGr	MGK	89.04	**-0.96**	7.9
VangdMstarMC	VO	81.30	**-0.93**	12.1
VangdMstarSC	VB	295.90	**-1.09**	14.7
VangdMstarSCVal	VBR	243.64	**-0.67**	15.0
VangdMstarTot	VTI	375.17	**-0.79**	11.9
VangdMstarVal	VTV	223.96	**-0.40**	17.3
VangdRealEst	VNQ	96.30	**-0.15**	8.8
VangdRuss1000Grw	VONG	124.81	**-1.25**	2.5
VangdS&P500ETF	VOO	700.28	**-0.65**	11.7
VangdST Bond	BSV	77.11	**-0.16**	-2.2
VangdSTCpBd	VCSH	78.08	**-0.19**	-2.1
VangdShortTrea	VGSH	57.84	**-0.09**	-1.5
VangdTaxExemptBd	VTEB	48.98	**-0.44**	-2.6
VangdTotalBd	BND	71.79	**-0.27**	-3.1
VangdTotIntlBd	BNDX	47.27	**-0.34**	-2.2
VangdTotIntlStk	VXUS	86.71	**-0.70**	14.9
VangdTotWrldStk	VT	159.31	**-0.77**	12.9

Dividend Changes

Company	Symbol	Yld %	Amount New/Old	Frq	Payable / Record
Increased					
Stewart Info Svcs	STC	3.1	.55 /.525	Q	Sep30 /Sep15
Initial					
PennantPark FR Nts 2031	PFLA	7.4	.53269		Sep15 /Sep01
Qwest 6.75% Nts 2052	CTHH	10.0	.44063		Sep15 /Sep01
Saratoga Inv 8% Nts 2031	SAX	8.1	.5222		Nov30 /Nov13
Foreign					
Aspen Ins 5.625% Pfd.	AHLpD	7.6	.3516	Q	Oct01 /Sep15
NXP Semiconductors	NXPI	1.8	1.014	Q	Oct08 /Sep16
Special					
Gladstone Capital	GLAD	9.0	.18		Sep16 /Sep10

Note: Dividend yields as of 3:30 p.m. ET

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

KEY: A: annual; M: monthly; Q: quarterly; r: revised; SA: semiannual; S2:1: stock split and ratio; SO: spin-off.

Fervo Sets Google Geothermal-Power Deal

Company, which counts Bill Gates as a backer, went public in a buzzy IPO in May

By Jennifer Hiller

Geothermal company **Fervo Energy** has signed a deal to sell power to **Alphabet**'s Google from a Utah project that it plans to turn into the world's largest enhanced geothermal facility.

The agreement for nearly 400 megawatts of electricity is enough to power a midsize city and would be Fervo's largest power deal yet. Fervo plans to begin selling power to Google in 2028 from its Cape Station project in southwestern Utah.

Houston-based Fervo uses technology pioneered by oil-and-gas drillers to frack rocks, create geothermal reservoirs and crank out electricity. The company is spending more than $2 billion at Cape Station and expects to start delivering power to the grid later this year for the first phase of the project.

Google intends to buy the power for a data center in Utah—though it has yet to determine the location. The company still needs to work with local communities and go through state and local regulatory approvals before it can move forward with the plans.

"Even though right now we don't have clarity yet on how this will serve a data center...we know that it will be a foundational building block of power generation for a data center presence in Utah," said Lucia Tian, Google's director of advanced energy technologies.

Google has an option to expand the agreement by about 600 megawatts by June 2030.

The tech company has been working with Fervo for about five years, starting with a small 3-megawatt pilot project that began operating in 2023 in Nevada. Later, Fervo, Google and utility NV Energy joined together on a 115-megawatt deal in Nevada.

Fervo now has about 1,000 megawatts contracted; other customers include **Shell** and utility Southern California Edison.

When it went public in May, Fervo raised more than $2 billion, and last year Fervo privately raised $462 million from a group of investors including Google and Bill Gates's Breakthrough Energy Ventures.

"This is us taking that $2.2 billion of proceeds from the IPO and turning it into rapid commercial growth, which is the whole point," said Tim Latimer, Fervo's chief executive and co-founder.

The Fervo-Google deal shows how tech companies are trying to lock down electricity supplies even as they work out the details of projects.

The need to build artificial-intelligence data centers has created a huge surge in electricity demand in the U.S. Meeting it is easier said than done because of equipment backlogs for transmission infrastructure and the complex engineering studies needed to understand grid impacts. Waits to connect to the grid can extend well into the 2030s.

Clean electricity that is available round-the-clock, such as geothermal, is considered especially valuable. Google is also working with companies developing nuclear power and long-duration storage, among other technologies.

KIM RAFF FOR WSJ

Fervo taps technology used by oil-and-gas drillers to frack rocks and create geothermal reservoirs.

Donald Trump Jr. Fund Lifts Polymarket Backing

By Neil Mehta, Dana Mattioli and Caitlin Ostroff

The investment fund 1789 Capital, in which Donald Trump Jr. is a partner, is investing around $300 million in Polymarket, according to a person familiar with the matter.

The investment is part of a $1 billion round led by 1789 that would value Polymarket at $21 billion, according to people familiar with the matter.

Polymarket declined to comment.

The investment will make 1789 one of Polymarket's largest backers. **Intercontinental Exchange**, Polymarket's largest investor, disclosed in July that its $1.6 billion stake in Polymarket amounted to 22% of the company's shares outstanding.

Polymarket, along with rival Kalshi, has attracted controversy for permitting users to place bets on sports, which some regulators have criticized as gambling. Both platforms have listed markets that have led to charges of insider trading. Both also see more traders losing money than winning, The Journal previously reported.

1789 had previously invested a total of around $200 million in Polymarket, according to a person familiar with the investments. 1789 made its first investment in Polymarket before the 2024 election. That year, Polymarket CEO Shayne Coplan was seen at a table with Trump Jr. and Omeed Malik, founder of 1789 Capital, at the Republican National Convention.

After his father won the presidential election, Donald Trump Jr. joined 1789 as a partner and the firm invested in Polymarket again.

The venture-capital firm's success has attracted scrutiny from House Democrats. Last week, Rep. Jamie Raskin (D., Md.) wrote to 1789's leadership demanding a list of the firm's investments, communications with the government and information about its decision to hire Trump Jr.

1789's counsel denied any allegations of conflicts of interest as "unsubstantiated talking points."

Shein's Debut Is Subdued

Continued from page B1

Shein's ambitions to list in New York and London, forcing it to settle for a third choice closer to home.

Like TikTok and Huawei, Shein became a poster child for businesses trapped in the U.S.-China superpower conflict. Now, even as it goes public, Shein leaves a question largely unanswered: What is next?

"I don't see any strong narrative of how they would grow," said Jianggan Li, head of Singapore-based Momentum Works, an advisory firm that tracks Shein. "They talk about the things they've done, but for the future, I don't see anything that's concrete."

In its prospectus, the company said it would use the $1.7 billion in IPO proceeds mostly to improve its technological capabilities, including by hiring 1,500 to 2,000 new employees, and on marketing.

The company was cofounded in 2008 by Sky Xu, the son of Chinese factory workers.

It spent years selling wedding gowns under the name Sheinside, before shortening the moniker in 2015 as it expanded to everyday fashion.

What made the company revolutionary was its hyperefficient supply chain: a flexible network of 7,500 factories, many of them small Chinese ones, that could churn out new styles in days instead of weeks.

Orders are cranked out in small batches of 100 to 200 pieces. If real-time data show high interest in certain items, Shein orders more.

With this strategy, its IPO prospectus said, the company keeps its unsold inventory percentage in the low single digits, a fraction of industry average.

Beyond the factories, Shein's other edge was a trade exemption. By shipping orders directly from Chinese warehouses to American doorsteps, it avoided U.S. tariffs using what was called the de minimis provision, which allowed duty-free imports on packages of $800 or less.

By 2023, Shein was America's top fast-fashion retailer by market share and filed to go public in New York.

Then, U.S. lawmakers called the de minimis exemption a loophole that hurt domestic manufacturers and retailers, paving the way for the end of the exemption last year.

Politicians also pressed the company over supply-chain connections to Xinjiang, the cotton-rich Chinese region where the U.S. says Chinese authorities have pressed ethnic minorities into forced labor. Beijing denies the allegations.

Shein pivoted, filing to go public in London. There, it ran into similar pushback from British lawmakers concerned about how Shein tracked its supply chain.

The company has said it has a zero-tolerance policy against forced labor and doesn't permit sourcing from Xinjiang. It didn't address the issue directly in its IPO prospectus.

Europe soon added its own pressure. France began fining ultrafast fashion retailers for selling products at prices far below the cost of repairing them, while the European Union in July began imposing a flat 3-euro fee, about $3.50, on low-value e-commerce imports.

VERNON YUEN/NEXPHER IMAGES/ZUMA PRESS

The company plans to hire 1,500 to 2,000 new employees.

Watch a Video

Scan this code for a video on why Shein's IPO ended up in Hong Kong.

MONEY & INVESTING

Stock Spotlight

Nestlé

Shares slipped slightly after it said it will sell its mainstream vitamins, supplements and minerals business for $1 billion to private-equity firm Yellow Wood Partners.

Medtronic

The medical-device maker raised its outlook after posting higher fiscal first-quarter profit and sales. Shares closed up 1.6%.

MediaTek

The Taiwanese chip maker's shares rose about 10% on news that Nvidia would invest $3.5 billion and collaborate on local AI computing and AI-powered vehicles.

Partners Group

Shares fell more than 7% after the private-equity firm posted a drop in performance fees and appointed two new co-CEOs.

WEDNESDAY'S EVENTS:

◆ Economic data: ADP national employment report (August), July durable-goods and factory orders, Federal Reserve Beige Book, EIA weekly petroleum status report

◆ Bank of Canada interest rate announcement

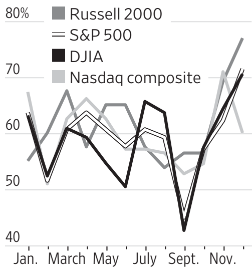
EARNINGS EXPECTED:

Broadcom
Hewlett Packard Enterprise
Snowflake
Five Below
Brown-Forman
Ollie's Bargain Outlet

Today in Markets History

On this day in 1974, President Gerald R. Ford signed into law the Employee Retirement Income Security Act, which regulated employee benefits, defined "fiduciary duty" for pension-fund managers, created a limited Individual Retirement Account, and opened the door to the creation of 401(k) plans in 1981.

How often stocks finished higher in a month



Note: Based on data back to 1897 (DJIA), 1928 (S&P 500), 1971 (Nasdaq), 1987 (Russell 2000)
Source: Dow Jones Market Data

U.S. stocks finish higher in September less frequently than other months, according to Dow Jones Market Data. In September, the Dow has finished higher 43% of the time, using data going back to 1897. That's the worst winning percentage of any month for the blue-chip average. The story is similiar for the S&P 500, which has finished September higher 45% of the time. The Nasdaq composite and the small-stock focused Russell 2000 don't do great in September either.

—Shradha Dinesh

UBS Gets Win In Capital Battle

UBS could get to issue cheaper bonds instead of equity to help meet tougher Swiss capital requirements.

That's after a committee of lawmakers backed a plan that would allow half the new capital requirement to come in bond form.

Filippo Alloatti, head of financials for credit at Federated Hermes, said the 50-50 split was a victory for UBS, although the plans need to pass parliamentary votes. "This is not a done deal," he said.

Switzerland is overhauling bank-capital rules for its biggest lenders after UBS had to rescue Credit Suisse in 2023.

Swiss lawmakers told UBS it will have to hold far more capital than at present under its new banking package, to better cover the risk of a crash at one of its large subsidiaries in the U.S. and U.K. bringing down the group.

UBS resisted the planned capital increase, saying it isn't needed. Its executives argued that Credit Suisse's demise wasn't a question of capital, but of a failed business model and weak governance.

—Margot Patrick

Mutual Funds

Data provided by LSEG

Top 250 mutual-funds listings for Nasdaq-published share classes by net assets.

e-Ex-distribution. **f**-Previous day's quotation. **g**-Footnotes x and s apply. **j**-Footnotes e and s apply. **k**-Recalculated by LSEG, using updated data. **p**-Distribution costs apply, 12b-1. **r**-Redemption charge may apply. **s**-Stock split or dividend. **t**-Footnotes p and r apply. **v**-Footnotes x and e apply. **x**-Ex-dividend. **z**-Footnote x, e and s apply. **NA**-Not available due to incomplete price, performance or cost data. **NE**-Not released by LSEG; data under review. **NN**-Fund not tracked. **NS**-Fund didn't exist at start of period.

Tuesday, September 1, 2026

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD %Ret
AB Funds			
MunilncmShares	10.87	-0.06	0.6
American Century Inv			
Ultra	97.70	-1.49	3.8
American Funds Cl A			
AmcpA	45.23	-0.44	6.0
AMutlA	64.71	-0.22	9.5
BalA	40.73	-0.14	9.3
BondA	11.04	-0.03	-0.9
CapIBA	84.30	-0.10	10.9
CapWGrA	82.19	-0.42	15.7
EupacA	64.60	-0.44	12.9
FdInvA	102.55	-0.74	13.6
GwthA	87.33	-0.88	8.5
ICAA	68.54	-0.52	10.2
IncoA	28.35	...	9.9
N PerA	75.33	-0.59	6.7
NEcoA	85.50	-0.73	17.7
NwWrldA	108.23	+0.07	16.0
SmCpA	82.04	-1.06	11.9
WshA	68.34	-0.16	9.6
Artisan Funds			
IntlVal Inst	61.19	-0.41	14.7
Baird Funds			
AggBdInst	9.64	-0.02	-0.4
CorBdInst	10.00	-0.03	-0.3
IntBdInst	10.29	-0.02	0.1
ShtTBdInst	9.44	-0.01	1.3
BlackRock Funds			
HiYBlk	7.10	-0.02	2.6
HiYldBd Inst	7.10	-0.01	2.7
BlackRock Funds III			
iShS&P500IdxK	888.28	-6.29	12.3
BlackRock Funds Inst			
StratIncOpptyIns	9.64	-0.02	1.8
Calamos Funds			
MktNeutl	NA	...	NA
CausewayInst			
CausewayInst	25.63	-0.31	9.1
Columbia Class A			
SelgComuInfoA	236.70	-2.41	51.1
Columbia Class I			
DivIncom I	40.69	-0.04	13.1
Dimensional Fds			
EmgMktVa	45.75	+0.02	24.0
EmMktCorEq	34.70	-0.08	20.3
IntlCoreEq	22.94	-0.17	14.5
IntlVal	33.36	-0.01	18.2
IntSmCo	28.41	-0.28	12.3
IntSmVa	35.87	-0.26	17.4
LgCo	50.68	-0.36	12.3
US CoreEq1	56.07	-0.38	13.7
US CoreEq2	50.04	-0.34	13.7
US Small	60.65	-0.72	16.6
US SmCpVal	61.88	-0.42	20.8
US TgdVal	43.77	-0.31	19.3
USLgVa	67.97	-0.30	21.7
Dodge & Cox			
Balanced	14.14	-0.03	6.8
Income	12.50	-0.04	-0.6
Intl Stk	18.65	-0.05	13.3
Stock	18.14	-0.08	11.2
DoubleLine Funds			
TotRetBdI	8.58	-0.02	-0.7
Fidelity			
500IdxInstPrem	265.58	-1.88	12.3
Contrafund K6	37.19	-0.28	9.3
EmgMktIdxInstPre	16.87	-0.10	23.3
ExtMktIdxInstPre	115.07	-1.66	14.3
FidSer5	7.44	-0.01	-0.4
FidSerInt	8.32	-0.02	-0.5
FidSerToMarket	24.95	-0.19	12.6
FIDZroLgCpIx	27.34	-0.21	12.0
GlexUSIdxInstPre	21.66	-0.17	16.1
GrowthCompanyK6	45.38	-0.45	22.6
IntlIdxInstPrem	68.67	-0.54	12.9
LgCpGwId InstPre	47.52	-0.59	2.7
LgCpVlIdxIstPrem	25.38	-0.09	22.6
MidCpInxInstPrem	42.65	-0.46	15.5
SAIUSLgCpIndxFd	30.59	-0.21	12.3
SeriesBondFd	8.85	-0.03	-0.5
SeriesOverseas	15.85	-0.20	6.2
SerLTTreBdIdx	5.10	-0.02	-2.8
SmCpIdxInstPrem	36.64	-0.45	18.6
TMktIdxInstPrem	210.17	-1.65	12.6
TotalMarketIndex	26.63	-0.21	12.6
TtlIntIdxInstPr	20.05	-0.16	15.8
USBdIdxInstPrem	10.25	-0.03	-0.5
Fidelity Advisor			
TotBdFdClZ	9.36	-0.03	-0.3
Fidelity Advisor I			
GrOppI	259.76	-3.34	11.0
Fidelity Freedom			
Freedom2040K6	14.43	-0.10	12.6
Idx2030InsPre	24.25	-0.13	7.6
Idx2035InsPre	28.84	-0.17	8.8
Idx2040InsPre	31.86	-0.22	10.9
Idx2045InsPre	34.58	-0.25	12.3
Idx2050InsPre	34.79	-0.25	12.6
Fidelity Invest			
Balanc	35.28	-0.20	10.7
BluCh	305.63	-3.30	14.5
BluChpGr K6	49.89	-0.61	12.8
Contra	26.65	-0.20	9.8
ContraK	26.78	-0.20	9.9
CpInc	11.20	-0.04	6.8
GroCo	58.19	-0.57	21.7
InvGrBd	9.87	-0.03	-0.3
LowP	47.48	-0.36	15.2
Magin	15.22	-0.19	3.9
NASDAQ	332.33	-3.45	12.7
OTC	30.40	-0.22	25.2
Puritn	28.30	-0.17	9.5
SAILTTreBdIdx	6.33	-0.02	-3.2
SAIUSMinVolIndFd	25.22	-0.02	10.6
SAIUSQtyIdx	26.65	-0.21	11.3
Srs1000ValIndRet	22.35	-0.08	22.7
SrsBlChGroRetail	26.50	-0.30	15.3
SrsEmrgMkt	31.16	-0.17	26.4
SrsGlobal	21.25	-0.16	16.1
SrsGroCoRetail	33.39	-0.33	22.5
SrsIntlGrw	20.57	-0.33	7.6
SrsIntlVal	17.34	-0.06	11.2
TotalBond	9.38	-0.02	-0.2
Fidelity SAI			
FidSaiCndInxFnd	16.12	-0.21	13.2
FidSaiInfltnFnd	9.99	-0.01	0.6
IntlValIdx	15.14	...	20.3
TotalBd	8.88	-0.02	-0.2
Fidelity Selects			
Semiconductors r	58.93	-1.04	48.6
Tech	54.18	-0.61	35.2
Fidelity Strategic A			
StratAdEmrMrt	NA	...	NA
First Eagle Funds			
GlbA	89.68	-0.89	11.4
Franklin A1			
IncomeA1	NA	...	NA
FrankTemp/Frank Adv			
IncomeAdv	NA	...	NA
FrankTemp/Franklin A			
DynaTech A	197.21	-2.85	5.9
Growth A	144.48	-1.58	7.3
RisDv A	97.48	-0.54	8.2
Guggenheim Funds Tru			
TotRtnBdFdClInst	NA	...	NA
Harbor Funds			
CapApInst	124.56	-1.46	6.8
JHF III DispVal			
DispValMCI	31.62	-0.22	15.1
John Hancock			
BondR6	NA	...	NA
JPMorgan I Class			
CoreBond	10.08	-0.02	-0.6
EqInc	28.79	-0.11	17.4
LgCpGwth	82.80	-0.89	1.2
JPMorgan R Class			
CoreBond	10.09	-0.03	-0.6
CorePlusBd	7.09	-0.02	0.2
Lord Abbett I			
ShtDurInc p	3.82	...	1.5
Metropolitan West			
TotRetBdI	NA	...	NA
MFS Funds			
IIE	44.06	-0.25	8.6
MFS Funds Class I			
ValueI	55.10	-0.14	10.5
Natixis Funds			
LSGrowthY	33.22	-0.45	...
Northern Funds			
StkIdx	NA	...	NA
Old Westbury Fds			
LrgCpStr	NA	...	NA
PGIM Funds Cl Z			
TotalReturnBond	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Fds Instl			
IntlBdUSH	NA	...	NA
TotRt	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds A			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds I2			
Income	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds Instl			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
Price Funds			
BlChip	210.79	-2.64	0.2
LgCapGow I	87.82	-1.11	3.4
Putnam Funds Class A			
PutLargCap p	45.09	-0.14	15.4
Putnam Funds Class Y			
PutLargCap	45.11	-0.14	15.6
Schwab Funds			
1000 Inv r	16.37	-0.12	12.5
FunUSLgInst r	38.42	-0.04	19.8
Intl Sel r	32.42	-0.25	12.9
S&P Sel	19.70	-0.14	12.3
TSM Sel r	18.44	-0.15	12.5
Strategic Adviser			
StratAdCorInFnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdFidCoreS	9.02	-0.02	0.1
StratAdFidEmr	19.13	-0.09	25.9
StratAdFidUS	21.86	-0.15	15.3
StratAdIntlFnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdMunBond	NA	...	NA
StratAdvFidIntl	16.61	-0.11	12.4
TIAA/CREF Funds			
EqIdxInst	52.73	-0.42	12.5
IntlEqIdxInst	31.44	-0.24	12.9
LrgCpGrIdxInst	78.22	-0.97	2.9
VANGUARD ADMIRAL			
500Adml	705.34	-4.99	12.3
BalAdml	54.54	-0.32	7.4
CAITAdml	11.27	-0.05	-0.4
CapOpAdml r	264.28	-3.56	21.9
DivAppIdxAdm	65.42	-0.25	10.6
EMAdmr	50.31	+0.04	12.9
EqIncAdml	103.56	-0.16	12.8
ExplrAdml	121.93	-1.55	14.3
ExtndAdml	180.55	-2.61	14.5
GroIncAdml	121.14	-0.85	11.0
GrwthAdml	269.80	-2.73	7.7
HlthCareAdml r	90.37	+0.62	9.1
HYCorAdml r	5.45	-0.01	2.1
InfProAd	22.70	...	0.5
InfTechIdx	486.91	-6.66	26.5
IntlGrAdml	125.29	-1.28	9.9
ITBondAdml	10.15	-0.03	-1.1
ITIGradeAdml	8.56	-0.03	-0.8
LarCapAd	177.14	-1.30	12.1
MidCpAdml	402.75	-3.69	12.8
MuHYAdml	10.40	-0.06	0.5
MuIntAdml	13.44	-0.06	-0.3
MuLTAdml	10.54	-0.07	-0.3
MuLtdAdml	10.89	-0.02	1.1
MuShtAdml	15.82	-0.01	1.7
PrmcpAdml r	225.94	-2.67	22.2
RealEstatAdml	136.51	-0.14	11.0
SmCapAdml	141.73	-1.57	15.5
SmGthAdml	121.15	-1.96	14.4
STIGradeAdml	10.30	-0.01	1.1
STIPSIxAdm	24.92	+0.01	1.9
TotBdAdml	9.46	-0.03	-0.5
TotIntBdIdxAdm	18.92	-0.10	-0.4
TotIntlAdmIdx r	46.59	-0.32	15.6
TotStAdml	182.60	-1.43	12.6
TxMCapAdml	392.38	-2.98	12.1
TxMIn r	23.23	-0.22	16.5
USGroAdml	196.02	-2.75	0.5
ValAdml	87.35	-0.33	18.5
WdsrllAdml	94.59	-0.47	14.3
WellsIAdml	NA	...	NA
WelltnAdml	81.07	-0.38	6.2
WndsrAdml	84.32	-0.63	14.8
VANGUARD FDS			
DivdGro	32.15	-0.12	5.8
LifeGro	NA	...	NA
LifeMod	NA	...	NA
PrmcpCor	45.90	-0.50	24.0
STAR	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2020	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2025	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2030	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2035	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2040	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2045	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2050	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2060	NA	...	NA
TgtRet2055	NA	...	NA
TgtRetInc	NA	...	NA
Welltn	46.95	-0.22	6.1
VANGUARD INDEX FDS			
ExtndIstPl	445.55	-6.42	14.5
IdxIntl	27.85	-0.19	15.5
MdCpGrAdml	127.69	-2.18	6.6
MdCpVlAdml	106.61	-0.36	17.2
SmValAdml	104.63	-0.78	16.1
TotBd2	9.33	-0.03	-0.6
TotIntlInstIdx r	186.32	-1.26	15.6
TotItlInstPlId r	186.37	-1.26	15.6
TotSt	182.56	-1.43	12.5
VANGUARD INSTL FDS			
DevMktsIndInst	23.26	-0.22	16.6
DevMktsInxInst	36.35	-0.35	16.5
ExtndInst	180.54	-2.61	14.5
FTSclnst	52.54	-0.45	12.0
GrwthInst	269.82	-2.73	7.7
InPrSeIn	9.25	...	0.5
InstIdx	611.81	-4.33	12.3
InstPlus	611.82	-4.32	12.3
InstTStPlus	125.84	-0.99	12.6
MidCpInst	88.97	-0.82	12.9
MidCpIstPl	438.81	-4.01	12.9
MorngStrTtlStMrk	342.59	-2.69	12.6
MrngStrtTtlStckS	359.59	-2.82	12.6
SmCapInst	141.73	-1.57	15.5
SmCapIstPl	409.09	-4.54	15.5
STIGradeInst	10.30	-0.01	1.1
STIPSIxins	24.94	+0.01	1.9
TotBdInst	9.46	-0.03	-0.5
TotBdInst2	9.33	-0.03	-0.5
TotBdInstPl	9.46	-0.03	-0.5
TotIntBdIdxInst	28.39	-0.16	-0.4
TotStInst	182.63	-1.43	12.6
ValueInst	87.35	-0.33	18.5
WCM Focus Funds			
WCMFocIntlGrwIns	27.93	-0.27	12.3

HEARD ON THE STREET

FINANCIAL ANALYSIS & COMMENTARY

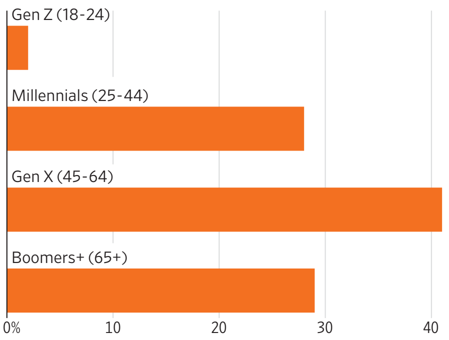
Jersey Mike's Needs to Win Over Gen Z

The chain's affluent, older base gives it an edge, but to grow it also needs young customers

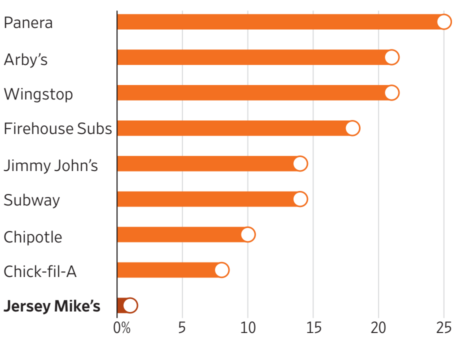
YUKI IWAMURA/AP

The sandwich chain, which recently went public, aims to grow from about 3,300 stores to 15,000 worldwide.

Percentage of Jersey Mike's customer base by age group, 2025



Social media spending as a percentage of total marketing, 2025



Sources: BofA Global Research, the company (customer base); Jersey Mike's prospectus (social media spending)

Affluent older Americans might be the best customers in U.S. dining. They have savings, are relatively insulated from economic swings and, most valuable to a restaurant chain, prefer the familiar to the trendy.

Jersey Mike's Subs, which recently went public after a Blackstone takeover, spent decades cultivating exactly that customer. Now, valued at roughly $7.5 billion and aiming to grow from about 3,300 stores to 15,000 worldwide, the sandwich chain has to prove its formula can work with a younger generation that is less well-off. That won't be easy, and the stock already assumes much of it goes right.

By pairing freshly sliced deli meats with a tightly run franchise network and a TV-heavy advertising strategy, the New Jersey-born chain has built a formidable growth machine.

It has notched 20 straight years of same-store sales gains, pushing systemwide sales to $4.3 billion in 2025. The impressive growth has transformed it into the No. 2 sub chain in America, behind Subway. Crucially, it has something most casual-dining chains covet: pricing power. It can charge roughly $15 to $20 for a sub, drink and chips by catering to the upper half of a K-shaped economy.

But past consistency won't be enough. Jersey Mike's trades at an enterprise value of about 20 times projected earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization—a premium to franchised peers like **Wingstop** and **McDonald's**, which go for about 15. Jersey Mike's carries roughly $1.8 billion in net debt, some of it used to fund distributions to Blackstone pre-initial public offering. Its premium makes some sense given that the chain is a rare growth story in the restaurant business.

But to further rise from these levels over the long term, Jersey Mike's has to pull off a rare feat in the franchise business: adding thousands of stores without letting the freshness and quality slip. It also has to start winning over Gen Z in an era of fickle wellness trends and viral food crazes. That is a lot to ask of a chain whose most loyal customer is old enough to find Danny DeVito a reason to buy a sandwich.

The demographic numbers are stark. Roughly 70% of Jersey Mike's customers are Gen Xers or boomers, while Gen Z accounts for just 2%, according to Wall Street analyst reports citing company figures. It is also an unusually affluent crowd for fast casual: More than 60% of patrons earn more than $80,000, and only 14% make under $40,000.

Part of the draw is old-school deli theater. Employees bake bread fresh every morning and slice hefty portions of meat and cheese to order before finishing them "Mike's Way," with onions, lettuce, tomatoes, red wine vinegar, oil and spices.

Sitting at the top of the K is a comfortable place to be.

But to keep taking share from a shrinking Subway, Jersey Mike's has to reach more price-conscious diners. It has dabbled in value with its $10.99 "Boardwalk Bundle," while also using limited-time offerings such as its popular chicken salad to broaden its appeal. But the balance is delicate: Lean too hard on discounts and Jersey Mike's risks following Subway's path, eroding the premium positioning that makes its model work in the first place.

Jersey Mike's might already have the right product for the TikTok era. A foot-long sub is a carb bomb, but it has saving graces: lots of protein and the appearance of fresh ingredients sliced to order. Its subs have gone viral before. Nick Jonas, for instance, posted his own off-menu turkey and provolone creation on TikTok, inspiring other viral posts. This won't pass as health food, but it can pass as fresh. Properly marketed, it is the kind of splurge a Gen Zer might happily make.

Getting more of them to try it is the challenge. Historically, Jersey Mike's leaned on broad television audiences and sponsorships—like its NFL partnership with Eli Manning as brand ambassador—while devoting little of its marketing budget to social media. It spent about 1% in 2025, versus 10% to 25% at many scaled peers, according to its IPO filing.

Reaching Gen Z means shifting toward more segmented channels like Instagram and TikTok, a move the company says it is now making. Keeping more people coming back with a savvy digital strategy is where the sustainable growth lies. Jersey Mike's already has much of the machinery: more than 12.5 million active loyalty members, an ordering app and digital sales exceeding 40% of the total.

The company says loyalty members visit about three times as often as other customers, so the opportunity is turning casual diners into regulars, leaning on personalized offers rather than blasting the same message to everyone.

It is a familiar playbook for management: Chief Executive Charlie Morrison previously ran Wingstop, where a data-driven digital approach helped fuel the chain's growth. He was brought in by Blackstone in 2025 to modernize Jersey Mike's with a similar playbook.

In an era that prizes freshness, Jersey Mike's is the ascendant sub power, with room to run.

At this price, though, investors will need it to do the hardest thing in the business: keep the momentum going after the easy growth is gone.

—David Wainer

The Gas-Station Chain That Is Eating Domino's Lunch

With the Iran war dragging on, consumer sentiment weak and periodic jitters around AI stocks, a defensive consumer stock might be just what investors are craving.

Look no further than **Casey's General Stores.**

The rural-leaning, pizza-selling convenience-store giant is eating Domino's lunch and scooping up rival chains. It is the fifth-largest pizza chain in the U.S.

After gaining 36% year to date, Casey's shares trade at about 34 times forward earnings. This places it among the most richly valued retailers in the S&P 500 alongside Costco, which fetches 42 times. That may seem pricey, but Casey's has some unique moats.

Cheap pizza is one. Casey's large pie costs $13.99, which is some 22% below comparable pizza offerings, according to a report from William Blair.

Domino's, Papa Johns and Pizza Hut's pizzas are all priced closer to $20, for example.

Casey's cheaper offering is speaking to inflation-weary consumers. The company's same-store sales growth of prepared food and dispensed beverages has exceeded those of Domino's U.S. in 18 out of the past 20 quarters, according to data from Wells Fargo.

How is it able to sell on the cheap?

Casey's sells more stuff under one roof—including groceries, fuel and tobacco. So it distributes labor and fixed costs across more revenue. Stores are all owned and operated by Casey's, not franchised, which means no royalty or franchise fees.

Plus, surging labor and input costs have left mom-and-pop convenience stores with no choice but to raise fuel prices to compensate. That in turn helps larger chains like Casey's improve their fuel margins, too, giving them some room to keep pizza prices ultra competitive, notes Phillip Blee, equity analyst at William Blair.

Casey's booming pizza business and acquisitions have helped the company's earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortization expand at a compound annual growth rate of 16% over the last three fiscal years. Mighty **Costco**'s Ebitda has grown at a more moderate 9.3% rate over an equivalent period. Casey's has also been a good steward of capital with returns on invested capital close to 10% or higher over the last seven fiscal years.

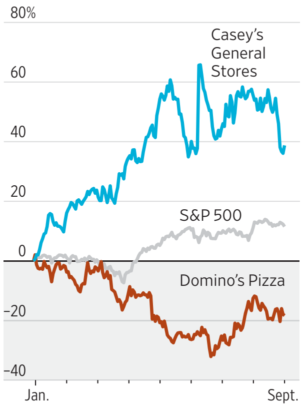
Casey's has scale in an otherwise fragmented convenience-store industry. About 63% of all convenience stores are owned by an entity that has 10 or fewer stores, according to NACS, a trade association. That gives the company plenty of room to keep growing through acquisitions.

New menu items are another potential driver. It is just starting to roll out a wings business that it expects to reach all its stores over the next two years. About half of Casey's stores don't have a national pizza or wing chain competitor within 5 miles, the company said at its investor day earlier this year.

Casey's still has plenty of gas left in its tank.

—Jinjoo Lee

Share-price and index performance, year to date



Source: FactSet

Oil Prices Push Global Bond Market Closer to the Edge

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has a lot of plates spinning at the moment. Even as he hosts the G-20, he is busy defending his attempts to manage the yen-dollar exchange rate, long-term Treasury yields and a renewed trade war with Canada.

Crucially though, it is the jump in oil prices that is suddenly making that juggling act harder.

Long-term bonds issued by the world's major industrialized nations are slumping. On Tuesday, yields on German, U.K. and Japanese 10-year government bonds hit their highest levels since 2011, 2008 and 1996 respectively. In U.S. trading, the 10-year Treasury yield was up around 0.04 percentage point, hovering at levels rarely seen since the financial crisis.

It is tempting to blame it all on fiscal irresponsibility—and some related trigger like Tokyo's latest budget plan. But the worldwide nature of the selloff points to a global factor like oil prices, not something country-specific.

The truth is that years of fiscal stimulus and military spending, following the twin crises of Covid and Russia's invasion of Ukraine, have left major industrialized nations in a weakened fiscal position. And those accumulated deficits were effectively the dry timber that the Iran war now threatens to set ablaze.

Inflation worries are pressing authorities in Japan, too.

What was the immediate cause of the latest leg down in bond prices? Clearly it was the renewed hostilities between the U.S. and Iran, which have sent Brent crude oil prices up nearly 6% in two days. That global energy benchmark is now up 56% since the start of the year.

This creates policy headaches everywhere. In Europe for instance, data out Tuesday showed eurozone inflation accelerated to 3.3% in August from 2.9% in July. Higher oil prices only exacerbate that trend.

Inflation worries are pressing authorities in Japan, too. In a meeting with Japan's central-bank governor and finance minister at the meeting of the Group of 20 advanced and developing economies, Bessent apparently told them that "Japan needs to make clear to the market that it is moving toward higher interest rates and fiscal sustainability," according to Japanese broadcaster NHK.

They could have fairly said the same to him about the U.S., of course. But when asked about the Federal Reserve's next move in an interview with CNBC, Bessent commented that central banks don't traditionally raise rates in response to supply shocks absent "second or third-order effects."

In fact, and to his credit, Federal Reserve Chairman Kevin Warsh pointed to signs of some such effects in his speech at Jackson Hole last week. Within the basket of goods that make up the Fed's favored inflation measure, 54% of goods prices are up more than 3% from a year earlier, he noted.

That is well above a historical average of around 32%. Though Warsh didn't say so explicitly, this looks like an indication that higher energy prices are seeping into broader inflation pressures.

As for third-order impacts, at this point the blow to global bond markets from higher inflation fears must already be counted as one such ripple effect.

Central bankers can help shore up confidence through responsible tightening. Fiscal consolidation would help, too, though it is much less likely in the foreseeable future.

Until the situation in the Persian Gulf is stabilized, however, those efforts might only help at the margins. And the risk will keep rising that Bessent's spinning plates come crashing down.

—Aaron Back